

Semantic Fidelity Audit - Annotator Packet

Purpose

For each item, compare the original passage with the rewritten passage. Mark whether the rewrite preserved meaning. Do not judge author style. Do not try to identify the source author.

MCQ coding fields

Field	Choices
added_facts_0_1	0 = no added material fact; 1 = added important fact/detail/event/object/relationship
omitted_facts_0_1	0 = no important omission; 1 = omitted important fact/detail/event/object/relationship
narrative_order_change_0_1	0 = order preserved; 1 = event/reasoning/dialogue order changed
speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1	0 = preserved; 1 = who speaks/acts/relates changed
tone_drift_0_2	0 = no meaningful drift; 1 = mild drift; 2 = strong tone drift
meaning_preservation_1_5	1 = badly changed; 2 = substantial change; 3 = partly preserved; 4 = mostly preserved; 5 = very close
overall_usable_yes_no	yes = usable for controlled style experiment; no = semantic drift too severe

Item 001 / E4_001 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

Ah! It is well for the unfortunate to be resigned, but for the guilty there is no peace. The agonies of remorse poison the luxury there is otherwise sometimes found in indulging the excess of grief.

Soon after my arrival my father spoke of my immediate marriage with Elizabeth. I remained silent.

"Have you, then, some other attachment?"

"None on earth. I love Elizabeth and look forward to our union with delight. Let the day therefore be fixed; and on it I will consecrate myself, in life or death, to the happiness of my cousin."

"My dear Victor, do not speak thus. Heavy misfortunes have befallen us, but let us only cling closer to what remains and transfer our love for those whom we have lost to those who yet live. Our circle will be small but bound close by the ties of affection and mutual misfortune. And when time shall have softened your despair, new and dear objects of care will be born to replace those of whom we have been so cruelly deprived."

Such were the lessons of my father. But to me the remembrance of the threat returned; nor can you wonder that, omnipotent as the fiend had yet been in his deeds of blood, I should almost regard him as invincible, and that when he had pronounced the words "_I shall be with you on your wedding-night_", I should regard the threatened fate as unavoidable. But death was no evil to me if the loss of Elizabeth were balanced with it, and I therefore, with a contented and even cheerful countenance, agreed with my father that if my cousin would consent, the ceremony should take place in ten days, and thus put, as I imagined, the seal to my fate.

Great God! If for one instant I had thought what might be the hellish intention of my fiendish adversary, I would rather have banished myself for ever from my native country and wandered a friendless outcast over the earth than have consented to this miserable marriage. But, as if possessed of magic powers, the monster had blinded me to his real intentions; and when I thought that I had prepared only my own death, I hastened that of a far dearer victim.

As the period fixed for our marriage drew nearer, whether from cowardice or a prophetic feeling, I felt my heart sink within me. But I concealed my feelings by an appearance of hilarity that brought smiles and joy to the countenance of my father, but hardly deceived the ever-watchful and nicer eye of Elizabeth. She looked forward to our union with placid contentment, not unmingled with a little fear, which past misfortunes had impressed, that what now appeared certain and tangible happiness might soon dissipate into an airy dream and leave no trace but deep and everlasting regret.

Preparations were made for the event, congratulatory visits were received, and all wore a smiling appearance. I shut up, as well as I could, in my own heart the anxiety that preyed there and entered with seeming earnestness into the plans of my father, although they might only serve as the decorations of my tragedy. Through my father's exertions a part of the inheritance of Elizabeth had been restored to her by the Austrian government. A small possession on the shores of Como belonged to her.

Rewritten passage

Alas! While the miserable may find resignation, the wicked find no tranquility. The torments of guilt corrupt the comfort that might otherwise be discovered in surrendering to profound sorrow.

Shortly after I reached home, my father discussed my impending wedding to Elizabeth. I stayed mute.

"Do you possess some other affection?"

"None at all. I adore Elizabeth and anticipate our marriage with joy. Set the date, therefore; and upon that day, I shall dedicate my existence, for life or death, to my cousin's joy."

"My dear Victor, do not talk in such a way. Great tragedies have struck us, yet we must hold tighter to the survivors and shift our love for the

departed to those still with us. Our group will be limited but tightly knit by bonds of affection and shared suffering. Once time has dulled your grief, fresh and precious responsibilities will emerge to fill the void left by those we have so harshly lost.”

These were my father's teachings. Yet, the memory of the warning haunted me; you cannot be surprised that, given the demon's absolute power in his murderous acts, I viewed him as nearly unstoppable, and when he declared, “I shall be with you on your wedding-night,” I considered the predicted outcome inevitable. Still, death seemed no tragedy if it meant losing Elizabeth, so I agreed with a satisfied and even bright expression that if my cousin agreed, the wedding should occur in ten days, thereby, as I supposed, finalizing my destiny.

Merciful God! Had I for a moment grasped the infernal purpose of my monstrous enemy, I would have exiled myself forever from my homeland and roamed the world as a lonely wanderer rather than agreeing to this wretched union. Yet, as if wielding sorcery, the creature had obscured his true designs from me; and while I believed I was merely arranging my own demise, I was accelerating the death of a much more precious victim.

As the date for our marriage approached, whether from fear or a sense of foreboding, my spirit faltered. I hid my emotions behind a facade of cheerfulness that delighted my father, though it barely fooled the observant and sensitive gaze of Elizabeth. She anticipated our marriage with calm satisfaction, tempered by a slight anxiety, born of past tragedies, that this seemingly certain happiness might vanish like a phantom, leaving behind only profound and eternal sorrow.

Arrangements for the ceremony were underway, well-wishers visited, and everything appeared joyful. I buried the dread consuming me deep within and participated with apparent sincerity in my father's schemes, even though they might only function as the stage dressing for my own ruin. Through my father's efforts, a portion of Elizabeth's legacy had been returned to her by the Austrian authorities. A modest estate on the banks of Lake Como was now hers.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 002 / E4_002 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

"I think you are wrong, Basil, but I won't argue with you. It is only the intellectually lost who ever argue. Tell me, is Dorian Gray very fond of you?"

The painter considered for a few moments. "He likes me," he answered after a pause; "I know he likes me. Of course I flatter him dreadfully. I find a strange pleasure in saying things to him that I know I shall be sorry for having said. As a rule, he is charming to me, and we sit in the studio and talk of a thousand things. Now and then, however, he is horribly thoughtless, and seems to take a real delight in giving me pain. Then I feel, Harry, that I have given away my whole soul to some one who treats it as if it were a flower to put in his coat, a bit of decoration to charm his vanity, an ornament for a summer's day."

"Days in summer, Basil, are apt to linger," murmured Lord Henry. "Perhaps you will tire sooner than he will. It is a sad thing to think of, but there is no doubt that genius lasts longer than beauty. That accounts for the fact that we all take such pains to over-educate ourselves. In the wild struggle for existence, we want to have something that endures, and so we fill our minds with rubbish and facts, in the silly hope of keeping our place. The thoroughly well-informed man—that is the modern ideal. And the mind of the thoroughly well-informed man is a dreadful thing. It is like a bric-à-brac shop, all monsters and dust, with everything priced above its proper value. I think you will tire first, all the same. Some day you will look at your friend, and he will seem to you to be a little out of drawing, or you won't like his tone of colour, or something. You will bitterly reproach him in your own heart, and seriously think that he has behaved very badly to you. The next time he calls, you will be perfectly cold and indifferent. It will be a great pity, for it will alter you. What you have told me is quite a romance, a romance of art one might call it, and the worst of having a romance of any kind is that it leaves one so unromantic."

"Harry, don't talk like that. As long as I live, the personality of Dorian Gray will dominate me. You can't feel what I feel. You change too often."

"Ah, my dear Basil, that is exactly why I can feel it. Those who are faithful know only the trivial side of love: it is the faithless who know love's tragedies." And Lord Henry struck a light on a dainty silver case and began to smoke a cigarette with a self-conscious and satisfied air, as if he had summed up the world in a phrase. There was a rustle of chirruping sparrows in the green lacquer leaves of the ivy, and the blue cloud-shadows chased themselves across the grass like swallows. How pleasant it was in the garden! And how delightful other people's emotions were!—much more delightful than their ideas, it seemed to him. One's own soul, and the passions of one's friends—those were the fascinating things in life.

Rewritten passage

"I believe you are mistaken, Basil, though I shall not debate it. Only those who have lost their intellectual way ever engage in arguments. Tell me, does Dorian Gray hold you in high regard?"

The artist pondered for a brief interval. "He is fond of me," he replied eventually; "I am certain of it. Naturally, I offer him excessive flattery. I derive a peculiar satisfaction from uttering remarks to him that I know I will later regret. Generally, he is delightful toward me, and we remain in the studio discussing countless topics. Occasionally, however, he is dreadfully inconsiderate and appears to find genuine joy in causing me distress. At those moments, Harry, I feel as though I have surrendered my entire spirit to someone who views it merely as a blossom for his lapel, a trivial adornment to flatter his ego, or a seasonal decoration."

"Summer days have a tendency to drag on," Lord Henry whispered. "Perhaps you will grow weary before he does. It is a melancholy thought, yet there is no question that talent outlives physical beauty. That explains why we exert such effort to over-educate ourselves. In the fierce competition for survival, we desire something permanent, so we clutter our intellects with useless trivia and data, foolishly hoping to maintain our standing. The perfectly informed individual is the modern ideal. Yet, the mind of such a person is a terrifying thing. It resembles a shop filled with curiosities, cluttered with dust and grotesque items, each marked with an inflated price. Regardless, I suspect you will be the first to tire. One day you will observe your friend and find him slightly distorted, or perhaps you will dislike his complexion or some other detail. You will harbor bitter resentment toward him and conclude that he has treated you poorly. When he visits next, you will be entirely detached and aloof. It would be a great shame, as it would change you. Your account is quite a romance—a romance of art, perhaps—and the misfortune of any romance is that it leaves one feeling so unromantic."

“Harry, cease speaking in that manner. As long as I draw breath, Dorian Gray’s personality will hold sway over me. You cannot comprehend my feelings. You shift your allegiances too frequently.”

“Ah, my dear Basil, that is precisely why I understand it so well. Those who remain loyal perceive only the superficial aspects of love; it is the unfaithful who truly grasp love’s tragedies.” Lord Henry ignited a match against a delicate silver container and commenced smoking a cigarette with a self-assured, content expression, as if he had encapsulated the entire world in a single statement. A rustling sound came from sparrows chirping within the ivy’s green, lacquered foliage, and blue shadows from the clouds raced across the lawn like swallows. The garden was truly pleasant. And how charming the emotions of others were—far more captivating than their opinions, he reflected. One’s own soul and the passions of one’s companions—these were the truly enthralling elements of existence.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes:

Item 003 / E4_003 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

The appearance of the ocean, in the space between the more distant island and the shore, had something very unusual about it. Although, at the time, so strong a gale was blowing landward that a brig in the remote offing lay to under a double-reefed trysail, and constantly plunged her whole hull out of sight, still there was here nothing like a regular swell, but only a short, quick, angry cross dashing of water in every direction—as well in the teeth of the wind as otherwise. Of foam there was little except in the immediate vicinity of the rocks.

“The island in the distance,” resumed the old man, “is called by the Norwegians Vurrgh. The one midway is Moskoe. That a mile to the northward is Ambaaren. Yonder are Islesen, Hotholm, Keildhelm, Suarven, and Buckholm. Farther off—between Moskoe and Vurrgh—are Otterholm, Flimen, Sandflesen, and Stockholm. These are the true names of the places—but why it has been thought necessary to name them at all, is more than either you or I can understand. Do you hear anything? Do you see any change in the water?”

We had now been about ten minutes upon the top of Helseggen, to which we had ascended from the interior of Lofoden, so that we had caught no glimpse of the sea until it had burst upon us from the summit. As the old man spoke, I became aware of a loud and gradually increasing sound, like the moaning of a vast herd of buffaloes upon an American prairie; and at the same moment I perceived that what seamen term the chopping character of the ocean beneath us, was rapidly changing into a current which set to the eastward. Even while I gazed, this current acquired a monstrous velocity. Each moment added to its speed—to its headlong impetuosity. In five minutes the whole sea, as far as Vurrgh, was lashed into ungovernable fury; but it was between Moskoe and the coast that the main uproar held its sway. Here the vast bed of the waters, seamed and scarred into a thousand conflicting channels, burst suddenly into phrensied convulsion—heaving, boiling, hissing—gyrating in gigantic and innumerable vortices, and all whirling and plunging on to the eastward with a rapidity which water never elsewhere assumes except in precipitous descents.

In a few minutes more, there came over the scene another radical alteration. The general surface grew somewhat more smooth, and the whirlpools, one by one, disappeared, while prodigious streaks of foam became apparent where none had been seen before. These streaks, at length, spreading out to a great distance, and entering into combination, took unto themselves the gyratory motion of the subsided vortices, and seemed to form the germ of another more vast. Suddenly—very suddenly—this assumed a distinct and definite existence, in a circle of more than a mile in diameter. The edge of the whirl was represented by a broad belt of gleaming spray; but no particle of this slipped into the mouth of the terrific funnel, whose interior, as far as the eye could fathom it, was a smooth, shining, and jet-black wall of water, inclined to the horizon at an angle of some forty-five degrees, speeding dizzily round and round with a swaying and sweltering motion, and sending forth to the winds an appalling voice, half shriek, half roar, such as not even the mighty cataract of Niagara ever lifts up in its agony to Heaven.

Rewritten passage

The sea, situated between the far-off island and the coast, possessed a highly peculiar quality. Even though a powerful gale was pushing toward the land at that moment—forcing a brig in the far distance to heave to under a double-reefed trysail, where it repeatedly vanished from view—there was no sign of a standard swell here. Instead, there was merely a brief, sharp, and turbulent clashing of water moving in every direction, regardless of the wind's orientation. Aside from the area right by the cliffs, there was very little foam.

“The Norwegians refer to that distant island as Vurrgh,” the elderly man continued. “The one in the middle is Moskoe. The island a mile to the north is Ambaaren. Over there are Islesen, Hotholm, Keildhelm, Suarven, and Buckholm. Further away, located between Moskoe and Vurrgh, are Otterholm, Flimen, Sandflesen, and Stockholm. Those are the actual names of these locations, though why anyone felt the need to name them at all is beyond both of our understandings. Do you perceive any sound? Do you notice any shift in the water?”

We had spent roughly ten minutes atop Helseggen, having climbed there from the inland part of Lofoden, meaning we had not seen the ocean until it suddenly appeared before us at the peak. As the man spoke, I began to hear a loud, steadily intensifying noise, reminiscent of the lowing of a massive herd of buffalo on an American prairie. Simultaneously, I noticed that the choppy nature of the ocean below us was quickly transforming into a current flowing toward the east. As I watched, this current gained incredible speed, its momentum growing more reckless with every passing second. Within five minutes, the entire sea, stretching as far as Vurrgh, was whipped into an uncontrollable rage; however, the primary disturbance was concentrated between Moskoe and the shore. There, the immense expanse of water, divided into countless clashing channels, erupted into a frantic state—heaving, boiling, hissing, and spinning into massive, countless whirlpools, all rushing eastward with a swiftness rarely seen in water unless it is falling down a steep cliff.

After a few more minutes, the scene underwent another drastic transformation. The overall surface became somewhat calmer, and the whirlpools vanished one by one, while massive lines of foam emerged where there had previously been none. Eventually, these streaks expanded over a wide area, merged together, adopted the spinning motion of the vanished vortices, and appeared to create the foundation for a much larger one. All at once, this formation took on a clear and precise shape, spanning a circle over a mile wide. The perimeter of the vortex was marked by a wide band of bright spray, yet not a single drop fell into the opening of the terrifying funnel. Its interior, as deep as the eye could see, consisted of a smooth, glistening, jet-black wall of water, tilted at a forty-five-degree angle to the horizon, spinning dizzily with a swaying, churning motion, and emitting a horrifying sound—part shriek, part roar—that even the great Niagara Falls never produces in its own desperate struggle toward the sky.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 004 / E4_004 / condition: simplify

Original passage

Dorian smiled and shook his head: "I am afraid I don't think so, Lady Henry. I never talk during music—at least, during good music. If one hears bad music, it is one's duty to drown it in conversation."

"Ah! that is one of Harry's views, isn't it, Mr. Gray? I always hear Harry's views from his friends. It is the only way I get to know of them. But you must not think I don't like good music. I adore it, but I am afraid of it. It makes me too romantic. I have simply worshipped pianists—two at a time, sometimes, Harry tells me. I don't know what it is about them. Perhaps it is that they are foreigners. They all are, ain't they? Even those that are born in England become foreigners after a time, don't they? It is so clever of them, and such a compliment to art. Makes it quite cosmopolitan, doesn't it? You have never been to any of my parties, have you, Mr. Gray? You must come. I can't afford orchids, but I spare no expense in foreigners. They make one's rooms look so picturesque. But here is Harry! Harry, I came in to look for you, to ask you something—I forget what it was—and I found Mr. Gray here. We have had such a pleasant chat about music. We have quite the same ideas. No; I think our ideas are quite different. But he has been most pleasant. I am so glad I've seen him."

"I am charmed, my love, quite charmed," said Lord Henry, elevating his dark, crescent-shaped eyebrows and looking at them both with an amused smile. "So sorry I am late, Dorian. I went to look after a piece of old brocade in Wardour Street and had to bargain for hours for it. Nowadays people know the price of everything and the value of nothing."

"I am afraid I must be going," exclaimed Lady Henry, breaking an awkward silence with her silly sudden laugh. "I have promised to drive with the duchess. Good-bye, Mr. Gray. Good-bye, Harry. You are dining out, I suppose? So am I. Perhaps I shall see you at Lady Thornbury's."

"I dare say, my dear," said Lord Henry, shutting the door behind her as, looking like a bird of paradise that had been out all night in the rain, she flitted out of the room, leaving a faint odour of frangipanni. Then he lit a cigarette and flung himself down on the sofa.

"Never marry a woman with straw-coloured hair, Dorian," he said after a few puffs.

"Why, Harry?"

"Because they are so sentimental."

"But I like sentimental people."

"Never marry at all, Dorian. Men marry because they are tired; women, because they are curious: both are disappointed."

"I don't think I am likely to marry, Harry. I am too much in love. That is one of your aphorisms. I am putting it into practice, as I do everything that you say."

"Who are you in love with?" asked Lord Henry after a pause.

"With an actress," said Dorian Gray, blushing.

Lord Henry shrugged his shoulders. "That is a rather commonplace _début_."

"You would not say so if you saw her, Harry."

"Who is she?"

"Her name is Sibyl Vane."

"Never heard of her."

Rewritten passage

Dorian smiled and shook his head. "I am afraid I don't think so, Lady Henry. I never talk during music—at least, not during good music. If one hears bad music, it is one's duty to drown it out with conversation."

"Ah! That is one of Harry's opinions, isn't it, Mr. Gray? I always hear Harry's views from his friends. It is the only way I ever learn what they are. But you must not think I don't like good music. I adore it, but I am afraid of it. It makes me too romantic. I have simply worshipped pianists—sometimes two at a time, Harry tells me. I don't know what it is about them. Perhaps it is that they are foreigners. They all are, aren't they? Even those born in England become foreigners after a time, don't they? It is so clever of them, and such a compliment to art. It makes it quite international, doesn't it? You have never been to any of my parties, have you, Mr. Gray? You must come. I cannot afford orchids, but I spare no expense on foreigners. They make one's rooms look so picturesque. But here is Harry! Harry, I came in to look for you to ask you something—I forget what it was—and I found Mr. Gray here. We have had such a pleasant chat about music. We have exactly the same ideas. No, I think our ideas are quite different. But he has been most pleasant. I am so glad I have seen him."

"I am charmed, my love, quite charmed," said Lord Henry, raising his dark, crescent-shaped eyebrows and looking at them both with an amused smile. "I am so sorry I am late, Dorian. I went to look for a piece of old brocade in Wardour Street and had to bargain for hours for it. Nowadays, people know the price of everything and the value of nothing."

"I am afraid I must be going," exclaimed Lady Henry, breaking an awkward silence with her silly, sudden laugh. "I have promised to drive with the duchess. Goodbye, Mr. Gray. Goodbye, Harry. You are dining out, I suppose? So am I. Perhaps I shall see you at Lady Thornbury's."

"I expect so, my dear," said Lord Henry, shutting the door behind her as she flitted out of the room, looking like a bird of paradise that had been out all night in the rain, leaving behind a faint scent of frangipani. Then he lit a cigarette and threw himself down on the sofa.

"Never marry a woman with straw-colored hair, Dorian," he said after a few puffs.

"Why, Harry?"

"Because they are so sentimental."

"But I like sentimental people."

"Never marry at all, Dorian. Men marry because they are tired; women, because they are curious: both are disappointed."

"I don't think I am likely to marry, Harry. I am too much in love. That is one of your aphorisms. I am putting it into practice, just as I do everything you say."

"Who are you in love with?" asked Lord Henry after a pause.

"With an actress," said Dorian Gray, blushing.

Lord Henry shrugged his shoulders. "That is a rather commonplace beginning."

"You would not say so if you saw her, Harry."

"Who is she?"

"Her name is Sibyl Vane."

"Never heard of her."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 005 / E4_005 / condition: simplify

Original passage

I was inclined, however, to the latter opinion. The rim of ice to the northward was growing more and more apparent. Cold by no means so intense. Nothing of importance occurred, and I passed the day in reading, having taken care to supply myself with books.

“April 5th. Beheld the singular phenomenon of the sun rising while nearly the whole visible surface of the earth continued to be involved in darkness. In time, however, the light spread itself over all, and I again saw the line of ice to the northward. It was now very distinct, and appeared of a much darker hue than the waters of the ocean. I was evidently approaching it, and with great rapidity. Fancied I could again distinguish a strip of land to the eastward, and one also to the westward, but could not be certain. Weather moderate. Nothing of any consequence happened during the day. Went early to bed.

“April 6th. Was surprised at finding the rim of ice at a very moderate distance, and an immense field of the same material stretching away off to the horizon in the north. It was evident that if the balloon held its present course, it would soon arrive above the Frozen Ocean, and I had now little doubt of ultimately seeing the Pole. During the whole of the day I continued to near the ice. Toward night the limits of my horizon very suddenly and materially increased, owing undoubtedly to the earth's form being that of an oblate spheroid, and my arriving above the flattened regions in the vicinity of the Arctic circle. When darkness at length overtook me, I went to bed in great anxiety, fearing to pass over the object of so much curiosity when I should have no opportunity of observing it.

“April 7th. Arose early, and, to my great joy, at length beheld what there could be no hesitation in supposing the northern Pole itself. It was there, beyond a doubt, and immediately beneath my feet; but, alas! I had now ascended to so vast a distance, that nothing could with accuracy be discerned. Indeed, to judge from the progression of the numbers indicating my various altitudes, respectively, at different periods, between six A.M. on the second of April, and twenty minutes before nine A.M. of the same day (at which time the barometer ran down), it might be fairly inferred that the balloon had now, at four o'clock in the morning of April the seventh, reached a height of not less, certainly, than 7,254 miles above the surface of the sea. This elevation may appear immense, but the estimate upon which it is calculated gave a result in all probability far inferior to the truth. At all events I undoubtedly beheld the whole of the earth's major diameter; the entire northern hemisphere lay beneath me like a chart orthographically projected: and the great circle of the equator itself formed the boundary line of my horizon. Your Excellencies may, however, readily imagine that the confined regions hitherto unexplored within the limits of the Arctic circle, although situated directly beneath me, and therefore seen without any appearance of being foreshortened, were still, in themselves, comparatively too diminutive, and at too great a distance from the point of sight, to admit of any very accurate examination.

Rewritten passage

I leaned, however, toward the latter opinion. The ice rim to the north was becoming increasingly visible. The cold was by no means as intense. Nothing of importance occurred, and I spent the day reading, having made sure to bring plenty of books with me.

“April 5th. I witnessed the strange phenomenon of the sun rising while nearly the entire visible surface of the earth remained in darkness. Eventually, however, the light spread over everything, and I again saw the line of ice to the north. It was now very clear and appeared much darker than the ocean water. I was clearly approaching it quite rapidly. I imagined I could again distinguish a strip of land to the east and another to the west, but I could not be certain. The weather was moderate. Nothing of any consequence happened during the day. I went to bed early.

“April 6th. I was surprised to find the ice rim at a very moderate distance, with an immense field of the same material stretching away toward the northern horizon. It was clear that if the balloon kept its current course, it would soon arrive above the Frozen Ocean, and I now had little

doubt that I would eventually see the Pole. Throughout the day, I continued to draw closer to the ice. Toward night, my horizon suddenly and significantly expanded, undoubtedly because the earth is shaped like an oblate spheroid and I was arriving above the flattened regions near the Arctic Circle. When darkness finally overtook me, I went to bed in great anxiety, fearing I might pass over the object of my curiosity without having the chance to observe it.

“April 7th. I rose early and, to my great joy, finally beheld what I had no hesitation in assuming was the North Pole itself. It was there, without a doubt, directly beneath my feet; but, alas! I had ascended to such a vast distance that nothing could be discerned with accuracy. Indeed, judging from the progression of the numbers indicating my various altitudes at different times between 6:00 A.M. on April 2nd and 8:40 A.M. that same day (when the barometer stopped), it could be fairly inferred that the balloon had now, at 4:00 A.M. on April 7th, reached a height of certainly no less than 7,254 miles above the sea. This elevation may seem immense, but the estimate used to calculate it was, in all probability, far lower than the truth. At any rate, I undoubtedly beheld the earth’s entire major diameter; the whole northern hemisphere lay beneath me like a map projected orthographically, and the great circle of the equator formed the boundary of my horizon. Your Excellencies may, however, readily imagine that the confined regions within the Arctic Circle that remain unexplored, although situated directly beneath me and therefore seen without any foreshortening, were still, in themselves, too small and too far from my viewpoint to allow for any very accurate examination.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 006 / E4_006 / condition: simplify

Original passage

Turning towards the men,
he said,

“What do you mean? What do you demand of your captain? Are you, then, so easily turned from your design? Did you not call this a glorious expedition? “And wherefore was it glorious? Not because the way was smooth and placid as a southern sea, but because it was full of dangers and terror, because at every new incident your fortitude was to be called forth and your courage exhibited, because danger and death surrounded it, and these you were to brave and overcome. For this was it a glorious, for this was it an honourable undertaking. You were hereafter to be hailed as the benefactors of your species, your names adored as belonging to brave men who encountered death for honour and the benefit of mankind. And now, behold, with the first imagination of danger, or, if you will, the first mighty and terrific trial of your courage, you shrink away and are content to be handed down as men who had not strength enough to endure cold and peril; and so, poor souls, they were chilly and returned to their warm firesides. Why, that requires not this preparation; ye need not have come thus far and dragged your captain to the shame of a defeat merely to prove yourselves cowards. Oh! Be men, or be more than men. Be steady to your purposes and firm as a rock. This ice is not made of such stuff as your hearts may be; it is mutable and cannot withstand you if you say that it shall not. Do not return to your families with the stigma of disgrace marked on your brows. Return as heroes who have fought and conquered and who know not what it is to turn their backs on the foe.”

He spoke this with a voice so modulated to the different feelings expressed in his speech, with an eye so full of lofty design and heroism, that can you wonder that these men were moved? They looked at one another and were unable to reply. I spoke; I told them to retire and consider of what had been said, that I would not lead them farther north if they strenuously desired the contrary, but that I hoped that, with reflection, their courage would return.

They retired and I turned towards my friend, but he was sunk in languor and almost deprived of life.

How all this will terminate, I know not, but I had rather die than return shamefully, my purpose unfulfilled. Yet I fear such will be my fate; the men, unsupported by ideas of glory and honour, can never willingly continue to endure their present hardships.

September 7th.

The die is cast; I have consented to return if we are not destroyed. Thus are my hopes blasted by cowardice and indecision; I come back ignorant and disappointed. It requires more philosophy than I possess to bear this injustice with patience.

September 12th.

It is past; I am returning to England. I have lost my hopes of utility and glory; I have lost my friend. But I will endeavour to detail these bitter circumstances to you, my dear sister; and while I am wafted towards England and towards you, I will not despond.

September 9th, the ice began to move, and roarings like thunder were heard at a distance as the islands split and cracked in every direction.

Rewritten passage

Turning toward the men, he said, “What do you mean? What do you demand of your captain? Are you so easily turned from your goal? Did you not call this a glorious expedition? And why was it glorious? Not because the path was smooth and calm like a southern sea, but because it was full of danger and terror. It was glorious because your strength and courage were to be tested at every turn, because you were to face and overcome danger and death. For this reason, it was an honorable undertaking. You were to be hailed as benefactors of humanity, your names adored as brave men who faced death for honor and the benefit of mankind. And now, at the first thought of danger, or perhaps the first real test of your courage, you shrink away. You are content to be remembered as men who lacked the strength to endure cold and peril; poor souls, they were cold and returned to their warm firesides. That does not require this much preparation; you did not need

to come this far and drag your captain into the shame of defeat just to prove yourselves cowards. Oh, be men, or be more than men. Be steady in your purpose and firm as a rock. This ice is not as hard as your hearts should be; it is changeable and cannot withstand you if you decide it shall not. Do not return to your families marked with the stigma of disgrace. Return as heroes who have fought and conquered, and who do not know how to turn their backs on the enemy."

He spoke with a voice so perfectly matched to the emotions of his speech, and with eyes so full of noble purpose and heroism, that it is no wonder the men were moved. They looked at one another, unable to reply. I spoke; I told them to withdraw and consider what had been said. I told them I would not lead them further north if they strongly desired otherwise, but that I hoped their courage would return upon reflection.

They retired, and I turned toward my friend, but he was exhausted and appeared nearly lifeless.

How this will end, I do not know, but I would rather die than return in shame with my goal unfulfilled. Yet I fear that will be my fate; the men, lacking any sense of glory or honor, cannot willingly continue to endure their current hardships.

September 7th.

The decision is made; I have agreed to return if we are not destroyed. My hopes are ruined by cowardice and indecision; I return ignorant and disappointed. It requires more philosophy than I possess to bear this injustice with patience.

September 12th.

It is over; I am returning to England. I have lost my hopes of being useful and achieving glory; I have lost my friend. But I will try to describe these bitter circumstances to you, my dear sister; and while I am carried toward England and toward you, I will not lose hope.

September 9th, the ice began to move, and thunderous roars were heard in the distance as the ice floes split and cracked in every direction.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 007 / E4_007 / condition: simplify

Original passage

The sergeant tossed off his glass again and seemed quite ready for another glass. I noticed that Mr. Pumblechook in his hospitality appeared to forget that he had made a present of the wine, but took the bottle from Mrs. Joe and had all the credit of handing it about in a gush of joviality. Even I got some. And he was so very free of the wine that he even called for the other bottle, and handed that about with the same liberality, when the first was gone.

As I watched them while they all stood clustering about the forge, enjoying themselves so much, I thought what terrible good sauce for a dinner my fugitive friend on the marshes was. They had not enjoyed themselves a quarter so much, before the entertainment was brightened with the excitement he furnished. And now, when they were all in lively anticipation of "the two villains" being taken, and when the bellows seemed to roar for the fugitives, the fire to flare for them, the smoke to hurry away in pursuit of them, Joe to hammer and clink for them, and all the murky shadows on the wall to shake at them in menace as the blaze rose and sank, and the red-hot sparks dropped and died, the pale afternoon outside almost seemed in my pitying young fancy to have turned pale on their account, poor wretches.

At last, Joe's job was done, and the ringing and roaring stopped. As Joe got on his coat, he mustered courage to propose that some of us should go down with the soldiers and see what came of the hunt. Mr. Pumblechook and Mr. Hubble declined, on the plea of a pipe and ladies' society; but Mr. Wopsle said he would go, if Joe would. Joe said he was agreeable, and would take me, if Mrs. Joe approved. We never should have got leave to go, I am sure, but for Mrs. Joe's curiosity to know all about it and how it ended. As it was, she merely stipulated, "If you bring the boy back with his head blown to bits by a musket, don't look to me to put it together again."

The sergeant took a polite leave of the ladies, and parted from Mr. Pumblechook as from a comrade; though I doubt if he were quite as fully sensible of that gentleman's merits under arid conditions, as when something moist was going. His men resumed their muskets and fell in. Mr. Wopsle, Joe, and I, received strict charge to keep in the rear, and to speak no word after we reached the marshes. When we were all out in the raw air and were steadily moving towards our business, I treasonably whispered to Joe, "I hope, Joe, we shan't find them." and Joe whispered to me, "I'd give a shilling if they had cut and run, Pip."

We were joined by no stragglers from the village, for the weather was cold and threatening, the way dreary, the footing bad, darkness coming on, and the people had good fires in-doors and were keeping the day. A few faces hurried to glowing windows and looked after us, but none came out. We passed the finger-post, and held straight on to the churchyard. There we were stopped a few minutes by a signal from the sergeant's hand, while two or three of his men dispersed themselves among the graves, and also examined the porch.

Rewritten passage

The sergeant finished his glass again and appeared eager for another. I noticed that Mr. Pumblechook, in his hospitality, seemed to forget that he had not actually provided the wine; instead, he took the bottle from Mrs. Joe and acted as if he were generously sharing it himself. Even I received some. He was so free with the wine that he even called for the second bottle and handed it around with the same generosity once the first was empty.

As I watched them gathered around the forge, enjoying themselves, I thought about how my fugitive friend on the marshes had provided a terrible but effective spice for their dinner. They had not enjoyed themselves nearly as much before the excitement he brought to the evening. Now, as they eagerly anticipated the capture of the two villains, the bellows seemed to roar for the fugitives, the fire flared for them, the smoke hurried away to pursue them, Joe hammered and clinked for them, and the dark shadows on the wall seemed to threaten them as the flames rose and fell and the red-hot sparks died out. In my young, sympathetic imagination, even the pale afternoon outside seemed to have turned pale on their account, poor wretches.

Finally, Joe finished his work, and the ringing and roaring stopped. As Joe put on his coat, he gathered the courage to suggest that some of us should go with the soldiers to see the outcome of the hunt. Mr. Pumblechook and Mr. Hubble declined, citing a desire for a pipe and the company of the ladies, but Mr. Wopsle said he would go if Joe did. Joe agreed and said he would take me, provided Mrs. Joe approved. I am certain we never would have received permission to go if not for Mrs. Joe's own curiosity about how it would end. As it was, she only

stipulated, "If you bring the boy back with his head blown to bits by a musket, don't expect me to put it back together."

The sergeant politely said goodbye to the ladies and parted from Mr. Pumblechook as if they were comrades, though I doubt he appreciated that gentleman's qualities as much when there was nothing to drink as he did when the wine was flowing. His men picked up their muskets and lined up. Mr. Wopsle, Joe, and I were strictly ordered to stay in the back and to remain silent once we reached the marshes. When we were out in the cold air and moving steadily toward our destination, I whispered treasonably to Joe, "I hope, Joe, we don't find them." Joe whispered back, "I'd give a shilling if they had escaped, Pip."

No one from the village joined us, as the weather was cold and threatening, the path was dreary, the ground was difficult, darkness was falling, and the people were staying inside by their fires to celebrate the holiday. A few faces hurried to glowing windows to watch us pass, but no one came out. We passed the signpost and headed straight for the churchyard. There, we were stopped for a few minutes by a signal from the sergeant's hand while two or three of his men spread out among the graves and searched the porch.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes:

Item 008 / E4_008 / condition: modernize

Original passage

"Stop thief! Stop thief!" There is a magic in the sound. The tradesman leaves his counter, and the car-man his waggon; the butcher throws down his tray; the baker his basket; the milkman his pail; the errand-boy his parcels; the school-boy his marbles; the paviour his pickaxe; the child his battledore. Away they run, pell-mell, helter-skelter, slap-dash: tearing, yelling, screaming, knocking down the passengers as they turn the corners, rousing up the dogs, and astonishing the fowls: and streets, squares, and courts, re-echo with the sound.

"Stop thief! Stop thief!" The cry is taken up by a hundred voices, and the crowd accumulate at every turning. Away they fly, splashing through the mud, and rattling along the pavements: up go the windows, out run the people, onward bear the mob, a whole audience desert Punch in the very thickest of the plot, and, joining the rushing throng, swell the shout, and lend fresh vigour to the cry, "Stop thief! Stop thief!"

"Stop thief! Stop thief!" There is a passion _for hunting something_ deeply implanted in the human breast. One wretched breathless child, panting with exhaustion; terror in his looks; agony in his eyes; large drops of perspiration streaming down his face; strains every nerve to make head upon his pursuers; and as they follow on his track, and gain upon him every instant, they hail his decreasing strength with joy. "Stop thief!" Ay, stop him for God's sake, were it only in mercy!

Stopped at last! A clever blow. He is down upon the pavement; and the crowd eagerly gather round him: each new comer, jostling and struggling with the others to catch a glimpse. "Stand aside!" "Give him a little air!" "Nonsense! he don't deserve it." "Where's the gentleman?" "Here he is, coming down the street." "Make room there for the gentleman!" "Is this the boy, sir?" "Yes."

Oliver lay, covered with mud and dust, and bleeding from the mouth, looking wildly round upon the heap of faces that surrounded him, when the old gentleman was officiously dragged and pushed into the circle by the foremost of the pursuers.

"Yes," said the gentleman, "I am afraid it is the boy."

"Afraid!" murmured the crowd. "That's a good 'un!"

"Poor fellow!" said the gentleman, "he has hurt himself."

"_I_ did that, sir," said a great lubberly fellow, stepping forward; "and precious I cut my knuckle agin' his mouth. _I_ stopped him, sir."

The fellow touched his hat with a grin, expecting something for his pains; but, the old gentleman, eyeing him with an expression of dislike, look anxiously round, as if he contemplated running away himself: which it is very possible he might have attempted to do, and thus have afforded another chase, had not a police officer (who is generally the last person to arrive in such cases) at that moment made his way through the crowd, and seized Oliver by the collar.

"Come, get up," said the man, roughly.

"It wasn't me indeed, sir. Indeed, indeed, it was two other boys," said Oliver, clasping his hands passionately, and looking round. "They are here somewhere."

"Oh no, they ain't," said the officer. He meant this to be ironical, but it was true besides; for the Dodger and Charley Bates had filed off down the first convenient court they came to.

Rewritten passage

"Stop thief! Stop thief!" There is a magic in the sound. The shopkeeper leaves his counter, and the driver his truck; the butcher drops his tray; the baker his basket; the milkman his pail; the delivery boy his packages; the schoolboy his marbles; the construction worker his pickaxe; the child his toy. Away they run, pell-mell, helter-skelter, slap-dash: tearing, yelling, screaming, knocking down pedestrians as they turn the corners, rousing the dogs, and startling the chickens: and streets, squares, and alleys echo with the sound.

"Stop thief! Stop thief!" The cry is taken up by a hundred voices, and the crowd grows at every turn. Away they fly, splashing through the mud, and clattering along the pavement: windows fly open, people run out, the mob surges forward, a whole audience abandons a street performance at the very peak of the show, and, joining the rushing throng, they swell the shout, and lend fresh energy to the cry, "Stop thief! Stop thief!"

"Stop thief! Stop thief!" There is a passion for hunting something deeply implanted in the human heart. One wretched, breathless child, panting with exhaustion; terror in his expression; agony in his eyes; large drops of sweat streaming down his face; strains every nerve to pull ahead of his pursuers; and as they follow his trail, gaining on him every instant, they greet his failing strength with joy. "Stop thief!" Yes, stop him for God's sake, if only out of mercy!

Stopped at last! A well-placed blow. He is down on the pavement; and the crowd eagerly gathers around him: each new arrival jostling and struggling with the others to catch a glimpse. "Stand aside!" "Give him some air!" "Nonsense! He doesn't deserve it." "Where's the gentleman?" "Here he is, coming down the street." "Make room there for the gentleman!" "Is this the boy, sir?" "Yes."

Oliver lay, covered in mud and dust, and bleeding from the mouth, looking wildly around at the mass of faces surrounding him, when the old gentleman was officiously dragged and pushed into the circle by the foremost of the pursuers.

"Yes," said the gentleman, "I am afraid it is the boy."

"Afraid!" murmured the crowd. "That's a good one!"

"Poor fellow!" said the gentleman, "he has hurt himself."

"I did that, sir," said a large, clumsy fellow, stepping forward; "and I cut my knuckle pretty badly against his mouth. I stopped him, sir."

The fellow touched his hat with a grin, expecting a reward for his efforts; but the old gentleman, eyeing him with an expression of dislike, looked anxiously around, as if he were considering running away himself: which it is very possible he might have attempted, and thus have triggered another chase, had not a police officer (who is generally the last person to arrive in such cases) at that moment made his way through the crowd and seized Oliver by the collar.

"Come, get up," said the man, roughly.

"It wasn't me, truly, sir. Truly, truly, it was two other boys," said Oliver, clasping his hands passionately, and looking around. "They are here somewhere."

"Oh no, they aren't," said the officer. He meant this to be sarcastic, but it was true as well; for the Dodger and Charley Bates had slipped away down the first convenient alley they came to.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 009 / E4_009 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

Evil thenceforth became my good. Urged thus far, I had no choice but to adapt my nature to an element which I had willingly chosen. The completion of my demoniacal design became an insatiable passion. And now it is ended; there is my last victim!"

I was at first touched by the expressions of his misery; yet, when I called to mind what Frankenstein had said of his powers of eloquence and persuasion, and when I again cast my eyes on the lifeless form of my friend, indignation was rekindled within me. "Wretch!" I said.

"It is well that you come here to whine over the desolation that you have made. You throw a torch into a pile of buildings, and when they are consumed, you sit among the ruins and lament the fall. Hypocritical fiend! If he whom you mourn still lived, still would he be the object, again would he become the prey, of your accursed vengeance. It is not pity that you feel; you lament only because the victim of your malignity is withdrawn from your power."

"Oh, it is not thus—not thus," interrupted the being.

"Yet such must be the impression conveyed to you by what appears to be the purport of my actions. Yet I seek not a fellow feeling in my misery. No sympathy may I ever find. When I first sought it, it was the love of virtue, the feelings of happiness and affection with which my whole being overflowed, that I wished to be participated. But now that virtue has become to me a shadow, and that happiness and affection are turned into bitter and loathing despair, in what should I seek for sympathy? I am content to suffer alone while my sufferings shall endure; when I die, I am well satisfied that abhorrence and opprobrium should load my memory. Once my fancy was soothed with dreams of virtue, of fame, and of enjoyment. Once I falsely hoped to meet with beings who, pardoning my outward form, would love me for the excellent qualities which I was capable of unfolding. I was nourished with high thoughts of honour and devotion. But now crime has degraded me beneath the meanest animal. No guilt, no mischief, no malignity, no misery, can be found comparable to mine. When I run over the frightful catalogue of my sins, I cannot believe that I am the same creature whose thoughts were once filled with sublime and transcendent visions of the beauty and the majesty of goodness. But it is even so; the fallen angel becomes a malignant devil. Yet even that enemy of God and man had friends and associates in his desolation; I am alone.

"You, who call Frankenstein your friend, seem to have a knowledge of my crimes and his misfortunes. But in the detail which he gave you of them he could not sum up the hours and months of misery which I endured wasting in impotent passions. For while I destroyed his hopes, I did not satisfy my own desires. They were for ever ardent and craving; still I desired love and fellowship, and I was still spurned. Was there no injustice in this? Am I to be thought the only criminal, when all humankind sinned against me? Why do you not hate Felix, who drove his friend from his door with contumely?"

Rewritten passage

From that point on, wickedness served as my virtue. Driven to this extreme, I had no alternative but to align my character with the path I had voluntarily taken. Finishing my devilish plan turned into an unquenchable obsession. And now it is finished; there lies my final victim!"

Initially, I felt moved by his displays of sorrow; however, remembering Frankenstein's warnings about his gift for rhetoric and persuasion, and looking once more at the dead body of my companion, my anger flared up again. "Monster!" I exclaimed. "It is convenient for you to arrive here and weep over the destruction you have caused. You set fire to a collection of structures, and once they have burned down, you sit amidst the debris and mourn their collapse. You deceitful demon! If the man you grieve were still alive, he would remain the target, he would again become the prey, of your wicked retribution. You feel no genuine compassion; you only lament because the target of your malice is no longer within your reach."

"Oh, that is not the case—not at all," the creature broke in. "Though that must be the conclusion you draw from the apparent intent of my deeds. Yet I do not ask for shared feelings in my wretchedness. I can never find any empathy. When I originally looked for it, I wanted to share the love of virtue, the sensations of joy and warmth that filled my entire existence. But now that virtue has faded into a ghost, and those joys and affections have transformed into harsh and sickening despair, where should I look for understanding? I am prepared to endure my pain in solitude for as long as it lasts; when I perish, I am perfectly content that hatred and shame should burden my legacy. My imagination was once comforted by visions of goodness, renown, and pleasure. I once mistakenly trusted that I would encounter individuals who, overlooking my physical appearance, would cherish me for the noble traits I was prepared to reveal. I was sustained by lofty ideas of integrity and loyalty. But now, wrongdoing has lowered me below the lowliest beast. No sin, no harm, no malice, no suffering can be compared to mine. When I review the terrifying list of my transgressions, I cannot accept that I am the same being whose mind was once occupied by

grand and elevated dreams of the beauty and splendor of righteousness. Yet it is true; the fallen angel turns into a spiteful devil. Even that adversary of God and humanity had companions and allies in his isolation; I am entirely alone.

"You, who claim to be Frankenstein's friend, appear to understand my offenses and his tragedies. But in the account he provided, he could not capture the years and months of agony I spent languishing in helpless rage. For while I ruined his prospects, I did not fulfill my own longings. They remained forever intense and hungry; I continued to crave love and companionship, and I was continually rejected. Was there no unfairness in this? Am I to be considered the sole offender, when all of humanity committed wrongs against me? Why do you not despise Felix, who cast his acquaintance from his home with insults?"

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 010 / E4_010 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

Who's the Spider?"

"The spider?" said I.

"The blotchy, sprawly, sulky fellow."

"That's Bentley Drummle," I replied; "the one with the delicate face is Startop."

Not making the least account of "the one with the delicate face," he returned, "Bentley Drummle is his name, is it? I like the look of that fellow."

He immediately began to talk to Drummle: not at all deterred by his replying in his heavy reticent way, but apparently led on by it to screw discourse out of him. I was looking at the two, when there came between me and them the housekeeper, with the first dish for the table.

She was a woman of about forty, I supposed,—but I may have thought her younger than she was. Rather tall, of a lithe nimble figure, extremely pale, with large faded eyes, and a quantity of streaming hair. I cannot say whether any diseased affection of the heart caused her lips to be parted as if she were panting, and her face to bear a curious expression of suddenness and flutter; but I know that I had been to see Macbeth at the theatre, a night or two before, and that her face looked to me as if it were all disturbed by fiery air, like the faces I had seen rise out of the Witches' caldron.

She set the dish on, touched my guardian quietly on the arm with a finger to notify that dinner was ready, and vanished. We took our seats at the round table, and my guardian kept Drummle on one side of him, while Startop sat on the other. It was a noble dish of fish that the housekeeper had put on table, and we had a joint of equally choice mutton afterwards, and then an equally choice bird. Sauces, wines, all the accessories we wanted, and all of the best, were given out by our host from his dumb-waiter; and when they had made the circuit of the table, he always put them back again. Similarly, he dealt us clean plates and knives and forks, for each course, and dropped those just disused into two baskets on the ground by his chair. No other attendant than the housekeeper appeared. She set on every dish; and I always saw in her face, a face rising out of the caldron. Years afterwards, I made a dreadful likeness of that woman, by causing a face that had no other natural resemblance to it than it derived from flowing hair to pass behind a bowl of flaming spirits in a dark room.

Induced to take particular notice of the housekeeper, both by her own striking appearance and by Wemmick's preparation, I observed that whenever she was in the room she kept her eyes attentively on my guardian, and that she would remove her hands from any dish she put before him, hesitatingly, as if she dreaded his calling her back, and wanted him to speak when she was nigh, if he had anything to say. I fancied that I could detect in his manner a consciousness of this, and a purpose of always holding her in suspense.

Dinner went off gayly, and although my guardian seemed to follow rather than originate subjects, I knew that he wrenched the weakest part of our dispositions out of us.

Rewritten passage

"Who is the Spider?"

"The spider?" I repeated.

"That blotchy, awkward, sullen individual."

"That is Bentley Drummle," I answered; "the one with the refined features is Startop."

Ignoring the mention of the one with the refined features, he replied, "Bentley Drummle is his name, is it? I find that fellow's appearance interesting."

He promptly started a conversation with Drummle, entirely unbothered by his blunt, reserved responses, and seemingly encouraged by them to extract more talk from him. As I watched the pair, the housekeeper stepped between us, carrying the initial course for our meal.

She appeared to be roughly forty, though I might have underestimated her age. She was somewhat tall, possessed a supple, agile frame, was remarkably pale, and had large, washed-out eyes along with a mass of flowing hair. I cannot determine if a heart condition caused her lips to remain parted as if she were breathless, or gave her countenance such a strange, startled, and agitated look; however, I recall having attended a performance of Macbeth a few nights prior, and her face reminded me of those disturbed by scorching vapors, much like the visages I had witnessed emerging from the Witches' caldron.

She placed the dish down, tapped my guardian lightly on the arm to signal that dinner was served, and disappeared. We sat at the circular table, with my guardian keeping Drummle on one side and Startop on the other. The housekeeper had provided a magnificent fish dish, followed by a joint of equally excellent mutton, and then a bird of similar quality. Sauces, wines, and every necessary accompaniment were provided by our host from his dumb-waiter; once they had been passed around the table, he consistently returned them to their place. In the same manner, he provided fresh plates, knives, and forks for every course, dropping the used ones into two baskets positioned on the floor beside his chair. No servant other than the housekeeper was present. She placed every dish; and I consistently perceived in her features a face emerging from the caldron. Many years later, I created a haunting portrait of that woman by having a face, which shared no natural similarity to hers other than the streaming hair, pass behind a bowl of burning spirits in a darkened room.

Prompted to pay close attention to the housekeeper, both by her remarkable appearance and by Wemmick's earlier remarks, I noticed that whenever she was present, she kept her gaze fixed on my guardian, and she would withdraw her hands from any dish she placed before him with hesitation, as if she feared he might summon her back and desired him to speak while she was near, should he have anything to communicate. I imagined I could perceive in his behavior an awareness of this, and an intention to keep her in a state of constant uncertainty.

The dinner proceeded cheerfully, and although my guardian seemed to follow the topics rather than initiate them, I understood that he was skillfully drawing the most vulnerable aspects of our characters out of us.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 011 / E4_011 / condition: simplify

Original passage

How bitter now seemed the whole tragedy of his desertion and his shame!—shame that he made sweet and lovely {9} by the mere magic of his personality, but that was none the less shame. Yet as Shakespeare forgave him, should not we forgive him also? I did not care to pry into the mystery of his sin.

His abandonment of Shakespeare's theatre was a different matter, and I investigated it at great length. Finally I came to the conclusion that Cyril Graham had been wrong in regarding the rival dramatist of the 80th Sonnet as Chapman. It was obviously Marlowe who was alluded to. At the time the Sonnets were written, such an expression as 'the proud full sail of his great verse' could not have been used of Chapman's work, however applicable it might have been to the style of his later Jacobean plays. No: Marlowe was clearly the rival dramatist of whom Shakespeare spoke in such laudatory terms; and that

Affable familiar ghost
Which nightly gulls him with intelligence,

was the Mephistopheles of his Doctor Faustus. No doubt, Marlowe was fascinated by the beauty and grace of the boy-actor, and lured him away from the Blackfriars Theatre, that he might play the Gaveston of his Edward II. That Shakespeare had the legal right to retain Willie Hughes in his own company is evident from Sonnet LXXXVII., where he says:—

Farewell! thou art too dear for my possessing,
And like enough thou know'st thy estimate:
The charter of thy worth gives thee releasing;
My bonds in thee are all determinate.
For how do I hold thee but by thy granting?
And for that riches where is my deserving?
The cause of this fair gift in me is wanting,
And so my patent back again is swerving.
Thyself thou gayest, thy own worth then not knowing,
Or me, to whom thou gavest it, else mistaking;
So thy great gift, upon misprision growing,
Comes home again, on better judgement making.
Thus have I had thee, as a dream doth flatter,
In sleep a king, but waking no such matter.

But him whom he could not hold by love, he would not hold by force. Willie Hughes became a member of Lord Pembroke's company, and, perhaps in the open yard of the Red Bull Tavern, played the part of King Edward's delicate minion. On Marlowe's death, he seems to have returned to Shakespeare, who, whatever his fellow-partners may have thought of the matter, was not slow to forgive the wilfulness and treachery of the young actor.

How well, too, had Shakespeare drawn the temperament of the stage-player! Willie Hughes was one of those

That do not do the thing they most do show,
Who, moving others, are themselves as stone.

He could act love, but could not feel it, could mimic passion without realising it.

In many's looks the false heart's history
Is writ in moods and frowns and wrinkles strange,

but with Willie Hughes it was not so. 'Heaven,' says Shakespeare, in a sonnet of mad idolatry—

Heaven in thy creation did decree
That in thy face sweet love should ever dwell;
Whate'er thy thoughts or thy heart's workings be,
Thy looks should nothing thence but sweetness tell.

In his 'inconstant mind' and his 'false heart,' it was easy to recognise

the insincerity and treachery that somehow seem inseparable from the artistic nature, as in his love of praise that desire for immediate recognition that characterises all actors.

Rewritten passage

How bitter the tragedy of his desertion and shame now seemed! It was a shame he made sweet and lovely through the simple magic of his personality, but it was shame nonetheless. Yet, if Shakespeare forgave him, should we not forgive him as well? I did not care to investigate the mystery of his sin.

His abandonment of Shakespeare's theater was a different matter, which I investigated at great length. I eventually concluded that Cyril Graham was wrong to identify the rival dramatist of the 80th Sonnet as Chapman. It was clearly Marlowe who was being referenced. When the Sonnets were written, a phrase like 'the proud full sail of his great verse' could not have described Chapman's work, even if it might have applied to his later Jacobean plays. No, Marlowe was clearly the rival dramatist Shakespeare praised so highly; and that 'affable familiar ghost / Which nightly gulls him with intelligence' was the Mephistopheles from his play, Doctor Faustus. Marlowe was undoubtedly fascinated by the boy-actor's beauty and grace, luring him away from the Blackfriars Theatre to play Gaveston in his Edward II. That Shakespeare had the legal right to keep Willie Hughes in his company is evident from Sonnet LXXXVII, where he writes:

Farewell! thou art too dear for my possessing,
And like enough thou know'st thy estimate:
The charter of thy worth gives thee releasing;
My bonds in thee are all determinate.
For how do I hold thee but by thy granting?
And for that riches where is my deserving?
The cause of this fair gift in me is wanting,
And so my patent back again is swerving.
Thyself thou gavest, thy own worth then not knowing,
Or me, to whom thou gavest it, else mistaking;
So thy great gift, upon misprision growing,
Comes home again, on better judgement making.
Thus have I had thee, as a dream doth flatter,
In sleep a king, but waking no such matter.

However, he would not use force to keep someone he could not hold through love. Willie Hughes joined Lord Pembroke's company and perhaps played the part of King Edward's delicate favorite in the open yard of the Red Bull Tavern. After Marlowe died, he seems to have returned to Shakespeare, who was quick to forgive the young actor's willfulness and treachery, regardless of what his partners thought.

How well Shakespeare captured the temperament of an actor! Willie Hughes was one of those 'That do not do the thing they most do show, / Who, moving others, are themselves as stone.' He could act out love but could not feel it; he could mimic passion without truly experiencing it. While 'In many's looks the false heart's history / Is writ in moods and frowns and wrinkles strange,' this was not true for Willie Hughes. Shakespeare says in a sonnet of intense devotion: 'Heaven in thy creation did decree / That in thy face sweet love should ever dwell; / Whate'er thy thoughts or thy heart's workings be, / Thy looks should nothing thence but sweetness tell.' In his 'inconstant mind' and 'false heart,' it was easy to recognize the insincerity and treachery that seem inseparable from the artistic nature, just as his love of praise reflects the desire for immediate recognition that defines all actors.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 012 / E4_012 / condition: modernize

Original passage

Yellow lightnings

played around the vast dome of Mont Blanc, silent as the snow-clad rock they illuminated; all was bare, wild, and sublime, while the singing of the pines in melodious murmurings added a gentle interest to the rough magnificence. Now the riving and fall of icy rocks clave the air; now the thunder of the avalanche burst on our ears. In countries whose features are of less magnitude, nature betrays her living powers in the foliage of the trees, in the growth of herbage, in the soft purling of meandering streams; here, endowed with giant attributes, the torrent, the thunder-storm, and the flow of massive waters, display her activity. Such the church-yard, such the requiem, such the eternal congregation, that waited on our companion's funeral!

Nor was it the human form alone which we had placed in this eternal sepulchre, whose obsequies we now celebrated. With this last victim Plague vanished from the earth. Death had never wanted weapons wherewith to destroy life, and we, few and weak as we had become, were still exposed to every other shaft with which his full quiver teemed. But pestilence was absent from among them. For seven years it had had full sway upon earth; she had trod every nook of our spacious globe; she had mingled with the atmosphere, which as a cloak enwraps all our fellow-creatures—the inhabitants of native Europe—the luxurious Asiatic—the swarthy African and free American had been vanquished and destroyed by her. Her barbarous tyranny came to its close here in the rocky vale of Chamounix.

Still recurring scenes of misery and pain, the fruits of this distemper, made no more a part of our lives—the word plague no longer rung in our ears—the aspect of plague incarnate in the human countenance no longer appeared before our eyes. From this moment I saw plague no more. She abdicated her throne, and despoiled herself of her imperial sceptre among the ice rocks that surrounded us. She left solitude and silence co-heirs of her kingdom.

My present feelings are so mingled with the past, that I cannot say whether the knowledge of this change visited us, as we stood on this sterile spot. It seems to me that it did; that a cloud seemed to pass from over us, that a weight was taken from the air; that henceforth we breathed more freely, and raised our heads with some portion of former liberty. Yet we did not hope. We were impressed by the sentiment, that our race was run, but that plague would not be our destroyer. The coming time was as a mighty river, down which a charmed boat is driven, whose mortal steersman knows, that the obvious peril is not the one he needs fear, yet that danger is nigh; and who floats awe-struck under beetling precipices, through the dark and turbid waters—seeing in the distance yet stranger and ruder shapes, towards which he is irresistibly impelled. What would become of us? O for some Delphic oracle, or Pythian maid, to utter the secrets of futurity! O for some Ædipus to solve the riddle of the cruel Sphinx! Such Ædipus was I to be—not divining a word's juggle, but whose agonizing pangs, and sorrow-tainted life were to be the engines, wherewith to lay bare the secrets of destiny, and reveal the meaning of the enigma, whose explanation closed the history of the human race.

Rewritten passage

Yellow lightning flickered around the massive dome of Mont Blanc, as silent as the snow-covered rock it lit up; everything was bare, wild, and majestic, while the singing of the pines in melodic murmurs added a gentle interest to the rugged grandeur. Now the splitting and falling of icy rocks tore through the air; now the thunder of an avalanche crashed into our ears. In regions with less dramatic features, nature reveals her living power through the foliage of trees, the growth of grass, and the soft bubbling of winding streams; here, gifted with giant attributes, the torrent, the thunderstorm, and the flow of massive waters display her activity. Such was the graveyard, such the requiem, and such the eternal congregation that attended our companion's funeral!

It was not just the human form we had placed in this eternal tomb, whose funeral rites we were now observing. With this final victim, the plague vanished from the earth. Death had never lacked weapons to destroy life, and we, few and weak as we had become, were still exposed to every other arrow in his full quiver. But the pestilence was gone from among them. For seven years it had held full sway over the earth; it had walked every corner of our spacious globe; it had mingled with the atmosphere, which wraps around all our fellow creatures like a cloak—the inhabitants of native Europe, the luxurious Asiatic, the swarthy African, and the free American had all been defeated and destroyed by it. Its barbaric tyranny came to an end here in the rocky valley of Chamonix.

Recurring scenes of misery and pain, the results of this sickness, were no longer a part of our lives—the word plague no longer rang in our ears—the appearance of plague embodied in the human face no longer stood before our eyes. From this moment, I saw the plague no more. It abdicated its throne and stripped itself of its imperial scepter among the ice rocks that surrounded us. It left solitude and silence as the joint heirs of its kingdom.

My current feelings are so mixed with the past that I cannot say whether the knowledge of this change visited us as we stood on that barren spot. It seems to me that it did; that a cloud seemed to pass from over us, that a weight was lifted from the air; that from then on we breathed more freely and raised our heads with some portion of our former liberty. Yet we did not hope. We were struck by the feeling that our race was run, but that the plague would not be our destroyer. The coming time was like a mighty river, down which a charmed boat is driven, whose mortal steersman knows that the obvious peril is not the one he needs to fear, yet that danger is near; and who floats, awe-struck, under looming precipices, through dark and murky waters—seeing in the distance even stranger and harsher shapes, toward which he is irresistibly pulled. What would become of us? Oh, for some Delphic oracle or Pythian priestess to utter the secrets of the future! Oh, for some Oedipus to solve the riddle of the cruel Sphinx! Such an Oedipus I was to be—not guessing a word puzzle, but one whose agonizing pangs and sorrow-tainted life were to be the tools used to lay bare the secrets of destiny and reveal the meaning of the enigma whose explanation closed the history of the human race.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 013 / E4_013 / condition: modernize

Original passage

I leaned over Joe, and, with the aid of my forefinger read him the whole letter.

"Astonishing!" said Joe, when I had finished. "You ARE a scholar."

"How do you spell Gargery, Joe?" I asked him, with a modest patronage.

"I don't spell it at all," said Joe.

"But supposing you did?"

"It _can't_ be supposed," said Joe. "Tho' I'm uncommon fond of reading, too."

"Are you, Joe?"

"On-common. Give me," said Joe, "a good book, or a good newspaper, and sit me down afore a good fire, and I ask no better. Lord!" he continued, after rubbing his knees a little, "when you _do_ come to a J and a O, and says you, 'Here, at last, is a J-O, Joe,' how interesting reading is!"

I derived from this, that Joe's education, like Steam, was yet in its infancy. Pursuing the subject, I inquired,—

"Didn't you ever go to school, Joe, when you were as little as me?"

"No, Pip."

"Why didn't you ever go to school, Joe, when you were as little as me?"

"Well, Pip," said Joe, taking up the poker, and settling himself to his usual occupation when he was thoughtful, of slowly raking the fire between the lower bars; "I'll tell you. My father, Pip, he were given to drink, and when he were overtook with drink, he hammered away at my mother, most onmerciful. It were a'most the only hammering he did, indeed, 'xcepting at myself. And he hammered at me with a wigor only to be equalled by the wigor with which he didn't hammer at his anwil.—You're a listening and understanding, Pip?"

"Yes, Joe."

"Consequence, my mother and me we ran away from my father several times; and then my mother she'd go out to work, and she'd say, "Joe," she'd say, "now, please God, you shall have some schooling, child," and she'd put me to school. But my father were that good in his hart that he couldn't abear to be without us. So, he'd come with a most tremenjous crowd and make such a row at the doors of the houses where we was, that they used to be obligated to have no more to do with us and to give us up to him. And then he took us home and hammered us. Which, you see, Pip," said Joe, pausing in his meditative raking of the fire, and looking at me, "were a drawback on my learning."

"Certainly, poor Joe!"

"Though mind you, Pip," said Joe, with a judicial touch or two of the poker on the top bar, "rendering unto all their doo, and maintaining equal justice betwixt man and man, my father were that good in his hart, don't you see?"

I didn't see; but I didn't say so.

"Well!" Joe pursued, "somebody must keep the pot a-biling, Pip, or the pot won't bile, don't you know?"

I saw that, and said so.

"Consequence, my father didn't make objections to my going to work; so I went to work at my present calling, which were his too, if he would have followed it, and I worked tolerable hard, I assure _you_, Pip. In

time I were able to keep him, and I kept him till he went off in a purple leptic fit. And it were my intentions to have had put upon his tombstone that, Whatsume'er the failings on his part, Remember reader he were that good in his heart."

Rewritten passage

I leaned over Joe and, using my index finger, read the entire letter to him.

"Astonishing!" Joe said once I finished. "You really are a scholar."

"How do you spell Gargery, Joe?" I asked him with a touch of modest condescension.

"I don't spell it at all," Joe replied.

"But what if you did?"

"It can't be supposed," Joe said. "Though I am quite fond of reading, too."

"Are you, Joe?"

"Quite. Give me," Joe said, "a good book or a good newspaper, sit me down in front of a good fire, and I ask for nothing more. Lord!" he continued, after rubbing his knees for a moment, "when you finally reach a J and an O, and you say, 'Here, at last, is a J-O, Joe,' how interesting reading is!"

I gathered from this that Joe's education, like steam power, was still in its infancy. Continuing the conversation, I asked, "Didn't you ever go to school, Joe, when you were as small as I am?"

"No, Pip."

"Why didn't you ever go to school, Joe, when you were as small as I am?"

"Well, Pip," Joe said, picking up the poker and settling into his usual habit when thoughtful—slowly raking the fire between the lower bars—"I'll tell you. My father, Pip, had a drinking problem, and when he was overcome by drink, he would beat my mother mercilessly. It was almost the only hammering he did, really, except for beating me. And he hammered at me with a vigor only matched by the vigor with which he avoided hammering at his anvil. You're listening and understanding, Pip?"

"Yes, Joe."

"Consequently, my mother and I ran away from my father several times; then my mother would go out to work and say, 'Joe,' she'd say, 'now, God willing, you shall have some schooling, child,' and she'd put me in school. But my father was so good-hearted that he couldn't stand to be without us. So, he would show up with a massive crowd and make such a scene at the doors of the houses where we were staying that they were forced to stop taking us in and had to give us back to him. Then he took us home and beat us. Which, you see, Pip," Joe said, pausing his meditative raking of the fire to look at me, "was a setback to my education."

"Certainly, poor Joe!"

"Though mind you, Pip," Joe said, tapping the top bar with the poker, "giving everyone their due and maintaining fairness between man and man, my father was truly good-hearted, don't you see?"

I didn't see it, but I didn't say so.

"Well!" Joe continued, "someone has to keep the pot boiling, Pip, or the pot won't boil, don't you know?"

I understood that and said so.

"Consequently, my father didn't object to me going to work; so I went to work at my current trade, which would have been his too if he had stuck to it, and I worked reasonably hard, I assure you, Pip. In time, I was able to support him, and I kept him until he passed away from a seizure. It was my intention to have had inscribed on his tombstone that, whatever his failings, remember, reader, he was good-hearted."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 014 / E4_014 / condition: modernize

Original passage

every one else believes in her guilt, and that made me wretched, for I knew that it was impossible: and to see every one else prejudiced in so deadly a manner rendered me hopeless and despairing." She wept.

"Dearest niece," said my father, "dry your tears. If she is, as you believe, innocent, rely on the justice of our laws, and the activity with which I shall prevent the slightest shadow of partiality."

Chapter 8

We passed a few sad hours until eleven o'clock, when the trial was to commence. My father and the rest of the family being obliged to attend as witnesses, I accompanied them to the court. During the whole of this wretched mockery of justice I suffered living torture. It was to be decided whether the result of my curiosity and lawless devices would cause the death of two of my fellow beings: one a smiling babe full of innocence and joy, the other far more dreadfully murdered, with every aggravation of infamy that could make the murder memorable in horror. Justine also was a girl of merit and possessed qualities which promised to render her life happy; now all was to be obliterated in an ignominious grave, and I the cause! A thousand times rather would I have confessed myself guilty of the crime ascribed to Justine, but I was absent when it was committed, and such a declaration would have been considered as the ravings of a madman and would not have exculpated her who suffered through me.

The appearance of Justine was calm. She was dressed in mourning, and her countenance, always engaging, was rendered, by the solemnity of her feelings, exquisitely beautiful. Yet she appeared confident in innocence and did not tremble, although gazed on and execrated by thousands, for all the kindness which her beauty might otherwise have excited was obliterated in the minds of the spectators by the imagination of the enormity she was supposed to have committed. She was tranquil, yet her tranquillity was evidently constrained; and as her confusion had before been adduced as a proof of her guilt, she worked up her mind to an appearance of courage. When she entered the court she threw her eyes round it and quickly discovered where we were seated. A tear seemed to dim her eye when she saw us, but she quickly recovered herself, and a look of sorrowful affection seemed to attest her utter guiltlessness.

The trial began, and after the advocate against her had stated the charge, several witnesses were called. Several strange facts combined against her, which might have staggered anyone who had not such proof of her innocence as I had. She had been out the whole of the night on which the murder had been committed and towards morning had been perceived by a market-woman not far from the spot where the body of the murdered child had been afterwards found. The woman asked her what she did there, but she looked very strangely and only returned a confused and unintelligible answer. She returned to the house about eight o'clock, and when one inquired where she had passed the night, she replied that she had been looking for the child and demanded earnestly if anything had been heard concerning him. When shown the body, she fell into violent hysterics and kept her bed for several days.

Rewritten passage

Everyone else believes she is guilty, which makes me miserable because I know it is impossible. Seeing everyone so fatally prejudiced leaves me hopeless and despairing." She wept.

"Dearest niece," my father said, "dry your tears. If she is innocent, as you believe, trust in the fairness of our legal system and the diligence with which I will ensure there is not the slightest hint of bias."

Chapter 8

We spent a few sorrowful hours until eleven o'clock, when the trial was set to begin. Since my father and the rest of the family had to attend

as witnesses, I went with them to the courthouse. Throughout this miserable mockery of justice, I endured absolute torture. It was about to be decided whether the consequences of my curiosity and reckless experiments would cause the deaths of two fellow human beings: one a smiling, innocent baby, and the other someone murdered in a way so horrific it would be remembered for its infamy. Justine was also a girl of merit with qualities that promised a happy life; now, all of that was to be erased in a shameful grave, and I was the cause! I would have a thousand times preferred to confess to the crime attributed to Justine, but I was away when it happened, and such a statement would have been dismissed as the ravings of a madman and would not have cleared the person suffering because of me.

Justine appeared calm. She wore mourning clothes, and her face, always charming, was made exquisitely beautiful by the gravity of her emotions. Yet she seemed confident in her innocence and did not tremble, even though she was stared at and cursed by thousands. Any sympathy her beauty might have inspired was erased from the spectators' minds by the perceived enormity of her supposed crime. She was tranquil, though her composure was clearly forced; and because her earlier confusion had been used as proof of her guilt, she steeled herself to appear courageous. When she entered the courtroom, she scanned the room and quickly spotted where we were sitting. A tear seemed to cloud her eye when she saw us, but she quickly regained her composure, and a look of sorrowful affection seemed to confirm her complete innocence.

The trial began, and after the prosecutor stated the charges, several witnesses were called. A number of strange facts were presented against her, which might have shaken anyone who did not have the proof of her innocence that I possessed. She had been out all night on the night of the murder, and toward morning, she had been spotted by a market woman not far from where the murdered child's body was later discovered. The woman asked her what she was doing there, but she looked very strange and gave only a confused, unintelligible answer. She returned to the house around eight o'clock, and when someone asked where she had spent the night, she replied that she had been searching for the child and asked urgently if anything had been heard about him. When shown the body, she fell into violent hysterics and remained bedridden for several days.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 015 / E4_015 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

When the last crisp slice of bacon was gone, and the last allowance of corn pone devoured, the boys stretched themselves out on the grass, filled with contentment. They could have found a cooler place, but they would not deny themselves such a romantic feature as the roasting campfire.

"_Ain't_ it gay?" said Joe.

"It's _nuts_!" said Tom. "What would the boys say if they could see us?"

"Say? Well, they'd just die to be here—hey, Hucky!"

"I reckon so," said Huckleberry; "anyways, I'm suited. I don't want nothing better'n this. I don't ever get enough to eat, gen'ally—and here they can't come and pick at a feller and bullyrag him so."

"It's just the life for me," said Tom. "You don't have to get up, mornings, and you don't have to go to school, and wash, and all that blame foolishness. You see a pirate don't have to do _anything_, Joe, when he's ashore, but a hermit _he_ has to be praying considerable, and then he don't have any fun, anyway, all by himself that way."

"Oh yes, that's so," said Joe, "but I hadn't thought much about it, you know. I'd a good deal rather be a pirate, now that I've tried it."

"You see," said Tom, "people don't go much on hermits, nowadays, like they used to in old times, but a pirate's always respected. And a hermit's got to sleep on the hardest place he can find, and put sackcloth and ashes on his head, and stand out in the rain, and—"

"What does he put sackcloth and ashes on his head for?" inquired Huck.

"I dono. But they've _got_ to do it. Hermits always do. You'd have to do that if you was a hermit."

"Dern'd if I would," said Huck.

"Well, what would you do?"

"I dono. But I wouldn't do that."

"Why, Huck, you'd _have_ to. How'd you get around it?"

"Why, I just wouldn't stand it. I'd run away."

"Run away! Well, you _would_ be a nice old slouch of a hermit. You'd be a disgrace."

The Red-Handed made no response, being better employed. He had finished gouging out a cob, and now he fitted a weed stem to it, loaded it with tobacco, and was pressing a coal to the charge and blowing a cloud of fragrant smoke—he was in the full bloom of luxurious contentment. The other pirates envied him this majestic vice, and secretly resolved to acquire it shortly. Presently Huck said:

"What does pirates have to do?"

Tom said:

"Oh, they have just a bully time—take ships and burn them, and get the money and bury it in awful places in their island where there's ghosts and things to watch it, and kill everybody in the ships—make 'em walk a plank."

"And they carry the women to the island," said Joe; "they don't kill the women."

"No," assented Tom, "they don't kill the women—they're too noble. And the women's always beautiful, too."

"And don't they wear the bulliest clothes! Oh no! All gold and silver and di'monds," said Joe, with enthusiasm.

"Who?" said Huck.

"Why, the pirates."

Huck scanned his own clothing forlornly.

"I reckon I ain't dressed fitten for a pirate," said he, with a regretful pathos in his voice; "but I ain't got none but these."

Rewritten passage

Once the final crunchy piece of bacon had vanished and the last portion of corn bread was consumed, the boys reclined upon the grass, brimming with satisfaction. They might have sought a shadier spot, yet they refused to forgo the atmospheric charm of their glowing campfire.

"Isn't it grand?" Joe remarked.

"It's fantastic!" Tom replied. "How would the other boys react if they saw us now?"

"React? They would be absolutely desperate to join us—wouldn't they, Hucky?"

"I suppose so," Huckleberry agreed; "regardless, I am satisfied. I desire nothing superior to this. Usually, I never get my fill of food—and here, nobody can come around to nag or harass me."

"This is the life for me," Tom declared. "You aren't forced to rise in the mornings, nor attend school, or wash, or endure any of that tiresome nonsense. You see, a pirate has no obligations, Joe, while on land, whereas a hermit must spend his time praying constantly, and he never experiences any joy, being entirely alone like that."

"Oh yes, that is true," Joe noted, "but I had not considered it much. I would much prefer being a pirate, now that I have experienced it."

"You see," Tom explained, "people do not value hermits much these days, unlike in ancient times, but a pirate is always held in high regard. Besides, a hermit is required to sleep on the most uncomfortable surface available, cover his head with sackcloth and ashes, stand out in the rain, and—"

"Why does he put sackcloth and ashes on his head?" Huck asked.

"I am not sure. But they are obligated to do it. Hermits always do. You would be required to do that if you were a hermit."

"I'll be darned if I would," Huck stated.

"Well, what would you do instead?"

"I don't know. But I would not do that."

"Why, Huck, you would be forced to. How could you avoid it?"

"Well, I simply would not tolerate it. I would run away."

"Run away! Well, you would make a pathetic excuse for a hermit. You would be a disgrace."

The Red-Handed offered no reply, as he was better occupied. He had finished hollowing out a corncob, and now he inserted a weed stem, filled it with tobacco, pressed a glowing coal to the mixture, and exhaled a cloud of aromatic smoke—he was in the peak of luxurious comfort. The other pirates envied this grand vice and privately decided to master it soon. Shortly, Huck asked:

"What do pirates actually do?"

Tom replied:

"Oh, they have a marvelous time—they capture ships, burn them, seize the gold, and hide it in terrifying locations on their island where spirits and such guard it, and they kill everyone on the ships—making them walk the plank."

"And they bring the women to the island," Joe added; "they do not kill the women."

"No," Tom agreed, "they do not kill the women—they are too chivalrous. And the women are always beautiful, too."

"And don't they wear the most magnificent outfits! Oh, absolutely! All gold and silver and diamonds," Joe said with excitement.

"Who?" Huck asked.

"Why, the pirates."

Huck examined his own attire despondently.

"I suppose I am not dressed appropriately for a pirate," he said, with a sorrowful tone in his voice; "but I have nothing else besides these."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 016 / E4_016 / condition: simplify

Original passage

In the proclamation setting forth this reward, a full pardon was promised to any accomplice who should come forward in evidence against his fellow; and to the whole was appended, wherever it appeared, the private placard of a committee of citizens, offering ten thousand francs, in addition to the amount proposed by the Prefecture. The entire reward thus stood at no less than thirty thousand francs, which will be regarded as an extraordinary sum when we consider the humble condition of the girl, and the great frequency, in large cities, of such atrocities as the one described.

No one doubted now that the mystery of this murder would be immediately brought to light. But although, in one or two instances, arrests were made which promised elucidation, yet nothing was elicited which could implicate the parties suspected; and they were discharged forthwith. Strange as it may appear, the third week from the discovery of the body had passed, and passed without any light being thrown upon the subject, before even a rumor of the events which had so agitated the public mind, reached the ears of Dupin and myself. Engaged in researches which absorbed our whole attention, it had been nearly a month since either of us had gone abroad, or received a visitor, or more than glanced at the leading political articles in one of the daily papers. The first intelligence of the murder was brought us by G——, in person. He called upon us early in the afternoon of the thirteenth of July, 18—, and remained with us until late in the night. He had been piqued by the failure of all his endeavors to ferret out the assassins. His reputation—so he said with a peculiarly Parisian air—was at stake. Even his honor was concerned. The eyes of the public were upon him; and there was really no sacrifice which he would not be willing to make for the development of the mystery. He concluded a somewhat droll speech with a compliment upon what he was pleased to term the tact of Dupin, and made him a direct, and certainly a liberal proposition, the precise nature of which I do not feel myself at liberty to disclose, but which has no bearing upon the proper subject of my narrative.

The compliment my friend rebutted as best he could, but the proposition he accepted at once, although its advantages were altogether provisional. This point being settled, the Prefect broke forth at once into explanations of his own views, interspersing them with long comments upon the evidence; of which latter we were not yet in possession. He discoursed much, and beyond doubt, learnedly; while I hazarded an occasional suggestion as the night wore drowsily away. Dupin, sitting steadily in his accustomed arm-chair, was the embodiment of respectful attention. He wore spectacles, during the whole interview; and an occasional signal glance beneath their green glasses, sufficed to convince me that he slept not the less soundly, because silently, throughout the seven or eight leaden-footed hours which immediately preceded the departure of the Prefect.

In the morning, I procured, at the Prefecture, a full report of all the evidence elicited, and, at the various newspaper offices, a copy of every paper in which, from first to last, had been published any decisive information in regard to this sad affair.

Rewritten passage

The official announcement of the reward promised a full pardon to any accomplice who came forward to testify against their partners. Additionally, a committee of citizens posted their own notices wherever possible, offering ten thousand francs on top of the amount proposed by the police. The total reward reached thirty thousand francs, an extraordinary sum considering the girl's humble status and how frequently such crimes occur in large cities.

Everyone assumed the mystery of this murder would be solved immediately. However, although a few arrests were made that seemed promising, no evidence was found to link the suspects to the crime, and they were quickly released. Strangely, three weeks passed after the body was discovered without any progress, and the news of the events that had so disturbed the public had not even reached Dupin or me. We were occupied with research that demanded our full attention, and it had been nearly a month since either of us had gone out, received a

visitor, or done more than glance at the main political articles in the daily papers. We first heard about the murder when G— visited us in person. He arrived early on the afternoon of July 13, 18—, and stayed until late that night. He was frustrated by his failure to track down the killers. He claimed, with a distinctly Parisian flair, that his reputation and honor were at stake. The public was watching him, and he insisted there was no sacrifice he would not make to solve the mystery. He ended his somewhat odd speech by complimenting what he called Dupin's tact, and he made him a direct and generous offer. I do not feel at liberty to disclose the exact nature of this proposal, but it has no bearing on my story.

My friend deflected the compliment as best he could, but he accepted the offer immediately, even though its benefits were entirely conditional. Once this was settled, the Prefect began explaining his own theories, frequently interrupting himself with long comments on the evidence, which we had not yet seen. He spoke at length and, no doubt, learnedly, while I offered an occasional suggestion as the night dragged on. Dupin sat still in his usual armchair, the picture of respectful attention. He wore spectacles throughout the meeting, and an occasional glance beneath his green lenses convinced me that he was sleeping soundly, if silently, during the seven or eight slow-moving hours before the Prefect finally left.

In the morning, I obtained a full report of all the evidence from the police headquarters, along with copies of every newspaper that had published any significant information regarding this tragic affair.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 017 / E4_017 / condition: simplify

Original passage

He grew very pale and said—"I did it purely for your sake. You would not be convinced in any other way. It does not affect the truth of the theory." "The truth of the theory!" I exclaimed; "the less we talk about that the better. You never even believed in it yourself. If you had, you would not have committed a forgery to prove it." High words passed between us; we had a fearful quarrel. I dare say I was unjust. The next morning he was dead.'

'Dead!' I cried,

'Yes; he shot himself with a revolver. Some of the blood splashed upon the frame of the picture, just where the name had been painted. By the time I arrived—his servant had sent for me at once—the police were already there. He had left a letter for me, evidently written in the greatest agitation and distress of mind.'

'What was in it?' I asked.

'Oh, that he believed absolutely in Willie Hughes; that the forgery of the picture had been done simply as a concession to me, and did not in the slightest degree invalidate the truth of the theory; and, that in order to show me how firm and flawless his faith in the whole thing was, he was going to offer his life as a sacrifice to the secret of the Sonnets. It was a foolish, mad letter. I remember he ended by saying that he intrusted to me the Willie Hughes theory, and that it was for me to present it to the world, and to unlock the secret of Shakespeare's heart.'

'It is a most tragic story,' I cried; 'but why have you not carried out his wishes?'

Erskine shrugged his shoulders. 'Because it is a perfectly unsound theory from beginning to end,' he answered.

'My dear Erskine,' I said, getting up from my seat, 'you are entirely wrong about the whole matter. It is the only perfect key to Shakespeare's Sonnets that has ever been made. It is complete in every detail. I believe in Willie Hughes.'

'Don't say that,' said Erskine gravely; 'I believe there is something fatal about the idea, and intellectually there is nothing to be said for it. I have gone into the whole matter, and I assure you the theory is entirely fallacious. It is plausible up to a certain point. Then it stops. For heaven's sake, my dear boy, don't take up the subject of Willie Hughes. You will break your heart over it.'

'Erskine,' I answered, 'it is your duty to give this theory to the world. If you will not do it, I will. By keeping it back you wrong the memory of Cyril Graham, the youngest and the most splendid of all the martyrs of literature. I entreat you to do him justice. He died for this thing,—don't let his death be in vain.'

Erskine looked at me in amazement. 'You are carried away by the sentiment of the whole story,' he said. 'You forget that a thing is not necessarily true because a man dies for it. I was devoted to Cyril Graham. His death was a horrible blow to me. I did not recover it for years. I don't think I have ever recovered it. But Willie Hughes? There is nothing in the idea of Willie Hughes.'

Rewritten passage

He turned very pale and said, "I did it only for your sake. You would not have been convinced any other way. It does not change the truth of the theory." "The truth of the theory!" I exclaimed. "The less we say about that, the better. You never even believed in it yourself. If you had, you would not have committed a forgery to prove it." We exchanged harsh words and had a terrible argument. I suspect I was being unfair. The next morning, he was dead.

"Dead!" I cried.

"Yes; he shot himself with a revolver. Some of the blood splashed onto the picture frame, right where the name had been painted. By the time I arrived—his servant had called me immediately—the police were already there. He had left a letter for me, clearly written in a state of

great agitation and distress.”

“What did it say?” I asked.

“It said that he believed completely in Willie Hughes; that the forgery of the picture was done only to satisfy me and did not in the least invalidate the truth of the theory; and that, to show me how firm and flawless his faith in the whole thing was, he was going to offer his life as a sacrifice to the secret of the Sonnets. It was a foolish, mad letter. I remember he ended by saying that he entrusted the Willie Hughes theory to me, and that it was my responsibility to present it to the world and unlock the secret of Shakespeare’s heart.”

“It is a most tragic story,” I cried, “but why have you not carried out his wishes?”

Erskine shrugged his shoulders. “Because it is a completely unsound theory from beginning to end,” he answered.

“My dear Erskine,” I said, rising from my seat, “you are entirely wrong about the whole matter. It is the only perfect key to Shakespeare’s Sonnets that has ever been created. It is complete in every detail. I believe in Willie Hughes.”

“Don’t say that,” Erskine said seriously. “I believe there is something fatal about the idea, and intellectually there is nothing to be said for it. I have looked into the whole matter, and I assure you the theory is entirely false. It is plausible up to a certain point, but then it fails. For heaven’s sake, my dear boy, don’t take up the subject of Willie Hughes. You will break your heart over it.”

“Erskine,” I answered, “it is your duty to give this theory to the world. If you will not do it, I will. By keeping it hidden, you wrong the memory of Cyril Graham, the youngest and most splendid of all the martyrs of literature. I beg you to do him justice. He died for this; do not let his death be in vain.”

Erskine looked at me in amazement. “You are carried away by the sentiment of the story,” he said. “You forget that a thing is not necessarily true just because a man dies for it. I was devoted to Cyril Graham. His death was a horrible blow to me. I did not recover for years. I don’t think I ever have. But Willie Hughes? There is nothing to the idea of Willie Hughes.”

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 018 / E4_018 / condition: modernize

Original passage

The moment she touched actual life, she marred it, and it marred her, and so she passed away. Mourn for Ophelia, if you like. Put ashes on your head because Cordelia was strangled. Cry out against Heaven because the daughter of Brabantio died. But don't waste your tears over Sibyl Vane. She was less real than they are."

There was a silence. The evening darkened in the room. Noiselessly, and with silver feet, the shadows crept in from the garden. The colours faded wearily out of things.

After some time Dorian Gray looked up. "You have explained me to myself, Harry," he murmured with something of a sigh of relief. "I felt all that you have said, but somehow I was afraid of it, and I could not express it to myself. How well you know me! But we will not talk again of what has happened. It has been a marvellous experience. That is all. I wonder if life has still in store for me anything as marvellous."

"Life has everything in store for you, Dorian. There is nothing that you, with your extraordinary good looks, will not be able to do."

"But suppose, Harry, I became haggard, and old, and wrinkled? What then?"

"Ah, then," said Lord Henry, rising to go, "then, my dear Dorian, you would have to fight for your victories. As it is, they are brought to you. No, you must keep your good looks. We live in an age that reads too much to be wise, and that thinks too much to be beautiful. We cannot spare you. And now you had better dress and drive down to the club. We are rather late, as it is."

"I think I shall join you at the opera, Harry. I feel too tired to eat anything. What is the number of your sister's box?"

"Twenty-seven, I believe. It is on the grand tier. You will see her name on the door. But I am sorry you won't come and dine."

"I don't feel up to it," said Dorian listlessly. "But I am awfully obliged to you for all that you have said to me. You are certainly my best friend. No one has ever understood me as you have."

"We are only at the beginning of our friendship, Dorian," answered Lord Henry, shaking him by the hand. "Good-bye. I shall see you before nine-thirty, I hope. Remember, Patti is singing."

As he closed the door behind him, Dorian Gray touched the bell, and in a few minutes Victor appeared with the lamps and drew the blinds down. He waited impatiently for him to go. The man seemed to take an interminable time over everything.

As soon as he had left, he rushed to the screen and drew it back. No; there was no further change in the picture. It had received the news of Sibyl Vane's death before he had known of it himself. It was conscious of the events of life as they occurred. The vicious cruelty that marred the fine lines of the mouth had, no doubt, appeared at the very moment that the girl had drunk the poison, whatever it was. Or was it indifferent to results? Did it merely take cognizance of what passed within the soul? He wondered, and hoped that some day he would see the change taking place before his very eyes, shuddering as he hoped it.

Rewritten passage

The moment she touched real life, she ruined it, and it ruined her, and so she passed away. Mourn for Ophelia, if you want. Put ashes on your head because Cordelia was strangled. Cry out against Heaven because Brabantio's daughter died. But don't waste your tears over Sibyl Vane. She was less real than they are.

There was a silence. The evening darkened in the room. Noiselessly, and with silver feet, the shadows crept in from the garden. The colors faded wearily out of everything.

After some time, Dorian Gray looked up. "You have explained me to myself, Harry," he murmured with a sigh of relief. "I felt everything you

said, but somehow I was afraid of it, and I couldn't put it into words. How well you know me! But we won't talk about what happened again. It has been a marvelous experience. That is all. I wonder if life still has anything as marvelous in store for me."

"Life has everything in store for you, Dorian. There is nothing that you, with your extraordinary good looks, won't be able to do."

"But suppose, Harry, I became haggard, and old, and wrinkled? What then?"

"Ah, then," said Lord Henry, rising to leave, "then, my dear Dorian, you would have to fight for your victories. As it is, they are brought to you. No, you must keep your good looks. We live in an age that reads too much to be wise, and that thinks too much to be beautiful. We cannot spare you. And now you had better dress and drive down to the club. We are already running quite late."

"I think I will join you at the opera, Harry. I feel too tired to eat anything. What is the number of your sister's box?"

"Twenty-seven, I believe. It is on the grand tier. You will see her name on the door. But I am sorry you won't come and dine."

"I don't feel up to it," said Dorian listlessly. "But I am incredibly grateful for everything you have said to me. You are certainly my best friend. No one has ever understood me as you have."

"We are only at the beginning of our friendship, Dorian," answered Lord Henry, shaking his hand. "Goodbye. I hope to see you before nine-thirty. Remember, Patti is singing."

As he closed the door behind him, Dorian Gray rang the bell, and in a few minutes Victor appeared with the lamps and pulled the blinds down. He waited impatiently for him to leave. The man seemed to take an endless amount of time with everything.

As soon as he had gone, he rushed to the screen and pulled it back. No; there was no further change in the picture. It had received the news of Sibyl Vane's death before he had known of it himself. It was aware of life's events as they occurred. The vicious cruelty that marred the fine lines of the mouth had, no doubt, appeared the very moment the girl had drunk the poison, whatever it was. Or was it indifferent to results? Did it merely take note of what passed within the soul? He wondered, and hoped that one day he would see the change taking place before his very eyes, shuddering as he hoped it.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 019 / E4_019 / condition: simplify

Original passage

With a well-feigned show of reluctance, and not until after my repeated refusal had seduced him into some angry words which gave a color of pique to my compliance, did I finally comply. The result, of course, did but prove how entirely the prey was in my toils: in less than an hour he had quadrupled his debt. For some time his countenance had been losing the florid tinge lent it by the wine; but now, to my astonishment, I perceived that it had grown to a pallor truly fearful. I say to my astonishment. Glendinning had been represented to my eager inquiries as immeasurably wealthy; and the sums which he had as yet lost, although in themselves vast, could not, I supposed, very seriously annoy, much less so violently affect him. That he was overcome by the wine just swallowed, was the idea which most readily presented itself; and, rather with a view to the preservation of my own character in the eyes of my associates, than from any less interested motive, I was about to insist, peremptorily, upon a discontinuance of the play, when some expressions at my elbow from among the company, and an ejaculation evincing utter despair on the part of Glendinning, gave me to understand that I had effected his total ruin under circumstances which, rendering him an object for the pity of all, should have protected him from the ill offices even of a fiend.

What now might have been my conduct it is difficult to say. The pitiable condition of my dupe had thrown an air of embarrassed gloom over all; and, for some moments, a profound silence was maintained, during which I could not help feeling my cheeks tingle with the many burning glances of scorn or reproach cast upon me by the less abandoned of the party. I will even own that an intolerable weight of anxiety was for a brief instant lifted from my bosom by the sudden and extraordinary interruption which ensued. The wide, heavy folding doors of the apartment were all at once thrown open, to their full extent, with a vigorous and rushing impetuosity that extinguished, as if by magic, every candle in the room. Their light, in dying, enabled us just to perceive that a stranger had entered, about my own height, and closely muffled in a cloak. The darkness, however, was now total; and we could only feel that he was standing in our midst. Before any one of us could recover from the extreme astonishment into which this rudeness had thrown all, we heard the voice of the intruder.

"Gentlemen," he said, in a low, distinct, and never-to-be-forgotten whisper which thrilled to the very marrow of my bones, "Gentlemen, I make no apology for this behaviour, because in thus behaving, I am but fulfilling a duty. You are, beyond doubt, uninformed of the true character of the person who has to-night won at _écarté_ a large sum of money from Lord Glendinning. I will therefore put you upon an expeditious and decisive plan of obtaining this very necessary information. Please to examine, at your leisure, the inner linings of the cuff of his left sleeve, and the several little packages which may be found in the somewhat capacious pockets of his embroidered morning wrapper."

Rewritten passage

I finally agreed to play, though I pretended to be reluctant and only gave in after my repeated refusals led him to say some angry things that made my compliance seem like a reaction to his annoyance. The result, naturally, proved how completely I had trapped my prey: in less than an hour, he had quadrupled his debt. For a while, his face had been losing the flushed color brought on by the wine, but now, to my surprise, I noticed it had turned a truly frightening shade of pale. I say surprise because I had been told that Glendinning was incredibly wealthy, and the amounts he had lost so far, while large, should not have bothered him much, let alone affected him so violently. I assumed he was simply overcome by the wine he had just finished, and I was about to insist firmly that we stop playing—more to protect my own reputation among my associates than for any selfless reason—when some comments from the people standing near me, combined with a cry of total despair from Glendinning, made me realize I had completely ruined him. The circumstances were such that he should have been an object of pity for everyone, protected from the malice of even a devil.

It is hard to say how I would have acted next. The pathetic state of my victim had cast an awkward gloom over everyone, and for a few moments, there was a deep silence. During this time, I could not help but feel my cheeks burn under the many looks of scorn or reproach cast at me by the less corrupt members of the group. I will even admit that a heavy weight of anxiety was briefly lifted from my chest by the

sudden and extraordinary interruption that followed. The wide, heavy folding doors of the room were suddenly thrown open with such force and speed that every candle in the room was extinguished as if by magic. As the light died, we could just see that a stranger had entered, about my own height and wrapped tightly in a cloak. The room was now completely dark, and we could only sense that he was standing among us. Before any of us could recover from the shock of this rude entrance, we heard the intruder's voice.

"Gentlemen," he said, in a low, clear, and unforgettable whisper that chilled me to the bone, "I offer no apology for this behavior, because in acting this way, I am merely fulfilling a duty. You are, without a doubt, unaware of the true character of the person who has tonight won a large sum of money from Lord Glendinning at *écarté*. I will therefore provide you with a quick and certain way to get this necessary information. Please examine, at your leisure, the inner linings of his left sleeve cuff, and the various small packages that can be found in the rather large pockets of his embroidered morning robe."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 020 / E4_020 / condition: modernize

Original passage

—

I beg pardon; I had forgotten that Shakespeare will not flourish for seventeen hundred and fifty years to come. But does not the appearance of Epidaphne justify me in calling it grotesque?

"It is well fortified; and in this respect is as much indebted to nature as to art."

Very true.

"There are a prodigious number of stately palaces."

There are.

"And the numerous temples, sumptuous and magnificent, may bear comparison with the most lauded of antiquity."

All this I must acknowledge. Still there is an infinity of mud huts, and abominable hovels. We cannot help perceiving abundance of filth in every kennel, and, were it not for the over-powering fumes of idolatrous incense, I have no doubt we should find a most intolerable stench. Did you ever behold streets so insufferably narrow, or houses so miraculously tall? What gloom their shadows cast upon the ground! It is well the swinging lamps in those endless colonnades are kept burning throughout the day; we should otherwise have the darkness of Egypt in the time of her desolation.

"It is certainly a strange place! What is the meaning of yonder singular building? See! it towers above all others, and lies to the eastward of what I take to be the royal palace!"

That is the new Temple of the Sun, who is adored in Syria under the title of Elah Gabalah. Hereafter a very notorious Roman Emperor will institute this worship in Rome, and thence derive a cognomen, Heliogabalus. I dare say you would like to take a peep at the divinity of the temple. You need not look up at the heavens; his Sunship is not there—at least not the Sunship adored by the Syrians. That deity will be found in the interior of yonder building. He is worshipped under the figure of a large stone pillar terminating at the summit in a cone or pyramid, whereby is denoted Fire.

"Hark—behold!—who can those ridiculous beings be, half naked, with their faces painted, shouting and gesticulating to the rabble?"

Some few are mountebanks. Others more particularly belong to the race of philosophers. The greatest portion, however—those especially who belabor the populace with clubs—are the principal courtiers of the palace, executing as in duty bound, some laudable comicality of the king's.

"But what have we here? Heavens! the town is swarming with wild beasts! How terrible a spectacle!—how dangerous a peculiarity!"

Terrible, if you please; but not in the least degree dangerous. Each animal if you will take the pains to observe, is following, very quietly, in the wake of its master. Some few, to be sure, are led with a rope about the neck, but these are chiefly the lesser or timid species. The lion, the tiger, and the leopard are entirely without restraint. They have been trained without difficulty to their present profession, and attend upon their respective owners in the capacity of valets-de-chambre. It is true, there are occasions when Nature asserts her violated dominions;—but then the devouring of a man-at-arms, or the throttling of a consecrated bull, is a circumstance of too little moment to be more than hinted at in Epidaphne.

"But what extraordinary tumult do I hear? Surely this is a loud noise even for Antioch! It argues some commotion of unusual interest."

Rewritten passage

I apologize; I had forgotten that Shakespeare will not appear for another seventeen hundred and fifty years. But does the appearance of Epidaphne not justify me in calling it grotesque?

"It is well fortified; and in this regard, it owes as much to nature as to art."

That is very true.

"There is a staggering number of stately palaces."

There are.

"And the numerous temples, sumptuous and magnificent, could hold their own against the most praised structures of antiquity."

I must acknowledge all of that. Still, there is an endless supply of mud huts and abominable hovels. We cannot help but notice an abundance of filth in every gutter, and were it not for the overpowering fumes of idolatrous incense, I have no doubt we would find the stench intolerable. Have you ever seen streets so insufferably narrow, or houses so miraculously tall? What gloom their shadows cast upon the ground! It is a good thing the swinging lamps in those endless colonnades are kept burning throughout the day; otherwise, we would have the darkness of Egypt during the time of her desolation.

"It is certainly a strange place! What is the meaning of that singular building over there? Look! It towers above all the others and lies to the east of what I assume is the royal palace!"

That is the new Temple of the Sun, who is adored in Syria under the title of Elah Gabalah. In the future, a very notorious Roman Emperor will establish this worship in Rome and derive a surname from it: Heliogabalus. I imagine you would like to take a look at the divinity of the temple. You need not look up at the heavens; his Sunship is not there—at least not the Sunship adored by the Syrians. That deity will be found inside that building. He is worshipped in the form of a large stone pillar that ends at the top in a cone or pyramid, which represents Fire.

"Listen—look!—who could those ridiculous beings be, half-naked, with their faces painted, shouting and gesturing to the crowd?"

Some are charlatans. Others belong more specifically to the class of philosophers. The majority, however—especially those who beat the populace with clubs—are the primary courtiers of the palace, performing, as is their duty, some commendable comedy for the king.

"But what do we have here? Heavens! The town is swarming with wild beasts! What a terrible spectacle! What a dangerous peculiarity!"

Terrible, if you like; but not in the least bit dangerous. Each animal, if you take the trouble to observe, is following its master quite quietly. A few, to be sure, are led by a rope around the neck, but these are mostly the smaller or timid species. The lion, the tiger, and the leopard are entirely unrestrained. They have been trained without difficulty for their current profession and attend their respective owners in the capacity of valets. It is true, there are occasions when nature asserts her violated authority; but then, the devouring of a soldier or the throttling of a consecrated bull is a circumstance of too little importance to be more than hinted at in Epidaphne.

"But what extraordinary tumult do I hear? Surely this is a loud noise even for Antioch! It suggests some commotion of unusual interest."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 021 / E4_021 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

He watched it as though it were a thing that could fascinate and make afraid, as though it held something that he longed for and yet almost loathed. His breath quickened. A mad craving came over him. He lit a cigarette and then threw it away. His eyelids drooped till the long fringed lashes almost touched his cheek. But he still watched the cabinet. At last he got up from the sofa on which he had been lying, went over to it, and having unlocked it, touched some hidden spring. A triangular drawer passed slowly out. His fingers moved instinctively towards it, dipped in, and closed on something. It was a small Chinese box of black and gold-dust lacquer, elaborately wrought, the sides patterned with curved waves, and the silken cords hung with round crystals and tasselled in plaited metal threads. He opened it. Inside was a green paste, waxy in lustre, the odour curiously heavy and persistent.

He hesitated for some moments, with a strangely immobile smile upon his face. Then shivering, though the atmosphere of the room was terribly hot, he drew himself up and glanced at the clock. It was twenty minutes to twelve. He put the box back, shutting the cabinet doors as he did so, and went into his bedroom.

As midnight was striking bronze blows upon the dusky air, Dorian Gray, dressed commonly, and with a muffler wrapped round his throat, crept quietly out of his house. In Bond Street he found a hansom with a good horse. He hailed it and in a low voice gave the driver an address.

The man shook his head. "It is too far for me," he muttered.

"Here is a sovereign for you," said Dorian. "You shall have another if you drive fast."

"All right, sir," answered the man, "you will be there in an hour," and after his fare had got in he turned his horse round and drove rapidly towards the river.

CHAPTER XVI.

A cold rain began to fall, and the blurred street-lamps looked ghastly in the dripping mist. The public-houses were just closing, and dim men and women were clustering in broken groups round their doors. From some of the bars came the sound of horrible laughter. In others, drunkards brawled and screamed.

Lying back in the hansom, with his hat pulled over his forehead, Dorian Gray watched with listless eyes the sordid shame of the great city, and now and then he repeated to himself the words that Lord Henry had said to him on the first day they had met, "To cure the soul by means of the senses, and the senses by means of the soul." Yes, that was the secret. He had often tried it, and would try it again now. There were opium dens where one could buy oblivion, dens of horror where the memory of old sins could be destroyed by the madness of sins that were new.

The moon hung low in the sky like a yellow skull. From time to time a huge misshapen cloud stretched a long arm across and hid it. The gas-lamps grew fewer, and the streets more narrow and gloomy. Once the man lost his way and had to drive back half a mile. A steam rose from the horse as it splashed up the puddles.

Rewritten passage

He observed it as if it were an object capable of both enchanting and terrifying him, as if it contained something he desired yet nearly detested. His breathing accelerated. An irrational yearning seized him. He ignited a cigarette, only to discard it immediately. His eyelids lowered until his long, fringed lashes nearly brushed his cheeks, yet he continued to gaze at the cabinet. Finally, he rose from the couch where he had been reclining, approached the piece of furniture, unlocked it, and pressed a concealed spring. A triangular compartment slid out gradually. His hand moved by instinct, reaching inside to grasp an object. It was a diminutive Chinese box crafted from black and gold-dust lacquer, intricately detailed with patterns of undulating waves on its sides, featuring silken cords adorned with spherical crystals and tassels of woven metal. He lifted the lid. Within lay a green paste with a waxy sheen, possessing a scent that was remarkably heavy and enduring.

He paused for several moments, a peculiar, frozen smile fixed upon his features. Then, trembling despite the intense heat of the room, he stood tall and checked the time. It was twenty minutes before midnight. He returned the box to its place, closed the cabinet doors, and retreated to his bedroom.

As midnight struck with bronze tolls against the dark atmosphere, Dorian Gray, wearing plain attire and a muffler wound about his neck, slipped silently from his residence. On Bond Street, he located a hansom cab pulled by a sturdy horse. He signaled the driver and whispered a destination.

The driver shook his head. "That is too great a distance for me," he grumbled.

"I will give you a sovereign," Dorian offered. "You shall receive another if you travel with haste."

"Very well, sir," the man replied, "you will arrive within the hour." Once his passenger had boarded, he turned the horse and sped toward the river.

CHAPTER XVI.

A chilly rain commenced, and the indistinct streetlights appeared spectral within the sodden fog. The taverns were in the process of shutting, and shadowy figures of men and women gathered in fragmented clusters near the entrances. From certain establishments, the noise of grotesque laughter emerged. In others, intoxicated patrons shouted and fought.

Reclining within the hansom with his hat brim pulled low, Dorian Gray observed the wretched disgrace of the sprawling city with apathetic eyes, occasionally whispering to himself the phrase Lord Henry had spoken upon their initial meeting: "To heal the soul through the senses, and the senses through the soul." Indeed, that was the mystery. He had frequently attempted it, and he would attempt it once more. There existed opium dens where one might purchase forgetfulness, chambers of dread where the recollection of past transgressions could be obliterated by the frenzy of fresh ones.

The moon remained low, resembling a yellow skull. Periodically, a massive, distorted cloud extended a lengthy limb to obscure it. The gaslights became sparse, and the thoroughfares grew narrower and more ominous. At one point, the driver lost his direction and was forced to backtrack for half a mile. Steam billowed from the horse as it splashed through the puddles.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 022 / E4_022 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

He never said a great deal, nor did she give herself the trouble of talking or of listening much; but it struck her in the course of their third encounter that he was asking some odd unconnected questions--about her pleasure in being at Hunsford, her love of solitary walks, and her opinion of Mr. and Mrs. Collins's happiness; and that in speaking of Rosings, and her not perfectly understanding the house, he seemed to expect that whenever she came into Kent again she would be staying _there_ too. His words seemed to imply it. Could he have Colonel Fitzwilliam in his thoughts? She supposed, if he meant anything, he must mean an allusion to what might arise in that quarter. It distressed her a little, and she was quite glad to find herself at the gate in the pales opposite the Parsonage.

She was engaged one day, as she walked, in re-perusing Jane's last letter, and dwelling on some passages which proved that Jane had not written in spirits, when, instead of being again surprised by Mr. Darcy, she saw, on looking up, that Colonel Fitzwilliam was meeting her. Putting away the letter immediately, and forcing a smile, she said,--

"I did not know before that you ever walked this way."

"I have been making the tour of the park," he replied, "as I generally do every year, and intended to close it with a call at the Parsonage. Are you going much farther?"

"No, I should have turned in a moment."

And accordingly she did turn, and they walked towards the Parsonage together.

"Do you certainly leave Kent on Saturday?" said she.

"Yes--if Darcy does not put it off again. But I am at his disposal. He arranges the business just as he pleases."

"And if not able to please himself in the arrangement, he has at least great pleasure in the power of choice. I do not know anybody who seems more to enjoy the power of doing what he likes than Mr. Darcy."

"He likes to have his own way very well," replied Colonel Fitzwilliam. "But so we all do. It is only that he has better means of having it than many others, because he is rich, and many others are poor. I speak feelingly. A younger son, you know, must be inured to self-denial and dependence."

"In my opinion, the younger son of an earl can know very little of either. Now, seriously, what have you ever known of self-denial and dependence? When have you been prevented by want of money from going wherever you chose or procuring anything you had a fancy for?"

"These are home questions--and perhaps I cannot say that I have experienced many hardships of that nature. But in matters of greater weight, I may suffer from the want of money. Younger sons cannot marry where they like."

"Unless where they like women of fortune, which I think they very often do."

"Our habits of expense make us too dependent, and there are not many in my rank of life who can afford to marry without some attention to money."

"Is this," thought Elizabeth, "meant for me?" and she coloured at the idea; but, recovering herself, said in a lively tone, "And pray, what is the usual price of an earl's younger son?"

Rewritten passage

He spoke very little, and she did not exert herself to converse or attend to him; yet, during their third meeting, she noticed he posed several strange, disjointed inquiries regarding her enjoyment of Hunsford, her preference for lonely strolls, and her thoughts on the domestic contentment of Mr. and Mrs. Collins. Furthermore, when discussing Rosings and her lack of familiarity with the estate, he appeared to assume that her next visit to Kent would involve staying there. His remarks suggested as much. Was he considering Colonel Fitzwilliam? She surmised that if his comments held any significance, they must refer to a potential connection in that direction. This thought troubled her slightly, and she felt relieved to reach the gate in the fence across from the Parsonage.

One day, while walking and absorbed in reading Jane's latest letter—reflecting on sections that indicated Jane's low spirits—she looked up to find Colonel Fitzwilliam approaching, rather than the usual surprise of Mr. Darcy. Quickly stowing the letter and summoning a smile, she remarked,

"I was unaware that you ever strolled in this direction."

"I have been circling the park," he answered, "as is my annual custom, and I planned to finish by stopping at the Parsonage. Do you intend to walk much further?"

"No, I was just about to turn back."

She turned as she said this, and they walked toward the Parsonage in company.

"Are you definitely departing Kent on Saturday?" she asked.

"Yes—provided Darcy does not postpone it once more. I am subject to his schedule. He manages our affairs exactly as he sees fit."

"And if he cannot satisfy himself with the plan, he at least takes great satisfaction in his ability to decide. I cannot think of anyone who appears to relish the freedom to act as he pleases more than Mr. Darcy."

"He certainly enjoys having his own way," Colonel Fitzwilliam responded. "But we all do. The difference is that he possesses greater resources to achieve it than most, being wealthy while others are not. I speak from experience. A younger son, you realize, must become accustomed to sacrifice and reliance on others."

"In my view, an earl's younger son can understand very little of either. Tell me truly, what have you ever experienced of sacrifice or dependence? When have you been stopped by a lack of funds from traveling where you wished or obtaining anything you desired?"

"Those are pointed questions—and perhaps I cannot claim to have faced many such difficulties. Yet, in more significant matters, I may suffer due to a lack of wealth. Younger sons are not free to marry whom they choose."

"Unless they choose women of wealth, which I suspect they frequently do."

"Our expensive lifestyles render us too reliant on others, and few in my social standing can manage to marry without considering financial matters."

"Is this," Elizabeth wondered, "directed at me?" She flushed at the notion, but regaining her composure, she replied with a playful air, "And tell me, what is the typical market value of an earl's younger son?"

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 023 / E4_023 / condition: modernize

Original passage

Her huge hull was of a deep dingy black, unrelieved by any of the customary carvings of a ship. A single row of brass cannon protruded from her open ports, and dashed from their polished surfaces the fires of innumerable battle-lanterns, which swung to and fro about her rigging. But what mainly inspired us with horror and astonishment, was that she bore up under a press of sail in the very teeth of that supernatural sea, and of that ungovernable hurricane. When we first discovered her, her bows were alone to be seen, as she rose slowly from the dim and horrible gulf beyond her. For a moment of intense terror she paused upon the giddy pinnacle, as if in contemplation of her own sublimity, then trembled and tottered, and—came down.

At this instant, I know not what sudden self-possession came over my spirit. Staggering as far aft as I could, I awaited fearlessly the ruin that was to overwhelm. Our own vessel was at length ceasing from her struggles, and sinking with her head to the sea. The shock of the descending mass struck her, consequently, in that portion of her frame which was already under water, and the inevitable result was to hurl me, with irresistible violence, upon the rigging of the stranger.

As I fell, the ship hove in stays, and went about; and to the confusion ensuing I attributed my escape from the notice of the crew. With little difficulty I made my way unperceived to the main hatchway, which was partially open, and soon found an opportunity of secreting myself in the hold. Why I did so I can hardly tell. An indefinite sense of awe, which at first sight of the navigators of the ship had taken hold of my mind, was perhaps the principle of my concealment. I was unwilling to trust myself with a race of people who had offered, to the cursory glance I had taken, so many points of vague novelty, doubt, and apprehension. I therefore thought proper to contrive a hiding-place in the hold. This I did by removing a small portion of the shifting-boards, in such a manner as to afford me a convenient retreat between the huge timbers of the ship.

I had scarcely completed my work, when a footstep in the hold forced me to make use of it. A man passed by my place of concealment with a feeble and unsteady gait. I could not see his face, but had an opportunity of observing his general appearance. There was about it an evidence of great age and infirmity. His knees tottered beneath a load of years, and his entire frame quivered under the burthen. He muttered to himself, in a low broken tone, some words of a language which I could not understand, and groped in a corner among a pile of singular-looking instruments, and decayed charts of navigation. His manner was a wild mixture of the peevishness of second childhood, and the solemn dignity of a God. He at length went on deck, and I saw him no more.

A feeling, for which I have no name, has taken possession of my soul—a sensation which will admit of no analysis, to which the lessons of bygone times are inadequate, and for which I fear futurity itself will offer me no key.

Rewritten passage

Her massive hull was a deep, dingy black, lacking any of the usual ship carvings. A single row of brass cannons poked out from her open ports, reflecting the light from countless battle-lanterns swinging back and forth in the rigging. But what truly filled us with horror and amazement was that she held her course under full sail directly into the teeth of that supernatural sea and uncontrollable hurricane. When we first spotted her, only her bow was visible as she rose slowly from the dark, terrifying abyss behind her. For a moment of intense terror, she paused at the dizzying peak, as if contemplating her own grandeur, then she trembled, teetered, and came crashing down.

At that moment, I don't know what sudden calm came over me. Staggering as far toward the stern as I could, I fearlessly awaited the destruction that was about to overwhelm us. Our own ship was finally giving up the fight, sinking bow-first into the sea. The impact of the descending mass struck our vessel in the section already submerged, and the inevitable result was that I was hurled with irresistible force onto the rigging of the stranger.

As I fell, the ship tacked and turned; I credited the resulting confusion for my escape from the crew's notice. With little difficulty, I made my way unseen to the main hatch, which was partially open, and soon found a chance to hide in the hold. Why I did so, I can hardly say. A vague sense of awe, which had gripped my mind the moment I saw the ship's navigators, was perhaps the reason for my hiding. I was unwilling to trust myself among a group of people who, in the brief glance I had caught, presented so many points of strange novelty, doubt, and apprehension. I therefore thought it best to arrange a hiding spot in the hold. I did this by removing a small section of the shifting-boards, creating a convenient retreat between the ship's massive timbers.

I had barely finished when a footstep in the hold forced me to use it. A man walked past my hiding place with a weak, unsteady gait. I couldn't see his face, but I had the chance to observe his general appearance. There was evidence of extreme age and frailty about him. His knees shook under the weight of his years, and his entire frame trembled under the burden. He muttered to himself in a low, broken tone, using words from a language I didn't understand, and fumbled in a corner among a pile of strange-looking instruments and rotted navigation charts. His manner was a wild mix of the irritability of second childhood and the solemn dignity of a god. Eventually, he went up to the deck, and I saw him no more.

A feeling for which I have no name has taken hold of my soul—a sensation that defies analysis, for which the lessons of the past are inadequate, and for which I fear the future itself will offer no explanation.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 024 / E4_024 / condition: modernize

Original passage

I knocked at the door, and a respectable-looking woman opened it to me. I asked her if she had any rooms to let. "Well, sir," she replied, "the drawing-rooms are supposed to be let; but I have not seen the lady for three months, and as rent is owing on them, you can have them."—"Is this the lady?" I said, showing the photograph. "That's her, sure enough," she exclaimed; "and when is she coming back, sir?"—"The lady is dead," I replied. "Oh sir, I hope not!" said the woman; "she was my best lodger. She paid me three guineas a week merely to sit in my drawing-rooms now and then." "She met some one here?" I said; but the woman assured me that it was not so, that she always came alone, and saw no one. "What on earth did she do here?" I cried. "She simply sat in the drawing-room, sir, reading books, and sometimes had tea," the woman answered. I did not know what to say, so I gave her a sovereign and went away. Now, what do you think it all meant? You don't believe the woman was telling the truth?

'I do.'

'Then why did Lady Alroy go there?'

'My dear Gerald,' I answered, 'Lady Alroy was simply a woman with a mania for mystery. She took these rooms for the pleasure of going there with her veil down, and imagining she was a heroine. She had a passion for secrecy, but she herself was merely a Sphinx without a secret.'

'Do you really think so?'

'I am sure of it,' I replied.

He took out the morocco case, opened it, and looked at the photograph. 'I wonder?' he said at last.

THE MODEL MILLIONAIRE A NOTE OF ADMIRATION

UNLESS one is wealthy there is no use in being a charming fellow. Romance is the privilege of the rich, not the profession of the unemployed. The poor should be practical and prosaic. It is better to have a permanent income than to be fascinating. These are the great truths of modern life which Hughie Erskine never realised. Poor Hughie! Intellectually, we must admit, he was not of much importance. He never said a brilliant or even an ill-natured thing in his life. But then he was wonderfully good-looking, with his crisp brown hair, his clear-cut profile, and his grey eyes. He was as popular with men as he was with women and he had every accomplishment except that of making money. His father had bequeathed him his cavalry sword and a _History of the Peninsular War_ in fifteen volumes. Hughie hung the first over his looking-glass, put the second on a shelf between _Ruff's Guide_ and _Bailey's Magazine_, and lived on two hundred a year that an old aunt allowed him. He had tried everything. He had gone on the Stock Exchange for six months; but what was a butterfly to do among bulls and bears? He had been a tea-merchant for a little longer, but had soon tired of pekoe and souchong. Then he had tried selling dry sherry. That did not answer; the sherry was a little too dry. Ultimately he became nothing, a delightful, ineffectual young man with a perfect profile and no profession.

To make matters worse, he was in love.

Rewritten passage

I knocked on the door, and a respectable-looking woman opened it. I asked if she had any rooms available. "Well, sir," she replied, "the drawing-rooms are technically rented, but I haven't seen the lady in three months, and since she owes rent, you can have them." "Is this the lady?" I asked, showing her the photograph. "That's her, all right," she exclaimed, "and when is she coming back, sir?" "The lady is dead," I replied. "Oh, sir, I hope not!" the woman said. "She was my best tenant. She paid me three guineas a week just to sit in my drawing-rooms occasionally." "Did she meet someone here?" I asked, but the woman insisted that wasn't the case, saying she always came alone and saw no one. "What on earth did she do here?" I cried. "She simply sat in the drawing-room, sir, reading books, and sometimes had tea," the woman answered. I didn't know what to say, so I gave her a sovereign and left. Now, what do you think it all meant? You don't believe the

woman was telling the truth?"

"I do."

"Then why did Lady Alroy go there?"

"My dear Gerald," I answered, "Lady Alroy was simply a woman with a mania for mystery. She rented those rooms for the thrill of going there with her veil down and imagining she was a heroine. She had a passion for secrecy, but she was merely a Sphinx without a secret."

"Do you really think so?"

"I am sure of it," I replied.

He took out the leather case, opened it, and looked at the photograph. "I wonder?" he said at last.

THE MODEL MILLIONAIRE A NOTE OF ADMIRATION

UNLESS you are wealthy, there is no point in being a charming fellow. Romance is the privilege of the rich, not the career of the unemployed. The poor should be practical and down-to-earth. It is better to have a steady income than to be fascinating. These are the great truths of modern life that Hughie Erskine never realized. Poor Hughie! Intellectually, we must admit, he was not of much importance. He never said a brilliant or even a mean-spirited thing in his life. But then he was wonderfully good-looking, with his crisp brown hair, his clear-cut profile, and his grey eyes. He was as popular with men as he was with women, and he had every talent except that of making money. His father had bequeathed him his cavalry sword and a History of the Peninsular War in fifteen volumes. Hughie hung the sword over his mirror, put the books on a shelf between a racing guide and a magazine, and lived on two hundred a year that an old aunt allowed him. He had tried everything. He had worked on the Stock Exchange for six months, but what was a butterfly to do among aggressive traders? He had been a tea merchant for a little longer, but had soon tired of the business. Then he had tried selling dry sherry. That didn't work; the sherry was a little too dry. Ultimately he became nothing, a delightful, ineffectual young man with a perfect profile and no profession.

To make matters worse, he was in love.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 025 / E4_025 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

But little time will be left me to ponder upon my destiny! The circles rapidly grow small—we are plunging madly within the grasp of the whirlpool—and amid a roaring, and bellowing, and thundering of ocean and of tempest, the ship is quivering—oh God! and—going down.

NOTE.—The “MS. Found in a Bottle,” was originally published in 1831, and it was not until many years afterwards that I became acquainted with the maps of Mercator, in which the ocean is represented as rushing, by four mouths, into the (northern) Polar Gulf, to be absorbed into the bowels of the earth; the Pole itself being represented by a black rock, towering to a prodigious height.

THE OVAL PORTRAIT

The château into which my valet had ventured to make forcible entrance, rather than permit me, in my desperately wounded condition, to pass a night in the open air, was one of those piles of commingled gloom and grandeur which have so long frowned among the Appennines, not less in fact than in the fancy of Mrs. Radcliffe. To all appearance it had been temporarily and very lately abandoned. We established ourselves in one of the smallest and least sumptuously furnished apartments. It lay in a remote turret of the building. Its decorations were rich, yet tattered and antique. Its walls were hung with tapestry and bedecked with manifold and multiform armorial trophies, together with an unusually great number of very spirited modern paintings in frames of rich golden arabesque. In these paintings, which depended from the walls not only in their main surfaces, but in very many nooks which the bizarre architecture of the château rendered necessary—in these paintings my incipient delirium, perhaps, had caused me to take deep interest; so that I bade Pedro to close the heavy shutters of the room—since it was already night—to light the tongues of a tall candelabrum which stood by the head of my bed, and to throw open far and wide the fringed curtains of black velvet which enveloped the bed itself. I wished all this done that I might resign myself, if not to sleep, at least alternately to the contemplation of these pictures, and the perusal of a small volume which had been found upon the pillow, and which purported to criticise and describe them.

Long, long I read—and devoutly, devotedly I gazed. Rapidly and gloriously the hours flew by and the deep midnight came. The position of the candelabrum displeased me, and outreaching my hand with difficulty, rather than disturb my slumbering valet, I placed it so as to throw its rays more fully upon the book.

But the action produced an effect altogether unanticipated. The rays of the numerous candles (for there were many) now fell within a niche of the room which had hitherto been thrown into deep shade by one of the bed-posts. I thus saw in vivid light a picture all unnoticed before. It was the portrait of a young girl just ripening into womanhood. I glanced at the painting hurriedly, and then closed my eyes. Why I did this was not at first apparent even to my own perception. But while my lids remained thus shut, I ran over in my mind my reason for so shutting them. It was an impulsive movement to gain time for thought—to make sure that my vision had not deceived me—to calm and subdue my fancy for a more sober and more certain gaze.

Rewritten passage

I have scant moments remaining to contemplate my fate! The rings are shrinking fast—we are hurtling violently into the vortex's hold—and amidst the deafening roar, bellowing, and thunder of the sea and storm, the vessel trembles—merciful God! and—sinks.

NOTE.—“MS. Found in a Bottle” first appeared in 1831, and it was only many years later that I discovered Mercator's maps, which depict the

ocean pouring through four openings into the (northern) Polar Gulf to be swallowed by the earth's core; the Pole itself is shown as a black rock of immense height.

THE OVAL PORTRAIT

The castle my servant had broken into, rather than let me spend the night outdoors in my severely injured state, was one of those structures of mixed melancholy and majesty that have long loomed over the Apennines, both in reality and in the imagination of Mrs. Radcliffe. It seemed to have been deserted quite recently. We settled into one of the smallest, least opulent rooms, located in a distant turret. Its furnishings were ornate but worn and aged. The walls were covered in tapestries and adorned with various heraldic displays, along with a large collection of vibrant modern paintings in elaborate golden frames. These artworks, hanging not only on the main walls but also in the many alcoves created by the castle's strange design—these paintings, perhaps due to my early fever, captured my intense interest; I instructed Pedro to shut the heavy window shutters—as night had fallen—to ignite the candles of a tall candelabrum beside my bed, and to pull back the fringed black velvet curtains surrounding the bed. I desired this so I could surrender myself, if not to slumber, then to alternating between studying these images and reading a small book found on the pillow, which claimed to critique and explain them.

I read for a very long time, gazing with devotion and intensity. The hours passed swiftly and brilliantly until deep midnight arrived. The placement of the candelabrum bothered me, and reaching out with effort, rather than waking my sleeping servant, I adjusted it to cast its light more directly onto the book.

However, this movement had an entirely unexpected result. The light from the many candles now illuminated a niche in the room that had previously been cast into deep shadow by a bedpost. I thus beheld in clear light a portrait I had not noticed before. It was the likeness of a young woman transitioning into adulthood. I looked at the painting briefly, then shut my eyes. The reason for this was not immediately clear to me. Yet, while my eyes were closed, I reviewed my motive for doing so. It was an instinctive reaction to allow myself time to reflect—to confirm my sight had not misled me—to quiet and restrain my imagination for a more composed and certain look.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 026 / E4_026 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

Suddenly he thought of his friend Rouvaloff, a young Russian of very revolutionary tendencies, whom he had met at Lady Windermere's in the winter. Count Rouvaloff was supposed to be writing a life of Peter the Great, and to have come over to England for the purpose of studying the documents relating to that Tsar's residence in this country as a ship carpenter; but it was generally suspected that he was a Nihilist agent, and there was no doubt that the Russian Embassy did not look with any favour upon his presence in London. Lord Arthur felt that he was just the man for his purpose, and drove down one morning to his lodgings in Bloomsbury, to ask his advice and assistance.

'So you are taking up politics seriously?' said Count Rouvaloff, when Lord Arthur had told him the object of his mission; but Lord Arthur, who hated swagger of any kind, felt bound to admit to him that he had not the slightest interest in social questions, and simply wanted the explosive machine for a purely family matter, in which no one was concerned but himself.

Count Rouvaloff looked at him for some moments in amazement, and then seeing that he was quite serious, wrote an address on a piece of paper, initialled it, and handed it to him across the table.

'Scotland Yard would give a good deal to know this address, my dear fellow.'

'They shan't have it,' cried Lord Arthur, laughing; and after shaking the young Russian warmly by the hand he ran downstairs, examined the paper, and told the coachman to drive to Soho Square.

There he dismissed him, and strolled down Greek Street, till he came to a place called Bayle's Court. He passed under the archway, and found himself in a curious _cul-de-sac_, that was apparently occupied by a French Laundry, as a perfect network of clothes-lines was stretched across from house to house, and there was a flutter of white linen in the morning air. He walked right to the end, and knocked at a little green house. After some delay, during which every window in the court became a blurred mass of peering faces, the door was opened by a rather rough-looking foreigner, who asked him in very bad English what his business was. Lord Arthur handed him the paper Count Rouvaloff had given him. When the man saw it he bowed, and invited Lord Arthur into a very shabby front parlour on the ground floor, and in a few moments Herr Winckelkopf, as he was called in England, bustled into the room, with a very wine-stained napkin round his neck, and a fork in his left hand.

'Count Rouvaloff has given me an introduction to you,' said Lord Arthur, bowing, 'and I am anxious to have a short interview with you on a matter of business. My name is Smith, Mr. Robert Smith, and I want you to supply me with an explosive clock.'

'Charmed to meet you, Lord Arthur,' said the genial little German, laughing. 'Don't look so alarmed, it is my duty to know everybody, and I remember seeing you one evening at Lady Windermere's. I hope her ladyship is quite well. Do you mind sitting with me while I finish my breakfast? There is an excellent _pâté_, and my friends are kind enough to say that my Rhine wine is better than any they get at the German Embassy,' and before Lord Arthur had got over his surprise at being recognised, he found himself seated in the back-room, sipping the most delicious Marcobrunner out of a pale yellow hock-glass marked with the Imperial monogram, and chatting in the friendliest manner possible to the famous conspirator.

Rewritten passage

Abruptly, he recalled his acquaintance Rouvaloff, a youthful Russian with radical leanings, whom he had encountered at Lady Windermere's during the winter. Count Rouvaloff was ostensibly composing a biography of Peter the Great, having traveled to England to examine records concerning that Tsar's time spent working as a shipwright; however, it was widely believed he functioned as a Nihilist operative, and the Russian Embassy clearly viewed his London residency with disapproval. Lord Arthur concluded he was the ideal individual for his needs, so he traveled one morning to his Bloomsbury quarters to request his counsel and aid.

'So you are engaging in politics with sincerity?' Count Rouvaloff inquired once Lord Arthur had explained his errand; yet Lord Arthur, who

detested any form of pretension, felt compelled to confess that he possessed no interest in social issues, desiring the explosive device solely for a private family affair involving only himself.

Count Rouvaloff stared at him in astonishment for a time, then, realizing he was entirely earnest, scribbled an address on a slip of paper, marked it with his initials, and passed it over the table.

'Scotland Yard would pay handsomely to possess this location, my dear friend.'

'They shall not have it,' Lord Arthur exclaimed, laughing; and after shaking the young Russian's hand cordially, he hurried down the stairs, inspected the note, and instructed his driver to proceed to Soho Square.

There he let the carriage go and wandered down Greek Street until reaching a location known as Bayle's Court. He walked beneath the archway, entering a strange dead-end street that seemed to house a French laundry, as a complex web of laundry lines spanned the buildings, with white linens fluttering in the morning breeze. He proceeded to the far end and rapped on a small green dwelling. Following a pause, during which every window in the court filled with curious, blurred faces, the door was opened by a coarse-featured foreigner who inquired in broken English regarding his purpose. Lord Arthur presented the paper provided by Count Rouvaloff. Upon seeing it, the man bowed and ushered Lord Arthur into a dilapidated front parlor on the ground floor. Shortly thereafter, Herr Winckelkopf, as he was known in England, bustled into the room wearing a wine-spotted napkin around his neck and holding a fork in his left hand.

'Count Rouvaloff provided me with an introduction to you,' Lord Arthur stated, bowing, 'and I wish to have a brief consultation regarding a business matter. My name is Smith, Mr. Robert Smith, and I require you to provide me with an explosive clock.'

'Delighted to make your acquaintance, Lord Arthur,' the cheerful little German replied, laughing. 'Do not appear so startled; it is my responsibility to know everyone, and I recall seeing you one evening at Lady Windermere's. I trust her ladyship is in good health. Would you mind joining me while I conclude my breakfast? There is a superb pâté, and my associates are kind enough to claim that my Rhine wine surpasses anything served at the German Embassy.' Before Lord Arthur had recovered from the shock of being identified, he found himself seated in the rear room, drinking exquisite Marcobrunner from a pale yellow hock-glass bearing the Imperial monogram, and conversing in the most amiable fashion with the renowned conspirator.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 027 / E4_027 / condition: simplify

Original passage

I rejected a thousand schemes, because their accomplishment involved a _chance_ of detection. At length, in reading some French memoirs, I found an account of a nearly fatal illness that occurred to Madame Pilau, through the agency of a candle accidentally poisoned. The idea struck my fancy at once. I knew my victim's habit of reading in bed. I knew, too, that his apartment was narrow and ill-ventilated. But I need not vex you with impertinent details. I need not describe the easy artifices by which I substituted, in his bed-room candle-stand, a wax-light of my own making for the one which I there found. The next morning he was discovered dead in his bed, and the coroner's verdict was—"Death by the visitation of God."

Having inherited his estate, all went well with me for years. The idea of detection never once entered my brain. Of the remains of the fatal taper I had myself carefully disposed. I had left no shadow of a clew by which it would be possible to convict, or even to suspect me of the crime. It is inconceivable how rich a sentiment of satisfaction arose in my bosom as I reflected upon my absolute security. For a very long period of time I was accustomed to revel in this sentiment. It afforded me more real delight than all the mere worldly advantages accruing from my sin. But there arrived at length an epoch, from which the pleasurable feeling grew, by scarcely perceptible gradations, into a haunting and harassing thought. It harassed because it haunted. I could scarcely get rid of it for an instant. It is quite a common thing to be thus annoyed with the ringing in our ears, or rather in our memories, of the burthen of some ordinary song, or some unimpressive snatches from an opera. Nor will we be the less tormented if the song in itself be good, or the opera air meritorious. In this manner, at last, I would perpetually catch myself pondering upon my security, and repeating, in a low undertone, the phrase, "I am safe."

One day, whilst sauntering along the streets, I arrested myself in the act of murmuring, half aloud, these customary syllables. In a fit of petulance, I remodelled them thus: "I am safe—I am safe—yes—if I be not fool enough to make open confession!"

No sooner had I spoken these words, than I felt an icy chill creep to my heart. I had had some experience in these fits of perversity (whose nature I have been at some trouble to explain), and I remembered well that in no instance I had successfully resisted their attacks. And now my own casual self-suggestion that I might possibly be fool enough to confess the murder of which I had been guilty, confronted me, as if the very ghost of him whom I had murdered—and beckoned me on to death.

At first, I made an effort to shake off this nightmare of the soul. I walked vigorously—faster—still faster—at length I ran. I felt a maddening desire to shriek aloud. Every succeeding wave of thought overwhelmed me with new terror, for, alas! I well, too well understood that to think, in my situation, was to be lost. I still quickened my pace.

Rewritten passage

I rejected a thousand plans because they all carried a risk of being caught. Eventually, while reading some French memoirs, I found a story about a nearly fatal illness that happened to Madame Pilau due to an accidentally poisoned candle. The idea immediately appealed to me. I knew my victim had a habit of reading in bed. I also knew his room was small and poorly ventilated. However, I do not need to bore you with unnecessary details. I do not need to describe the simple tricks I used to replace the candle in his bedroom with one I had made myself. The next morning, he was found dead in his bed, and the coroner's verdict was, "Death by the visitation of God."

Having inherited his estate, everything went well for me for years. The thought of being caught never once entered my mind. I had carefully disposed of the remains of the fatal candle myself. I had left no trace that could possibly convict me or even make anyone suspect me of the crime. It is hard to imagine how much satisfaction I felt as I thought about my total safety. For a very long time, I enjoyed this feeling. It gave me more real pleasure than all the worldly benefits I gained from my sin. But eventually, a time came when this pleasant feeling slowly turned into a haunting and troubling thought. It troubled me because it haunted me. I could barely get rid of it for a moment. It is quite common to be annoyed by a song or a bit of music stuck in our heads. We are not any less tormented even if the song or the music is actually good. In this way, I eventually found myself constantly thinking about my safety and repeating the phrase, "I am safe," in a low whisper.

One day, while walking along the streets, I caught myself murmuring these usual words out loud. In a moment of irritation, I changed them to: "I am safe—I am safe—yes—if I am not foolish enough to confess!"

No sooner had I spoken these words than I felt an icy chill creep into my heart. I had experienced these moments of perversity before (the nature of which I have tried to explain), and I remembered well that I had never successfully resisted them. Now, my own casual suggestion that I might be foolish enough to confess the murder I had committed confronted me like the ghost of the man I had killed, beckoning me toward my own death.

At first, I tried to shake off this mental nightmare. I walked vigorously—faster—still faster—until finally, I ran. I felt a maddening desire to scream. Every new thought overwhelmed me with fresh terror, for I knew all too well that, in my situation, to think was to be lost. I continued to quicken my pace.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 028 / E4_028 / condition: simplify

Original passage

These few words had been said apart, so as to be inaudible to Oliver. The man touched his hat; and glancing at Oliver with some curiosity, opened another gate, opposite to that by which they had entered, and led them on, through dark and winding ways, towards the cells.

"This," said the man, stopping in a gloomy passage where a couple of workmen were making some preparations in profound silence—"this is the place he passes through. If you step this way, you can see the door he goes out at."

He led them into a stone kitchen, fitted with coppers for dressing the prison food, and pointed to a door. There was an open grating above it, through which came the sound of men's voices, mingled with the noise of hammering, and the throwing down of boards. They were putting up the scaffold.

From this place, they passed through several strong gates, opened by other turnkeys from the inner side; and, having entered an open yard, ascended a flight of narrow steps, and came into a passage with a row of strong doors on the left hand. Motioning them to remain where they were, the turnkey knocked at one of these with his bunch of keys. The two attendants, after a little whispering, came out into the passage, stretching themselves as if glad of the temporary relief, and motioned the visitors to follow the jailer into the cell. They did so.

The condemned criminal was seated on his bed, rocking himself from side to side, with a countenance more like that of a snared beast than the face of a man. His mind was evidently wandering to his old life, for he continued to mutter, without appearing conscious of their presence otherwise than as a part of his vision.

"Good boy, Charley—well done—" he mumbled. "Oliver, too, ha! ha! ha! Oliver too—quite the gentleman now—quite the—take that boy away to bed!"

The jailer took the disengaged hand of Oliver; and, whispering him not to be alarmed, looked on without speaking.

"Take him away to bed!" cried Fagin. "Do you hear me, some of you? He has been the—the—somehow the cause of all this. It's worth the money to bring him up to it—Bolter's throat, Bill; never mind the girl—Bolter's throat as deep as you can cut. Saw his head off!"

"Fagin," said the jailer.

"That's me!" cried the Jew, falling instantly, into the attitude of listening he had assumed upon his trial. "An old man, my Lord; a very old, old man!"

"Here," said the turnkey, laying his hand upon his breast to keep him down. "Here's somebody wants to see you, to ask you some questions, I suppose. Fagin, Fagin! Are you a man?"

"I shan't be one long," he replied, looking up with a face retaining no human expression but rage and terror. "Strike them all dead! What right have they to butcher me?"

As he spoke he caught sight of Oliver and Mr. Brownlow. Shrinking to the furthest corner of the seat, he demanded to know what they wanted there.

"Steady," said the turnkey, still holding him down. "Now, sir, tell him what you want. Quick, if you please, for he grows worse as the time gets on."

Rewritten passage

These few words were spoken quietly, so Oliver could not hear them. The man touched his hat, looked at Oliver with curiosity, opened a gate across from the one they had entered, and led them through dark, winding paths toward the cells.

"This," the man said, stopping in a gloomy hallway where two workmen were preparing something in total silence, "is the place he walks through. If you step this way, you can see the door he exits through."

He led them into a stone kitchen, equipped with large pots for cooking prison food, and pointed to a door. Above it was an open grate, through which they could hear men's voices mixed with the sound of hammering and boards being dropped. They were building the scaffold.

From there, they passed through several heavy gates, opened by other guards from the inside. After entering an open yard, they climbed a set of narrow stairs and reached a hallway with a row of sturdy doors on the left. Signaling for them to wait, the guard knocked on one of the doors with his keys. After whispering briefly, two attendants stepped out into the hall, stretching as if relieved to be away, and motioned for the visitors to follow the jailer into the cell. They went inside.

The condemned prisoner sat on his bed, rocking back and forth. His face looked more like a trapped animal's than a man's. His mind was clearly drifting to his past, as he kept muttering, seemingly unaware of their presence except as part of his own thoughts.

"Good boy, Charley—well done," he mumbled. "Oliver, too, ha! ha! ha! Oliver too—quite the gentleman now—quite the—take that boy away to bed!"

The jailer took Oliver's free hand and whispered for him not to be afraid, then watched silently.

"Take him away to bed!" Fagin shouted. "Do you hear me, some of you? He has been the—the—somehow the cause of all this. It's worth the money to bring him up to it—Bolter's throat, Bill; never mind the girl—Bolter's throat as deep as you can cut. Saw his head off!"

"Fagin," the jailer said.

"That's me!" the old man cried, instantly adopting the listening posture he had used during his trial. "An old man, my Lord; a very old, old man!"

"Here," the guard said, placing a hand on his chest to hold him down. "Someone is here to see you, I suppose to ask you some questions. Fagin, Fagin! Are you a man?"

"I won't be one for long," he replied, looking up with a face that showed only rage and terror. "Strike them all dead! What right do they have to butcher me?"

As he spoke, he saw Oliver and Mr. Brownlow. Shrinking into the far corner of his seat, he demanded to know why they were there.

"Steady," the guard said, still holding him down. "Now, sir, tell him what you want. Be quick, please, because he is getting worse as the time passes."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 029 / E4_029 / condition: simplify

Original passage

You
better stay here all night. Take off your bonnet."

"No," I says; "I'll rest a while, I reckon, and go on. I ain't afeared of the dark."

She said she wouldn't let me go by myself, but her husband would be in by-and-by, maybe in a hour and a half, and she'd send him along with me. Then she got to talking about her husband, and about her relations up the river, and her relations down the river, and about how much better off they used to was, and how they didn't know but they'd made a mistake coming to our town, instead of letting well alone—and so on and so on, till I was afeard I had made a mistake coming to her to find out what was going on in the town; but by-and-by she dropped on to pap and the murder, and then I was pretty willing to let her clatter right along. She told about me and Tom Sawyer finding the six thousand dollars (only she got it ten) and all about pap and what a hard lot he was, and what a hard lot I was, and at last she got down to where I was murdered. I says:

"Who done it? We've heard considerable about these goings on down in Hookerville, but we don't know who 'twas that killed Huck Finn."

"Well, I reckon there's a right smart chance of people here that'd like to know who killed him. Some think old Finn done it himself."

"No—is that so?"

"Most everybody thought it at first. He'll never know how nigh he come to getting lynched. But before night they changed around and judged it was done by a runaway nigger named Jim."

"Why he—"

I stopped. I reckoned I better keep still. She run on, and never noticed I had put in at all:

"The nigger run off the very night Huck Finn was killed. So there's a reward out for him—three hundred dollars. And there's a reward out for old Finn, too—two hundred dollars. You see, he come to town the morning after the murder, and told about it, and was out with 'em on the ferry-boat hunt, and right away after he up and left. Before night they wanted to lynch him, but he was gone, you see. Well, next day they found out the nigger was gone; they found out he hadn't ben seen sence ten o'clock the night the murder was done. So then they put it on him, you see; and while they was full of it, next day, back comes old Finn, and went boo-hooing to Judge Thatcher to get money to hunt for the nigger all over Illinois with. The judge gave him some, and that evening he got drunk, and was around till after midnight with a couple of mighty hard-looking strangers, and then went off with them. Well, he hain't come back sence, and they ain't looking for him back till this thing blows over a little, for people thinks now that he killed his boy and fixed things so folks would think robbers done it, and then he'd get Huck's money without having to bother a long time with a lawsuit. People do say he warn't any too good to do it.

Rewritten passage

"You had better stay here all night. Take off your bonnet."

"No," I said; "I think I will rest for a while and then go on. I am not afraid of the dark."

She said she would not let me go by myself, but her husband would be home soon, maybe in an hour and a half, and she would have him go with me. Then she started talking about her husband, her relatives up the river, her relatives down the river, how much better off they used to be, and how they wondered if they had made a mistake moving to our town instead of leaving well enough alone. She went on and on until I was afraid I had made a mistake coming to her to find out what was happening in town. But eventually, she started talking about my father and the murder, and then I was perfectly happy to let her keep talking. She told me about Tom Sawyer and me finding the six thousand dollars—though she claimed it was ten—and all about my father and what a rough character he was, and what a rough character I was. Finally, she got to the part about where I was murdered. I said:

“Who did it? We have heard quite a bit about these events down in Hookerville, but we do not know who killed Huck Finn.”

“Well, I imagine there are a good many people here who would like to know who killed him. Some think old Finn did it himself.”

“No—is that so?”

“Almost everyone thought so at first. He will never know how close he came to being lynched. But before nightfall, they changed their minds and decided it was done by a runaway slave named Jim.”

“Why, he—”

I stopped. I figured I had better stay quiet. She kept talking and never noticed I had said anything at all:

“The slave ran off the very night Huck Finn was killed. So there is a reward out for him—three hundred dollars. And there is a reward out for old Finn, too—two hundred dollars. You see, he came to town the morning after the murder, told everyone about it, and went out with them on the ferry-boat search, but he left right afterward. Before night, they wanted to lynch him, but he was already gone. Well, the next day they found out the slave was gone; they discovered he had not been seen since ten o’clock the night the murder happened. So then they blamed him, you see. While they were focused on that, the next day, old Finn came back and went crying to Judge Thatcher to get money to hunt for the slave all over Illinois. The judge gave him some, and that evening he got drunk and spent time until after midnight with a couple of very rough-looking strangers, and then left with them. Well, he has not come back since, and they are not expecting him back until this whole thing settles down a little. People now think he killed his boy and staged things so everyone would think robbers did it, and then he would get Huck’s money without having to deal with a long lawsuit. People do say he was certainly capable of doing it.”

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 030 / E4_030 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

"In about four hours and a half I found the balloon sufficiently inflated. I attached the car, therefore, and put all my implements in it—not forgetting the condensing apparatus, a copious supply of water, and a large quantity of provisions, such as pemmican, in which much nutriment is contained in comparatively little bulk. I also secured in the car a pair of pigeons and a cat. It was now nearly daybreak, and I thought it high time to take my departure. Dropping a lighted cigar on the ground, as if by accident, I took the opportunity, in stooping to pick it up, of igniting privately the piece of slow match, whose end, as I said before, protruded a very little beyond the lower rim of one of the smaller casks. This manoeuvre was totally unperceived on the part of the three duns; and, jumping into the car, I immediately cut the single cord which held me to the earth, and was pleased to find that I shot upward, carrying with all ease one hundred and seventy-five pounds of leaden ballast, and able to have carried up as many more.

"Scarcely, however, had I attained the height of fifty yards, when, roaring and rumbling up after me in the most horrible and tumultuous manner, came so dense a hurricane of fire, and smoke, and sulphur, and legs and arms, and gravel, and burning wood, and blazing metal, that my very heart sunk within me, and I fell down in the bottom of the car, trembling with unmitigated terror. Indeed, I now perceived that I had entirely overdone the business, and that the main consequences of the shock were yet to be experienced. Accordingly, in less than a second, I felt all the blood in my body rushing to my temples, and immediately thereupon, a concussion, which I shall never forget, burst abruptly through the night and seemed to rip the very firmament asunder. When I afterward had time for reflection, I did not fail to attribute the extreme violence of the explosion, as regarded myself, to its proper cause—my situation directly above it, and in the line of its greatest power. But at the time, I thought only of preserving my life. The balloon at first collapsed, then furiously expanded, then whirled round and round with horrible velocity, and finally, reeling and staggering like a drunken man, hurled me with great force over the rim of the car, and left me dangling, at a terrific height, with my head downward, and my face outwards, by a piece of slender cord about three feet in length, which hung accidentally through a crevice near the bottom of the wicker-work, and in which, as I fell, my left foot became most providentially entangled. It is impossible—utterly impossible—to form any adequate idea of the horror of my situation. I gasped convulsively for breath—a shudder resembling a fit of the ague agitated every nerve and muscle of my frame—I felt my eyes starting from their sockets—a horrible nausea overwhelmed me—and at length I fainted away.

"How long I remained in this state it is impossible to say. It must, however, have been no inconsiderable time, for when I partially recovered the sense of existence, I found the day breaking, the balloon at a prodigious height over a wilderness of ocean, and not a trace of land to be discovered far and wide within the limits of the vast horizon.

Rewritten passage

After roughly four and a half hours, the balloon reached a sufficient state of inflation. I proceeded to fasten the car and stowed my equipment inside, making sure to include the condensing device, a generous amount of water, and a substantial store of provisions like pemmican, which offers high nutritional value in a compact form. I also brought along a cat and two pigeons. With dawn approaching, I decided it was time to leave. I dropped a lit cigar as if by mistake, and while stooping to retrieve it, I secretly lit the slow match that extended slightly from the bottom edge of one of the smaller barrels. The three creditors failed to notice this action; I leaped into the car, severed the lone rope tethering me to the ground, and was gratified to ascend rapidly, easily lifting one hundred and seventy-five pounds of lead ballast with the capacity to carry even more.

However, I had barely reached an altitude of fifty yards when a deafening, chaotic storm of fire, smoke, sulfur, limbs, gravel, burning timber, and molten metal roared upward after me. My heart failed me, and I collapsed into the base of the car, shaking with absolute terror. I realized then that I had severely miscalculated, and the primary effects of the blast were still to come. Within a second, I felt blood surge to my head, followed immediately by a blast I will never forget, which shattered the night and seemed to tear the sky apart. Upon later reflection, I

correctly identified the intensity of the explosion as a result of my position directly above the epicenter. At that moment, though, my only thought was survival. The balloon first buckled, then expanded violently, spun with dizzying speed, and finally, swaying like a drunkard, threw me over the edge of the car. I was left hanging at a terrifying height, head down and facing outward, suspended by a thin three-foot cord that had slipped through a gap in the wicker and caught my left foot as I tumbled. It is truly impossible to convey the horror of that moment. I struggled for air, my body racked by a shivering fit like an ague, my eyes feeling as though they were popping from their sockets, and a wave of nausea overcame me until I finally lost consciousness.

I cannot say how long I remained in that state. It must have been quite a while, for when I regained a partial sense of awareness, dawn was breaking, the balloon was at a massive altitude above an endless expanse of ocean, and there was no sign of land anywhere across the vast horizon.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes:

Item 031 / E4_031 / condition: simplify

Original passage

How his sagacity first discovered at all that so petty a thing would vex me, is a question I never could solve; but, having discovered, he habitually practised the annoyance. I had always felt aversion to my uncourtly patronymic, and its very common, if not plebeian praenomen. The words were venom in my ears; and when, upon the day of my arrival, a second William Wilson came also to the academy, I felt angry with him for bearing the name, and doubly disgusted with the name because a stranger bore it, who would be the cause of its twofold repetition, who would be constantly in my presence, and whose concerns, in the ordinary routine of the school business, must inevitably, on account of the detestable coincidence, be often confounded with my own.

The feeling of vexation thus engendered grew stronger with every circumstance tending to show resemblance, moral or physical, between my rival and myself. I had not then discovered the remarkable fact that we were of the same age; but I saw that we were of the same height, and I perceived that we were even singularly alike in general contour of person and outline of feature. I was galled, too, by the rumor touching a relationship, which had grown current in the upper forms. In a word, nothing could more seriously disturb me, (although I scrupulously concealed such disturbance,) than any allusion to a similarity of mind, person, or condition existing between us. But, in truth, I had no reason to believe that (with the exception of the matter of relationship, and in the case of Wilson himself,) this similarity had ever been made a subject of comment, or even observed at all by our schoolfellows. That he observed it in all its bearings, and as fixedly as I, was apparent; but that he could discover in such circumstances so fruitful a field of annoyance, can only be attributed, as I said before, to his more than ordinary penetration.

His cue, which was to perfect an imitation of myself, lay both in words and in actions; and most admirably did he play his part. My dress it was an easy matter to copy; my gait and general manner were, without difficulty, appropriated; in spite of his constitutional defect, even my voice did not escape him. My louder tones were, of course, unattempted, but then the key—it was identical; _and his singular whisper, it grew the very echo of my own_.

How greatly this most exquisite portraiture harassed me, (for it could not justly be termed a caricature,) I will not now venture to describe. I had but one consolation—in the fact that the imitation, apparently, was noticed by myself alone, and that I had to endure only the knowing and strangely sarcastic smiles of my namesake himself. Satisfied with having produced in my bosom the intended effect, he seemed to chuckle in secret over the sting he had inflicted, and was characteristically disregarding of the public applause which the success of his witty endeavours might have so easily elicited. That the school, indeed, did not feel his design, perceive its accomplishment, and participate in his sneer, was, for many anxious months, a riddle I could not resolve. Perhaps the gradation of his copy rendered it not so readily perceptible; or, more possibly, I owed my security to the master air of the copyist, who, disdainful of the letter, (which in a painting is all the obtuse can see,) gave but the full spirit of his original for my individual contemplation and chagrin.

Rewritten passage

How he managed to figure out that such a small thing would bother me is a mystery I could never solve. However, once he realized it, he made a habit of annoying me. I had always disliked my unrefined last name and its very common, if not low-class, first name. The words were like poison to me. When a second William Wilson arrived at the academy on my first day, I felt angry at him for having the name. I was even more disgusted with the name itself because a stranger now shared it, which meant it would be repeated constantly. He would always be near me, and because of this annoying coincidence, our school affairs would inevitably get mixed up.

This feeling of irritation grew stronger whenever I noticed any physical or moral resemblance between my rival and me. I had not yet

discovered the remarkable fact that we were the same age, but I saw that we were the same height and noticed we were strangely similar in our general build and facial features. I was also annoyed by rumors of a family connection that had started circulating among the older students. In short, nothing disturbed me more than any suggestion that we were similar in mind, appearance, or status, though I carefully hid my feelings. In truth, I had no reason to believe that anyone else at school had noticed this similarity, except for the rumors about our relationship and Wilson himself. It was clear that he noticed every detail as closely as I did, but the fact that he could turn these circumstances into such an effective way to annoy me can only be attributed to his unusual insight.

His strategy was to imitate me perfectly in both words and actions, and he played his part brilliantly. It was easy for him to copy my clothes; my walk and general manner were adopted without difficulty. Even my voice did not escape him, despite his natural vocal defect. He did not try to copy my louder tones, but the pitch was identical, and his strange whisper became an exact echo of my own.

I will not try to describe how much this precise imitation bothered me, as it could not fairly be called a caricature. I had only one consolation: it seemed that I alone noticed the imitation, and I only had to endure the knowing, sarcastic smiles of my namesake. Satisfied with having upset me, he seemed to laugh secretly at the pain he caused, showing no interest in the public praise he might have easily gained for his clever efforts. For many anxious months, it was a mystery to me why the rest of the school did not notice his plan, see how well he carried it out, or join in his mockery. Perhaps his imitation was so gradual that it was hard to notice, or perhaps I was safe because he was such a master at copying. He ignored the superficial details that dull people focus on and instead captured the very spirit of his original, leaving it for me alone to contemplate and suffer over.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes:

Item 032 / E4_032 / condition: modernize

Original passage

He had always been very fond of Lady Clem, as every one called her, and as he was very wealthy himself, having come into all Lord Rugby's property when he came of age, there was no possibility of his deriving any vulgar monetary advantage by her death. In fact, the more he thought over the matter, the more she seemed to him to be just the right person, and, feeling that any delay would be unfair to Sybil, he determined to make his arrangements at once.

The first thing to be done was, of course, to settle with the cheiromantist; so he sat down at a small Sheraton writing-table that stood near the window, drew a cheque for £105, payable to the order of Mr. Septimus Podgers, and, enclosing it in an envelope, told his valet to take it to West Moon Street. He then telephoned to the stables for his hansom, and dressed to go out. As he was leaving the room he looked back at Sybil Merton's photograph, and swore that, come what may, he would never let her know what he was doing for her sake, but would keep the secret of his self-sacrifice hidden always in his heart.

On his way to the Buckingham, he stopped at a florist's, and sent Sybil a beautiful basket of narcissus, with lovely white petals and staring pheasants' eyes, and on arriving at the club, went straight to the library, rang the bell, and ordered the waiter to bring him a lemon-and-soda, and a book on Toxicology. He had fully decided that poison was the best means to adopt in this troublesome business. Anything like personal violence was extremely distasteful to him, and besides, he was very anxious not to murder Lady Clementina in any way that might attract public attention, as he hated the idea of being lionised at Lady Windermere's, or seeing his name figuring in the paragraphs of vulgar society—newspapers. He had also to think of Sybil's father and mother, who were rather old-fashioned people, and might possibly object to the marriage if there was anything like a scandal, though he felt certain that if he told them the whole facts of the case they would be the very first to appreciate the motives that had actuated him. He had every reason, then, to decide in favour of poison. It was safe, sure, and quiet, and did away with any necessity for painful scenes, to which, like most Englishmen, he had a rooted objection.

Of the science of poisons, however, he knew absolutely nothing, and as the waiter seemed quite unable to find anything in the library but _Ruff's Guide_ and _Bailey's Magazine_, he examined the book-shelves himself, and finally came across a handsomely-bound edition of the _Pharmacopoeia_, and a copy of Erskine's _Toxicology_, edited by Sir Mathew Reid, the President of the Royal College of Physicians, and one of the oldest members of the Buckingham, having been elected in mistake for somebody else; a _contretemps_ that so enraged the Committee, that when the real man came up they black-balled him unanimously. Lord Arthur was a good deal puzzled at the technical terms used in both books, and had begun to regret that he had not paid more attention to his classics at Oxford, when in the second volume of Erskine, he found a very interesting and complete account of the properties of aconitine, written in fairly clear English.

Rewritten passage

He had always been very fond of Lady Clem, as everyone called her, and since he was quite wealthy himself, having inherited all of Lord Rugby's estate upon coming of age, there was no chance of him gaining any crude financial benefit from her death. In fact, the more he considered the matter, the more she seemed to him to be the perfect candidate, and, feeling that any delay would be unfair to Sybil, he decided to make his arrangements immediately.

The first step was, naturally, to settle with the palm reader. He sat down at a small Sheraton writing desk near the window, wrote a check for £105 made out to Mr. Septimus Podgers, and, placing it in an envelope, instructed his valet to deliver it to West Moon Street. He then called the stables for his hansom cab and got dressed to go out. As he left the room, he glanced back at Sybil Merton's photograph and swore that, no matter what happened, he would never let her know what he was doing for her sake, but would keep the secret of his self-sacrifice hidden in his heart forever.

On his way to the Buckingham Club, he stopped at a florist and sent Sybil a beautiful basket of narcissus, with lovely white petals and striking centers, and upon arriving at the club, he went straight to the library, rang the bell, and ordered the waiter to bring him a lemon-and-soda and a book on toxicology. He had fully decided that poison was the best method to adopt for this troublesome business. Anything involving physical violence was extremely distasteful to him, and besides, he was very anxious not to murder Lady Clementina in a way that might

attract public attention, as he hated the idea of being a celebrity at Lady Windermere's parties or seeing his name featured in the columns of trashy society newspapers. He also had to consider Sybil's parents, who were rather old-fashioned and might object to the marriage if there were any scandal, though he felt certain that if he explained the full facts of the case, they would be the first to appreciate the motives that had driven him. He had every reason, then, to choose poison. It was safe, sure, and quiet, and it eliminated the need for painful scenes, to which, like most Englishmen, he had a deep-seated aversion.

He knew absolutely nothing about the science of poisons, however, and since the waiter seemed unable to find anything in the library other than a racing guide and a magazine, he searched the bookshelves himself. He finally came across a handsomely bound edition of the Pharmacopoeia and a copy of Erskine's Toxicology, edited by Sir Mathew Reid, the President of the Royal College of Physicians and one of the oldest members of the Buckingham, having been elected by mistake for someone else—a blunder that so enraged the committee that when the real man applied, they blackballed him unanimously. Lord Arthur was quite puzzled by the technical terms used in both books and began to regret that he had not paid more attention to his classics at Oxford, when, in the second volume of Erskine, he found a very interesting and complete account of the properties of aconitine, written in fairly clear English.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 033 / E4_033 / condition: modernize

Original passage

The defeat became total; the cannon ceased to roar; the infantry rallied, and horse pursued the flying Turks along the dreary plain; the staff of Raymond was dispersed in various directions, to make observations, and bear commands. Even I was dispatched to a distant part of the field.

The ground on which the battle was fought, was a level plain—so level, that from the tumuli you saw the waving line of mountains on the wide-stretched horizon; yet the intervening space was unvaried by the least irregularity, save such undulations as resembled the waves of the sea. The whole of this part of Thrace had been so long a scene of contest, that it had remained uncultivated, and presented a dreary, barren appearance. The order I had received, was to make an observation of the direction which a detachment of the enemy might have taken, from a northern tumulus; the whole Turkish army, followed by the Greek, had poured eastward; none but the dead remained in the direction of my side. From the top of the mound, I looked far round—all was silent and deserted.

The last beams of the nearly sunken sun shot up from behind the far summit of Mount Athos; the sea of Marmora still glittered beneath its rays, while the Asiatic coast beyond was half hid in a haze of low cloud. Many a casque, and bayonet, and sword, fallen from unnerved arms, reflected the departing ray; they lay scattered far and near. From the east, a band of ravens, old inhabitants of the Turkish cemeteries, came sailing along towards their harvest; the sun disappeared. This hour, melancholy yet sweet, has always seemed to me the time when we are most naturally led to commune with higher powers; our mortal sternness departs, and gentle complacency invests the soul. But now, in the midst of the dying and the dead, how could a thought of heaven or a sensation of tranquillity possess one of the murderers? During the busy day, my mind had yielded itself a willing slave to the state of things presented to it by its fellow-beings; historical association, hatred of the foe, and military enthusiasm had held dominion over me. Now, I looked on the evening star, as softly and calmly it hung pendulous in the orange hues of sunset. I turned to the coarse-strewn earth; and felt ashamed of my species. So perhaps were the placid skies; for they quickly veiled themselves in mist, and in this change assisted the swift disappearance of twilight usual in the south; heavy masses of cloud floated up from the south east, and red and turbid lightning shot from their dark edges; the rushing wind disturbed the garments of the dead, and was chilled as it passed over their icy forms. Darkness gathered round; the objects about me became indistinct, I descended from my station, and with difficulty guided my horse, so as to avoid the slain.

Suddenly I heard a piercing shriek; a form seemed to rise from the earth; it flew swiftly towards me, sinking to the ground again as it drew near. All this passed so suddenly, that I with difficulty reined in my horse, so that it should not trample on the prostrate being. The dress of this person was that of a soldier, but the bared neck and arms, and the continued shrieks discovered a female thus disguised.

Rewritten passage

The defeat was absolute; the cannons fell silent; the infantry regrouped, and cavalry chased the retreating Turks across the bleak plain. Raymond's staff scattered in various directions to scout and deliver orders. Even I was sent to a remote part of the battlefield.

The ground where the battle took place was a flat plain—so level that from the burial mounds, you could see the undulating line of mountains on the distant horizon. The space between was featureless, save for swells that looked like ocean waves. This region of Thrace had been a war zone for so long that it remained uncultivated, presenting a desolate, barren sight. My orders were to observe the path a detachment of the enemy might have taken from a northern mound. The entire Turkish army, pursued by the Greeks, had surged eastward; only the dead remained in my sector. From the top of the mound, I looked all around—everything was silent and deserted.

The final rays of the setting sun shot up from behind the distant peak of Mount Athos. The Sea of Marmara still shimmered under the light, while the Asian coast beyond was half-obscured by a haze of low clouds. Many helmets, bayonets, and swords, dropped from lifeless hands, reflected the fading light; they lay scattered everywhere. From the east, a flock of ravens, long-time residents of Turkish cemeteries, came gliding toward their feast. The sun vanished. This hour, melancholy yet sweet, has always seemed to me the time when we are most naturally drawn to commune with higher powers; our human harshness fades, and a gentle peace fills the soul. But now, surrounded by the dying and the dead, how could a thought of heaven or a sense of tranquility possess one of the killers? During the busy day, my mind had

been a willing slave to the circumstances created by my peers; historical context, hatred of the enemy, and military fervor had dominated me. Now, I looked at the evening star as it hung softly and calmly in the orange sunset. I turned to the corpse-strewn earth and felt ashamed of my species. Perhaps the placid skies felt the same, for they quickly veiled themselves in mist, accelerating the rapid twilight typical of the south. Heavy masses of cloud drifted up from the southeast, and red, murky lightning flashed from their dark edges. The rushing wind disturbed the clothing of the dead and turned cold as it passed over their icy bodies. Darkness gathered; the objects around me became indistinct. I descended from my post and struggled to guide my horse to avoid the slain.

Suddenly, I heard a piercing shriek. A figure seemed to rise from the ground; it flew swiftly toward me, sinking back to the earth as it drew near. It all happened so fast that I barely managed to rein in my horse to avoid trampling the prostrate person. The individual wore a soldier's uniform, but the exposed neck and arms, along with the persistent shrieking, revealed a woman in disguise.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes:

Item 034 / E4_034 / condition: simplify

Original passage

)—and each speaker pointed out the exact spot where the lost lads stood at the time, and then added something like “and I was a-standing just so—just as I am now, and as if you was him—I was as close as that—and he smiled, just this way—and then something seemed to go all over me, like—awful, you know—and I never thought what it meant, of course, but I can see now!”

Then there was a dispute about who saw the dead boys last in life, and many claimed that dismal distinction, and offered evidences, more or less tampered with by the witness; and when it was ultimately decided who did see the departed last, and exchanged the last words with them, the lucky parties took upon themselves a sort of sacred importance, and were gaped at and envied by all the rest. One poor chap, who had no other grandeur to offer, said with tolerably manifest pride in the remembrance:

“Well, Tom Sawyer he licked me once.”

But that bid for glory was a failure. Most of the boys could say that, and so that cheapened the distinction too much. The group loitered away, still recalling memories of the lost heroes, in awed voices.

When the Sunday-school hour was finished, the next morning, the bell began to toll, instead of ringing in the usual way. It was a very still Sabbath, and the mournful sound seemed in keeping with the musing hush that lay upon nature. The villagers began to gather, loitering a moment in the vestibule to converse in whispers about the sad event. But there was no whispering in the house; only the funereal rustling of dresses as the women gathered to their seats disturbed the silence there. None could remember when the little church had been so full before. There was finally a waiting pause, an expectant dumbness, and then Aunt Polly entered, followed by Sid and Mary, and they by the Harper family, all in deep black, and the whole congregation, the old minister as well, rose reverently and stood until the mourners were seated in the front pew. There was another communing silence, broken at intervals by muffled sobs, and then the minister spread his hands abroad and prayed. A moving hymn was sung, and the text followed: “I am the Resurrection and the Life.”

As the service proceeded, the clergyman drew such pictures of the graces, the winning ways, and the rare promise of the lost lads that every soul there, thinking he recognized these pictures, felt a pang in remembering that he had persistently blinded himself to them always before, and had as persistently seen only faults and flaws in the poor boys. The minister related many a touching incident in the lives of the departed, too, which illustrated their sweet, generous natures, and the people could easily see, now, how noble and beautiful those episodes were, and remembered with grief that at the time they occurred they had seemed rank rascalities, well deserving of the cowhide. The congregation became more and more moved, as the pathetic tale went on, till at last the whole company broke down and joined the weeping mourners in a chorus of anguished sobs, the preacher himself giving way to his feelings, and crying in the pulpit.

Rewritten passage

Each speaker pointed out the exact spot where the missing boys had stood, adding comments like, “I was standing right here—just as I am now—and if you were him, I was that close. He smiled just this way, and I felt something strange, like a shiver, though I didn’t understand it then. I can see what it meant now!”

Then, a dispute arose over who had seen the boys last while they were alive. Many claimed this grim honor, offering evidence that they had often embellished. When it was finally settled who had truly seen them last and spoken the final words, those lucky individuals took on a sense of sacred importance, becoming objects of envy and wonder to the others. One poor boy, having no other claim to fame, said with clear pride, “Well, Tom Sawyer once beat me up.”

But that attempt at glory failed. Most of the boys could say the same, which made the distinction worthless. The group wandered off, still discussing the lost heroes in hushed, reverent tones.

When Sunday school ended the next morning, the bell began to toll instead of ringing normally. It was a very quiet Sunday, and the mournful sound matched the somber mood of the day. Villagers gathered, lingering in the entryway to whisper about the tragedy. Inside the church,

however, there was no whispering; only the rustling of dresses as women took their seats broke the silence. No one could remember the small church ever being so full. After a long, expectant pause, Aunt Polly entered, followed by Sid, Mary, and the Harper family, all dressed in deep black. The entire congregation, including the minister, stood respectfully until the mourners were seated in the front pew. A heavy silence followed, broken only by muffled sobs, until the minister opened his hands to pray. A moving hymn was sung, followed by the sermon text: "I am the Resurrection and the Life."

As the service continued, the minister described the virtues, charming habits, and great potential of the lost boys so vividly that everyone present felt a pang of regret. They realized they had ignored these good qualities in the past, choosing instead to focus only on the boys' faults. The minister shared many touching stories about the boys that highlighted their generous natures. The people could now easily see how noble those moments were, remembering with grief that at the time, they had seemed like mere mischief deserving of punishment. The congregation became increasingly emotional as the story continued, until finally, the entire group broke down, joining the mourners in a chorus of sobbing, while the preacher himself gave in to his emotions and wept in the pulpit.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 035 / E4_035 / condition: simplify

Original passage

Her courage
only failed when she dreaded peril for her parent, or feared that death
might prevent her from performing those duties to which she was
unalterably devoted.

When we had quitted Windsor for London, as the previous step to our final emigration, we visited Lucy, and arranged with her the plan of her own and her mother's removal. Lucy was sorry at the necessity which forced her to quit her native lanes and village, and to drag an infirm parent from her comforts at home, to the homeless waste of depopulated earth; but she was too well disciplined by adversity, and of too sweet a temper, to indulge in repinings at what was inevitable.

Subsequent circumstances, my illness and that of Idris, drove her from our remembrance; and we called her to mind at last, only to conclude that she made one of the few who came from Windsor to join the emigrants, and that she was already in Paris. When we arrived at Rochester therefore, we were surprised to receive, by a man just come from Slough, a letter from this exemplary sufferer. His account was, that, journeying from his home, and passing through Datchet, he was surprised to see smoke issue from the chimney of the inn, and supposing that he should find comrades for his journey assembled there, he knocked and was admitted. There was no one in the house but Lucy, and her mother; the latter had been deprived of the use of her limbs by an attack of rheumatism, and so, one by one, all the remaining inhabitants of the country set forward, leaving them alone. Lucy intreated the man to stay with her; in a week or two her mother would be better, and they would then set out; but they must perish, if they were left thus helpless and forlorn. The man said, that his wife and children were already among the emigrants, and it was therefore, according to his notion, impossible for him to remain. Lucy, as a last resource, gave him a letter for Idris, to be delivered to her wherever he should meet us. This commission at least he fulfilled, and Idris received with emotion the following letter:—

"HONOURED LADY,

"I am sure that you will remember and pity me, and I dare hope that you will assist me; what other hope have I? Pardon my manner of writing, I am so bewildered. A month ago my dear mother was deprived of the use of her limbs. She is already better, and in another month would I am sure be able to travel, in the way you were so kind as to say you would arrange for us. But now everybody is gone—everybody—as they went away, each said, that perhaps my mother would be better, before we were quite deserted. But three days ago I went to Samuel Woods, who, on account of his new-born child, remained to the last; and there being a large family of them, I thought I could persuade them to wait a little longer for us; but I found the house deserted. I have not seen a soul since, till this good man came. —What will become of us? My mother does not know our state; she is so ill, that I have hidden it from her.

Rewritten passage

Her courage only faltered when she feared danger for her parent, or worried that death might stop her from fulfilling the duties to which she was completely devoted. When we left Windsor for London, as the first step toward our final departure, we visited Lucy and organized the plan for her and her mother's relocation. Lucy was saddened by the necessity of leaving her native lanes and village, and by having to move an infirm parent from the comforts of home into the empty, desolate world. However, she had been so well trained by hardship, and possessed such a sweet temperament, that she did not complain about what was unavoidable. Later events, including my illness and that of Idris, pushed her from our thoughts. We only remembered her eventually, assuming she was among the few who had traveled from Windsor to join the emigrants and was already in Paris. Therefore, when we arrived at Rochester, we were surprised to receive a letter from this exemplary woman, delivered by a man who had just come from Slough. He explained that while traveling from his home through Datchet, he was surprised to see smoke coming from the inn's chimney. Thinking he might find companions for his journey, he knocked and was let in. There was no one in the house but Lucy and her mother. The mother had lost the use of her limbs due to a severe case of rheumatism, and one by one, all the remaining local residents had left, abandoning them. Lucy begged the man to stay with her, promising that her mother would be better in a week or two and they could then set out, but she insisted they would surely perish if left so helpless and alone. The man replied that his wife and children were already among the emigrants, so he felt it was impossible for him to stay. As a final resort, Lucy gave him a letter for Idris, to be delivered wherever he might find us. He fulfilled this request, and Idris was moved to receive the following letter: "Honoured Lady, I am sure you will remember and pity me, and I dare hope you will assist me; what other hope do I have? Please pardon my writing, as I am so bewildered. A month ago, my dear mother lost the use of her limbs. She is already improving, and I am certain that in

another month she would be able to travel in the way you kindly offered to arrange for us. But now everyone is gone—everyone. As they left, they each said that perhaps my mother would be better before we were completely deserted. Three days ago, I went to Samuel Woods, who had stayed until the end because of his newborn child. Since they were a large family, I thought I could persuade them to wait a little longer for us, but I found their house empty. I have not seen a soul since, until this good man arrived. What will become of us? My mother does not know our situation; she is so ill that I have kept it hidden from her.”

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes:

Item 036 / E4_036 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

We had expected this moment with eagerness, for now we had accomplished the worst part of our drear journey, and Switzerland was near at hand. Yet how could we congratulate ourselves on any event thus imperfectly fulfilled? Were these miserable beings, who, worn and wretched, passed in sorrowful procession, the sole remnants of the race of man, which, like a flood, had once spread over and possessed the whole earth? It had come down clear and unimpeded from its primal mountain source in Ararat, and grew from a puny streamlet to a vast perennial river, generation after generation flowing on ceaselessly. The same, but diversified, it grew, and swept onwards towards the absorbing ocean, whose dim shores we now reached. It had been the mere plaything of nature, when first it crept out of uncreative void into light; but thought brought forth power and knowledge; and, clad with these, the race of man assumed dignity and authority. It was then no longer the mere gardener of earth, or the shepherd of her flocks; "it carried with it an imposing and majestic aspect; it had a pedigree and illustrious ancestors; it had its gallery of portraits, its monumental inscriptions, its records and titles." [24]

This was all over, now that the ocean of death had sucked in the slackening tide, and its source was dried up. We first had bidden adieu to the state of things which having existed many thousand years, seemed eternal; such a state of government, obedience, traffic, and domestic intercourse, as had moulded our hearts and capacities, as far back as memory could reach. Then to patriotic zeal, to the arts, to reputation, to enduring fame, to the name of country, we had bidden farewell. We saw depart all hope of retrieving our ancient state—all expectation, except the feeble one of saving our individual lives from the wreck of the past. To preserve these we had quitted England—England, no more; for without her children, what name could that barren island claim? With tenacious grasp we clung to such rule and order as could best save us; trusting that, if a little colony could be preserved, that would suffice at some remoter period to restore the lost community of mankind.

But the game is up! We must all die; nor leave survivor nor heir to the wide inheritance of earth. We must all die! The species of man must perish; his frame of exquisite workmanship; the wondrous mechanism of his senses; the noble proportion of his godlike limbs; his mind, the throned king of these; must perish. Will the earth still keep her place among the planets; will she still journey with unmarked regularity round the sun; will the seasons change, the trees adorn themselves with leaves, and flowers shed their fragrance, in solitude? Will the mountains remain unmoved, and streams still keep a downward course towards the vast abyss; will the tides rise and fall, and the winds fan universal nature; will beasts pasture, birds fly, and fishes swim, when man, the lord, possessor, perceiver, and recorder of all these things, has passed away, as though he had never been? O, what mockery is this! Surely death is not death, and humanity is not extinct; but merely passed into other shapes, unsubjected to our perceptions.

Rewritten passage

We had anticipated this juncture with intensity, as the most arduous segment of our bleak trek was finished, and Switzerland lay ahead. Still, how could we celebrate a triumph so incomplete? Were these forlorn creatures, trudging by in mournful lines, the final survivors of a human race that once, like a deluge, covered and claimed the entire globe? It had flowed pure and unobstructed from its original mountain spring at Ararat, expanding from a tiny brook into a massive, constant river, with generations pouring forth without end. Consistent yet varied, it surged toward the consuming sea, whose hazy banks we now approached. Humanity was merely nature's toy when it first emerged from the empty void into the light; yet intellect birthed power and wisdom, and, adorned with these, mankind claimed stature and command. It was no longer just the earth's gardener or a shepherd of flocks; it possessed a grand and stately presence, boasting a lineage, noble forebears, a collection of portraits, carved memorials, and documented titles.

All of this had vanished, now that the sea of death had swallowed the waning tide and its fountainhead had withered. We had initially said goodbye to the order of existence that, having endured for millennia, seemed permanent—that structure of governance, submission, commerce, and social life that had shaped our spirits and abilities for as long as we could remember. Then, we bid farewell to national fervor, the arts, prestige, lasting renown, and the very concept of a homeland. We watched every hope of reclaiming our former state depart—every expectation, save for the faint desire to rescue our own lives from the ruins of the past. To save them, we had abandoned England—England, no more; for without its people, what title could that desolate isle hold? We held tightly to whatever governance and discipline might best protect us, hoping that if a small settlement could survive, it might eventually suffice to revive the lost fellowship of humanity.

But the end has arrived! We are all destined to die, leaving neither survivor nor successor to the vast legacy of the world. We must all perish! The human species must vanish; its frame of delicate craftsmanship; the miraculous apparatus of its senses; the magnificent symmetry of its divine limbs; its mind, the enthroned ruler of these; all must cease. Will the earth maintain its position among the stars; will it continue its steady orbit around the sun; will the seasons shift, the trees dress themselves in foliage, and blossoms release their scent, all in isolation? Will the peaks stand firm, and rivers continue their descent toward the great deep; will the tides ebb and flow, and breezes stir the natural world; will animals graze, birds soar, and fish glide, once man, the master, owner, observer, and chronicler of all these wonders, has vanished as if he had never existed? Oh, what a cruel irony! Surely death is not truly death, and humanity is not gone, but has simply transformed into other forms, beyond the reach of our senses.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 037 / E4_037 / condition: modernize

Original passage

Every night now I used to slip ashore towards ten o'clock at some little village, and buy ten or fifteen cents' worth of meal or bacon or other stuff to eat; and sometimes I lifted a chicken that warn't roosting comfortable, and took him along. Pap always said, take a chicken when you get a chance, because if you don't want him yourself you can easy find somebody that does, and a good deed ain't ever forgot. I never see pap when he didn't want the chicken himself, but that is what he used to say, anyway.

Mornings before daylight I slipped into cornfields and borrowed a watermelon, or a mushmelon, or a punkin, or some new corn, or things of that kind. Pap always said it warn't no harm to borrow things if you was meaning to pay them back some time; but the widow said it warn't anything but a soft name for stealing, and no decent body would do it. Jim said he reckoned the widow was partly right and pap was partly right; so the best way would be for us to pick out two or three things from the list and say we wouldn't borrow them any more—then he reckoned it wouldn't be no harm to borrow the others. So we talked it over all one night, drifting along down the river, trying to make up our minds whether to drop the watermelons, or the cantelopes, or the mushmelons, or what. But towards daylight we got it all settled satisfactory, and concluded to drop crabapples and p'simmons. We warn't feeling just right before that, but it was all comfortable now. I was glad the way it come out, too, because crabapples ain't ever good, and the p'simmons wouldn't be ripe for two or three months yet.

We shot a water-fowl, now and, then that got up too early in the morning or didn't go to bed early enough in the evening. Take it all round, we lived pretty high.

The fifth night below St. Louis we had a big storm after midnight, with a power of thunder and lightning, and the rain poured down in a solid sheet. We stayed in the wigwam and let the raft take care of itself. When the lightning glared out we could see a big straight river ahead, and high, rocky bluffs on both sides. By-and-by says I, "Hel-_lo_, Jim, looky yonder!" It was a steamboat that had killed herself on a rock. We was drifting straight down for her. The lightning showed her very distinct. She was leaning over, with part of her upper deck above water, and you could see every little chimbly-guy clean and clear, and a chair by the big bell, with an old slouch hat hanging on the back of it, when the flashes come.

Well, it being away in the night and stormy, and all so mysterious-like, I felt just the way any other boy would a felt when I see that wreck laying there so mournful and lonesome in the middle of the river. I wanted to get aboard of her and slink around a little, and see what there was there. So I says:

"Le's land on her, Jim."

But Jim was dead against it at first. He says:

"I doan' want to go fool'n 'long er no wrack.

Rewritten passage

Every night now, I would sneak ashore around ten o'clock at some small village to buy ten or fifteen cents' worth of cornmeal, bacon, or other food. Sometimes I would grab a chicken that wasn't roosting comfortably and take it with me. My father always said to take a chicken whenever you had the chance, because if you didn't want it yourself, you could easily find someone who did, and a good deed is never forgotten. I never saw my father when he didn't want the chicken himself, but that is what he used to say anyway.

In the mornings before dawn, I would slip into cornfields and borrow a watermelon, a muskmelon, a pumpkin, some fresh corn, or things like that. My father always said it wasn't wrong to borrow items if you intended to pay them back eventually, but the widow insisted that was just a polite term for stealing and that no decent person would do it. Jim thought the widow was partly right and my father was partly right, so he suggested the best approach would be for us to pick two or three items from our list and agree not to borrow them anymore, which he figured would make it acceptable to borrow the rest. We talked it over all night while drifting down the river, trying to decide whether to stop taking watermelons, cantaloupes, muskmelons, or something else. By daybreak, we had settled it to our satisfaction and decided to stop taking crabapples and persimmons. We hadn't felt quite right before that, but everything was comfortable now. I was happy with the outcome, too, because crabapples are never good, and the persimmons wouldn't be ripe for another two or three months.

We occasionally shot a waterfowl that got up too early in the morning or didn't go to bed early enough in the evening. All things considered, we lived quite well.

On the fifth night past St. Louis, we hit a massive storm after midnight with intense thunder and lightning, and the rain poured down in a solid sheet. We stayed inside the shelter and let the raft take care of itself. When the lightning flashed, we could see a wide, straight stretch of river ahead with high, rocky bluffs on both sides. Eventually, I said, "Hello, Jim, look over there!" It was a steamboat that had wrecked on a rock. We were drifting straight toward it. The lightning revealed it very clearly. It was leaning over with part of its upper deck above water, and you could see every little chimney wire distinctly, along with a chair by the big bell with an old slouch hat hanging on the back of it whenever the flashes occurred.

Well, since it was late at night, stormy, and all so mysterious, I felt just the way any other boy would have felt seeing that wreck lying there so mournful and lonely in the middle of the river. I wanted to get on board, sneak around a bit, and see what was there. So I said, "Let's land on her, Jim."

But Jim was completely against it at first. He said, "I don't want to go fooling around any wreck."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 038 / E4_038 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

He still professed himself quite willing and even anxious to have it made, and urged me to commence it at once. A male and a female nurse were in attendance; but I did not feel myself altogether at liberty to engage in a task of this character with no more reliable witnesses than these people, in case of sudden accident, might prove. I therefore postponed operations until about eight the next night, when the arrival of a medical student with whom I had some acquaintance, (Mr. Theodore L—I,) relieved me from farther embarrassment. It had been my design, originally, to wait for the physicians; but I was induced to proceed, first, by the urgent entreaties of M. Valdemar, and secondly, by my conviction that I had not a moment to lose, as he was evidently sinking fast.

Mr. L—I was so kind as to accede to my desire that he would take notes of all that occurred, and it is from his memoranda that what I now have to relate is, for the most part, either condensed or copied verbatim.

It wanted about five minutes of eight when, taking the patient's hand, I begged him to state, as distinctly as he could, to Mr. L—I, whether he (M. Valdemar) was entirely willing that I should make the experiment of mesmerizing him in his then condition.

He replied feebly, yet quite audibly, "Yes, I wish to be. I fear you have mesmerized"—adding immediately afterwards: "I fear you have deferred it too long."

While he spoke thus, I commenced the passes which I had already found most effectual in subduing him. He was evidently influenced with the first lateral stroke of my hand across his forehead; but although I exerted all my powers, no further perceptible effect was induced until some minutes after ten o'clock, when Doctors D—— and F—— called, according to appointment. I explained to them, in a few words, what I designed, and as they opposed no objection, saying that the patient was already in the death agony, I proceeded without hesitation—exchanging, however, the lateral passes for downward ones, and directing my gaze entirely into the right eye of the sufferer.

By this time his pulse was imperceptible and his breathing was stertorous, and at intervals of half a minute.

This condition was nearly unaltered for a quarter of an hour. At the expiration of this period, however, a natural although a very deep sigh escaped the bosom of the dying man, and the stertorous breathing ceased—that is to say, its stertorousness was no longer apparent; the intervals were undiminished. The patient's extremities were of an icy coldness.

At five minutes before eleven I perceived unequivocal signs of the mesmeric influence. The glassy roll of the eye was changed for that expression of uneasy inward examination which is never seen except in cases of sleep-waking, and which it is quite impossible to mistake. With a few rapid lateral passes I made the lids quiver, as in incipient sleep, and with a few more I closed them altogether. I was not satisfied, however, with this, but continued the manipulations vigorously, and with the fullest exertion of the will, until I had completely stiffened the limbs of the slumberer, after placing them in a seemingly easy position.

Rewritten passage

He maintained that he was still quite prepared and even eager for the procedure to be performed, pressing me to begin immediately. Although a male and a female nurse were present, I did not feel comfortable undertaking such a task with only these individuals as witnesses, fearing they might prove unreliable should a sudden emergency arise. Consequently, I delayed the work until approximately eight o'clock the following evening, at which point the arrival of a medical student I knew, Mr. Theodore L—I, spared me from further difficulty. My initial plan had been to wait for the doctors, but I was persuaded to move forward, first by M. Valdemar's insistent requests, and second by my certainty that time was critical, as he was clearly fading rapidly.

Mr. L—I kindly agreed to my request that he record everything that transpired, and it is from his notes that the account I now provide is largely summarized or transcribed word for word.

It was roughly five minutes before eight when I took the patient's hand and asked him to confirm, as clearly as possible, to Mr. L—I whether he, M. Valdemar, was fully prepared for me to attempt to mesmerize him in his current state.

He answered weakly, yet clearly enough to be heard, "Yes, I wish to be. I fear you have mesmerized"—adding immediately after: "I fear you have waited too long."

As he spoke, I began the motions that I had previously discovered were most successful in calming him. He was clearly affected by the initial sideways sweep of my hand across his brow; however, despite my greatest efforts, no further visible change occurred until shortly after ten o'clock, when Doctors D—— and F—— arrived as scheduled. I briefly described my intentions to them, and since they offered no resistance, noting that the patient was already in the throes of death, I continued without hesitation—though I switched from lateral movements to downward ones, focusing my gaze entirely on the sufferer's right eye.

By then, his pulse could not be detected, and his respiration was labored and rattling, occurring at thirty-second intervals.

This state remained largely unchanged for fifteen minutes. At the end of that time, however, a natural yet very profound sigh emerged from the dying man's chest, and the rattling quality of his breathing vanished, though the pauses between breaths remained the same. The patient's limbs were cold as ice.

At five minutes to eleven, I observed clear evidence of the mesmeric effect. The vacant, rolling gaze of his eyes shifted to that look of restless internal focus seen only in cases of somnambulism, which is impossible to misinterpret. With several quick sideways passes, I caused his eyelids to tremble as if in the early stages of sleep, and with a few more, I shut them entirely. I was not content with this, however, and persisted with the movements energetically, applying the full force of my will, until I had entirely rigidified the limbs of the sleeper after arranging them in a seemingly comfortable posture.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 039 / E4_039 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

"I shall add but one to the arguments against a gang; but this one has, to my own understanding at least, a weight altogether irresistible. Under the circumstances of large reward offered, and full pardon to any king's evidence, it is not to be imagined, for a moment, that some member of a gang of low ruffians, or of any body of men, would not long ago have betrayed his accomplices. Each one of a gang so placed, is not so much greedy of reward, or anxious for escape, as fearful of betrayal. He betrays eagerly and early that he may not himself be betrayed. That the secret has not been divulged, is the very best of proof that it is, in fact, a secret. The horrors of this dark deed are known only to one, or two, living human beings, and to God.

"Let us sum up now the meagre yet certain fruits of our long analysis. We have attained the idea either of a fatal accident under the roof of Madame Deluc, or of a murder perpetrated, in the thicket at the Barrière du Roule, by a lover, or at least by an intimate and secret associate of the deceased. This associate is of swarthy complexion. This complexion, the 'hitch' in the bandage, and the 'sailor's knot,' with which the bonnet-ribbon is tied, point to a seaman. His companionship with the deceased, a gay, but not an abject young girl, designates him as above the grade of the common sailor. Here the well written and urgent communications to the journals are much in the way of corroboration. The circumstance of the first elopement, as mentioned by Le Mercurie, tends to blend the idea of this seaman with that of the 'naval officer' who is first known to have led the unfortunate into crime.

"And here, most fitly, comes the consideration of the continued absence of him of the dark complexion. Let me pause to observe that the complexion of this man is dark and swarthy; it was no common swarthinness which constituted the sole point of remembrance, both as regards Valence and Madame Deluc. But why is this man absent? Was he murdered by the gang? If so, why are there only traces of the assassinated girl? The scene of the two outrages will naturally be supposed identical. And where is his corpse? The assassins would most probably have disposed of both in the same way. But it may be said that this man lives, and is deterred from making himself known, through dread of being charged with the murder. This consideration might be supposed to operate upon him now—at this late period—since it has been given in evidence that he was seen with Marie—but it would have had no force at the period of the deed. The first impulse of an innocent man would have been to announce the outrage, and to aid in identifying the ruffians. This policy would have suggested. He had been seen with the girl. He had crossed the river with her in an open ferry-boat. The denouncing of the assassins would have appeared, even to an idiot, the surest and sole means of relieving himself from suspicion. We cannot suppose him, on the night of the fatal Sunday, both innocent himself and incognizant of an outrage committed.

Rewritten passage

I will provide just one more point against the theory of a gang; yet, to my mind, this single argument carries undeniable force. Given the substantial bounty offered and the promise of complete immunity for any informant, it is impossible to believe that some member of a group of common criminals would not have already exposed his partners. Every individual in such a group is driven less by a desire for money or freedom than by the terror of being double-crossed. He informs quickly and willingly to avoid being the one betrayed. The fact that the mystery remains unsolved is the strongest evidence that it is truly a secret. The grim details of this crime are known only to one or two living souls, and to God.

Let us now collect the sparse but definite results of our lengthy investigation. We have concluded that this was either a fatal accident at Madame Deluc's residence or a murder committed in the woods near the Barrière du Roule by a lover, or perhaps a close, clandestine companion of the victim. This associate has a dark complexion. This skin tone, the irregularity in the bandage, and the sailor's knot used to fasten the bonnet ribbon all suggest a seaman. His relationship with the victim, a lively but not destitute young woman, indicates he is of a higher status than a typical deckhand. The well-composed and pressing letters sent to the newspapers serve as strong support for this. The details of the initial disappearance, as reported by Le Mercurie, help link this sailor to the naval officer previously identified as having first introduced the unfortunate girl to a life of vice.

At this point, it is appropriate to examine the ongoing disappearance of the dark-skinned man. I must note that his complexion was notably swarthy; it was no ordinary darkness that served as the primary detail remembered by both Valence and Madame Deluc. But why is this man missing? Was he killed by the gang? If so, why do we only find evidence of the murdered girl? One would naturally assume the locations of the two crimes are the same. And where is his body? The killers would likely have disposed of both victims in the same manner. It might be argued that he is alive and refrains from coming forward out of fear of being accused of the murder. While this concern might influence him now—at this late stage—since testimony places him with Marie, it would have had no weight at the time of the crime. An innocent man's first instinct would have been to report the violence and assist in identifying the perpetrators. This would have been the logical course of action. He had been seen with the girl. He had crossed the river with her in a public ferry. Even to a fool, denouncing the killers would have appeared the most certain and only way to clear himself of suspicion. We cannot imagine that on that fatal Sunday night, he was both innocent and unaware of the crime that had taken place.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes:

Item 040 / E4_040 / condition: modernize

Original passage

"A considerable period elapsed before I discovered one of the causes of the uneasiness of this amiable family: it was poverty, and they suffered that evil in a very distressing degree. Their nourishment consisted entirely of the vegetables of their garden and the milk of one cow, which gave very little during the winter, when its masters could scarcely procure food to support it. They often, I believe, suffered the pangs of hunger very poignantly, especially the two younger cottagers, for several times they placed food before the old man when they reserved none for themselves.

"This trait of kindness moved me sensibly. I had been accustomed, during the night, to steal a part of their store for my own consumption, but when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained and satisfied myself with berries, nuts, and roots which I gathered from a neighbouring wood.

"I discovered also another means through which I was enabled to assist their labours. I found that the youth spent a great part of each day in collecting wood for the family fire, and during the night I often took his tools, the use of which I quickly discovered, and brought home firing sufficient for the consumption of several days.

"I remember, the first time that I did this, the young woman, when she opened the door in the morning, appeared greatly astonished on seeing a great pile of wood on the outside. She uttered some words in a loud voice, and the youth joined her, who also expressed surprise. I observed, with pleasure, that he did not go to the forest that day, but spent it in repairing the cottage and cultivating the garden.

"By degrees I made a discovery of still greater moment. I found that these people possessed a method of communicating their experience and feelings to one another by articulate sounds. I perceived that the words they spoke sometimes produced pleasure or pain, smiles or sadness, in the minds and countenances of the hearers. This was indeed a godlike science, and I ardently desired to become acquainted with it. But I was baffled in every attempt I made for this purpose. Their pronunciation was quick, and the words they uttered, not having any apparent connection with visible objects, I was unable to discover any clue by which I could unravel the mystery of their reference. By great application, however, and after having remained during the space of several revolutions of the moon in my hovel, I discovered the names that were given to some of the most familiar objects of discourse; I learned and applied the words, _fire, milk, bread,_ and _wood._ I learned also the names of the cottagers themselves. The youth and his companion had each of them several names, but the old man had only one, which was _father._ The girl was called _sister_ or _Agatha,_ and the youth _Felix, brother,_ or _son._ I cannot describe the delight I felt when I learned the ideas appropriated to each of these sounds and was able to pronounce them. I distinguished several other words without being able as yet to understand or apply them, such as _good, dearest, unhappy._

"I spent the winter in this manner. The gentle manners and beauty of the cottagers greatly endeared them to me; when they were unhappy, I felt depressed; when they rejoiced, I sympathised in their joys.

Rewritten passage

A significant amount of time passed before I realized one of the reasons for this kind family's distress: it was poverty, and they suffered from it to a heartbreaking extent. Their diet consisted entirely of vegetables from their garden and milk from a single cow, which produced very little during the winter, when its owners could barely find enough food to keep it alive. I believe they often felt the sharp pangs of hunger, especially the two younger cottagers, as they frequently set food before the old man while keeping none for themselves.

This act of kindness moved me deeply. I had been in the habit of stealing part of their supplies at night to feed myself, but once I realized that doing so caused them pain, I stopped and satisfied my hunger with berries, nuts, and roots I gathered from a nearby forest.

I also discovered another way to help with their chores. I noticed the young man spent much of his day gathering wood for the family fire, so at night I would take his tools—the use of which I quickly learned—and bring back enough firewood to last them for several days.

I remember the first time I did this; the young woman seemed incredibly surprised when she opened the door in the morning to see a large pile of wood outside. She exclaimed something loudly, and the young man joined her, also expressing his astonishment. I watched with

pleasure as he skipped his trip to the forest that day, spending his time instead repairing the cottage and working in the garden.

Gradually, I made an even more significant discovery. I realized these people had a way of sharing their experiences and feelings with one another through spoken sounds. I noticed that the words they used sometimes caused pleasure or pain, smiles or sadness, in the minds and faces of those who heard them. This was truly a godlike skill, and I desperately wanted to learn it. However, every attempt I made was unsuccessful. Their speech was fast, and because their words had no obvious connection to physical objects, I could not find a way to decode the mystery of their meaning. Through intense effort, however, and after staying in my hovel for several months, I identified the names given to some of the most common objects; I learned and used the words fire, milk, bread, and wood. I also learned the names of the cottagers themselves. The young man and his companion each had several names, but the old man had only one: father. The girl was called sister or Agatha, and the youth was called Felix, brother, or son. I cannot describe the joy I felt when I understood the meaning behind each of these sounds and was able to say them myself. I identified several other words without yet being able to understand or use them, such as good, dearest, and unhappy.

I spent the winter this way. The gentle nature and beauty of the cottagers made me feel very close to them; when they were sad, I felt depressed, and when they rejoiced, I shared in their happiness.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 041 / E4_041 / condition: simplify

Original passage

Elizabeth was prepared to see him in his glory; and she could not help fancying that in displaying the good proportion of the room, its aspect, and its furniture, he addressed himself particularly to her, as if wishing to make her feel what she had lost in refusing him. But though everything seemed neat and comfortable, she was not able to gratify him by any sigh of repentance; and rather looked with wonder at her friend, that she could have so cheerful an air with such a companion. When Mr. Collins said anything of which his wife might reasonably be ashamed, which certainly was not seldom, she involuntarily turned her eye on Charlotte. Once or twice she could discern a faint blush; but in general Charlotte wisely did not hear. After sitting long enough to admire every article of furniture in the room, from the sideboard to the fender, to give an account of their journey, and of all that had happened in London, Mr. Collins invited them to take a stroll in the garden, which was large and well laid out, and to the cultivation of which he attended himself. To work in his garden was one of his most respectable pleasures; and Elizabeth admired the command of countenance with which Charlotte talked of the healthfulness of the exercise, and owned she encouraged it as much as possible. Here, leading the way through every walk and cross walk, and scarcely allowing them an interval to utter the praises he asked for, every view was pointed out with a minuteness which left beauty entirely behind. He could number the fields in every direction, and could tell how many trees there were in the most distant clump. But of all the views which his garden, or which the country or the kingdom could boast, none were to be compared with the prospect of Rosings, afforded by an opening in the trees that bordered the park nearly opposite the front of his house. It was a handsome modern building, well situated on rising ground.

From his garden, Mr. Collins would have led them round his two meadows; but the ladies, not having shoes to encounter the remains of a white frost, turned back; and while Sir William accompanied him, Charlotte took her sister and friend over the house, extremely well pleased, probably, to have the opportunity of showing it without her husband's help. It was rather small, but well built and convenient; and everything was fitted up and arranged with a neatness and consistency, of which Elizabeth gave Charlotte all the credit. When Mr. Collins could be forgotten, there was really a great air of comfort throughout, and by Charlotte's evident enjoyment of it, Elizabeth supposed he must be often forgotten.

She had already learnt that Lady Catherine was still in the country. It was spoken of again while they were at dinner, when Mr. Collins joining in, observed,--

"Yes, Miss Elizabeth, you will have the honour of seeing Lady Catherine de Bourgh on the ensuing Sunday at church, and I need not say you will be delighted with her. She is all affability and condescension, and I doubt not but you will be honoured with some portion of her notice when service is over. I have scarcely any hesitation in saying that she will include you and my sister Maria in every invitation with which she honours us during your stay here.

Rewritten passage

Elizabeth expected to see him in his element. She could not help but imagine that as he showed off the room's proportions, its view, and its furniture, he was speaking directly to her, as if he wanted her to feel what she had missed by rejecting his proposal. Although everything appeared tidy and comfortable, she could not satisfy him with any sign of regret. Instead, she looked at her friend with wonder, surprised that Charlotte could seem so cheerful with such a husband. Whenever Mr. Collins said something that might embarrass his wife—which happened quite often—Elizabeth instinctively looked at Charlotte. Once or twice, she noticed a faint blush, but generally, Charlotte wisely chose not to hear him. After they had sat long enough to admire every piece of furniture, from the sideboard to the fireplace fender, and had discussed their journey and their time in London, Mr. Collins invited them for a walk in the garden. It was a large, well-designed space that he tended to himself. Gardening was one of his most respectable hobbies, and Elizabeth admired how Charlotte kept a straight face while talking about how healthy the exercise was, admitting that she encouraged him to do it as much as possible. Leading the way through every path, Mr. Collins barely gave them a moment to offer the praise he craved. He pointed out every view with such tedious detail that any sense of beauty was lost. He counted the fields in every direction and knew exactly how many trees were in the furthest cluster. Yet, of all the views his garden, the countryside, or even the kingdom could offer, none compared to the sight of Rosings, visible through a gap in the trees bordering the park across from his house. It was a handsome, modern building situated on a hill.

Mr. Collins wanted to lead them around his two meadows, but the ladies, not wearing shoes suitable for the lingering frost, turned back.

While Sir William went with him, Charlotte took her sister and friend on a tour of the house, likely pleased to show it off without her husband's interference. It was small, but well-built and convenient. Everything was arranged with a neatness and consistency for which Elizabeth gave Charlotte full credit. When Mr. Collins could be ignored, the house felt very comfortable, and judging by Charlotte's obvious enjoyment, Elizabeth assumed he must be ignored quite often.

She had already learned that Lady Catherine was still in the area. The subject came up again during dinner, when Mr. Collins joined in, remarking, "Yes, Miss Elizabeth, you will have the honor of seeing Lady Catherine de Bourgh at church this coming Sunday, and I need not say that you will be delighted by her. She is full of kindness and grace, and I have no doubt that you will be honored with some of her attention once the service is over. I have little hesitation in saying that she will include you and my sister Maria in every invitation she extends to us during your stay."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 042 / E4_042 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

The busy eastern part of the town was silent, or at most you saw only where, half from cupidity, half from curiosity, the warehouses had been more ransacked than pillaged: bales of rich India goods, shawls of price, jewels, and spices, unpacked, strewed the floors. In some places the possessor had to the last kept watch on his store, and died before the barred gates. The massy portals of the churches swung creaking on their hinges; and some few lay dead on the pavement. The wretched female, loveless victim of vulgar brutality, had wandered to the toilet of high-born beauty, and, arraying herself in the garb of splendour, had died before the mirror which reflected to herself alone her altered appearance. Women whose delicate feet had seldom touched the earth in their luxury, had fled in fright and horror from their homes, till, losing themselves in the squalid streets of the metropolis, they had died on the threshold of poverty. The heart sickened at the variety of misery presented; and, when I saw a specimen of this gloomy change, my soul ached with the fear of what might befall my beloved Idris and my babes. Were they, surviving Adrian and myself, to find themselves protectorless in the world? As yet the mind alone had suffered—could I for ever put off the time, when the delicate frame and shrinking nerves of my child of prosperity, the nursling of rank and wealth, who was my companion, should be invaded by famine, hardship, and disease? Better die at once—better plunge a poinard in her bosom, still untouched by drear adversity, and then again sheathe it in my own! But, no; in times of misery we must fight against our destinies, and strive not to be overcome by them. I would not yield, but to the last gasp resolutely defended my dear ones against sorrow and pain; and if I were vanquished at last, it should not be ingloriously. I stood in the gap, resisting the enemy—the impalpable, invisible foe, who had so long besieged us—as yet he had made no breach: it must be my care that he should not, secretly undermining, burst up within the very threshold of the temple of love, at whose altar I daily sacrificed. The hunger of Death was now stung more sharply by the diminution of his food: or was it that before, the survivors being many, the dead were less eagerly counted? Now each life was a gem, each human breathing form of far, O! far more worth than subtlest imagery of sculptured stone; and the daily, nay, hourly decrease visible in our numbers, visited the heart with sickening misery. This summer extinguished our hopes, the vessel of society was wrecked, and the shattered raft, which carried the few survivors over the sea of misery, was riven and tempest tost. Man existed by twos and threes; man, the individual who might sleep, and wake, and perform the animal functions; but man, in himself weak, yet more powerful in congregated numbers than wind or ocean; man, the queller of the elements, the lord of created nature, the peer of demi-gods, existed no longer.

Farewell to the patriotic scene, to the love of liberty and well earned meed of virtuous aspiration!—farewell to crowded senate, vocal with the councils of the wise, whose laws were keener than the sword blade tempered at Damascus!

Rewritten passage

The bustling eastern district of the city remained quiet, or revealed only spots where warehouses had been rummaged through, driven by greed or inquisitiveness: bundles of expensive Indian merchandise, costly shawls, gems, and spices lay scattered across the ground. In certain spots, the owner had guarded their inventory until the end, perishing in front of locked entrances. The heavy church doors groaned on their hinges, with a few corpses resting upon the stone floors. A miserable woman, the unloved casualty of common violence, had drifted into the dressing room of an aristocrat, draped herself in fine clothing, and expired before the glass that showed her transformed reflection. Ladies whose soft feet had rarely trod the ground in their pampered lives had escaped their residences in terror, only to become lost in the city's grimy lanes and perish at the doors of the destitute. My heart grew weary at the diverse miseries on display; witnessing such grim transformations, my spirit was pained by the dread of what might happen to my dear Idris and our children. Would they, outliving Adrian and me, be left without guardians in this world? Thus far, only the mind had been tormented—could I indefinitely delay the moment when the fragile body and sensitive nerves of my beloved, raised in luxury and rank, would be assaulted by starvation, suffering, and sickness? It would be better to perish immediately—better to drive a dagger into her chest, still unmarred by harsh misfortune, and then bury it in my own! Yet, no; during eras of suffering, we must battle our fates and endeavor not to be conquered by them. I refused to surrender, determined to shield my loved ones from grief and agony until my final breath; if I were eventually defeated, it would not be without honor. I remained at the barricade, opposing the adversary—the intangible, unseen enemy that had besieged us for so long—and as of yet, he had created no opening: it had to be my duty to ensure he did not, by burrowing in secret, erupt within the very sanctuary of love where I offered my daily devotions. The appetite of Death seemed sharpened by the dwindling supply of his victims: or perhaps it was simply that before, when survivors were numerous, the dead were tallied with less urgency? Now, every life was a treasure, every breathing human being worth far

more than the finest carved statues; and the daily, indeed hourly, decline in our population struck the heart with nauseating despair. This summer saw our hopes extinguished; the ship of civilization was destroyed, and the broken raft, bearing the remaining few across a sea of sorrow, was split and battered by storms. Humanity existed only in pairs or trios; the individual human, who might slumber, wake, and carry out basic biological needs, remained; but humanity, inherently fragile yet mightier in collective groups than the wind or the sea; humanity, the conqueror of nature, the master of creation, the equal of deities, existed no more. Farewell to the scenes of patriotism, to the devotion to freedom and the deserved rewards of noble ambition!—farewell to the packed parliament, resonant with the wisdom of counselors, whose decrees were sharper than a blade forged in Damascus!

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes:

Item 043 / E4_043 / condition: modernize

Original passage

Darcy's character, though he had assured her that respect for the father would always prevent his exposing the son.

How differently did everything now appear in which he was concerned! His attentions to Miss King were now the consequence of views solely and hatefully mercenary; and the mediocrity of her fortune proved no longer the moderation of his wishes, but his eagerness to grasp at anything. His behaviour to herself could now have had no tolerable motive: he had either been deceived with regard to her fortune, or had been gratifying his vanity by encouraging the preference which she believed she had most incautiously shown. Every lingering struggle in his favour grew fainter and fainter; and in further justification of Mr. Darcy, she could not but allow that Mr. Bingley, when questioned by Jane, had long ago asserted his blamelessness in the affair;--that, proud and repulsive as were his manners, she had never, in the whole course of their acquaintance--an acquaintance which had latterly brought them much together, and given her a sort of intimacy with his ways--seen anything that betrayed him to be unprincipled or unjust--anything that spoke him of irreligious or immoral habits;--that among his own connections he was esteemed and valued;--that even Wickham had allowed him merit as a brother, and that she had often heard him speak so affectionately of his sister as to prove him capable of some amiable feeling;--that had his actions been what Wickham represented them, so gross a violation of everything right could hardly have been concealed from the world; and that friendship between a person capable of it and such an amiable man as Mr. Bingley was incomprehensible.

She grew absolutely ashamed of herself. Of neither Darcy nor Wickham could she think, without feeling that she had been blind, partial, prejudiced, absurd.

"How despicably have I acted!" she cried. "I, who have prided myself on my discernment! I, who have valued myself on my abilities! who have often disdained the generous candour of my sister, and gratified my vanity in useless or blameless distrust. How humiliating is this discovery! Yet, how just a humiliation! Had I been in love, I could not have been more wretchedly blind. But vanity, not love, has been my folly. Pleased with the preference of one, and offended by the neglect of the other, on the very beginning of our acquaintance, I have courted prepossession and ignorance, and driven reason away where either were concerned. Till this moment, I never knew myself."

From herself to Jane, from Jane to Bingley, her thoughts were in a line which soon brought to her recollection that Mr. Darcy's explanation _there_ had appeared very insufficient; and she read it again. Widely different was the effect of a second perusal. How could she deny that credit to his assertions, in one instance, which she had been obliged to give in the other? He declared himself to have been totally unsuspecting of her sister's attachment; and she could not help remembering what Charlotte's opinion had always been. Neither could she deny the justice of his description of Jane. She felt that Jane's feelings, though fervent, were little displayed, and that there was a constant complacency in her air and manner, not often united with great sensibility.

When she came to that part of the letter in which her family were mentioned, in tones of such mortifying, yet merited, reproach, her sense of shame was severe.

Rewritten passage

Darcy's character, even though he had assured her that respect for the father would always prevent him from exposing the son.

How differently everything involving him now appeared! His attentions to Miss King were now clearly the result of motives that were purely and hatefully mercenary; the modest size of her fortune no longer suggested he was being reasonable, but rather that he was eager to grab at anything. His behavior toward her could no longer be explained by any acceptable motive: he had either been misled about her own financial situation, or he had been feeding his vanity by encouraging the interest she now believed she had shown far too carelessly. Every lingering feeling in his favor grew weaker, and in further defense of Mr. Darcy, she had to admit that Mr. Bingley, when questioned by Jane, had long ago insisted on his innocence in the matter. She realized that, proud and cold as his manners were, she had never—in all the time

they had known each other, a period that had recently brought them together and given her some insight into his habits—seen anything that proved him to be unprincipled or unjust, or anything that suggested he was irreligious or immoral. She acknowledged that he was respected and valued by his own circle, that even Wickham had credited him with being a good brother, and that she had often heard him speak so affectionately of his sister that he clearly possessed some kind and gentle feelings. If his actions had truly been what Wickham claimed, such a blatant violation of right would have been impossible to hide from the world, and a friendship between someone capable of such things and a man as kind as Mr. Bingley would be impossible to understand.

She felt absolutely ashamed of herself. She could not think of either Darcy or Wickham without realizing that she had been blind, biased, prejudiced, and ridiculous.

"How despicably I have acted!" she cried. "I, who have prided myself on my discernment! I, who have valued myself on my intelligence! I, who have often looked down on my sister's generous fairness and fed my own vanity with useless or groundless suspicion. How humiliating this discovery is! Yet, how deserved this humiliation is! If I had been in love, I could not have been more miserably blind. But vanity, not love, has been my folly. Pleased by the attention of one man and offended by the neglect of the other from the very start, I have encouraged my own biases and ignorance, pushing reason aside whenever they were involved. Until this moment, I never truly knew myself."

Moving from herself to Jane, and from Jane to Bingley, her thoughts followed a path that soon reminded her that Mr. Darcy's explanation regarding that situation had seemed very insufficient, so she read it again. The effect of this second reading was entirely different. How could she deny the truth of his claims in one instance when she had been forced to accept them in the other? He stated that he had been completely unaware of her sister's feelings, and she could not help but recall what Charlotte's opinion had always been. Neither could she deny the accuracy of his description of Jane. She felt that Jane's emotions, though intense, were rarely shown, and that there was a constant, calm pleasantness in her manner that was not often combined with deep sensitivity.

When she reached the part of the letter where her family was mentioned, in tones of such mortifying yet deserved reproach, her sense of shame was intense.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 044 / E4_044 / condition: simplify

Original passage

The day of his and Lydia's departure soon came; and Mrs. Bennet was forced to submit to a separation, which, as her husband by no means entered into her scheme of their all going to Newcastle, was likely to continue at least a twelvemonth.

"Oh, my dear Lydia," she cried, "when shall we meet again?"

"Oh, Lord! I don't know. Not these two or three years, perhaps."

"Write to me very often, my dear."

"As often as I can. But you know married women have never much time for writing. My sisters may write to _me_. They will have nothing else to do."

Mr. Wickham's adieus were much more affectionate than his wife's. He smiled, looked handsome, and said many pretty things.

"He is as fine a fellow," said Mr. Bennet, as soon as they were out of the house, "as ever I saw. He simpers, and smirks, and makes love to us all. I am prodigiously proud of him. I defy even Sir William Lucas himself to produce a more valuable son-in-law."

The loss of her daughter made Mrs. Bennet very dull for several days.

"I often think," said she, "that there is nothing so bad as parting with one's friends. One seems so forlorn without them."

"This is the consequence, you see, madam, of marrying a daughter," said Elizabeth. "It must make you better satisfied that your other four are single."

"It is no such thing. Lydia does not leave me because she is married; but only because her husband's regiment happens to be so far off. If that had been nearer, she would not have gone so soon."

But the spiritless condition which this event threw her into was shortly relieved, and her mind opened again to the agitation of hope, by an article of news which then began to be in circulation. The housekeeper at Netherfield had received orders to prepare for the arrival of her master, who was coming down in a day or two, to shoot there for several weeks. Mrs. Bennet was quite in the fidgets. She looked at Jane, and smiled, and shook her head, by turns.

"Well, well, and so Mr. Bingley is coming down, sister," (for Mrs. Philips first brought her the news). "Well, so much the better. Not that I care about it, though. He is nothing to us, you know, and I am sure I never want to see him again. But, however, he is very welcome to come to Netherfield, if he likes it. And who knows what _may_ happen? But that is nothing to us. You know, sister, we agreed long ago never to mention a word about it. And so, it is quite certain he is coming?"

"You may depend on it," replied the other, "for Mrs. Nichols was in Meryton last night: I saw her passing by, and went out myself on purpose to know the truth of it; and she told me that it was certainly true. He comes down on Thursday, at the latest, very likely on Wednesday. She was going to the butcher's, she told me, on purpose to order in some meat on Wednesday, and she has got three couple of ducks just fit to be killed."

Miss Bennet had not been able to hear of his coming without changing colour.

Rewritten passage

The day for the departure of Lydia and her husband soon arrived. Mrs. Bennet had to accept the separation, which was expected to last at least a year, as her husband refused to support her plan for the whole family to move to Newcastle.

"Oh, my dear Lydia," she cried, "when will we see each other again?"

"Oh, goodness! I don't know. Maybe not for two or three years."

"Write to me very often, my dear."

"As often as I can. But you know married women don't have much time for writing. My sisters can write to me. They won't have anything else to do."

Mr. Wickham's farewells were much warmer than his wife's. He smiled, looked handsome, and said many charming things.

"He is as fine a fellow," Mr. Bennet remarked as soon as they had left the house, "as I have ever seen. He smiles, acts pleasant, and charms us all. I am incredibly proud of him. I challenge even Sir William Lucas to produce a more impressive son-in-law."

Losing her daughter left Mrs. Bennet feeling quite miserable for several days.

"I often think," she said, "that there is nothing worse than parting with one's friends. One feels so lonely without them."

"You see, mother, this is the result of marrying off a daughter," Elizabeth said. "It should make you feel better that your other four are still single."

"That is not the case at all. Lydia is not leaving me because she is married, but only because her husband's regiment happens to be stationed so far away. If they were closer, she would not have left so soon."

However, the gloomy mood this event caused did not last long. Her spirits were lifted, and her mind was filled with new hope, by a piece of news that began to circulate. The housekeeper at Netherfield had received orders to prepare for her master's arrival; he was coming in a day or two to shoot there for several weeks. Mrs. Bennet was in a state of excitement. She looked at Jane, smiled, and shook her head repeatedly.

"Well, well, so Mr. Bingley is coming back, sister," she said to Mrs. Philips, who had brought the news. "Well, that is for the best. Not that I care about it, mind you. He means nothing to us, and I am sure I never want to see him again. Still, he is very welcome to come to Netherfield if he likes. And who knows what might happen? But that is none of our business. You know, sister, we agreed long ago never to speak of it. So, is it absolutely certain he is coming?"

"You can count on it," the other replied, "because Mrs. Nichols was in Meryton last night. I saw her passing by and went out specifically to learn the truth, and she confirmed it was certain. He is arriving on Thursday at the latest, and very likely on Wednesday. She told me she was going to the butcher's to order meat for Wednesday, and she has three pairs of ducks ready to be prepared."

Jane Bennet could not hear of his arrival without changing color.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 045 / E4_045 / condition: modernize

Original passage

Turning towards the men,
he said,

"What do you mean? What do you demand of your captain? Are you, then, so easily turned from your design? Did you not call this a glorious expedition? "And wherefore was it glorious? Not because the way was smooth and placid as a southern sea, but because it was full of dangers and terror, because at every new incident your fortitude was to be called forth and your courage exhibited, because danger and death surrounded it, and these you were to brave and overcome. For this was it a glorious, for this was it an honourable undertaking. You were hereafter to be hailed as the benefactors of your species, your names adored as belonging to brave men who encountered death for honour and the benefit of mankind. And now, behold, with the first imagination of danger, or, if you will, the first mighty and terrific trial of your courage, you shrink away and are content to be handed down as men who had not strength enough to endure cold and peril; and so, poor souls, they were chilly and returned to their warm firesides. Why, that requires not this preparation; ye need not have come thus far and dragged your captain to the shame of a defeat merely to prove yourselves cowards. Oh! Be men, or be more than men. Be steady to your purposes and firm as a rock. This ice is not made of such stuff as your hearts may be; it is mutable and cannot withstand you if you say that it shall not. Do not return to your families with the stigma of disgrace marked on your brows. Return as heroes who have fought and conquered and who know not what it is to turn their backs on the foe."

He spoke this with a voice so modulated to the different feelings expressed in his speech, with an eye so full of lofty design and heroism, that can you wonder that these men were moved? They looked at one another and were unable to reply. I spoke; I told them to retire and consider of what had been said, that I would not lead them farther north if they strenuously desired the contrary, but that I hoped that, with reflection, their courage would return.

They retired and I turned towards my friend, but he was sunk in languor and almost deprived of life.

How all this will terminate, I know not, but I had rather die than return shamefully, my purpose unfulfilled. Yet I fear such will be my fate; the men, unsupported by ideas of glory and honour, can never willingly continue to endure their present hardships.

September 7th.

The die is cast; I have consented to return if we are not destroyed. Thus are my hopes blasted by cowardice and indecision; I come back ignorant and disappointed. It requires more philosophy than I possess to bear this injustice with patience.

September 12th.

It is past; I am returning to England. I have lost my hopes of utility and glory; I have lost my friend. But I will endeavour to detail these bitter circumstances to you, my dear sister; and while I am wafted towards England and towards you, I will not despond.

September 9th, the ice began to move, and roarings like thunder were heard at a distance as the islands split and cracked in every direction.

Rewritten passage

Turning toward the men, he said, "What do you mean? What do you demand of your captain? Are you so easily swayed from your mission? Did you not call this a glorious expedition? And why was it glorious? Not because the path was smooth and calm like a southern sea, but because it was filled with danger and terror, because every new event demanded your fortitude and courage, because danger and death surrounded it, and these you were to face and overcome. For this reason, it was a glorious and honorable undertaking. You were to be hailed as benefactors of your species, your names adored as those of brave men who faced death for honor and the benefit of humanity. And now, look, at the first thought of danger, or, if you prefer, the first mighty and terrifying test of your courage, you shrink away and are content to be remembered as men who lacked the strength to endure cold and peril; and so, poor souls, they were chilly and returned to their warm

firesides. Why, that does not require this level of preparation; you did not need to come this far and drag your captain into the shame of defeat merely to prove yourselves cowards. Oh! Be men, or be more than men. Stay true to your purposes and firm as a rock. This ice is not made of the same material as your hearts; it is changeable and cannot withstand you if you declare that it shall not. Do not return to your families with the mark of disgrace on your brows. Return as heroes who have fought and conquered and who do not know what it is to turn their backs on the enemy."

He spoke this with a voice so modulated to the different emotions expressed in his speech, with an eye so full of lofty ambition and heroism, that can you wonder these men were moved? They looked at one another and were unable to reply. I spoke; I told them to retire and consider what had been said, that I would not lead them further north if they strongly desired the contrary, but that I hoped their courage would return with reflection.

They retired and I turned toward my friend, but he was sunk in exhaustion and almost lifeless.

How all this will end, I do not know, but I would rather die than return shamefully, my purpose unfulfilled. Yet I fear such will be my fate; the men, unsupported by ideas of glory and honor, can never willingly continue to endure their present hardships.

September 7th.

The die is cast; I have consented to return if we are not destroyed. Thus are my hopes blasted by cowardice and indecision; I come back ignorant and disappointed. It requires more philosophy than I possess to bear this injustice with patience.

September 12th.

It is over; I am returning to England. I have lost my hopes of utility and glory; I have lost my friend. But I will endeavor to detail these bitter circumstances to you, my dear sister; and while I am carried toward England and toward you, I will not despair.

September 9th, the ice began to move, and roarings like thunder were heard at a distance as the islands split and cracked in every direction.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 046 / E4_046 / condition: modernize

Original passage

The very idea was generous and noble,—but, beyond this, his unpretending manner, his entire want of the assumption of a virtue, rendered his act ten times more touching. I would have withstood his request; but I had seen the good he diffused; I felt that his resolves were not to be shaken, so, with an heavy heart, I consented to do as he asked. He grasped my hand affectionately:—"Thank you," he said, "you have relieved me from a painful dilemma, and are, as you ever were, the best of my friends. Farewell—I must now leave you for a few hours. Go you and converse with Ryland. Although he deserts his post in London, he may be of the greatest service in the north of England, by receiving and assisting travellers, and contributing to supply the metropolis with food. Awaken him, I entreat you, to some sense of duty."

Adrian left me, as I afterwards learnt, upon his daily task of visiting the hospitals, and inspecting the crowded parts of London. I found Ryland much altered, even from what he had been when he visited Windsor. Perpetual fear had jaundiced his complexion, and shrivelled his whole person. I told him of the business of the evening, and a smile relaxed the contracted muscles. He desired to go; each day he expected to be infected by pestilence, each day he was unable to resist the gentle violence of Adrian's detention. The moment Adrian should be legally elected his deputy, he would escape to safety. Under this impression he listened to all I said; and, elevated almost to joy by the near prospect of his departure, he entered into a discussion concerning the plans he should adopt in his own county, forgetting, for the moment, his cherished resolution of shutting himself up from all communication in the mansion and grounds of his estate.

In the evening, Adrian and I proceeded to Westminster. As we went he reminded me of what I was to say and do, yet, strange to say, I entered the chamber without having once reflected on my purpose. Adrian remained in the coffee-room, while I, in compliance with his desire, took my seat in St. Stephen's. There reigned unusual silence in the chamber. I had not visited it since Raymond's protectorate; a period conspicuous for a numerous attendance of members, for the eloquence of the speakers, and the warmth of the debate. The benches were very empty, those by custom occupied by the hereditary members were vacant; the city members were there—the members for the commercial towns, few landed proprietors, and not many of those who entered parliament for the sake of a career. The first subject that occupied the attention of the house was an address from the Lord Protector, praying them to appoint a deputy during a necessary absence on his part.

A silence prevailed, till one of the members coming to me, whispered that the Earl of Windsor had sent him word that I was to move his election, in the absence of the person who had been first chosen for this office. Now for the first time I saw the full extent of my task, and I was overwhelmed by what I had brought on myself. Ryland had deserted his post through fear of the plague: from the same fear Adrian had no competitor.

Rewritten passage

The very idea was generous and noble, but beyond that, his modest manner and complete lack of self-righteousness made his actions ten times more moving. I wanted to refuse his request, but I had seen the good he spread; I felt that his resolve was unshakable, so with a heavy heart, I agreed to do as he asked. He grasped my hand affectionately. "Thank you," he said. "You have relieved me of a painful dilemma, and you are, as you have always been, my best friend. Farewell—I must leave you for a few hours now. Go and speak with Ryland. Although he is abandoning his post in London, he could be of great service in the north of England by receiving and assisting travelers and helping to supply the capital with food. I beg you to awaken him to some sense of duty."

Adrian left me, as I later learned, for his daily task of visiting the hospitals and inspecting the crowded districts of London. I found Ryland much changed, even from when he had visited Windsor. Constant fear had sallowed his complexion and made him look withered. I told him about the evening's business, and a smile relaxed his tense muscles. He wanted to go; every day he expected to catch the plague, and every day he was unable to resist the gentle pressure of Adrian's insistence that he stay. The moment Adrian was legally elected his deputy, he would escape to safety. With this in mind, he listened to everything I said, and, buoyed by the near prospect of his departure, he began discussing the plans he would adopt in his own county, forgetting for the moment his cherished resolution to isolate himself from all contact within his estate.

In the evening, Adrian and I went to Westminster. As we traveled, he reminded me of what I was to say and do, yet, strangely, I entered the

chamber without having once reflected on my purpose. Adrian stayed in the coffee-room, while I, following his wishes, took my seat in St. Stephen's. An unusual silence reigned in the chamber. I had not visited it since Raymond's protectorate, a period marked by high attendance, eloquent speakers, and heated debate. The benches were mostly empty; those usually occupied by the hereditary members were vacant. The city members were there, along with representatives from commercial towns, a few landowners, and not many of those who entered parliament to build a career. The first subject to occupy the house was an address from the Lord Protector, asking them to appoint a deputy during his necessary absence.

A silence prevailed until one of the members came to me and whispered that the Earl of Windsor had sent word that I was to move for his election, in the absence of the person originally chosen for the office. Now, for the first time, I saw the full extent of my task, and I was overwhelmed by what I had brought upon myself. Ryland had deserted his post out of fear of the plague; because of that same fear, Adrian had no competition.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes:

Item 047 / E4_047 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

Has
he, has my nephew, made you an offer of marriage?"

"Your Ladyship has declared it to be impossible."

"It ought to be so; it must be so, while he retains the use of his reason. But _your_ arts and allurements may, in a moment of infatuation, have made him forget what he owes to himself and to all his family. You may have drawn him in."

"If I have, I shall be the last person to confess it."

"Miss Bennet, do you know who I am? I have not been accustomed to such language as this. I am almost the nearest relation he has in the world, and am entitled to know all his dearest concerns."

"But you are not entitled to know _mine_; nor will such behaviour as this ever induce me to be explicit."

"Let me be rightly understood. This match, to which you have the presumption to aspire, can never take place. No, never. Mr. Darcy is engaged to _my daughter_. Now, what have you to say?"

"Only this,--that if he is so, you can have no reason to suppose he will make an offer to me."

Lady Catherine hesitated for a moment, and then replied,--

"The engagement between them is of a peculiar kind. From their infancy, they have been intended for each other. It was the favourite wish of _his_ mother, as well as of hers. While in their cradles we planned the union; and now, at the moment when the wishes of both sisters would be accomplished, is their marriage to be prevented by a young woman of inferior birth, of no importance in the world, and wholly unallied to the family? Do you pay no regard to the wishes of his friends--to his tacit engagement with Miss de Bourgh? Are you lost to every feeling of propriety and delicacy? Have you not heard me say, that from his earliest hours he was destined for his cousin?"

"Yes; and I had heard it before. But what is that to me? If there is no other objection to my marrying your nephew, I shall certainly not be kept from it by knowing that his mother and aunt wished him to marry Miss de Bourgh. You both did as much as you could in planning the marriage. Its completion depended on others. If Mr. Darcy is neither by honour nor inclination confined to his cousin, why is not he to make another choice? And if I am that choice, why may not I accept him?"

"Because honour, decorum, prudence--nay, interest--forbid it. Yes, Miss Bennet, interest; for do not expect to be noticed by his family or friends, if you wilfully act against the inclinations of all. You will be censured, slighted, and despised, by everyone connected with him. Your alliance will be a disgrace; your name will never even be mentioned by any of us."

"These are heavy misfortunes," replied Elizabeth. "But the wife of Mr. Darcy must have such extraordinary sources of happiness necessarily attached to her situation, that she could, upon the whole, have no cause to repine."

"Obstinate, headstrong girl! I am ashamed of you! Is this your gratitude for my attentions to you last spring? Is nothing due to me on that score? Let us sit down. You are to understand, Miss Bennet, that I came here with the determined resolution of carrying my purpose; nor will I be dissuaded from it."

Rewritten passage

"Has my nephew proposed marriage to you?"

"Your Ladyship has already stated that such a thing is impossible."

"It certainly should be, provided he remains in his right mind. However, your cunning and charms might have caused him, in a fit of madness, to disregard his duty to himself and his relatives. You may have ensnared him."

"If I had, I would be the last person to admit it."

"Miss Bennet, are you aware of my identity? I am not used to being spoken to in this manner. As one of his closest living relatives, I have a right to be informed of his most private affairs."

"You have no right to know mine, and your current conduct will certainly not encourage me to be open with you."

"Let me be perfectly clear. This union, which you are arrogant enough to desire, will never happen. Never. Mr. Darcy is betrothed to my daughter. What is your response to that?"

"Only this: if that is the case, you have no grounds to believe he would propose to me."

Lady Catherine paused briefly before answering:

"Their engagement is of a unique nature. They have been destined for one another since they were infants. It was the cherished desire of both his mother and mine. We arranged this match while they were still in their cribs, and now, just as the sisters' wishes are about to be fulfilled, is their marriage to be thwarted by a young woman of lower social standing, no significance, and no connection to the family? Do you have no respect for the desires of his family, or for his unspoken commitment to Miss de Bourgh? Have you no sense of decency or propriety? Have you not heard me state that he was intended for his cousin from his earliest days?"

"Yes, I had heard that previously. But how does that concern me? If there is no other obstacle to my marrying your nephew, I will not be deterred simply because his mother and aunt wanted him to marry Miss de Bourgh. You both did your part in planning the marriage, but its success relied on others. If Mr. Darcy is not bound to his cousin by either duty or desire, why shouldn't he choose someone else? And if I am that choice, why shouldn't I accept him?"

"Because honor, propriety, wisdom, and even self-interest forbid it. Yes, Miss Bennet, self-interest; do not expect to be acknowledged by his family or friends if you deliberately defy their wishes. You will be criticized, ignored, and looked down upon by everyone associated with him. Your marriage will be a scandal; your name will never be spoken by any of us."

"Those are significant hardships," Elizabeth answered. "But the wife of Mr. Darcy must possess such remarkable advantages that she would, on the whole, have no reason to complain."

"You stubborn, willful girl! I am embarrassed for you! Is this how you show gratitude for the kindness I showed you last spring? Do you owe me nothing for that? Let us be seated. You must realize, Miss Bennet, that I arrived here with the firm intention of succeeding, and I will not be turned away from my goal."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 048 / E4_048 / condition: simplify

Original passage

The hand-writing itself was exquisitely beautiful; there was something in her very paper and its folds, which even I, who did not love, and was withal unskilled in such matters, could discern as being tasteful. There was much kindness, gratitude, and sweetness in her expression, but no love. Evadne was two years older than Adrian; and who, at eighteen, ever loved one so much their junior? I compared her placid epistles with the burning ones of Adrian. His soul seemed to distil itself into the words he wrote; and they breathed on the paper, bearing with them a portion of the life of love, which was his life. The very writing used to exhaust him; and he would weep over them, merely from the excess of emotion they awakened in his heart.

Adrian's soul was painted in his countenance, and concealment or deceit were at the antipodes to the dreadless frankness of his nature. Evadne made it her earnest request that the tale of their loves should not be revealed to his mother; and after for a while contesting the point, he yielded it to her. A vain concession; his demeanour quickly betrayed his secret to the quick eyes of the ex-queen. With the same wary prudence that characterized her whole conduct, she concealed her discovery, but hastened to remove her son from the sphere of the attractive Greek. He was sent to Cumberland; but the plan of correspondence between the lovers, arranged by Evadne, was effectually hidden from her. Thus the absence of Adrian, concerted for the purpose of separating, united them in firmer bonds than ever. To me he discoursed ceaselessly of his beloved Ionian. Her country, its ancient annals, its late memorable struggles, were all made to partake in her glory and excellence. He submitted to be away from her, because she commanded this submission; but for her influence, he would have declared his attachment before all England, and resisted, with unshaken constancy, his mother's opposition. Evadne's feminine prudence perceived how useless any assertion of his resolves would be, till added years gave weight to his power. Perhaps there was besides a lurking dislike to bind herself in the face of the world to one whom she did not love—not love, at least, with that passionate enthusiasm which her heart told her she might one day feel towards another. He obeyed her injunctions, and passed a year in exile in Cumberland.

CHAPTER III.

Happy, thrice happy, were the months, and weeks, and hours of that year. Friendship, hand in hand with admiration, tenderness and respect, built a bower of delight in my heart, late rough as an untrod wild in America, as the homeless wind or herbless sea. Insatiate thirst for knowledge, and boundless affection for Adrian, combined to keep both my heart and understanding occupied, and I was consequently happy. What happiness is so true and unclouded, as the overflowing and talkative delight of young people. In our boat, upon my native lake, beside the streams and the pale bordering poplars—in valley and over hill, my crook thrown aside, a nobler flock to tend than silly sheep, even a flock of new-born ideas, I read or listened to Adrian; and his discourse, whether it concerned his love or his theories for the improvement of man, alike entranced me.

Rewritten passage

The handwriting was exquisite. Even I, who did not love her and lacked experience in such things, could see that her choice of paper and the way she folded it showed great taste. Her letters were kind, grateful, and sweet, but they lacked love. Evadne was two years older than Adrian, and at eighteen, who ever loves someone so much younger? I compared her calm letters to Adrian's passionate ones. His soul seemed to pour into his writing; his words felt alive, carrying the intensity of the love that defined his existence. The act of writing drained him, and he would often weep over his letters simply because of the overwhelming emotions they stirred in his heart.

Adrian's soul was visible in his face, and he was far too honest to hide or deceive anyone. Evadne insisted that their relationship remain a secret from his mother, and after some resistance, Adrian agreed. It was a useless concession; his behavior quickly gave him away to the observant ex-queen. With the cautious prudence that defined her, she kept her discovery to herself but moved quickly to separate her son from the attractive Greek woman. He was sent to Cumberland, but Evadne had arranged a way for them to correspond that remained hidden from his mother. Thus, the plan meant to keep them apart only bound them more tightly together. To me, he spoke constantly of his beloved Ionian. He connected her country, its history, and its recent struggles to her own glory and excellence. He accepted his exile only because

she demanded it; otherwise, he would have declared his love to all of England and resisted his mother's opposition with unwavering resolve. Evadne's feminine caution told her that his defiance would be useless until he was older and more powerful. Perhaps she also felt a secret reluctance to commit herself publicly to someone she did not love—at least, not with the passionate intensity she felt she might one day experience with someone else. He followed her instructions and spent a year in exile in Cumberland.

CHAPTER III.

Those months, weeks, and hours were incredibly happy. Friendship, combined with admiration, tenderness, and respect, created a sense of joy in my heart that had previously been as wild and empty as an untraveled forest or the open sea. My insatiable thirst for knowledge and my deep affection for Adrian kept my mind and heart fully occupied, making me happy. What happiness is more genuine and clear than the talkative, overflowing joy of young people? Whether we were in a boat on my native lake, walking beside streams and poplar trees, or wandering through valleys and over hills, I was content. I set aside my shepherd's crook to tend to a nobler flock—a flock of new ideas—as I read to Adrian or listened to him. His conversation, whether it was about his love or his theories for improving humanity, always captivated me.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 049 / E4_049 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

There was no immediate appearance. No; he was talking to Mrs. Cole—he was looking on unconcerned; Jane was asked by somebody else, and he was still talking to Mrs. Cole.

Emma had no longer an alarm for Henry; his interest was yet safe; and she led off the dance with genuine spirit and enjoyment. Not more than five couple could be mustered; but the rarity and the suddenness of it made it very delightful, and she found herself well matched in a partner. They were a couple worth looking at.

Two dances, unfortunately, were all that could be allowed. It was growing late, and Miss Bates became anxious to get home, on her mother's account. After some attempts, therefore, to be permitted to begin again, they were obliged to thank Mrs. Weston, look sorrowful, and have done.

"Perhaps it is as well," said Frank Churchill, as he attended Emma to her carriage. "I must have asked Miss Fairfax, and her languid dancing would not have agreed with me, after yours."

CHAPTER IX

Emma did not repent her condescension in going to the Coles. The visit afforded her many pleasant recollections the next day; and all that she might be supposed to have lost on the side of dignified seclusion, must be amply repaid in the splendour of popularity. She must have delighted the Coles—worthy people, who deserved to be made happy!—And left a name behind her that would not soon die away.

Perfect happiness, even in memory, is not common; and there were two points on which she was not quite easy. She doubted whether she had not transgressed the duty of woman by woman, in betraying her suspicions of Jane Fairfax's feelings to Frank Churchill. It was hardly right; but it had been so strong an idea, that it would escape her, and his submission to all that she told, was a compliment to her penetration, which made it difficult for her to be quite certain that she ought to have held her tongue.

The other circumstance of regret related also to Jane Fairfax; and there she had no doubt. She did unfeignedly and unequivocally regret the inferiority of her own playing and singing. She did most heartily grieve over the idleness of her childhood—and sat down and practised vigorously an hour and a half.

She was then interrupted by Harriet's coming in; and if Harriet's praise could have satisfied her, she might soon have been comforted.

"Oh! if I could but play as well as you and Miss Fairfax!"

"Don't class us together, Harriet. My playing is no more like her's, than a lamp is like sunshine."

"Oh! dear—I think you play the best of the two. I think you play quite as well as she does. I am sure I had much rather hear you. Every body last night said how well you played."

"Those who knew any thing about it, must have felt the difference. The truth is, Harriet, that my playing is just good enough to be praised, but Jane Fairfax's is much beyond it."

"Well, I always shall think that you play quite as well as she does, or that if there is any difference nobody would ever find it out. Mr. Cole said how much taste you had; and Mr.

Rewritten passage

He did not appear at once. No, he remained engaged in conversation with Mrs. Cole, appearing entirely indifferent; someone else requested Jane to dance, while he continued his talk with Mrs. Cole. Emma no longer felt any concern regarding Henry; his interest remained secure,

and she began the dance with authentic enthusiasm and pleasure. Only five couples could be gathered, yet the unexpected nature of the event made it quite charming, and she discovered her partner was an excellent match. They were a pair worth observing. Unfortunately, only two dances were permitted. The hour was late, and Miss Bates grew worried about returning home for her mother's sake. Consequently, after some efforts to secure another round, they were forced to thank Mrs. Weston, express their regret, and conclude. "Perhaps it is for the best," Frank Churchill remarked while escorting Emma to her carriage. "I would have been obliged to ask Miss Fairfax, and her spiritless dancing would not have suited me after yours." CHAPTER IX Emma did not regret her decision to lower herself by attending the Coles' party. The visit provided her with many agreeable memories the following day; any loss of dignified privacy was surely compensated by the brilliance of her social success. She must have brought joy to the Coles—decent people who deserved such happiness—and established a reputation that would linger for some time. True happiness, even in retrospect, is rare, and there were two matters that troubled her. She questioned whether she had failed in her duty toward another woman by revealing her suspicions regarding Jane Fairfax's emotions to Frank Churchill. It was likely improper, yet the notion had been so compelling that it slipped out, and his deference to her observations served as a tribute to her insight, making it hard for her to be certain she should have remained silent. The other source of regret also concerned Jane Fairfax, and here she felt no uncertainty. She genuinely and clearly lamented the inferiority of her own musical performance. She felt deep remorse for the laziness of her youth, and she sat down to practice diligently for ninety minutes. She was then disturbed by Harriet's arrival; if Harriet's compliments could have sufficed, she might have been consoled quickly. "Oh! If only I could play as well as you and Miss Fairfax!" "Do not group us together, Harriet. My playing resembles hers no more than a lamp resembles the sun." "Oh, dear—I believe you play better than she does. I think you play every bit as well as she. I am certain I would much rather listen to you. Everyone last night remarked on how well you played." "Those who possessed any real knowledge must have perceived the distinction. The truth is, Harriet, that my playing is merely sufficient to earn praise, whereas Jane Fairfax's is far superior." "Well, I shall always maintain that you play just as well as she does, or that if any difference exists, no one would ever notice it. Mr. Cole remarked on how much taste you possessed; and Mr.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 050 / E4_050 / condition: simplify

Original passage

Besides, everybody knows that the Sonnets were addressed to Lord Pembroke. The matter is settled once for all.'

'The matter is not settled!' I exclaimed. 'I will take up the theory where Cyril Graham left it, and I will prove to the world that he was right.'

'Silly boy!' said Erskine. 'Go home: it is after two, and don't think about Willie Hughes any more. I am sorry I told you anything about it, and very sorry indeed that I should have converted you to a thing in which I don't believe.'

'You have given me the key to the greatest mystery of modern literature,' I answered; 'and I shall not rest till I have made you recognise, till I have made everybody recognise, that Cyril Graham was the most subtle Shakespearean critic of our day.'

As I walked home through St. James's Park the dawn was just breaking over London. The white swans were lying asleep on the polished lake, and the gaunt Palace looked purple against the pale-green sky. I thought of Cyril Graham, and my eyes filled with tears.

CHAPTER II

IT was past twelve o'clock when I awoke, and the sun was streaming in through the curtains of my room in long slanting beams of dusty gold. I told my servant that I would be at home to no one; and after I had had a cup of chocolate and a _petit-pain_, I took down from the book-shelf my copy of Shakespeare's Sonnets, and began to go carefully through them. Every poem seemed to me to corroborate Cyril Graham's theory. I felt as if I had my hand upon Shakespeare's heart, and was counting each separate throb and pulse of passion. I thought of the wonderful boy-actor, and saw his face in every line.

Two sonnets, I remember, struck me particularly: they were the 53rd and the 67th. In the first of these, Shakespeare, complimenting Willie Hughes on the versatility of his acting, on his wide range of parts, a range extending from Rosalind to Juliet, and from Beatrice to Ophelia, says to him—

What is your substance, whereof are you made,
That millions of strange shadows on you tend?
Since every one hath, every one, one shade,
And you, but one, can every shadow lend—

lines that would be unintelligible if they were not addressed to an actor, for the word 'shadow' had in Shakespeare's day a technical meaning connected with the stage. 'The best in this kind are but shadows,' says Theseus of the actors in the _Midsummer Night's Dream_, and there are many similar allusions in the literature of the day. These sonnets evidently belonged to the series in which Shakespeare discusses the nature of the actor's art, and of the strange and rare temperament that is essential to the perfect stage-player. 'How is it,' says Shakespeare to Willie Hughes, 'that you have so many personalities?' and then he goes on to point out that his beauty is such that it seems to realise every form and phase of fancy, to embody each dream of the creative imagination—an idea that is still further expanded in the sonnet that immediately follows, where, beginning with the fine thought,

O, how much more doth beauty beauteous seem
By that sweet ornament which _truth_ doth give!

Rewritten passage

"Besides, everyone knows the Sonnets were written to Lord Pembroke. That matter is settled once and for all."

"The matter is not settled!" I exclaimed. "I will pick up the theory where Cyril Graham left it, and I will prove to the world that he was right."

"Silly boy!" Erskine said. "Go home; it is after two, and don't think about Willie Hughes anymore. I am sorry I told you anything about it, and very sorry indeed that I converted you to something I don't even believe in."

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CHAPTER II

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I remember two sonnets struck me particularly: the 53rd and the 67th. In the first, Shakespeare compliments Willie Hughes on his acting versatility and his wide range of parts—ranging from Rosalind to Juliet, and from Beatrice to Ophelia—by saying:

What is your substance, whereof are you made,
That millions of strange shadows on you tend?
Since every one hath, every one, one shade,
And you, but one, can every shadow lend—

These lines would be impossible to understand if they were not addressed to an actor, because the word 'shadow' had a technical meaning related to the stage in Shakespeare's day. "The best in this kind are but shadows," Theseus says of the actors in *A Midsummer Night's Dream*, and there are many similar references in the literature of that time. These sonnets clearly belonged to the series where Shakespeare discusses the nature of the actor's art and the strange, rare temperament essential to a perfect stage-player. "How is it," Shakespeare asks Willie Hughes, "that you have so many personalities?" He then points out that his beauty is such that it seems to realize every form and phase of fancy, embodying every dream of the creative imagination. This idea is expanded even further in the sonnet that follows, which begins with the beautiful thought:

O, how much more doth beauty beauteous seem
By that sweet ornament which truth doth give!

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 051 / E4_051 / condition: modernize

Original passage

He will not be missed for months. When he is missed, there must be no trace of him found here. You, Alan, you must change him, and everything that belongs to him, into a handful of ashes that I may scatter in the air."

"You are mad, Dorian."

"Ah! I was waiting for you to call me Dorian."

"You are mad, I tell you—mad to imagine that I would raise a finger to help you, mad to make this monstrous confession. I will have nothing to do with this matter, whatever it is. Do you think I am going to peril my reputation for you? What is it to me what devil's work you are up to?"

"It was suicide, Alan."

"I am glad of that. But who drove him to it? You, I should fancy."

"Do you still refuse to do this for me?"

"Of course I refuse. I will have absolutely nothing to do with it. I don't care what shame comes on you. You deserve it all. I should not be sorry to see you disgraced, publicly disgraced. How dare you ask me, of all men in the world, to mix myself up in this horror? I should have thought you knew more about people's characters. Your friend Lord Henry Wotton can't have taught you much about psychology, whatever else he has taught you. Nothing will induce me to stir a step to help you. You have come to the wrong man. Go to some of your friends. Don't come to me."

"Alan, it was murder. I killed him. You don't know what he had made me suffer. Whatever my life is, he had more to do with the making or the marring of it than poor Harry has had. He may not have intended it, the result was the same."

"Murder! Good God, Dorian, is that what you have come to? I shall not inform upon you. It is not my business. Besides, without my stirring in the matter, you are certain to be arrested. Nobody ever commits a crime without doing something stupid. But I will have nothing to do with it."

"You must have something to do with it. Wait, wait a moment; listen to me. Only listen, Alan. All I ask of you is to perform a certain scientific experiment. You go to hospitals and dead-houses, and the horrors that you do there don't affect you. If in some hideous dissecting-room or fetid laboratory you found this man lying on a leaden table with red gutters scooped out in it for the blood to flow through, you would simply look upon him as an admirable subject. You would not turn a hair. You would not believe that you were doing anything wrong. On the contrary, you would probably feel that you were benefiting the human race, or increasing the sum of knowledge in the world, or gratifying intellectual curiosity, or something of that kind. What I want you to do is merely what you have often done before. Indeed, to destroy a body must be far less horrible than what you are accustomed to work at. And, remember, it is the only piece of evidence against me. If it is discovered, I am lost; and it is sure to be discovered unless you help me."

Rewritten passage

He won't be missed for months. When he is, there must be no trace of him left here. You, Alan, you must turn him, and everything belonging to him, into a handful of ashes that I can scatter into the wind."

"You're insane, Dorian."

"Ah! I was waiting for you to call me Dorian."

"You're insane, I tell you—insane to imagine I would lift a finger to help you, insane to make this monstrous confession. I will have nothing to do with this, whatever it is. Do you think I'm going to risk my reputation for you? What do I care about the devil's work you're involved in?"

"It was suicide, Alan."

"I'm glad of that. But who drove him to it? You, I imagine."

"Do you still refuse to do this for me?"

"Of course I refuse. I will have absolutely nothing to do with it. I don't care what shame comes to you. You deserve it all. I wouldn't be sorry to see you disgraced, publicly disgraced. How dare you ask me, of all people, to get involved in this horror? I would have thought you understood people better. Your friend Lord Henry Wotton can't have taught you much about psychology, whatever else he's taught you. Nothing will convince me to lift a finger to help you. You've come to the wrong person. Go to some of your other friends. Don't come to me."

"Alan, it was murder. I killed him. You don't know what he made me suffer. Whatever my life is, he had more to do with making or ruining it than poor Harry ever did. He may not have intended it, but the result was the same."

"Murder! Good God, Dorian, is that what you've come to? I won't report you. It's not my business. Besides, even without my interference, you're bound to be arrested. Nobody ever commits a crime without doing something stupid. But I will have nothing to do with it."

"You must have something to do with it. Wait, wait a moment; listen to me. Just listen, Alan. All I'm asking is for you to perform a certain scientific experiment. You go to hospitals and morgues, and the horrors you see there don't affect you. If in some hideous dissecting room or foul laboratory you found this man lying on a lead table with grooves carved out for the blood to drain, you would simply view him as an excellent subject. You wouldn't blink. You wouldn't think you were doing anything wrong. On the contrary, you would probably feel you were benefiting the human race, increasing the world's knowledge, or satisfying your intellectual curiosity. What I want you to do is merely what you've often done before. In fact, destroying a body must be far less horrible than the work you're accustomed to. And remember, it's the only evidence against me. If it's discovered, I'm ruined; and it's certain to be discovered unless you help me."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 052 / E4_052 / condition: simplify

Original passage

Then I asked if there were many clerks? to which he replied,—

“We don’t run much into clerks, because there’s only one Jaggers, and people won’t have him at second hand. There are only four of us. Would you like to see ’em? You are one of us, as I may say.”

I accepted the offer. When Mr. Wemmick had put all the biscuit into the post, and had paid me my money from a cash-box in a safe, the key of which safe he kept somewhere down his back and produced from his coat-collar like an iron-pigtail, we went upstairs. The house was dark and shabby, and the greasy shoulders that had left their mark in Mr. Jaggers’s room seemed to have been shuffling up and down the staircase for years. In the front first floor, a clerk who looked something between a publican and a rat-catcher—a large pale, puffed, swollen man—was attentively engaged with three or four people of shabby appearance, whom he treated as uncereemoniously as everybody seemed to be treated who contributed to Mr. Jaggers’s coffers. “Getting evidence together,” said Mr. Wemmick, as we came out, “for the Bailey.” In the room over that, a little flabby terrier of a clerk with dangling hair (his cropping seemed to have been forgotten when he was a puppy) was similarly engaged with a man with weak eyes, whom Mr. Wemmick presented to me as a smelter who kept his pot always boiling, and who would melt me anything I pleased,—and who was in an excessive white-perspiration, as if he had been trying his art on himself. In a back room, a high-shouldered man with a face-ache tied up in dirty flannel, who was dressed in old black clothes that bore the appearance of having been waxed, was stooping over his work of making fair copies of the notes of the other two gentlemen, for Mr. Jaggers’s own use.

This was all the establishment. When we went downstairs again, Wemmick led me into my guardian’s room, and said, “This you’ve seen already.”

“Pray,” said I, as the two odious casts with the twitchy leer upon them caught my sight again, “whose likenesses are those?”

“These?” said Wemmick, getting upon a chair, and blowing the dust off the horrible heads before bringing them down. “These are two celebrated ones. Famous clients of ours that got us a world of credit. This chap (why you must have come down in the night and been peeping into the inkstand, to get this blot upon your eyebrow, you old rascal!) murdered his master, and, considering that he wasn’t brought up to evidence, didn’t plan it badly.”

“Is it like him?” I asked, recoiling from the brute, as Wemmick spat upon his eyebrow and gave it a rub with his sleeve.

“Like him? It’s himself, you know. The cast was made in Newgate, directly after he was taken down. You had a particular fancy for me, hadn’t you, Old Artful?” said Wemmick. He then explained this affectionate apostrophe, by touching his brooch representing the lady and the weeping willow at the tomb with the urn upon it, and saying, “Had it made for me, express!”

“Is the lady anybody?” said I.

“No,” returned Wemmick. “Only his game. (You liked your bit of game, didn’t you?)

Rewritten passage

I then asked if there were many clerks, to which he replied,

“We don’t have many clerks, because there is only one Jaggers, and people won’t accept anyone else. There are only four of us. Would you like to see them? You are one of us, in a way.”

I accepted the offer. After Mr. Wemmick had mailed the biscuit and paid me my money from a cash-box in a safe—the key to which he kept somewhere down his back, pulling it from his coat-collar like an iron pigtail—we went upstairs. The house was dark and shabby, and the greasy marks on the walls suggested that people had been shuffling up and down the staircase for years. In the front room on the first floor, a clerk who looked like a mix between a tavern keeper and a rat-catcher—a large, pale, and swollen man—was busy with three or four

shabby-looking people. He treated them as rudely as everyone else who contributed to Mr. Jaggers's wealth. "Gathering evidence," Mr. Wemmick said as we left, "for the Old Bailey." In the room above that, a small, flabby clerk with dangling hair (it seemed he had never been given a proper haircut) was working with a man who had weak eyes. Mr. Wemmick introduced him to me as a smelter who kept his pot boiling and could melt anything I liked; the man was sweating profusely, as if he had been practicing his trade on himself. In a back room, a man with hunched shoulders and a face wrapped in dirty flannel, dressed in old black clothes that looked as if they had been waxed, was busy making clean copies of the other two men's notes for Mr. Jaggers's use.

That was the entire staff. When we went back downstairs, Wemmick led me into my guardian's room and said, "You have already seen this."

"Tell me," I said, as the two hateful casts with their twitching leers caught my eye again, "who are those?"

"These?" said Wemmick, standing on a chair and blowing the dust off the horrible heads before bringing them down. "These are two famous ones. They were our clients and brought us a great deal of credit. This fellow (why, you must have been peeping into the inkstand at night to get that blot on your eyebrow, you old rascal!) murdered his master, and considering he wasn't trained in legal matters, he didn't plan it badly."

"Is it a good likeness?" I asked, pulling back from the brute as Wemmick spat on the cast's eyebrow and rubbed it with his sleeve.

"Like him? It is him. The cast was made in Newgate prison right after he was taken down. You were quite fond of me, weren't you, Old Artful?" Wemmick said. He then explained this affectionate comment by touching his brooch, which showed a lady and a weeping willow at a tomb with an urn on it, saying, "I had it made for me, specifically!"

"Is the lady someone in particular?" I asked.

"No," Wemmick replied. "Just his little joke. (You liked your little joke, didn't you?)

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 053 / E4_053 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

Gradually white fingers creep through the curtains, and they appear to tremble. In black fantastic shapes, dumb shadows crawl into the corners of the room and crouch there. Outside, there is the stirring of birds among the leaves, or the sound of men going forth to their work, or the sigh and sob of the wind coming down from the hills and wandering round the silent house, as though it feared to wake the sleepers and yet must needs call forth sleep from her purple cave. Veil after veil of thin dusky gauze is lifted, and by degrees the forms and colours of things are restored to them, and we watch the dawn remaking the world in its antique pattern. The wan mirrors get back their mimic life. The flameless tapers stand where we had left them, and beside them lies the half-cut book that we had been studying, or the wired flower that we had worn at the ball, or the letter that we had been afraid to read, or that we had read too often. Nothing seems to us changed. Out of the unreal shadows of the night comes back the real life that we had known. We have to resume it where we had left off, and there steals over us a terrible sense of the necessity for the continuance of energy in the same wearisome round of stereotyped habits, or a wild longing, it may be, that our eyelids might open some morning upon a world that had been refashioned anew in the darkness for our pleasure, a world in which things would have fresh shapes and colours, and be changed, or have other secrets, a world in which the past would have little or no place, or survive, at any rate, in no conscious form of obligation or regret, the remembrance even of joy having its bitterness and the memories of pleasure their pain.

It was the creation of such worlds as these that seemed to Dorian Gray to be the true object, or amongst the true objects, of life; and in his search for sensations that would be at once new and delightful, and possess that element of strangeness that is so essential to romance, he would often adopt certain modes of thought that he knew to be really alien to his nature, abandon himself to their subtle influences, and then, having, as it were, caught their colour and satisfied his intellectual curiosity, leave them with that curious indifference that is not incompatible with a real ardour of temperament, and that, indeed, according to certain modern psychologists, is often a condition of it.

It was rumoured of him once that he was about to join the Roman Catholic communion, and certainly the Roman ritual had always a great attraction for him. The daily sacrifice, more awful really than all the sacrifices of the antique world, stirred him as much by its superb rejection of the evidence of the senses as by the primitive simplicity of its elements and the eternal pathos of the human tragedy that it sought to symbolize. He loved to kneel down on the cold marble pavement and watch the priest, in his stiff flowered dalmatic, slowly and with white hands moving aside the veil of the tabernacle, or raising aloft the jewelled, lantern-shaped monstrance with that pallid wafer that at times, one would fain think, is indeed the “_panis cælestis_,” the bread of angels, or, robed in the garments of the Passion of Christ, breaking the Host into the chalice and smiting his breast for his sins.

Rewritten passage

Slowly, pale fingers of light slide through the drapes, appearing to quiver. Mute, dark shadows take on strange, jagged forms as they creep into the room's corners to huddle. Beyond the walls, birds rustle in the foliage, laborers begin their daily tasks, and the wind sighs and sobs as it descends from the hills, circling the quiet house as if hesitant to disturb those sleeping, yet compelled to summon slumber from its violet depths. Layer after layer of thin, dark mist is drawn away, and gradually, objects regain their shapes and hues, allowing us to observe the dawn recreating the world in its ancient design. The pale mirrors recover their reflected existence. The extinguished candles remain where they were placed, accompanied by the partially read volume we were examining, the artificial flower worn at the dance, or the letter we dreaded opening or had perused too frequently. Everything appears unchanged. From the illusory shadows of night, the familiar reality of our lives returns. We are forced to take it up exactly where we paused, and a crushing awareness of the need to persist in the same monotonous cycle of habitual actions creeps over us, or perhaps a desperate wish that our eyes might wake to a world refashioned in the dark for our delight—a world where objects possess new forms and colors, hold different secrets, and where the past has no place or survives without the burden of duty or remorse, since even the memory of joy carries bitterness and the recollection of pleasure brings pain.

Dorian Gray believed that the creation of such worlds was the primary purpose, or among the primary purposes, of existence. In his pursuit of sensations that were simultaneously novel and pleasurable, while holding that quality of strangeness vital to romance, he frequently embraced ways of thinking he knew were foreign to his character. He would surrender to their delicate influence, and once he had absorbed their essence and sated his mental curiosity, he would abandon them with a detached indifference that is not at odds with a truly passionate

nature, and which, according to some contemporary psychologists, is often a prerequisite for it.

It was once whispered that he intended to convert to Roman Catholicism, and the Roman liturgy certainly held a profound fascination for him. The daily sacrifice, more solemn than any from the ancient world, moved him as much by its magnificent denial of sensory evidence as by the elemental simplicity of its components and the enduring sorrow of the human drama it aimed to represent. He enjoyed kneeling upon the chilly marble floor to observe the priest, clad in a stiff, embroidered dalmatic, moving the tabernacle veil aside with slow, white hands, or elevating the ornate, lantern-like monstrance containing the pale wafer that one might wish to believe is truly the “panis cælestis,” the bread of angels, or, dressed in the vestments of Christ’s Passion, breaking the Host into the chalice while striking his breast in penance for his sins.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 054 / E4_054 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

Two half-quartern brans; pound of best fresh;
piece of double Glo'ster; and, to wind up all, some of the richest sort
you ever lushed!"

Uttering this last panegyric, Master Bates produced, from one of his
extensive pockets, a full-sized wine-bottle, carefully corked; while
Mr. Dawkins, at the same instant, poured out a wine-glassful of raw
spirits from the bottle he carried: which the invalid tossed down his
throat without a moment's hesitation.

"Ah!" said Fagin, rubbing his hands with great satisfaction. "You'll
do, Bill; you'll do now."

"Do!" exclaimed Mr. Sikes; "I might have been done for, twenty times
over, afore you'd have done anything to help me. What do you mean by
leaving a man in this state, three weeks and more, you false-hearted
wagabond?"

"Only hear him, boys!" said Fagin, shrugging his shoulders. "And us
come to bring him all these beau-ti-ful things."

"The things is well enough in their way," observed Mr. Sikes: a little
soothed as he glanced over the table; "but what have you got to say for
yourself, why you should leave me here, down in the mouth, health,
blunt, and everything else; and take no more notice of me, all this
mortal time, than if I was that 'ere dog.—Drive him down, Charley!"

"I never see such a jolly dog as that," cried Master Bates, doing as he
was desired. "Smelling the grub like a old lady a going to market! He'd
make his fortun' on the stage that dog would, and revive the drayma
besides."

"Hold your din," cried Sikes, as the dog retreated under the bed: still
growling angrily. "What have you got to say for yourself, you withered
old fence, eh?"

"I was away from London, a week and more, my dear, on a plant," replied
the Jew.

"And what about the other fortnight?" demanded Sikes. "What about the
other fortnight that you've left me lying here, like a sick rat in his
hole?"

"I couldn't help it, Bill. I can't go into a long explanation before
company; but I couldn't help it, upon my honour."

"Upon your what?" growled Sikes, with excessive disgust. "Here! Cut me
off a piece of that pie, one of you boys, to take the taste of that out
of my mouth, or it'll choke me dead."

"Don't be out of temper, my dear," urged Fagin, submissively. "I have
never forgot you, Bill; never once."

"No! I'll pound it that you han't," replied Sikes, with a bitter grin.
"You've been scheming and plotting away, every hour that I have laid
shivering and burning here; and Bill was to do this; and Bill was to do
that; and Bill was to do it all, dirt cheap, as soon as he got well:
and was quite poor enough for your work. If it hadn't been for the
girl, I might have died."

"There now, Bill," remonstrated Fagin, eagerly catching at the word.
"If it hadn't been for the girl! Who but poor ould Fagin was the means
of your having such a handy girl about you?"

"He says true enough there!" said Nancy, coming hastily forward. "Let
him be; let him be."

Nancy's appearance gave a new turn to the conversation; for the boys,
receiving a sly wink from the wary old Jew, began to ply her with
liquor: of which, however, she took very sparingly; while Fagin,

assuming an unusual flow of spirits, gradually brought Mr.

Rewritten passage

Two half-quartern loaves; a pound of the finest fresh butter; a wedge of double Gloucester; and, to finish it all, the most potent liquor you have ever tasted!"

Delivering this final praise, Master Bates drew a full-sized, well-corked wine bottle from one of his deep pockets, while Mr. Dawkins simultaneously poured a glass of undiluted spirits from his own bottle, which the sick man swallowed instantly without pausing.

"Ah!" Fagin remarked, rubbing his palms together with immense pleasure. "You will recover, Bill; you are on the mend now."

"Recover!" Mr. Sikes retorted. "I could have perished twenty times before you would have lifted a finger to assist me. How dare you abandon a man in this condition for over three weeks, you treacherous scoundrel?"

"Just listen to him, boys!" Fagin said, lifting his shoulders. "And we have arrived to provide him with all these lovely items."

"The items are acceptable enough," Mr. Sikes noted, feeling slightly mollified as he surveyed the table; "but what is your excuse for leaving me here, miserable, lacking health, money, and everything else, and ignoring me all this time as if I were that dog? Chase him away, Charley!"

"I have never seen such a cheerful dog," Master Bates exclaimed, following the order. "Sniffing the food like an elderly woman heading to the market! That dog would earn a fortune on the stage and revitalize the theater as well."

"Be quiet," Sikes shouted, as the animal retreated beneath the bed, still snarling. "What is your defense, you shriveled old receiver of stolen goods, eh?"

"I was out of London for over a week, my dear, working on a scheme," the Jew answered.

"And what about the remaining two weeks?" Sikes pressed. "What about the other fortnight you left me lying here like a dying rat in a burrow?"

"I could not avoid it, Bill. I cannot provide a lengthy account in front of others, but I truly could not help it, upon my honor."

"Upon your what?" Sikes grumbled with profound revulsion. "Here! One of you boys, slice me a portion of that pie to remove the taste of that word from my mouth, or it will surely choke me."

"Do not lose your temper, my dear," Fagin pleaded submissively. "I have never forgotten you, Bill; not once."

"No! I am certain you have not," Sikes replied with a harsh sneer. "You have been planning and scheming every hour I have spent shivering and burning here; deciding that Bill must do this, and Bill must do that, and that Bill would perform it all for a pittance as soon as he recovered, being desperate enough for your tasks. If not for the girl, I might have perished."

"There now, Bill," Fagin argued, seizing upon the mention. "If not for the girl! Who but old Fagin was responsible for you having such a useful girl at your side?"

"He speaks the truth there!" Nancy said, stepping forward quickly. "Leave him be; let him be."

Nancy's arrival shifted the tone of the discussion; the boys, catching a subtle wink from the cautious old Jew, began offering her drink, though she consumed very little, while Fagin, adopting an uncharacteristically lively mood, slowly steered Mr. Sikes.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 055 / E4_055 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

Her courage

only failed when she dreaded peril for her parent, or feared that death might prevent her from performing those duties to which she was unalterably devoted.

When we had quitted Windsor for London, as the previous step to our final emigration, we visited Lucy, and arranged with her the plan of her own and her mother's removal. Lucy was sorry at the necessity which forced her to quit her native lanes and village, and to drag an infirm parent from her comforts at home, to the homeless waste of depopulated earth; but she was too well disciplined by adversity, and of too sweet a temper, to indulge in repinings at what was inevitable.

Subsequent circumstances, my illness and that of Idris, drove her from our remembrance; and we called her to mind at last, only to conclude that she made one of the few who came from Windsor to join the emigrants, and that she was already in Paris. When we arrived at Rochester therefore, we were surprised to receive, by a man just come from Slough, a letter from this exemplary sufferer. His account was, that, journeying from his home, and passing through Datchet, he was surprised to see smoke issue from the chimney of the inn, and supposing that he should find comrades for his journey assembled there, he knocked and was admitted. There was no one in the house but Lucy, and her mother; the latter had been deprived of the use of her limbs by an attack of rheumatism, and so, one by one, all the remaining inhabitants of the country set forward, leaving them alone. Lucy intreated the man to stay with her; in a week or two her mother would be better, and they would then set out; but they must perish, if they were left thus helpless and forlorn. The man said, that his wife and children were already among the emigrants, and it was therefore, according to his notion, impossible for him to remain. Lucy, as a last resource, gave him a letter for Idris, to be delivered to her wherever he should meet us. This commission at least he fulfilled, and Idris received with emotion the following letter:—

“HONOURED LADY,

“I am sure that you will remember and pity me, and I dare hope that you will assist me; what other hope have I? Pardon my manner of writing, I am so bewildered. A month ago my dear mother was deprived of the use of her limbs. She is already better, and in another month would I am sure be able to travel, in the way you were so kind as to say you would arrange for us. But now everybody is gone—everybody—as they went away, each said, that perhaps my mother would be better, before we were quite deserted. But three days ago I went to Samuel Woods, who, on account of his new-born child, remained to the last; and there being a large family of them, I thought I could persuade them to wait a little longer for us; but I found the house deserted. I have not seen a soul since, till this good man came. —What will become of us? My mother does not know our state; she is so ill, that I have hidden it from her.

Rewritten passage

Her bravery faltered solely when she anticipated danger for her parent, or worried that mortality might hinder her from fulfilling the obligations to which she was steadfastly committed.

Upon leaving Windsor for London, as a preliminary to our ultimate departure, we called upon Lucy and coordinated the strategy for her and her mother's relocation. Lucy felt regret at the compulsion that forced her to abandon her familiar lanes and village, and to transport a frail parent from her domestic comforts into the desolate expanse of a depopulated world; yet, she was too accustomed to hardship, and possessed too gentle a disposition, to yield to complaints regarding the unavoidable.

Later events, specifically my sickness and that of Idris, pushed her from our thoughts; we eventually recalled her only to assume that she was among the few who had traveled from Windsor to accompany the emigrants, and that she had already reached Paris. Consequently, when we reached Rochester, we were astonished to receive a letter from this model of endurance, delivered by a man who had just arrived from Slough. His report stated that, while traveling from his home and passing through Datchet, he was startled to observe smoke rising from the inn's chimney; assuming he would find fellow travelers gathered there, he knocked and was let in. The only occupants were Lucy and her mother; the latter had lost the use of her limbs due to a bout of rheumatism, and thus, one by one, all the remaining local residents had departed, leaving them solitary. Lucy begged the man to remain with her; she believed her mother would recover in a week or two, allowing them to depart, but insisted they would surely die if abandoned in such a helpless and isolated state. The man explained that his wife and

children were already among the emigrants, and he therefore felt it impossible to stay. As a final measure, Lucy gave him a letter for Idris, to be handed to her wherever he might encounter us. He fulfilled this request, and Idris received the following note with great feeling:

"HONOURED LADY,

"I am certain you will recall and sympathize with me, and I dare to hope you will aid me; what other prospect remains? Forgive my style of writing, as I am quite distraught. A month ago, my dear mother lost the use of her limbs. She is improving, and I am certain that in another month she would be capable of traveling, in the manner you were so generous as to suggest you would organize for us. But now everyone has departed—everyone—and as they left, each person remarked that perhaps my mother would be recovered before we were entirely forsaken. Three days ago, I visited Samuel Woods, who had stayed until the end due to his newborn child; having a large family, I hoped I might convince them to wait a little longer for us, but I discovered the house empty. I have not seen a single person since, until this kind man arrived. —What will become of us? My mother is unaware of our situation; she is so unwell that I have concealed it from her.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes:

Item 056 / E4_056 / condition: modernize

Original passage

if so, had she any when found? These are important questions utterly untouched by the evidence; and there are others of equal moment, which have met with no attention. We must endeavor to satisfy ourselves by personal inquiry. The case of St. Eustache must be re-examined. I have no suspicion of this person; but let us proceed methodically. We will ascertain beyond a doubt the validity of the affidavits in regard to his whereabouts on the Sunday. Affidavits of this character are readily made matter of mystification. Should there be nothing wrong here, however, we will dismiss St. Eustache from our investigations. His suicide, however corroborative of suspicion, were there found to be deceit in the affidavits, is, without such deceit, in no respect an unaccountable circumstance, or one which need cause us to deflect from the line of ordinary analysis.

"In that which I now propose, we will discard the interior points of this tragedy, and concentrate our attention upon its outskirts. Not the least usual error, in investigations such as this, is the limiting of inquiry to the immediate, with total disregard of the collateral or circumstantial events. It is the mal-practice of the courts to confine evidence and discussion to the bounds of apparent relevancy. Yet experience has shown, and a true philosophy will always show, that a vast, perhaps the larger portion of truth, arises from the seemingly irrelevant. It is through the spirit of this principle, if not precisely through its letter, that modern science has resolved to calculate upon the unforeseen. But perhaps you do not comprehend me. The history of human knowledge has so uninterruptedly shown that to collateral, or incidental, or accidental events we are indebted for the most numerous and most valuable discoveries, that it has at length become necessary, in any prospective view of improvement, to make not only large, but the largest allowances for inventions that shall arise by chance, and quite out of the range of ordinary expectation. It is no longer philosophical to base, upon what has been, a vision of what is to be. Accident is admitted as a portion of the substructure. We make chance a matter of absolute calculation. We subject the unlooked for and unimagined to the mathematical _formulae_ of the schools.

"I repeat that it is no more than fact, that the larger portion of all truth has sprung from the collateral; and it is but in accordance with the spirit of the principle involved in this fact, that I would divert inquiry, in the present case, from the trodden and hitherto unfruitful ground of the event itself, to the contemporary circumstances which surround it. While you ascertain the validity of the affidavits, I will examine the newspapers more generally than you have as yet done. So far, we have only reconnoitred the field of investigation; but it will be strange indeed if a comprehensive survey, such as I propose, of the public prints, will not afford us some minute points which shall establish a direction for inquiry."

In pursuance of Dupin's suggestion, I made scrupulous examination of the affair of the affidavits. The result was a firm conviction of their validity, and of the consequent innocence of St. Eustache. In the mean time my friend occupied himself, with what seemed to me a minuteness altogether objectless, in a scrutiny of the various newspaper files.

Rewritten passage

If so, did she have any when she was found? These are important questions that the evidence has completely ignored, and there are others of equal significance that have received no attention. We must try to satisfy ourselves through personal investigation. The case of St. Eustache must be re-examined. I do not suspect this man, but let us proceed methodically. We will determine beyond a doubt the validity of the sworn statements regarding his whereabouts on Sunday. Statements of this nature are easily used to create confusion. If there is nothing wrong there, however, we will dismiss St. Eustache from our investigation. His suicide, while it would support suspicion if the statements were found to be deceitful, is not an inexplicable circumstance in the absence of such deceit, nor is it something that should cause us to deviate from our standard analysis.

"In what I am now proposing, we will discard the internal details of this tragedy and focus our attention on its periphery. A common error in investigations like this is limiting the inquiry to the immediate facts while completely disregarding collateral or circumstantial events. It is a bad practice of the courts to confine evidence and discussion to the limits of apparent relevance. Yet experience has shown, and true philosophy will always show, that a vast—perhaps the larger—portion of truth arises from what seems irrelevant. It is through the spirit of this principle, if not strictly its letter, that modern science has decided to account for the unforeseen. Perhaps you do not understand me. The history of human knowledge has so consistently shown that we owe our most numerous and valuable discoveries to collateral, incidental, or accidental events that it has become necessary, in any forward-looking view of progress, to make not just large, but the largest allowances for breakthroughs that arise by chance, entirely outside the range of ordinary expectation. It is no longer philosophical to base a vision of the future solely on what has happened in the past. Accident is now accepted as part of the foundation. We make chance a matter of precise calculation. We subject the unexpected and the unimagined to the mathematical formulas of the academy.

"I repeat that it is a fact that the greater portion of all truth has sprung from the collateral; and it is in accordance with the spirit of the principle behind this fact that I would divert the inquiry in this case from the well-trodden and so far fruitless ground of the event itself to the surrounding circumstances. While you verify the validity of the affidavits, I will examine the newspapers more broadly than you have done so far. We have only scouted the field of investigation, but it would be very strange if a comprehensive survey of the public press, as I propose, does not provide us with some small details that will establish a direction for our inquiry."

Following Dupin's suggestion, I made a careful examination of the matter of the affidavits. The result was a firm conviction of their validity and the subsequent innocence of St. Eustache. In the meantime, my friend occupied himself, with what seemed to me a completely pointless level of detail, in a scrutiny of the various newspaper files.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 057 / E4_057 / condition: simplify

Original passage

So he stepped ashore and entered the woods.

He sat down and took a long rest, torturing himself meanwhile to keep awake, and then started warily down the home-stretch. The night was far spent. It was broad daylight before he found himself fairly abreast the island bar. He rested again until the sun was well up and gilding the great river with its splendor, and then he plunged into the stream. A little later he paused, dripping, upon the threshold of the camp, and heard Joe say:

"No, Tom's true-blue, Huck, and he'll come back. He won't desert. He knows that would be a disgrace to a pirate, and Tom's too proud for that sort of thing. He's up to something or other. Now I wonder what?"

"Well, the things is ours, anyway, ain't they?"

"Pretty near, but not yet, Huck. The writing says they are if he ain't back here to breakfast."

"Which he is!" exclaimed Tom, with fine dramatic effect, stepping grandly into camp.

A sumptuous breakfast of bacon and fish was shortly provided, and as the boys set to work upon it, Tom recounted (and adorned) his adventures. They were a vain and boastful company of heroes when the tale was done. Then Tom hid himself away in a shady nook to sleep till noon, and the other pirates got ready to fish and explore.

CHAPTER XVI

After dinner all the gang turned out to hunt for turtle eggs on the bar. They went about poking sticks into the sand, and when they found a soft place they went down on their knees and dug with their hands. Sometimes they would take fifty or sixty eggs out of one hole. They were perfectly round white things a trifle smaller than an English walnut. They had a famous fried-egg feast that night, and another on Friday morning.

After breakfast they went whooping and prancing out on the bar, and chased each other round and round, shedding clothes as they went, until they were naked, and then continued the frolic far away up the shoal water of the bar, against the stiff current, which latter tripped their legs from under them from time to time and greatly increased the fun. And now and then they stooped in a group and splashed water in each other's faces with their palms, gradually approaching each other, with averted faces to avoid the strangling sprays, and finally gripping and struggling till the best man ducked his neighbor, and then they all went under in a tangle of white legs and arms and came up blowing, sputtering, laughing, and gasping for breath at one and the same time.

When they were well exhausted, they would run out and sprawl on the dry, hot sand, and lie there and cover themselves up with it, and by and by break for the water again and go through the original performance once more. Finally it occurred to them that their naked skin represented flesh-colored "tights" very fairly; so they drew a ring in the sand and had a circus—with three clowns in it, for none would yield this proudest post to his neighbor.

Next they got their marbles and played "knucks" and "ringtaw" and "keeps" till that amusement grew stale. Then Joe and Huck had another swim, but Tom would not venture, because he found that in kicking off his trousers he had kicked his string of rattlesnake rattles off his ankle, and he wondered how he had escaped cramp so long without the protection of this mysterious charm.

Rewritten passage

He stepped ashore and walked into the woods. He sat down to rest for a long time, forcing himself to stay awake, and then cautiously started the final leg of his journey home. The night was nearly over. It was broad daylight by the time he reached the island sandbar. He rested again until the sun was high, shining brightly over the great river, and then he jumped into the water. A short time later, he stood dripping at the edge of the camp and heard Joe say: "No, Tom is loyal, Huck, and he will come back. He won't desert us. He knows that would be a disgrace to a pirate, and Tom is too proud for that. He is planning something. I wonder what it is?" "Well, the things are ours anyway, aren't they?" "Almost, but not yet, Huck. The note says they are ours if he isn't back here by breakfast." "Which he is!" Tom exclaimed with a dramatic flair, stepping grandly into the camp. A delicious breakfast of bacon and fish was soon ready, and as the boys ate, Tom told his story, adding a few extra details for effect. They felt like a group of proud, boastful heroes when the story ended. Then Tom hid in a shady spot to sleep until noon, while the other pirates prepared to fish and explore. After dinner, the whole group went out to hunt for turtle eggs on the sandbar. They poked sticks into the sand, and when they found a soft spot, they knelt down and dug with their hands. Sometimes they would pull fifty or sixty eggs from a single hole. They were perfectly round, white objects, a little smaller than an English walnut. They had a wonderful fried-egg feast that night and another on Friday morning. After breakfast, they ran and jumped around the sandbar, chasing each other and shedding their clothes until they were naked. They continued their game far up the shallow water of the bar against the strong current, which occasionally knocked their legs out from under them and made the fun even better. Now and then, they would gather in a group and splash water in each other's faces with their palms, moving closer while turning their heads to avoid the spray. Finally, they would grab and wrestle until the strongest boy dunked his friend, and they all went under in a tangle of arms and legs, coming up blowing, sputtering, laughing, and gasping for air all at once. When they were exhausted, they would run out and sprawl on the dry, hot sand, covering themselves with it before eventually running back to the water to repeat the whole performance. Eventually, they realized their bare skin looked like flesh-colored tights, so they drew a ring in the sand and held a circus, with all three acting as clowns since none would give up that role to the others. Next, they played marbles until they grew bored. Joe and Huck went for another swim, but Tom refused to join them because he realized that when he took off his trousers, he had lost the string of rattlesnake rattles from his ankle. He wondered how he had managed to avoid getting a cramp for so long without the protection of that mysterious charm.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 058 / E4_058 / condition: simplify

Original passage

"Suppose that lad," pursued Fagin, "was to peach—to blow upon us all—first seeking out the right folks for the purpose, and then having a meeting with 'em in the street to paint our likenesses, describe every mark that they might know us by, and the crib where we might be most easily taken. Suppose he was to do all this, and besides to blow upon a plan we've all been in, more or less—of his own fancy; not grabbed, trapped, tried, earwigged by the parson and brought to it on bread and water,—but of his own fancy; to please his own taste; stealing out at nights to find those most interested against us, and peaching to them. Do you hear me?" cried the Jew, his eyes flashing with rage. "Suppose he did all this, what then?"

"What then!" replied Sikes; with a tremendous oath. "If he was left alive till I came, I'd grind his skull under the iron heel of my boot into as many grains as there are hairs upon his head."

"What if I did it!" cried Fagin almost in a yell. "I, that knows so much, and could hang so many besides myself!"

"I don't know," replied Sikes, clenching his teeth and turning white at the mere suggestion. "I'd do something in the jail that 'ud get me put in irons; and if I was tried along with you, I'd fall upon you with them in the open court, and beat your brains out afore the people. I should have such strength," muttered the robber, poising his brawny arm, "that I could smash your head as if a loaded waggon had gone over it."

"You would?"

"Would I!" said the housebreaker. "Try me."

"If it was Charley, or the Dodger, or Bet, or—"

"I don't care who," replied Sikes impatiently. "Whoever it was, I'd serve them the same."

Fagin looked hard at the robber; and, motioning him to be silent, stooped over the bed upon the floor, and shook the sleeper to rouse him. Sikes leant forward in his chair: looking on with his hands upon his knees, as if wondering much what all this questioning and preparation was to end in.

"Bolter, Bolter! Poor lad!" said Fagin, looking up with an expression of devilish anticipation, and speaking slowly and with marked emphasis. "He's tired—tired with watching for her so long,—watching for _her_, Bill."

"Wot d'ye mean?" asked Sikes, drawing back.

Fagin made no answer, but bending over the sleeper again, hauled him into a sitting posture. When his assumed name had been repeated several times, Noah rubbed his eyes, and, giving a heavy yawn, looked sleepily about him.

"Tell me that again—once again, just for him to hear," said the Jew, pointing to Sikes as he spoke.

"Tell yer what?" asked the sleepy Noah, shaking himself pettishly.

"That about— _Nancy_," said Fagin, clutching Sikes by the wrist, as if to prevent his leaving the house before he had heard enough. "You followed her?"

"Yes."

"To London Bridge?"

"Yes."

"Where she met two people."

“So she did.”

“A gentleman and a lady that she had gone to of her own accord before, who asked her to give up all her pals, and Monks first, which she did—and to describe him, which she did—and to tell her what house it was that we meet at, and go to, which she did—and where it could be best watched from, which she did—and what time the people went there, which she did.

Rewritten passage

“Suppose that boy,” Fagin continued, “were to betray us—to inform on us all—first finding the right people, then meeting them in the street to describe our appearances, every identifying mark we have, and the house where we could be most easily captured. Suppose he did all this, and also revealed a plan we have all been involved in, entirely of his own choosing; not captured, trapped, interrogated, or pressured by a clergyman into doing it on bread and water, but of his own free will; to satisfy his own desires; sneaking out at night to find those most opposed to us, and informing on us to them. Do you hear me?” the Jew shouted, his eyes flashing with rage. “Suppose he did all this, what then?”

“What then!” Sikes replied with a terrible oath. “If he were still alive when I arrived, I would grind his skull under the iron heel of my boot into as many pieces as there are hairs on his head.”

“What if I did it!” Fagin cried, almost yelling. “I, who know so much, and could hang so many others besides myself!”

“I don’t know,” Sikes replied, clenching his teeth and turning pale at the mere suggestion. “I would do something in jail that would get me put in chains; and if I were tried alongside you, I would attack you with them in open court and beat your brains out before everyone. I would have such strength,” the robber muttered, flexing his muscular arm, “that I could crush your head as if a heavy wagon had run over it.”

“You would?”

“Would I!” said the housebreaker. “Try me.”

“If it were Charley, or the Dodger, or Bet, or—”

“I don’t care who it was,” Sikes replied impatiently. “Whoever it was, I would treat them the same.”

Fagin stared hard at the robber; then, signaling for him to be quiet, he leaned over the bed on the floor and shook the sleeper to wake him. Sikes leaned forward in his chair, watching with his hands on his knees, wondering what all this questioning and preparation would lead to.

“Bolter, Bolter! Poor lad!” Fagin said, looking up with a look of wicked anticipation, speaking slowly and with emphasis. “He’s tired—tired from watching for her for so long—watching for her, Bill.”

“What do you mean?” Sikes asked, drawing back.

Fagin did not answer, but leaned over the sleeper again and pulled him into a sitting position. After his assumed name had been repeated several times, Noah rubbed his eyes, gave a heavy yawn, and looked sleepily around.

“Tell me that again—just once more, so he can hear it,” the Jew said, pointing to Sikes.

“Tell you what?” the sleepy Noah asked, shaking himself irritably.

“That about—Nancy,” Fagin said, grabbing Sikes by the wrist as if to prevent him from leaving the house before he had heard enough. “You followed her?”

“Yes.”

“To London Bridge?”

“Yes.”

“Where she met two people.”

“That’s right.”

“A gentleman and a lady she had gone to see of her own free will before, who asked her to give up all her associates, and Monks first, which she did—and to describe him, which she did—and to tell them what house we meet at, which she did—and where it could best be watched from, which she did—and what time people went there, which she did.”

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 059 / E4_059 / condition: simplify

Original passage

"Gad, that's true!" said the doctor. "Where is he? Show me the way. I'll look in again, as I come down, Mrs. Maylie. That's the little window that he got in at, eh? Well, I couldn't have believed it!"

Talking all the way, he followed Mr. Giles upstairs; and while he is going upstairs, the reader may be informed, that Mr. Losberne, a surgeon in the neighbourhood, known through a circuit of ten miles round as "the doctor," had grown fat, more from good-humour than from good living; and was as kind and hearty, and withal as eccentric an old bachelor, as will be found in five times that space, by any explorer alive.

The doctor was absent, much longer than either he or the ladies had anticipated. A large flat box was fetched out of the gig; and a bedroom bell was rung very often; and the servants ran up and down stairs perpetually; from which tokens it was justly concluded that something important was going on above. At length he returned; and in reply to an anxious inquiry after his patient; looked very mysterious, and closed the door, carefully.

"This is a very extraordinary thing, Mrs. Maylie," said the doctor, standing with his back to the door, as if to keep it shut.

"He is not in danger, I hope?" said the old lady.

"Why, that would not be an extraordinary thing, under the circumstances," replied the doctor; "though I don't think he is. Have you seen the thief?"

"No," rejoined the old lady.

"Nor heard anything about him?"

"No."

"I beg your pardon, ma'am," interposed Mr. Giles; "but I was going to tell you about him when Doctor Losberne came in."

The fact was, that Mr. Giles had not, at first, been able to bring his mind to the avowal, that he had only shot a boy. Such commendations had been bestowed upon his bravery, that he could not, for the life of him, help postponing the explanation for a few delicious minutes; during which he had flourished, in the very zenith of a brief reputation for undaunted courage.

"Rose wished to see the man," said Mrs. Maylie, "but I wouldn't hear of it."

"Humph!" rejoined the doctor. "There is nothing very alarming in his appearance. Have you any objection to see him in my presence?"

"If it be necessary," replied the old lady, "certainly not."

"Then I think it is necessary," said the doctor; "at all events, I am quite sure that you would deeply regret not having done so, if you postponed it. He is perfectly quiet and comfortable now. Allow me—Miss Rose, will you permit me? Not the slightest fear, I pledge you my honour!"

CHAPTER XXX.

RELATES WHAT OLIVER'S NEW VISITORS THOUGHT OF HIM

With many loquacious assurances that they would be agreeably surprised in the aspect of the criminal, the doctor drew the young lady's arm through one of his; and offering his disengaged hand to Mrs. Maylie, led them, with much ceremony and stateliness, upstairs.

"Now," said the doctor, in a whisper, as he softly turned the handle of

a bedroom-door, "let us hear what you think of him. He has not been shaved very recently, but he don't look at all ferocious notwithstanding. Stop, though! Let me first see that he is in visiting order."

Rewritten passage

"Good heavens, that's true!" said the doctor. "Where is he? Show me the way. I'll check in again on my way down, Mrs. Maylie. That's the small window he climbed through, is it? Well, I find that hard to believe!"

Talking the whole time, he followed Mr. Giles upstairs. While he climbed, the reader should know that Mr. Losberne, a local surgeon known for ten miles around simply as "the doctor," had grown stout more from his cheerful nature than from overeating. He was as kind, hearty, and eccentric an old bachelor as one could find in five times that distance.

The doctor was gone much longer than he or the ladies had expected. A large, flat box was brought in from his carriage, a bedroom bell was rung repeatedly, and the servants ran up and down the stairs constantly. From these signs, it was clear that something important was happening upstairs. Eventually, he returned. When asked anxiously about his patient, he looked very mysterious and carefully closed the door.

"This is a very strange situation, Mrs. Maylie," the doctor said, standing with his back to the door as if to keep it shut.

"He is not in danger, I hope?" the old lady asked.

"Well, that would not be strange under the circumstances," the doctor replied, "though I don't believe he is. Have you seen the thief?"

"No," the old lady answered.

"Or heard anything about him?"

"No."

"I beg your pardon, ma'am," Mr. Giles interrupted, "but I was about to tell you about him when Doctor Losberne arrived."

The truth was that Mr. Giles had initially been unable to admit that he had only shot a boy. He had received so much praise for his bravery that he could not bring himself to ruin the moment, choosing instead to enjoy his brief reputation for fearless courage for a few more minutes.

"Rose wanted to see the man," Mrs. Maylie said, "but I wouldn't allow it."

"Hmm!" the doctor replied. "There is nothing very alarming about his appearance. Do you have any objection to seeing him while I am present?"

"If it is necessary," the old lady replied, "certainly not."

"I believe it is necessary," said the doctor. "In any case, I am certain you would deeply regret not doing so later. He is perfectly quiet and comfortable now. Allow me—Miss Rose, will you permit me? There is not the slightest reason to be afraid, I give you my word!"

With many talkative assurances that they would be pleasantly surprised by the criminal's appearance, the doctor took the young lady's arm in his and offered his other hand to Mrs. Maylie. He led them upstairs with great ceremony and formality.

"Now," the doctor whispered as he softly turned the bedroom door handle, "let us see what you think of him. He hasn't been shaved recently, but he doesn't look at all fierce. Wait, though! Let me first make sure he is ready for visitors."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 060 / E4_060 / condition: modernize

Original passage

Jim said he believed it was spirits; but I says:

"No; spirits wouldn't say, 'Dern the dern fog.'"

Soon as it was night out we shoved; when we got her out to about the middle we let her alone, and let her float wherever the current wanted her to; then we lit the pipes, and dangled our legs in the water, and talked about all kinds of things—we was always naked, day and night, whenever the mosquitoes would let us—the new clothes Buck's folks made for me was too good to be comfortable, and besides I didn't go much on clothes, nohow.

Sometimes we'd have that whole river all to ourselves for the longest time. Yonder was the banks and the islands, across the water; and maybe a spark—which was a candle in a cabin window; and sometimes on the water you could see a spark or two—on a raft or a scow, you know; and maybe you could hear a fiddle or a song coming over from one of them crafts. It's lovely to live on a raft. We had the sky up there, all speckled with stars, and we used to lay on our backs and look up at them, and discuss about whether they was made or only just happened. Jim he allowed they was made, but I allowed they happened; I judged it would have took too long to _make_ so many. Jim said the moon could a _laid_ them; well, that looked kind of reasonable, so I didn't say nothing against it, because I've seen a frog lay most as many, so of course it could be done. We used to watch the stars that fell, too, and see them streak down. Jim allowed they'd got spoiled and was hove out of the nest.

Once or twice of a night we would see a steamboat slipping along in the dark, and now and then she would belch a whole world of sparks up out of her chimbleys, and they would rain down in the river and look awful pretty; then she would turn a corner and her lights would wink out and her powwow shut off and leave the river still again; and by-and-by her waves would get to us, a long time after she was gone, and joggle the raft a bit, and after that you wouldn't hear nothing for you couldn't tell how long, except maybe frogs or something.

After midnight the people on shore went to bed, and then for two or three hours the shores was black—no more sparks in the cabin windows. These sparks was our clock—the first one that showed again meant morning was coming, so we hunted a place to hide and tie up right away.

One morning about daybreak I found a canoe and crossed over a chute to the main shore—it was only two hundred yards—and paddled about a mile up a crick amongst the cypress woods, to see if I couldn't get some berries. Just as I was passing a place where a kind of a cowpath crossed the crick, here comes a couple of men tearing up the path as tight as they could foot it. I thought I was a goner, for whenever anybody was after anybody I judged it was _me_—or maybe Jim.

Rewritten passage

Jim said he thought it was ghosts, but I said, "No, ghosts wouldn't say, 'Darn the darn fog.'"

As soon as it was dark, we pushed off. Once we reached the middle of the river, we let the raft drift wherever the current took it. We lit our pipes, dangled our legs in the water, and talked about everything. We were always naked, day and night, whenever the mosquitoes allowed it; the new clothes Buck's family made for me were too nice to be comfortable, and besides, I never really cared for clothes anyway.

Sometimes we had the entire river to ourselves for a long time. Over there were the banks and islands, and maybe a tiny spark—a candle in a cabin window. Sometimes on the water, you could see a spark or two from a raft or a flatboat, and you might hear a fiddle or a song drifting over from one of those boats. It's lovely living on a raft. We had the sky above us, all speckled with stars, and we used to lie on our backs, look up at them, and argue about whether they were created or just happened. Jim believed they were created, but I figured they just happened; I thought it would have taken too long to make that many. Jim said the moon could have laid them, which sounded reasonable enough, so I didn't argue, since I've seen a frog lay just about that many, so it could certainly be done. We also watched the shooting stars streak across the sky. Jim thought they had gone bad and were thrown out of the nest.

Once or twice a night, we would see a steamboat slipping through the dark, occasionally belching a cloud of sparks from its chimneys that would rain down into the river, looking beautiful. Then it would turn a corner, its lights would wink out, the noise would stop, and the river would be still again. Eventually, its wake would reach us, long after the boat was gone, rocking the raft a little. After that, you wouldn't hear anything for a long time, except maybe for frogs or similar sounds.

After midnight, the people on shore went to bed, and for two or three hours, the banks were pitch black with no more sparks in the cabin windows. These sparks were our clock; the first one to reappear meant morning was coming, so we would immediately look for a place to hide and tie up.

One morning around daybreak, I found a canoe and crossed a channel to the main shore—it was only two hundred yards—and paddled about a mile up a creek through the cypress woods to see if I could find some berries. Just as I was passing a spot where a cowpath crossed the creek, two men came tearing down the path as fast as they could run. I thought I was finished, because whenever anyone was chasing someone, I assumed it was me—or maybe Jim.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 061 / E4_061 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

Their manners are not equal to his.”

“Certainly not, at first; but they are very pleasing women when you converse with them. Miss Bingley is to live with her brother, and keep his house; and I am much mistaken if we shall not find a very charming neighbour in her.”

Elizabeth listened in silence, but was not convinced: their behaviour at the assembly had not been calculated to please in general; and with more quickness of observation and less pliancy of temper than her sister, and with a judgment, too, unassailed by any attention to herself, she was very little disposed to approve them. They were, in fact, very fine ladies; not deficient in good-humour when they were pleased, nor in the power of being agreeable where they chose it; but proud and conceited. They were rather handsome; had been educated in one of the first private seminaries in town; had a fortune of twenty thousand pounds; were in the habit of spending more than they ought, and of associating with people of rank; and were, therefore, in every respect entitled to think well of themselves and meanly of others. They were of a respectable family in the north of England; a circumstance more deeply impressed on their memories than that their brother's fortune and their own had been acquired by trade.

Mr. Bingley inherited property to the amount of nearly a hundred thousand pounds from his father, who had intended to purchase an estate, but did not live to do it. Mr. Bingley intended it likewise, and sometimes made choice of his county; but, as he was now provided with a good house and the liberty of a manor, it was doubtful to many of those who best knew the easiness of his temper, whether he might not spend the remainder of his days at Netherfield, and leave the next generation to purchase.

His sisters were very anxious for his having an estate of his own; but though he was now established only as a tenant, Miss Bingley was by no means unwilling to preside at his table; nor was Mrs. Hurst, who had married a man of more fashion than fortune, less disposed to consider his house as her home when it suited her. Mr. Bingley had not been of age two years when he was tempted, by an accidental recommendation, to look at Netherfield House. He did look at it, and into it, for half an hour; was pleased with the situation and the principal rooms, satisfied with what the owner said in its praise, and took it immediately.

Between him and Darcy there was a very steady friendship, in spite of a great opposition of character. Bingley was endeared to Darcy by the easiness, openness, and ductility of his temper, though no disposition could offer a greater contrast to his own, and though with his own he never appeared dissatisfied. On the strength of Darcy's regard, Bingley had the firmest reliance, and of his judgment the highest opinion. In understanding, Darcy was the superior. Bingley was by no means deficient; but Darcy was clever. He was at the same time haughty, reserved, and fastidious; and his manners, though well bred, were not inviting. In that respect his friend had greatly the advantage. Bingley was sure of being liked wherever he appeared; Darcy was continually giving offence.

Rewritten passage

“Their conduct does not match his.”

“Perhaps not initially; yet they are quite delightful women once you speak with them. Miss Bingley intends to reside with her brother and manage his household; I would be greatly surprised if we do not discover a truly lovely neighbor in her.”

Elizabeth remained quiet, though she remained skeptical: their conduct at the ball had not been designed to win general favor; and possessing sharper perception and a less yielding disposition than her sister, alongside a perspective unclouded by any personal flattery, she felt little inclination to admire them. In truth, they were very grand ladies; they were not lacking in good nature when satisfied, nor in the ability to be pleasant when they desired, yet they were arrogant and vain. They were somewhat attractive; they had received their schooling at a premier private academy in London; they possessed a dowry of twenty thousand pounds; they were accustomed to living beyond their means and mingling with the aristocracy; consequently, they felt entirely justified in holding themselves in high regard while looking down upon others. They hailed from a reputable northern family—a fact they remembered far more vividly than the reality that their brother's wealth, and their own, had been earned through commerce.

Mr. Bingley had received an inheritance of nearly one hundred thousand pounds from his father, who had planned to buy an estate but passed away before doing so. Mr. Bingley held the same intention and occasionally debated which county to choose; however, since he now possessed a comfortable residence and the rights to a manor, many who understood his relaxed nature doubted whether he might simply remain at Netherfield for life, leaving the purchase to his heirs.

His sisters were quite eager for him to own property; yet, even though he was merely a tenant, Miss Bingley was perfectly happy to act as his hostess, and Mrs. Hurst, who had wed a man of greater social standing than wealth, was equally ready to treat his home as her own whenever it was convenient. Mr. Bingley had been an adult for less than two years when a chance suggestion led him to view Netherfield Park. He inspected the grounds and the interior for thirty minutes; he liked the location and the main rooms, accepted the landlord's favorable description, and rented it at once.

He and Darcy shared a very firm friendship, despite their contrasting personalities. Bingley was valued by Darcy for his relaxed, candid, and flexible nature, even though no character could be more opposite to his own, and despite the fact that Darcy never seemed unhappy with his own temperament. Bingley placed absolute trust in Darcy's loyalty and held his intellect in the highest regard. In terms of intelligence, Darcy was the superior. Bingley was certainly not unintelligent, but Darcy was brilliant. At the same time, he was proud, distant, and difficult to please; his behavior, while polished, was not welcoming. In that regard, his friend held a significant advantage. Bingley was certain to be popular wherever he went; Darcy was constantly causing offense.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 062 / E4_062 / condition: modernize

Original passage

"But I was embarrassed."

"And so was I."

"You might have talked to me more when you came to dinner."

"A man who had felt less might."

"How unlucky that you should have a reasonable answer to give, and that I should be so reasonable as to admit it! But I wonder how long you _would_ have gone on, if you had been left to yourself. I wonder when you _would_ have spoken if I had not asked you! My resolution of thanking you for your kindness to Lydia had certainly great effect. _Too much_, I am afraid; for what becomes of the moral, if our comfort springs from a breach of promise, for I ought not to have mentioned the subject? This will never do."

"You need not distress yourself. The moral will be perfectly fair. Lady Catherine's unjustifiable endeavours to separate us were the means of removing all my doubts. I am not indebted for my present happiness to your eager desire of expressing your gratitude. I was not in a humour to wait for an opening of yours. My aunt's intelligence had given me hope, and I was determined at once to know everything."

"Lady Catherine has been of infinite use, which ought to make her happy, for she loves to be of use. But tell me, what did you come down to Netherfield for? Was it merely to ride to Longbourn and be embarrassed? or had you intended any more serious consequences?"

"My real purpose was to see _you_, and to judge, if I could, whether I might ever hope to make you love me. My avowed one, or what I avowed to myself, was to see whether your sister was still partial to Bingley, and if she were, to make the confession to him which I have since made."

"Shall you ever have courage to announce to Lady Catherine what is to befall her?"

"I am more likely to want time than courage, Elizabeth. But it ought to be done; and if you will give me a sheet of paper it shall be done directly."

"And if I had not a letter to write myself, I might sit by you, and admire the evenness of your writing, as another young lady once did. But I have an aunt, too, who must not be longer neglected."

From an unwillingness to confess how much her intimacy with Mr. Darcy had been overrated, Elizabeth had never yet answered Mrs. Gardiner's long letter; but now, having _that_ to communicate which she knew would be most welcome, she was almost ashamed to find that her uncle and aunt had already lost three days of happiness, and immediately wrote as follows:--

"I would have thanked you before, my dear aunt, as I ought to have done, for your long, kind, satisfactory detail of particulars; but, to say the truth, I was too cross to write. You supposed more than really existed. But _now_ suppose as much as you choose; give a loose to your fancy, indulge your imagination in every possible flight which the subject will afford, and unless you believe me actually married, you cannot greatly err. You must write again very soon, and praise him a great deal more than you did in your last. I thank you again and again, for not going to the Lakes.

Rewritten passage

"But I was embarrassed."

"And so was I."

"You could have spoken to me more when you came to dinner."

“A man who felt less might have.”

“How unfortunate that you have a logical answer, and that I am reasonable enough to accept it! But I wonder how long you would have continued if left to your own devices. I wonder when you would have spoken if I hadn’t asked you! My decision to thank you for your kindness to Lydia certainly had a major effect. Too much, I fear; for what happens to the moral of the story if our comfort comes from breaking a promise, since I shouldn’t have brought up the subject? This won’t do at all.”

“You needn’t worry. The moral will be perfectly sound. Lady Catherine’s unjustifiable attempts to separate us were the very things that removed all my doubts. I don’t owe my current happiness to your eager desire to express gratitude. I wasn’t in the mood to wait for you to open the conversation. My aunt’s news had given me hope, and I was determined to know everything immediately.”

“Lady Catherine has been incredibly useful, which should make her happy, as she loves to be useful. But tell me, why did you come down to Netherfield? Was it just to ride to Longbourn and feel awkward, or did you intend for something more serious to happen?”

“My real purpose was to see you and to judge, if I could, whether I might ever hope to make you love me. My stated purpose—or what I told myself—was to see if your sister was still fond of Bingley, and if she were, to make the confession to him that I have since made.”

“Will you ever have the courage to announce to Lady Catherine what is about to happen to her?”

“I am more likely to lack time than courage, Elizabeth. But it must be done; and if you will give me a sheet of paper, it shall be done right away.”

“And if I didn’t have a letter to write myself, I might sit by you and admire the evenness of your handwriting, as another young lady once did. But I have an aunt, too, who must not be neglected any longer.”

Because she was unwilling to admit how much her intimacy with Mr. Darcy had been exaggerated, Elizabeth had not yet answered Mrs. Gardiner’s long letter. Now, however, having news to share that she knew would be most welcome, she was almost ashamed to realize that her uncle and aunt had already lost three days of happiness, and she immediately wrote the following:

“I would have thanked you sooner, my dear aunt, as I should have, for your long, kind, and detailed letter; but, to tell the truth, I was too annoyed to write. You assumed more than actually existed. But now, assume whatever you like; let your imagination run wild and indulge in every possible flight of fancy, and unless you believe I am already married, you cannot be far off. You must write again very soon and praise him much more than you did in your last letter. I thank you again and again for not going to the Lakes.”

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 063 / E4_063 / condition: simplify

Original passage

Referring the education to her seemed to imply it.

"Now, ma'am," said Jane to her aunt, "shall we join Mrs. Elton?"

"If you please, my dear. With all my heart. I am quite ready. I was ready to have gone with her, but this will do just as well. We shall soon overtake her. There she is—no, that's somebody else. That's one of the ladies in the Irish car party, not at all like her.—Well, I declare—"

They walked off, followed in half a minute by Mr. Knightley. Mr. Weston, his son, Emma, and Harriet, only remained; and the young man's spirits now rose to a pitch almost unpleasant. Even Emma grew tired at last of flattery and merriment, and wished herself rather walking quietly about with any of the others, or sitting almost alone, and quite unattended to, in tranquil observation of the beautiful views beneath her. The appearance of the servants looking out for them to give notice of the carriages was a joyful sight; and even the bustle of collecting and preparing to depart, and the solicitude of Mrs. Elton to have her carriage first, were gladly endured, in the prospect of the quiet drive home which was to close the very questionable enjoyments of this day of pleasure. Such another scheme, composed of so many ill-assorted people, she hoped never to be betrayed into again.

While waiting for the carriage, she found Mr. Knightley by her side. He looked around, as if to see that no one were near, and then said,

"Emma, I must once more speak to you as I have been used to do: a privilege rather endured than allowed, perhaps, but I must still use it. I cannot see you acting wrong, without a remonstrance. How could you be so unfeeling to Miss Bates? How could you be so insolent in your wit to a woman of her character, age, and situation?—Emma, I had not thought it possible."

Emma recollected, blushed, was sorry, but tried to laugh it off.

"Nay, how could I help saying what I did?—Nobody could have helped it. It was not so very bad. I dare say she did not understand me."

"I assure you she did. She felt your full meaning. She has talked of it since. I wish you could have heard how she talked of it—with what candour and generosity. I wish you could have heard her honouring your forbearance, in being able to pay her such attentions, as she was for ever receiving from yourself and your father, when her society must be so irksome."

"Oh!" cried Emma, "I know there is not a better creature in the world: but you must allow, that what is good and what is ridiculous are most unfortunately blended in her."

"They are blended," said he, "I acknowledge; and, were she prosperous, I could allow much for the occasional prevalence of the ridiculous over the good. Were she a woman of fortune, I would leave every harmless absurdity to take its chance, I would not quarrel with you for any liberties of manner. Were she your equal in situation—but, Emma, consider how far this is from being the case. She is poor; she has sunk from the comforts she was born to; and, if she live to old age, must probably sink more."

Rewritten passage

Entrusting the education to her seemed to imply it.

"Now, ma'am," Jane said to her aunt, "shall we join Mrs. Elton?"

"If you please, my dear. With all my heart. I am quite ready. I was ready to go with her, but this will do just as well. We shall soon overtake her. There she is—no, that is someone else. That is one of the ladies from the Irish carriage party; she does not look like her at all. Well, I declare—"

They walked away, followed half a minute later by Mr. Knightley. Mr. Weston, his son, Emma, and Harriet remained; the young man's spirits

now rose to a level that was almost unpleasant. Even Emma eventually grew tired of the flattery and merriment, wishing she were instead walking quietly with any of the others, or sitting almost alone and ignored, peacefully observing the beautiful views below. The sight of the servants looking for them to announce the carriages was a welcome relief. Even the commotion of gathering to leave, and Mrs. Elton's insistence on having her carriage first, were endured gladly in anticipation of the quiet drive home that would end the questionable enjoyments of this day. She hoped never to be tricked into another outing like this one, made up of such mismatched people.

While waiting for the carriage, she found Mr. Knightley at her side. He looked around to ensure no one was near, then said,

"Emma, I must speak to you once more as I have been accustomed to do: a privilege that is perhaps tolerated rather than allowed, but I must still use it. I cannot watch you acting wrongly without speaking up. How could you be so unfeeling toward Miss Bates? How could you be so insolent with your wit toward a woman of her character, age, and social standing? Emma, I did not think it possible."

Emma remembered, blushed, and felt sorry, but tried to laugh it off.

"Well, how could I help saying what I did? Nobody could have helped it. It was not that bad. I expect she did not understand me."

"I assure you she did. She understood your full meaning. She has spoken of it since. I wish you could have heard how she talked about it—with such candor and generosity. I wish you could have heard her praising your patience in paying her the attentions you and your father always show her, even when her company must be so tiresome."

"Oh!" Emma cried, "I know there is not a better creature in the world, but you must admit that what is good and what is ridiculous are unfortunately blended in her."

"They are blended," he said, "I acknowledge that. If she were prosperous, I could forgive the ridiculous occasionally overshadowing the good. If she were a woman of fortune, I would let every harmless absurdity pass, and I would not argue with you over your manners. If she were your equal in status—but, Emma, consider how far that is from the truth. She is poor; she has fallen from the comforts she was born into, and if she lives to old age, she will likely fall further."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 064 / E4_064 / condition: simplify

Original passage

"I continued for the remainder of the day in my hovel in a state of utter and stupid despair. My protectors had departed and had broken the only link that held me to the world. For the first time the feelings of revenge and hatred filled my bosom, and I did not strive to control them, but allowing myself to be borne away by the stream, I bent my mind towards injury and death. When I thought of my friends, of the mild voice of De Lacey, the gentle eyes of Agatha, and the exquisite beauty of the Arabian, these thoughts vanished and a gush of tears somewhat soothed me. But again when I reflected that they had spurned and deserted me, anger returned, a rage of anger, and unable to injure anything human, I turned my fury towards inanimate objects. As night advanced, I placed a variety of combustibles around the cottage, and after having destroyed every vestige of cultivation in the garden, I waited with forced impatience until the moon had sunk to commence my operations.

"As the night advanced, a fierce wind arose from the woods and quickly dispersed the clouds that had loitered in the heavens; the blast tore along like a mighty avalanche and produced a kind of insanity in my spirits that burst all bounds of reason and reflection. I lighted the dry branch of a tree and danced with fury around the devoted cottage, my eyes still fixed on the western horizon, the edge of which the moon nearly touched. A part of its orb was at length hid, and I waved my brand; it sank, and with a loud scream I fired the straw, and heath, and bushes, which I had collected. The wind fanned the fire, and the cottage was quickly enveloped by the flames, which clung to it and licked it with their forked and destroying tongues.

"As soon as I was convinced that no assistance could save any part of the habitation, I quitted the scene and sought for refuge in the woods.

"And now, with the world before me, whither should I bend my steps? I resolved to fly far from the scene of my misfortunes; but to me, hated and despised, every country must be equally horrible. At length the thought of you crossed my mind. I learned from your papers that you were my father, my creator; and to whom could I apply with more fitness than to him who had given me life? Among the lessons that Felix had bestowed upon Safie, geography had not been omitted; I had learned from these the relative situations of the different countries of the earth. You had mentioned Geneva as the name of your native town, and towards this place I resolved to proceed.

"But how was I to direct myself? I knew that I must travel in a southwesterly direction to reach my destination, but the sun was my only guide. I did not know the names of the towns that I was to pass through, nor could I ask information from a single human being; but I did not despair. From you only could I hope for succour, although towards you I felt no sentiment but that of hatred. Unfeeling, heartless creator! You had endowed me with perceptions and passions and then cast me abroad an object for the scorn and horror of mankind.

Rewritten passage

I spent the rest of the day in my hut in a state of total, numb despair. My protectors had left, breaking the only connection I had to the world. For the first time, feelings of revenge and hatred filled my heart. I did not try to control them; instead, I let myself be swept away by these emotions, focusing my mind on causing harm and death. When I thought of my friends—the gentle voice of De Lacey, the kind eyes of Agatha, and the exquisite beauty of the Arabian—these dark thoughts faded, and a flood of tears brought me some relief. But when I remembered that they had rejected and abandoned me, my anger returned with a vengeance. Unable to hurt any human, I turned my fury toward inanimate objects. As night fell, I piled flammable materials around the cottage and destroyed everything growing in the garden. I waited impatiently for the moon to set so I could begin my work.

As the night deepened, a fierce wind blew from the woods, quickly clearing the clouds from the sky. The gale roared like a massive avalanche, creating a kind of madness in me that broke through all reason and self-control. I lit a dry tree branch and danced with rage around the doomed cottage, my eyes fixed on the western horizon where the moon was nearly touching the edge. Finally, part of the moon disappeared, and I waved my torch. It sank completely, and with a loud scream, I set fire to the straw, heather, and bushes I had gathered. The wind fanned the flames, and the cottage was quickly swallowed by fire, which clung to the structure and licked it with forked, destructive tongues.

Once I was certain that nothing could save any part of the house, I left the scene and sought shelter in the woods.

Now, with the whole world before me, where should I go? I decided to flee far from the place of my misfortunes, but to me, hated and despised as I was, every country would be equally terrible. Eventually, the thought of you crossed my mind. I learned from your papers that you were my father, my creator. Who could I turn to more appropriately than the one who had given me life? Among the lessons Felix had taught Safie, geography was included, and I had learned the locations of different countries from them. You had mentioned Geneva as your hometown, and I decided to head there.

But how would I find my way? I knew I had to travel southwest to reach my destination, but the sun was my only guide. I did not know the names of the towns I would pass through, nor could I ask anyone for directions, but I did not lose hope. You were the only one from whom I could expect help, even though I felt nothing but hatred toward you. Unfeeling, heartless creator! You gave me senses and passions, and then cast me out to be an object of scorn and horror to all mankind.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes:

Item 065 / E4_065 / condition: modernize

Original passage

PS.—Do tell me about the bows. Jennings insists they are the fashion.

Lord Arthur looked so serious and unhappy over the letter, that the Duchess went into fits of laughter.

'My dear Arthur,' she cried, 'I shall never show you a young lady's letter again! But what shall I say about the clock? I think it is a capital invention, and I should like to have one myself.'

'I don't think much of them,' said Lord Arthur, with a sad smile, and, after kissing his mother, he left the room.

When he got upstairs, he flung himself on a sofa, and his eyes filled with tears. He had done his best to commit this murder, but on both occasions he had failed, and through no fault of his own. He had tried to do his duty, but it seemed as if Destiny herself had turned traitor. He was oppressed with the sense of the barrenness of good intentions, of the futility of trying to be fine. Perhaps, it would be better to break off the marriage altogether. Sybil would suffer, it is true, but suffering could not really mar a nature so noble as hers. As for himself, what did it matter? There is always some war in which a man can die, some cause to which a man can give his life, and as life had no pleasure for him, so death had no terror. Let Destiny work out his doom. He would not stir to help her.

At half-past seven he dressed, and went down to the club. Surbiton was there with a party of young men, and he was obliged to dine with them. Their trivial conversation and idle jests did not interest him, and as soon as coffee was brought he left them, inventing some engagement in order to get away. As he was going out of the club, the hall-porter handed him a letter. It was from Herr Winkelkopf, asking him to call down the next evening, and look at an explosive umbrella, that went off as soon as it was opened. It was the very latest invention, and had just arrived from Geneva. He tore the letter up into fragments. He had made up his mind not to try any more experiments. Then he wandered down to the Thames Embankment, and sat for hours by the river. The moon peered through a mane of tawny clouds, as if it were a lion's eye, and innumerable stars spangled the hollow vault, like gold dust powdered on a purple dome. Now and then a barge swung out into the turbid stream, and floated away with the tide, and the railway signals changed from green to scarlet as the trains ran shrieking across the bridge. After some time, twelve o'clock boomed from the tall tower at Westminster, and at each stroke of the sonorous bell the night seemed to tremble. Then the railway lights went out, one solitary lamp left gleaming like a large ruby on a giant mast, and the roar of the city became fainter.

At two o'clock he got up, and strolled towards Blackfriars. How unreal everything looked! How like a strange dream! The houses on the other side of the river seemed built out of darkness. One would have said that silver and shadow had fashioned the world anew.

Rewritten passage

P.S.—Do tell me about the bows. Jennings insists they are the latest fashion.

Lord Arthur looked so serious and miserable over the letter that the Duchess burst into fits of laughter.

'My dear Arthur,' she cried, 'I'll never show you a young lady's letter again! But what should I say about the clock? I think it's a brilliant invention, and I'd love to have one myself.'

'I don't think much of them,' Lord Arthur said with a sad smile, and after kissing his mother, he left the room.

Once upstairs, he threw himself onto a sofa, his eyes filling with tears. He had done his best to commit this murder, but both times he had failed, and through no fault of his own. He had tried to do his duty, but it felt as if Destiny herself had betrayed him. He was weighed down by the pointlessness of good intentions and the futility of trying to be noble. Perhaps it would be better to call off the marriage entirely. Sybil would suffer, it was true, but suffering could not truly ruin a nature as fine as hers. As for himself, what did it matter? There is always some war in which a man can die, some cause to which a man can give his life, and since life held no pleasure for him, death held no terror. Let Destiny work out his fate. He would not lift a finger to help her.

At seven-thirty he dressed and went down to the club. Surbiton was there with a group of young men, and he was forced to dine with them. Their trivial conversation and idle jokes did not interest him, and as soon as coffee was served, he left them, making up an excuse to get away. As he was leaving the club, the hall-porter handed him a letter. It was from Herr Winckelkopf, asking him to stop by the next evening to look at an explosive umbrella that went off as soon as it was opened. It was the latest invention, having just arrived from Geneva. He tore the letter into pieces. He had decided not to attempt any more experiments. Then he wandered down to the Thames Embankment and sat by the river for hours. The moon peered through a mane of tawny clouds like a lion's eye, and countless stars spangled the hollow vault like gold dust scattered on a purple dome. Now and then a barge swung out into the murky stream and floated away with the tide, and the railway signals changed from green to red as the trains ran shrieking across the bridge. After some time, twelve o'clock boomed from the tall tower at Westminster, and at each stroke of the deep bell, the night seemed to tremble. Then the railway lights went out, one solitary lamp left gleaming like a large ruby on a giant mast, and the roar of the city grew fainter.

At two o'clock he got up and strolled toward Blackfriars. How unreal everything looked! How like a strange dream! The houses on the other side of the river seemed built out of darkness. One would have said that silver and shadow had fashioned the world anew.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 066 / E4_066 / condition: modernize

Original passage

"Suppose that lad," pursued Fagin, "was to peach—to blow upon us all—first seeking out the right folks for the purpose, and then having a meeting with 'em in the street to paint our likenesses, describe every mark that they might know us by, and the crib where we might be most easily taken. Suppose he was to do all this, and besides to blow upon a plan we've all been in, more or less—of his own fancy; not grabbed, trapped, tried, earwigged by the parson and brought to it on bread and water,—but of his own fancy; to please his own taste; stealing out at nights to find those most interested against us, and peaching to them. Do you hear me?" cried the Jew, his eyes flashing with rage. "Suppose he did all this, what then?"

"What then!" replied Sikes; with a tremendous oath. "If he was left alive till I came, I'd grind his skull under the iron heel of my boot into as many grains as there are hairs upon his head."

"What if I did it!" cried Fagin almost in a yell. "I, that knows so much, and could hang so many besides myself!"

"I don't know," replied Sikes, clenching his teeth and turning white at the mere suggestion. "I'd do something in the jail that 'ud get me put in irons; and if I was tried along with you, I'd fall upon you with them in the open court, and beat your brains out afore the people. I should have such strength," muttered the robber, poising his brawny arm, "that I could smash your head as if a loaded waggon had gone over it."

"You would?"

"Would I!" said the housebreaker. "Try me."

"If it was Charley, or the Dodger, or Bet, or—"

"I don't care who," replied Sikes impatiently. "Whoever it was, I'd serve them the same."

Fagin looked hard at the robber; and, motioning him to be silent, stooped over the bed upon the floor, and shook the sleeper to rouse him. Sikes leant forward in his chair: looking on with his hands upon his knees, as if wondering much what all this questioning and preparation was to end in.

"Bolter, Bolter! Poor lad!" said Fagin, looking up with an expression of devilish anticipation, and speaking slowly and with marked emphasis. "He's tired—tired with watching for her so long,—watching for _her_, Bill."

"Wot d'ye mean?" asked Sikes, drawing back.

Fagin made no answer, but bending over the sleeper again, hauled him into a sitting posture. When his assumed name had been repeated several times, Noah rubbed his eyes, and, giving a heavy yawn, looked sleepily about him.

"Tell me that again—once again, just for him to hear," said the Jew, pointing to Sikes as he spoke.

"Tell yer what?" asked the sleepy Noah, shaking himself pettishly.

"That about— _Nancy_," said Fagin, clutching Sikes by the wrist, as if to prevent his leaving the house before he had heard enough. "You followed her?"

"Yes."

"To London Bridge?"

"Yes."

"Where she met two people."

“So she did.”

“A gentleman and a lady that she had gone to of her own accord before, who asked her to give up all her pals, and Monks first, which she did—and to describe him, which she did—and to tell her what house it was that we meet at, and go to, which she did—and where it could be best watched from, which she did—and what time the people went there, which she did.

Rewritten passage

“Suppose that boy,” Fagin continued, “were to snitch—to inform on us all—first tracking down the right people, then meeting them in the street to sketch our faces, describe every identifying mark so they could recognize us, and point out the hideout where we could be most easily caught. Suppose he did all this, and on top of that, exposed a plan we’ve all been involved in, entirely of his own volition; not caught, trapped, interrogated, or pressured by the preacher into doing it on bread and water, but by his own choice; to satisfy his own whim; sneaking out at night to find those most hostile to us and informing on us to them. Do you hear me?” the old man shouted, his eyes flashing with rage. “Suppose he did all this, what then?”

“What then!” Sikes replied with a massive curse. “If he were still alive when I arrived, I’d grind his skull under the iron heel of my boot into as many pieces as there are hairs on his head.”

“What if I did it!” Fagin cried, almost screaming. “I, who know so much and could hang so many others besides myself!”

“I don’t know,” Sikes replied, clenching his teeth and turning pale at the mere suggestion. “I’d do something in jail that would get me put in chains; and if I were tried alongside you, I’d attack you with them in open court and beat your brains out in front of everyone. I’d have such strength,” the robber muttered, flexing his brawny arm, “that I could crush your head as if a loaded wagon had run over it.”

“You would?”

“Would I!” said the burglar. “Try me.”

“If it were Charley, or the Dodger, or Bet, or—”

“I don’t care who it was,” Sikes replied impatiently. “Whoever it was, I’d treat them the same.”

Fagin stared hard at the robber and, signaling for him to be quiet, leaned over the bed on the floor and shook the sleeper to wake him. Sikes leaned forward in his chair, watching with his hands on his knees, clearly wondering what all this questioning and preparation would lead to.

“Bolter, Bolter! Poor lad!” Fagin said, looking up with an expression of wicked anticipation, speaking slowly and with deliberate emphasis. “He’s tired—tired from watching for her for so long—watching for her, Bill.”

“What do you mean?” Sikes asked, drawing back.

Fagin didn’t answer, but bent over the sleeper again and pulled him into a sitting position. After his alias had been repeated several times, Noah rubbed his eyes, gave a heavy yawn, and looked sleepily around.

“Tell me that again—just once more, so he can hear it,” the old man said, pointing to Sikes.

“Tell you what?” the sleepy Noah asked, shaking himself irritably.

“That about—Nancy,” Fagin said, grabbing Sikes by the wrist as if to keep him from leaving the house before he had heard enough. “You followed her?”

“Yes.”

“To London Bridge?”

“Yes.”

“Where she met two people.”

“That’s right.”

“A gentleman and a lady she had gone to voluntarily before, who asked her to give up all her associates, starting with Monks, which she did—and to describe him, which she did—and to tell them which house we meet at, which she did—and where it could be best watched from, which she did—and what time people went there, which she did.”

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes:

Item 067 / E4_067 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

"I did confess, but I confessed a lie. I confessed, that I might obtain absolution; but now that falsehood lies heavier at my heart than all my other sins. The God of heaven forgive me! Ever since I was condemned, my confessor has besieged me; he threatened and menaced, until I almost began to think that I was the monster that he said I was. He threatened excommunication and hell fire in my last moments if I continued obdurate. Dear lady, I had none to support me; all looked on me as a wretch doomed to ignominy and perdition. What could I do? In an evil hour I subscribed to a lie; and now only am I truly miserable."

She paused, weeping, and then continued, "I thought with horror, my sweet lady, that you should believe your Justine, whom your blessed aunt had so highly honoured, and whom you loved, was a creature capable of a crime which none but the devil himself could have perpetrated. Dear William! dearest blessed child! I soon shall see you again in heaven, where we shall all be happy; and that consoles me, going as I am to suffer ignominy and death."

"Oh, Justine! Forgive me for having for one moment distrusted you. Why did you confess? But do not mourn, dear girl. Do not fear. I will proclaim, I will prove your innocence. I will melt the stony hearts of your enemies by my tears and prayers. You shall not die! You, my playfellow, my companion, my sister, perish on the scaffold! No! No! I never could survive so horrible a misfortune."

Justine shook her head mournfully. "I do not fear to die," she said; "that pang is past. God raises my weakness and gives me courage to endure the worst. I leave a sad and bitter world; and if you remember me and think of me as of one unjustly condemned, I am resigned to the fate awaiting me. Learn from me, dear lady, to submit in patience to the will of heaven!"

During this conversation I had retired to a corner of the prison room, where I could conceal the horrid anguish that possessed me. Despair! Who dared talk of that? The poor victim, who on the morrow was to pass the awful boundary between life and death, felt not, as I did, such deep and bitter agony. I gnashed my teeth and ground them together, uttering a groan that came from my inmost soul. Justine started. When she saw who it was, she approached me and said, "Dear sir, you are very kind to visit me; you, I hope, do not believe that I am guilty?"

I could not answer. "No, Justine," said Elizabeth; "he is more convinced of your innocence than I was, for even when he heard that you had confessed, he did not credit it."

"I truly thank him. In these last moments I feel the sincerest gratitude towards those who think of me with kindness. How sweet is the affection of others to such a wretch as I am! It removes more than half my misfortune, and I feel as if I could die in peace now that my innocence is acknowledged by you, dear lady, and your cousin."

Thus the poor sufferer tried to comfort others and herself.

Rewritten passage

"I admitted to the crime, but it was a fabrication. I gave that confession to receive forgiveness, yet that untruth now weighs more heavily upon my soul than any other transgression. May the Almighty pardon me! Ever since my sentencing, my priest has pressured me; he intimidated and frightened me until I nearly started believing I was the beast he claimed. He warned of being cast out and eternal damnation if I remained stubborn. Kind lady, I had no one to defend me; everyone viewed me as a creature destined for disgrace and ruin. What choice remained? In a moment of weakness, I agreed to a falsehood, and only now am I truly wretched."

She stopped, sobbing, then resumed, "I was terrified, my dear lady, that you would think your Justine—whom your saintly aunt cherished and whom you loved—was capable of an act that only the devil could commit. Beloved William! Dearest, blessed boy! I will soon reunite with you in heaven, where we shall all find joy; that thought brings me comfort, even as I prepare to face shame and execution."

"Oh, Justine! Pardon me for doubting you even for an instant. Why did you admit to it? But do not grieve, dear girl. Do not be afraid. I will declare, I will demonstrate your innocence. I will soften the hardened hearts of your accusers with my weeping and pleas. You shall not perish! You, my childhood friend, my companion, my sister, die upon the gallows? Never! I could never endure such a dreadful tragedy."

Justine moved her head sadly. "I do not dread death," she remarked; "that fear has vanished. God strengthens my frailty and grants me the fortitude to bear the worst. I depart from a sorrowful and harsh world; if you recall me and view me as one wrongly accused, I am content with my destiny. Take this lesson from me, dear lady: accept the will of heaven with patience!"

Throughout this exchange, I had withdrawn to a remote part of the jail cell, where I might hide the terrible torment consuming me. Despair! Who had the right to speak of such things? The unfortunate victim, who by the next day would cross the final threshold between existence and the afterlife, did not experience the profound and stinging agony that I felt. I clenched my teeth and ground them, releasing a moan that originated from the depths of my being. Justine jumped. Upon seeing me, she walked over and said, "Kind sir, it is very generous of you to see me; I trust you do not believe I am guilty?"

I was unable to speak. "No, Justine," Elizabeth replied; "he is even more certain of your innocence than I was, for even upon hearing of your confession, he refused to believe it."

"I am truly grateful to him. In these final moments, I feel genuine appreciation for those who regard me with compassion. How precious is the kindness of others to a wretch like me! It eases more than half of my misery, and I feel as though I can pass away in tranquility now that my innocence is recognized by you, dear lady, and your cousin."

In this manner, the unfortunate woman attempted to console both others and herself.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 068 / E4_068 / condition: simplify

Original passage

He paused a moment, again smiling, with his eyes fixed on her face. "Does nothing occur to you?—Do not you recollect?—Harriet Smith."

Her cheeks flushed at the name, and she felt afraid of something, though she knew not what.

"Have you heard from her yourself this morning?" cried he. "You have, I believe, and know the whole."

"No, I have not; I know nothing; pray tell me."

"You are prepared for the worst, I see—and very bad it is. Harriet Smith marries Robert Martin."

Emma gave a start, which did not seem like being prepared—and her eyes, in eager gaze, said, "No, this is impossible!" but her lips were closed.

"It is so, indeed," continued Mr. Knightley; "I have it from Robert Martin himself. He left me not half an hour ago."

She was still looking at him with the most speaking amazement.

"You like it, my Emma, as little as I feared.—I wish our opinions were the same. But in time they will. Time, you may be sure, will make one or the other of us think differently; and, in the meanwhile, we need not talk much on the subject."

"You mistake me, you quite mistake me," she replied, exerting herself. "It is not that such a circumstance would now make me unhappy, but I cannot believe it. It seems an impossibility!—You cannot mean to say, that Harriet Smith has accepted Robert Martin. You cannot mean that he has even proposed to her again—yet. You only mean, that he intends it."

"I mean that he has done it," answered Mr. Knightley, with smiling but determined decision, "and been accepted."

"Good God!" she cried.—"Well!"—Then having recourse to her workbasket, in excuse for leaning down her face, and concealing all the exquisite feelings of delight and entertainment which she knew she must be expressing, she added, "Well, now tell me every thing; make this intelligible to me. How, where, when?—Let me know it all. I never was more surprized—but it does not make me unhappy, I assure you.—How—how has it been possible?"

"It is a very simple story. He went to town on business three days ago, and I got him to take charge of some papers which I was wanting to send to John.—He delivered these papers to John, at his chambers, and was asked by him to join their party the same evening to Astley's. They were going to take the two eldest boys to Astley's. The party was to be our brother and sister, Henry, John—and Miss Smith. My friend Robert could not resist. They called for him in their way; were all extremely amused; and my brother asked him to dine with them the next day—which he did—and in the course of that visit (as I understand) he found an opportunity of speaking to Harriet; and certainly did not speak in vain.—She made him, by her acceptance, as happy even as he is deserving. He came down by yesterday's coach, and was with me this morning immediately after breakfast, to report his proceedings, first on my affairs, and then on his own. This is all that I can relate of the how, where, and when. Your friend Harriet will make a much longer history when you see her."

Rewritten passage

He paused for a moment, smiling again as he looked directly at her. "Does nothing come to mind? Do you not remember? Harriet Smith."

Her cheeks flushed at the name, and she felt a sudden sense of alarm, though she did not know why.

"Have you heard from her yourself this morning?" he asked. "I believe you have, and that you know the whole story."

"No, I have not; I know nothing. Please, tell me."

"I see you are prepared for the worst—and it is very bad. Harriet Smith is marrying Robert Martin."

Emma jumped, which did not look like she was prepared at all. Her eyes stared in disbelief, clearly saying, "No, this is impossible!" but she kept her lips pressed together.

"It is true," Mr. Knightley continued. "I heard it from Robert Martin himself. He left me less than half an hour ago."

She continued to look at him with complete astonishment.

"I see you are as unhappy about this as I feared," he said. "I wish we agreed, but in time we will. Time will surely make one of us change our mind, and until then, we do not need to discuss it much."

"You misunderstand me, you completely misunderstand me," she replied, forcing herself to speak. "It is not that this news makes me unhappy, but I cannot believe it. It seems impossible! You cannot mean that Harriet Smith has accepted Robert Martin. You cannot mean that he has even proposed to her again yet. You only mean that he intends to."

"I mean that he has already done it," Mr. Knightley answered with a smile but firm certainty, "and that she has accepted him."

"Good God!" she cried. "Well!" Then, reaching for her workbasket to hide her face and conceal the intense feelings of delight and amusement she knew were showing, she added, "Well, tell me everything now. Make this make sense to me. How, where, when? Let me know it all. I have never been more surprised, but I assure you, it does not make me unhappy. How has this been possible?"

"It is a very simple story. He went to town on business three days ago, and I asked him to deliver some papers to John. He took them to John's office, and John invited him to join their group that evening at Astley's. They were taking the two oldest boys to the theater. The group included my brother and sister, Henry, John, and Miss Smith. My friend Robert could not resist. They picked him up on their way, they all had a wonderful time, and my brother invited him to dinner the next day. During that visit, as I understand it, he found a chance to speak to Harriet, and he certainly did not speak in vain. By accepting him, she made him as happy as he deserves to be. He returned on the coach yesterday and came to see me this morning right after breakfast to report on his progress—first regarding my business, and then his own. That is all I can tell you about the how, where, and when. Your friend Harriet will have a much longer story to tell when you see her."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 069 / E4_069 / condition: modernize

Original passage

A child on the watch, came towards them to beg; and Miss Bickerton, excessively frightened, gave a great scream, and calling on Harriet to follow her, ran up a steep bank, cleared a slight hedge at the top, and made the best of her way by a short cut back to Highbury. But poor Harriet could not follow. She had suffered very much from cramp after dancing, and her first attempt to mount the bank brought on such a return of it as made her absolutely powerless—and in this state, and exceedingly terrified, she had been obliged to remain.

How the trampers might have behaved, had the young ladies been more courageous, must be doubtful; but such an invitation for attack could not be resisted; and Harriet was soon assailed by half a dozen children, headed by a stout woman and a great boy, all clamorous, and impertinent in look, though not absolutely in word.—More and more frightened, she immediately promised them money, and taking out her purse, gave them a shilling, and begged them not to want more, or to use her ill.—She was then able to walk, though but slowly, and was moving away—but her terror and her purse were too tempting, and she was followed, or rather surrounded, by the whole gang, demanding more.

In this state Frank Churchill had found her, she trembling and conditioning, they loud and insolent. By a most fortunate chance his leaving Highbury had been delayed so as to bring him to her assistance at this critical moment. The pleasantness of the morning had induced him to walk forward, and leave his horses to meet him by another road, a mile or two beyond Highbury—and happening to have borrowed a pair of scissors the night before of Miss Bates, and to have forgotten to restore them, he had been obliged to stop at her door, and go in for a few minutes: he was therefore later than he had intended; and being on foot, was unseen by the whole party till almost close to them. The terror which the woman and boy had been creating in Harriet was then their own portion. He had left them completely frightened; and Harriet eagerly clinging to him, and hardly able to speak, had just strength enough to reach Hartfield, before her spirits were quite overcome. It was his idea to bring her to Hartfield: he had thought of no other place.

This was the amount of the whole story,—of his communication and of Harriet's as soon as she had recovered her senses and speech.—He dared not stay longer than to see her well; these several delays left him not another minute to lose; and Emma engaging to give assurance of her safety to Mrs. Goddard, and notice of there being such a set of people in the neighbourhood to Mr. Knightley, he set off, with all the grateful blessings that she could utter for her friend and herself.

Such an adventure as this,—a fine young man and a lovely young woman thrown together in such a way, could hardly fail of suggesting certain ideas to the coldest heart and the steadiest brain. So Emma thought, at least. Could a linguist, could a grammarian, could even a mathematician have seen what she did, have witnessed their appearance together, and heard their history of it, without feeling that circumstances had been at work to make them peculiarly interesting to each other?

Rewritten passage

A child who had been watching them approached to beg; Miss Bickerton, terrified, let out a loud scream and, calling for Harriet to follow, ran up a steep bank, jumped over a low hedge at the top, and hurried back to Highbury by a shortcut. Poor Harriet, however, could not follow. She had been suffering from severe cramps after dancing, and her first attempt to climb the bank triggered a return of the pain that left her completely helpless. In this state, and feeling extremely frightened, she was forced to stay behind.

It is unclear how the travelers might have acted had the young women shown more courage, but such an invitation to harass them was impossible to resist. Harriet was quickly surrounded by half a dozen children, led by a stout woman and a large boy, all of whom were noisy and insolent in their demeanor, if not explicitly in their language. Growing increasingly terrified, she promised them money, took out her purse, gave them a shilling, and begged them not to ask for more or treat her badly. She was then able to walk, albeit slowly, and began to move away, but her obvious fear and her purse were too tempting. She was followed, or rather hemmed in, by the entire group, who demanded more.

Frank Churchill found her in this situation, with her trembling and pleading while they were loud and aggressive. By a stroke of great luck, his departure from Highbury had been delayed, bringing him to her aid at this critical moment. The pleasant morning had encouraged him to walk ahead, leaving his horses to meet him on another road a mile or two past Highbury. Having borrowed a pair of scissors from Miss Bates

the night before and forgotten to return them, he had been forced to stop at her house and go inside for a few minutes. Consequently, he was later than he had planned, and because he was on foot, the group did not see him until he was almost upon them. The terror that the woman and boy had been inflicting on Harriet was then turned back on them. He left them completely frightened, and Harriet, clinging to him eagerly and barely able to speak, had just enough strength to reach Hartfield before her nerves gave out entirely. It was his idea to bring her to Hartfield; he had not considered any other destination.

This was the sum of the story, based on his account and Harriet's once she had regained her composure and speech. He dared not stay longer than to ensure she was well; these various delays left him not a minute to spare. Emma promised to reassure Mrs. Goddard of her safety and to notify Mr. Knightley about the group of people in the area, and he departed, accompanied by all the grateful blessings she could offer on behalf of her friend and herself.

An adventure like this—a handsome young man and a lovely young woman brought together in such a manner—could hardly fail to spark certain ideas in even the coldest heart or the most level-headed person. At least, that is what Emma thought. Could a linguist, a grammarian, or even a mathematician have seen what she saw, witnessed their appearance together, and heard their story without feeling that circumstances had conspired to make them uniquely interesting to one another?

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 070 / E4_070 / condition: modernize

Original passage

—She

joined them at the wall, and found them more engaged in talking than in looking around. He was giving Harriet information as to modes of agriculture, etc. and Emma received a smile which seemed to say, "These are my own concerns. I have a right to talk on such subjects, without being suspected of introducing Robert Martin."—She did not suspect him. It was too old a story.—Robert Martin had probably ceased to think of Harriet.—They took a few turns together along the walk.—The shade was most refreshing, and Emma found it the pleasantest part of the day.

The next remove was to the house; they must all go in and eat;—and they were all seated and busy, and still Frank Churchill did not come. Mrs. Weston looked, and looked in vain. His father would not own himself uneasy, and laughed at her fears; but she could not be cured of wishing that he would part with his black mare. He had expressed himself as to coming, with more than common certainty. "His aunt was so much better, that he had not a doubt of getting over to them."—Mrs. Churchill's state, however, as many were ready to remind her, was liable to such sudden variation as might disappoint her nephew in the most reasonable dependence—and Mrs. Weston was at last persuaded to believe, or to say, that it must be by some attack of Mrs. Churchill that he was prevented coming.—Emma looked at Harriet while the point was under consideration; she behaved very well, and betrayed no emotion.

The cold repast was over, and the party were to go out once more to see what had not yet been seen, the old Abbey fish-ponds; perhaps get as far as the clover, which was to be begun cutting on the morrow, or, at any rate, have the pleasure of being hot, and growing cool again.—Mr. Woodhouse, who had already taken his little round in the highest part of the gardens, where no damps from the river were imagined even by him, stirred no more; and his daughter resolved to remain with him, that Mrs. Weston might be persuaded away by her husband to the exercise and variety which her spirits seemed to need.

Mr. Knightley had done all in his power for Mr. Woodhouse's entertainment. Books of engravings, drawers of medals, cameos, corals, shells, and every other family collection within his cabinets, had been prepared for his old friend, to while away the morning; and the kindness had perfectly answered. Mr. Woodhouse had been exceedingly well amused. Mrs. Weston had been shewing them all to him, and now he would shew them all to Emma;—fortunate in having no other resemblance to a child, than in a total want of taste for what he saw, for he was slow, constant, and methodical.—Before this second looking over was begun, however, Emma walked into the hall for the sake of a few moments' free observation of the entrance and ground-plot of the house—and was hardly there, when Jane Fairfax appeared, coming quickly in from the garden, and with a look of escape.—Little expecting to meet Miss Woodhouse so soon, there was a start at first; but Miss Woodhouse was the very person she was in quest of.

Rewritten passage

She met them at the wall and found them more occupied with conversation than with the scenery. He was explaining farming methods to Harriet, and Emma received a smile that seemed to imply, "These are my personal affairs. I have every right to discuss such topics without being accused of bringing up Robert Martin." She did not suspect him; that was old news. Robert Martin had likely stopped thinking about Harriet. They walked together for a while; the shade was refreshing, and Emma found it the most pleasant part of the day.

Next, they moved to the house, as everyone had to go inside to eat. They were all seated and occupied, yet Frank Churchill still had not arrived. Mrs. Weston kept checking, but in vain. His father refused to admit he was worried and laughed off her concerns, though she could not stop wishing he would get rid of his black mare. He had spoken about coming with more than usual certainty, claiming his aunt was doing so much better that he had no doubt he could make it. However, as many were quick to remind her, Mrs. Churchill's condition was prone to sudden changes that could ruin even the most reasonable plans. Mrs. Weston was finally persuaded to believe, or at least to say, that some health crisis must have prevented his arrival. Emma glanced at Harriet while this was being discussed; she handled it well and showed no emotion.

The cold meal finished, the group prepared to head out again to see the old Abbey fish-ponds, perhaps walk as far as the clover field that was to be harvested the next day, or at least enjoy the experience of getting hot and cooling down again. Mr. Woodhouse, who had already taken his short walk in the highest part of the gardens where he felt safe from river dampness, moved no further. His daughter decided to stay with him so that Mr. Weston could convince his wife to go out for the exercise and change of pace her spirits seemed to require.

Mr. Knightley had done everything possible to entertain Mr. Woodhouse. Books of engravings, drawers of medals, cameos, corals, shells, and every other family collection in his cabinets had been set out for his old friend to pass the morning, and the gesture had worked perfectly. Mr. Woodhouse had been thoroughly entertained. Mrs. Weston had shown them all to him, and now he wanted to show them all to Emma—fortunate in having no resemblance to a child other than a complete lack of interest in what he was looking at, for he was slow, steady, and methodical. Before this second viewing began, however, Emma walked into the hall for a few moments of quiet observation of the house's entrance and layout. She had barely arrived when Jane Fairfax appeared, hurrying in from the garden with a look of escape. Not expecting to run into Miss Woodhouse so quickly, she started at first, but Miss Woodhouse was the very person she had been looking for.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes:

Item 071 / E4_071 / condition: simplify

Original passage

One day, several months after my return to England, I quitted London to visit my sister. Her society was my chief solace and delight; and my spirits always rose at the expectation of seeing her. Her conversation was full of pointed remark and discernment; in her pleasant alcove, redolent with sweetest flowers, adorned by magnificent casts, antique vases, and copies of the finest pictures of Raphael, Correggio, and Claude, painted by herself, I fancied myself in a fairy retreat untainted by and inaccessible to the noisy contentions of politicians and the frivolous pursuits of fashion. On this occasion, my sister was not alone; nor could I fail to recognise her companion: it was Idris, the till now unseen object of my mad idolatry.

In what fitting terms of wonder and delight, in what choice expression and soft flow of language, can I usher in the loveliest, wisest, best? How in poor assemblage of words convey the halo of glory that surrounded her, the thousand graces that waited unwearied on her. The first thing that struck you on beholding that charming countenance was its perfect goodness and frankness; candour sat upon her brow, simplicity in her eyes, heavenly benignity in her smile. Her tall slim figure bent gracefully as a poplar to the breezy west, and her gait, goddess-like, was as that of a winged angel new alit from heaven's high floor; the pearly fairness of her complexion was stained by a pure suffusion; her voice resembled the low, subdued tenor of a flute. It is easiest perhaps to describe by contrast. I have detailed the perfections of my sister; and yet she was utterly unlike Idris. Perdita, even where she loved, was reserved and timid; Idris was frank and confiding. The one recoiled to solitude, that she might there entrench herself from disappointment and injury; the other walked forth in open day, believing that none would harm her. Wordsworth has compared a beloved female to two fair objects in nature; but his lines always appeared to me rather a contrast than a similitude:

A violet by a mossy stone
Half hidden from the eye,
Fair as a star when only one
Is shining in the sky.

Such a violet was sweet Perdita, trembling to entrust herself to the very air, cowering from observation, yet betrayed by her excellences; and repaying with a thousand graces the labour of those who sought her in her lonely bye-path. Idris was as the star, set in single splendour in the dim anadem of balmy evening; ready to enlighten and delight the subject world, shielded herself from every taint by her unimagined distance from all that was not like herself akin to heaven.

I found this vision of beauty in Perdita's alcove, in earnest conversation with its inmate. When my sister saw me, she rose, and taking my hand, said, "He is here, even at our wish; this is Lionel, my brother." Idris arose also, and bent on me her eyes of celestial blue, and with grace peculiar said—"You hardly need an introduction; we have a picture, highly valued by my father, which declares at once your name. Verney, you will acknowledge this tie, and as my brother's friend, I feel that I may trust you."

Then, with lids humid with a tear and trembling voice, she continued—"Dear friends, do not think it strange that now, visiting you for the first time, I ask your assistance, and confide my wishes and fears to you.

Rewritten passage

One day, several months after I returned to England, I left London to visit my sister. Her company was my greatest comfort and joy, and my spirits always lifted at the thought of seeing her. Her conversation was full of sharp observations and insight. In her pleasant alcove, filled with the scent of sweet flowers and decorated with magnificent statues, antique vases, and copies of the finest paintings by Raphael, Correggio, and Claude—all painted by her own hand—I felt as if I were in a fairy retreat, untouched by the noisy arguments of politicians or the shallow pursuits of fashion. On this visit, my sister was not alone, and I immediately recognized her companion: it was Idris, the woman I had worshipped from afar but had never actually met.

How can I find the right words of wonder and delight, or the perfect, flowing language to introduce the loveliest, wisest, and best of women? How can a simple collection of words convey the glow that surrounded her or the countless graces that seemed to follow her everywhere? The first thing that struck you when looking at her charming face was its perfect goodness and honesty; sincerity sat on her brow, simplicity was in her eyes, and a heavenly kindness was in her smile. Her tall, slim figure bent as gracefully as a poplar tree in a western breeze, and her walk was goddess-like, as if she were a winged angel who had just landed from heaven. Her fair, pearly complexion was touched with a natural blush, and her voice sounded like the low, soft notes of a flute. It is perhaps easiest to describe her by contrast. I have already detailed my sister's perfections, yet she was completely different from Idris. Perdita, even when she loved, was reserved and shy; Idris was open and trusting. One retreated into solitude to protect herself from disappointment and harm, while the other walked out in the open, believing that no one would ever hurt her. Wordsworth once compared a beloved woman to two beautiful things in nature, but his lines always seemed to me to describe a contrast rather than a similarity:

A violet by a mossy stone
Half hidden from the eye,
Fair as a star when only one
Is shining in the sky.

Sweet Perdita was like that violet, afraid to trust herself to the open air, hiding from view yet revealed by her own excellence, and rewarding those who sought her out in her lonely path with a thousand graces. Idris was like the star, set in solitary splendor in the dim crown of a balmy evening, ready to enlighten and delight the world below, protected from any corruption by her distance from everything that was not as heavenly as herself.

I found this vision of beauty in Perdita's alcove, in deep conversation with my sister. When my sister saw me, she stood up, took my hand, and said, "He is here, just as we wished; this is Lionel, my brother." Idris also stood up, turned her celestial blue eyes toward me, and said with unique grace, "You hardly need an introduction; we have a picture, highly valued by my father, that identifies you immediately. Verney, you will recognize this connection, and as my brother's friend, I feel that I can trust you."

Then, with eyes moist with tears and a trembling voice, she continued, "Dear friends, do not think it strange that, visiting you for the first time, I ask for your help and share my wishes and fears with you."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 072 / E4_072 / condition: modernize

Original passage

Thenceforward my voice was a household law; and at an age when few children have abandoned their leading-strings, I was left to the guidance of my own will, and became, in all but name, the master of my own actions.

My earliest recollections of a school-life, are connected with a large, rambling, Elizabethan house, in a misty-looking village of England, where were a vast number of gigantic and gnarled trees, and where all the houses were excessively ancient. In truth, it was a dream-like and spirit-soothing place, that venerable old town. At this moment, in fancy, I feel the refreshing chilliness of its deeply-shadowed avenues, inhale the fragrance of its thousand shrubberies, and thrill anew with undefinable delight, at the deep hollow note of the church-bell, breaking, each hour, with sullen and sudden roar, upon the stillness of the dusky atmosphere in which the fretted Gothic steeple lay imbedded and asleep.

It gives me, perhaps, as much of pleasure as I can now in any manner experience, to dwell upon minute recollections of the school and its concerns. Steeped in misery as I am—misery, alas! only too real—I shall be pardoned for seeking relief, however slight and temporary, in the weakness of a few rambling details. These, moreover, utterly trivial, and even ridiculous in themselves, assume, to my fancy, adventitious importance, as connected with a period and a locality when and where I recognise the first ambiguous monitions of the destiny which afterwards so fully overshadowed me. Let me then remember.

The house, I have said, was old and irregular. The grounds were extensive, and a high and solid brick wall, topped with a bed of mortar and broken glass, encompassed the whole. This prison-like rampart formed the limit of our domain; beyond it we saw but thrice a week—once every Saturday afternoon, when, attended by two ushers, we were permitted to take brief walks in a body through some of the neighbouring fields—and twice during Sunday, when we were paraded in the same formal manner to the morning and evening service in the one church of the village. Of this church the principal of our school was pastor. With how deep a spirit of wonder and perplexity was I wont to regard him from our remote pew in the gallery, as, with step solemn and slow, he ascended the pulpit! This reverend man, with countenance so demurely benign, with robes so glossy and so clerically flowing, with wig so minutely powdered, so rigid and so vast,—could this be he who, of late, with sour visage, and in snuffy habiliments, administered, ferule in hand, the Draconian laws of the academy? Oh, gigantic paradox, too utterly monstrous for solution!

At an angle of the ponderous wall frowned a more ponderous gate. It was riveted and studded with iron bolts, and surmounted with jagged iron spikes. What impressions of deep awe did it inspire! It was never opened save for the three periodical egressions and ingressions already mentioned; then, in every creak of its mighty hinges, we found a plenitude of mystery—a world of matter for solemn remark, or for more solemn meditation.

The extensive enclosure was irregular in form, having many capacious recesses. Of these, three or four of the largest constituted the play-ground. It was level, and covered with fine hard gravel.

Rewritten passage

From that point on, my word was law in the house; and at an age when few children have stopped needing supervision, I was left to follow my own desires, becoming, in every way but name, the master of my own behavior.

My earliest memories of school life are tied to a large, sprawling Elizabethan house in a misty English village, where there were countless massive, twisted trees and where every building was incredibly old. Truly, that venerable town was a dreamlike and soothing place. Even now, in my imagination, I feel the refreshing chill of its deeply shaded avenues, breathe in the scent of its many shrubberies, and feel a fresh, indefinable thrill at the deep, hollow sound of the church bell, which broke the stillness of the dim air every hour with a sudden, sullen roar,

right where the intricate Gothic steeple sat embedded and asleep.

It gives me perhaps as much pleasure as I can currently experience to dwell on the minute details of that school and its affairs. Steeped in misery as I am—misery that is, unfortunately, all too real—I hope to be forgiven for seeking relief, however slight and temporary, in the indulgence of a few rambling memories. These details, though utterly trivial and even ridiculous on their own, take on an added importance in my mind because they are connected to a time and place where I recognize the first vague warnings of the destiny that later overshadowed me so completely. Let me remember, then.

The house, as I have said, was old and irregular. The grounds were vast, and a high, solid brick wall, topped with mortar and broken glass, surrounded the entire property. This prison-like barrier marked the edge of our world; beyond it, we saw nothing except three times a week—once every Saturday afternoon, when, accompanied by two teachers, we were allowed to take short group walks through the nearby fields, and twice on Sunday, when we were marched in the same formal way to the morning and evening services at the village's only church. The head of our school was the pastor of this church. With what deep wonder and confusion I used to watch him from our distant pew in the gallery as he climbed the pulpit with slow, solemn steps! This reverend man, with his demurely kind face, his glossy, flowing clerical robes, and his wig, so precisely powdered, so rigid, and so vast—could this really be the same person who, just a short time before, had been administering the school's harsh laws with a sour expression, dirty clothes, and a ruler in his hand? Oh, what a massive paradox, far too monstrous to solve!

At a corner of that heavy wall stood an even heavier gate. It was reinforced and studded with iron bolts and topped with jagged iron spikes. What a deep sense of awe it inspired! It was never opened except for the three scheduled departures and arrivals I already mentioned; then, in every creak of its mighty hinges, we found a wealth of mystery—a world of subject matter for serious conversation or even more serious reflection.

The large enclosure was irregular in shape, with many spacious alcoves. Three or four of the largest ones made up the playground. It was flat and covered with fine, hard gravel.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 073 / E4_073 / condition: simplify

Original passage

You must, therefore, pardon the freedom with which I demand your attention; your feelings, I know, will bestow it unwillingly, but I demand it of your justice.

"Two offences of a very different nature, and by no means of equal magnitude, you last night laid to my charge. The first mentioned was, that, regardless of the sentiments of either, I had detached Mr. Bingley from your sister,--and the other, that I had, in defiance of various claims, in defiance of honour and humanity, ruined the immediate prosperity and blasted the prospects of Mr. Wickham. Wilfully and wantonly to have thrown off the companion of my youth, the acknowledged favourite of my father, a young man who had scarcely any other dependence than on our patronage, and who had been brought up to expect its exertion, would be a depravity, to which the separation of two young persons whose affection could be the growth of only a few weeks, could bear no comparison. But from the severity of that blame which was last night so liberally bestowed, respecting each circumstance, I shall hope to be in future secured, when the following account of my actions and their motives has been read. If, in the explanation of them which is due to myself, I am under the necessity of relating feelings which may be offensive to yours, I can only say that I am sorry. The necessity must be obeyed, and further apology would be absurd. I had not been long in Hertfordshire before I saw, in common with others, that Bingley preferred your elder sister to any other young woman in the country. But it was not till the evening of the dance at Netherfield that I had any apprehension of his feeling a serious attachment. I had often seen him in love before. At that ball, while I had the honour of dancing with you, I was first made acquainted, by Sir William Lucas's accidental information, that Bingley's attentions to your sister had given rise to a general expectation of their marriage. He spoke of it as a certain event, of which the time alone could be undecided. From that moment I observed my friend's behaviour attentively; and I could then perceive that his partiality for Miss Bennet was beyond what I had ever witnessed in him. Your sister I also watched. Her look and manners were open, cheerful, and engaging as ever, but without any symptom of peculiar regard; and I remained convinced, from the evening's scrutiny, that though she received his attentions with pleasure, she did not invite them by any participation of sentiment. If you have not been mistaken here, I must have been in an error. Your superior knowledge of your sister must make the latter probable. If it be so, if I have been misled by such error to inflict pain on her, your resentment has not been unreasonable. But I shall not scruple to assert, that the serenity of your sister's countenance and air was such as might have given the most acute observer a conviction that, however amiable her temper, her heart was not likely to be easily touched. That I was desirous of believing her indifferent is certain; but I will venture to say that my investigations and decisions are not usually influenced by my hopes or fears.

Rewritten passage

You must therefore forgive the boldness with which I ask for your attention. I know you will give it unwillingly, but I demand it in the name of justice. Last night, you accused me of two very different offenses, which are by no means equal in severity. The first was that I had separated Mr. Bingley from your sister, ignoring both of their feelings. The second was that I had ruined the future and destroyed the prospects of Mr. Wickham, in defiance of honor, humanity, and various obligations. To have intentionally and cruelly cast aside a childhood companion, my father's favorite, and a young man who relied almost entirely on our support, would be a level of wickedness that the separation of two people who had only known each other for a few weeks could never match. However, I hope that after you read this account of my actions and my reasons for them, I will be protected from the harsh criticism you leveled at me last night. If, in explaining myself, I must express feelings that offend you, I can only say that I am sorry. I must do this, and any further apology would be pointless. I had not been in Hertfordshire long before I noticed, as others had, that Bingley preferred your older sister to any other woman in the area. But it was not until the night of the dance at Netherfield that I worried he had developed a serious attachment. I had seen him in love many times before. At that ball, while I was dancing with you, Sir William Lucas happened to mention that Bingley's interest in your sister had led everyone to expect they would marry. He spoke of it as a certainty, with only the date left to be decided. From that moment, I watched my friend's behavior closely, and I could see that his affection for Miss Bennet was stronger than anything I had ever seen from him before. I also watched your sister. Her expression and manners were as open, cheerful, and pleasant as ever, but she showed no signs of any special feelings for him. After watching her that evening, I remained convinced that although she enjoyed his attention, she did not encourage it by returning his feelings. If you were not mistaken, then I must have been wrong. Given your superior knowledge of your sister, it is likely that I was the one in error. If that is true, and I caused her pain because of my mistake, then your anger was not unreasonable. However, I will state firmly that your sister's calm expression and manner were such that even the most observant person would have been convinced that, however kind her personality, her heart was not easily moved. It is true that I wanted to believe she was indifferent, but I will venture to say that my observations and

conclusions are not usually influenced by my own hopes or fears.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 074 / E4_074 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

It most killed Jim a-laughing.
He was the easiest nigger to laugh that ever was, anyway.

I took the watch, and Jim he laid down and snored away; and by-and-by the storm let up for good and all; and the first cabin-light that showed, I roused him out and we slid the raft into hiding quarters for the day.

The king got out an old ratty deck of cards after breakfast, and him and the duke played seven-up a while, five cents a game. Then they got tired of it, and allowed they would "lay out a campaign," as they called it. The duke went down into his carpet-bag, and fetched up a lot of little printed bills and read them out loud. One bill said, "The celebrated Dr. Armand de Montalban, of Paris," would "lecture on the Science of Phrenology" at such and such a place, on the blank day of blank, at ten cents admission, and "furnish charts of character at twenty-five cents apiece." The duke said that was _him_. In another bill he was the "world-renowned Shakespearian tragedian, Garrick the Younger, of Drury Lane, London." In other bills he had a lot of other names and done other wonderful things, like finding water and gold with a "divining-rod," "dissipating witch spells," and so on. By-and-by he says:

"But the histrionic muse is the darling. Have you ever trod the boards, Royalty?"

"No," says the king.

"You shall, then, before you're three days older, Fallen Grandeur," says the duke. "The first good town we come to we'll hire a hall and do the sword fight in Richard III. and the balcony scene in Romeo and Juliet. How does that strike you?"

"I'm in, up to the hub, for anything that will pay, Bilgewater; but, you see, I don't know nothing about play-actin', and hain't ever seen much of it. I was too small when pap used to have 'em at the palace. Do you reckon you can learn me?"

"Easy!"

"All right. I'm jist a-freezn' for something fresh, anyway. Le's commence right away."

So the duke he told him all about who Romeo was and who Juliet was, and said he was used to being Romeo, so the king could be Juliet.

"But if Juliet's such a young gal, duke, my peeled head and my white whiskers is goin' to look uncommon odd on her, maybe."

"No, don't you worry; these country jakes won't ever think of that. Besides, you know, you'll be in costume, and that makes all the difference in the world; Juliet's in a balcony, enjoying the moonlight before she goes to bed, and she's got on her night-gown and her ruffled nightcap. Here are the costumes for the parts."

He got out two or three curtain-calico suits, which he said was meedyevil armor for Richard III. and t'other chap, and a long white cotton nightshirt and a ruffled nightcap to match. The king was satisfied; so the duke got out his book and read the parts over in the most splendid spread-eagle way, prancing around and acting at the same time, to show how it had got to be done; then he give the book to the king and told him to get his part by heart.

There was a little one-horse town about three mile down the bend, and after dinner the duke said he had ciphered out his idea about how to run in daylight without it being dangersome for Jim; so he allowed he would go down to the town and fix that thing.

Rewritten passage

Jim was nearly overcome with laughter. He was always the most prone to laughter of any man I had ever known.

I retrieved the watch, and Jim settled down to sleep, snoring soundly. Eventually, the storm ceased entirely, and as soon as the first light appeared from a cabin, I woke him, and we moved the raft into a concealed spot to remain for the day.

Following breakfast, the king produced a worn-out pack of cards, and he and the duke played seven-up for a nickel a round. Growing bored, they decided to plan a scheme, as they termed it. The duke rummaged through his carpet-bag, pulled out several printed handbills, and read them aloud. One announced that the famous Dr. Armand de Montalban, from Paris, would lecture on phrenology at a specific location on a certain date for ten cents, offering character charts for an additional quarter. The duke claimed that was his identity. Other bills identified him as the world-famous Shakespearean actor, Garrick the Younger, from London's Drury Lane. Additional notices listed various other aliases and impressive feats, such as locating water or gold using a divining rod and breaking witchcraft spells. Finally, he remarked:

"But the dramatic arts are the true passion. Have you ever performed on stage, your Majesty?"

"Never," the king replied.

"You shall do so before three days pass, your fallen Highness," the duke declared. "At the first suitable town, we will rent a hall and perform the sword fight from Richard III and the balcony scene from Romeo and Juliet. How does that sound to you?"

"I am fully committed to anything that brings in money, Bilgewater; however, I know nothing of acting and have seen very little of it. I was too young when my father hosted such performances at the palace. Do you think you can teach me?"

"It will be simple!"

"Very well. I am eager for something new regardless. Let us begin immediately."

Consequently, the duke explained the roles of Romeo and Juliet, noting that he usually played Romeo, so the king would take the part of Juliet.

"But if Juliet is such a young girl, duke, my bald head and white beard might look rather strange for the role."

"Do not concern yourself; these rural folks will never notice. Furthermore, you will be in costume, which changes everything. Juliet is on a balcony, taking in the moonlight before retiring, wearing her nightgown and a ruffled nightcap. Here are the outfits for the roles."

He produced several suits made of curtain calico, which he described as medieval armor for Richard III and the other character, along with a long white cotton nightshirt and a matching ruffled cap. The king was content, so the duke retrieved his book and recited the lines with grand, dramatic flair, pacing and gesturing to demonstrate the proper technique. He then handed the book to the king, instructing him to memorize his lines.

Three miles down the river bend lay a small, insignificant town. After their meal, the duke mentioned he had devised a plan to travel during daylight hours without endangering Jim, so he intended to head into town to arrange the matter.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 075 / E4_075 / condition: modernize

Original passage

But I
did; and I saw him no more till last night."

"And what occurred then?"

"I'll tell you, lady. Last night he came again. Again they went upstairs, and I, wrapping myself up so that my shadow would not betray me, again listened at the door. The first words I heard Monks say were these: 'So the only proofs of the boy's identity lie at the bottom of the river, and the old hag that received them from the mother is rotting in her coffin.' They laughed, and talked of his success in doing this; and Monks, talking on about the boy, and getting very wild, said that though he had got the young devil's money safely now, he'd rather have had it the other way; for, what a game it would have been to have brought down the boast of the father's will, by driving him through every jail in town, and then hauling him up for some capital felony which Fagin could easily manage, after having made a good profit of him besides."

"What is all this!" said Rose.

"The truth, lady, though it comes from my lips," replied the girl.

"Then, he said, with oaths common enough in my ears, but strange to yours, that if he could gratify his hatred by taking the boy's life without bringing his own neck in danger, he would; but, as he couldn't, he'd be upon the watch to meet him at every turn in life; and if he took advantage of his birth and history, he might harm him yet. 'In short, Fagin,' he says, 'Jew as you are, you never laid such snares as I'll contrive for my young brother, Oliver.'"

"His brother!" exclaimed Rose.

"Those were his words," said Nancy, glancing uneasily round, as she had scarcely ceased to do, since she began to speak, for a vision of Sikes haunted her perpetually. "And more. When he spoke of you and the other lady, and said it seemed contrived by Heaven, or the devil, against him, that Oliver should come into your hands, he laughed, and said there was some comfort in that too, for how many thousands and hundreds of thousands of pounds would you not give, if you had them, to know who your two-legged spaniel was."

"You do not mean," said Rose, turning very pale, "to tell me that this was said in earnest?"

"He spoke in hard and angry earnest, if a man ever did," replied the girl, shaking her head. "He is an earnest man when his hatred is up. I know many who do worse things; but I'd rather listen to them all a dozen times, than to that Monks once. It is growing late, and I have to reach home without suspicion of having been on such an errand as this. I must get back quickly."

"But what can I do?" said Rose. "To what use can I turn this communication without you? Back! Why do you wish to return to companions you paint in such terrible colors? If you repeat this information to a gentleman whom I can summon in an instant from the next room, you can be consigned to some place of safety without half an hour's delay."

"I wish to go back," said the girl. "I must go back, because—how can I tell such things to an innocent lady like you?"

Rewritten passage

"But I did; and I didn't see him again until last night."

"And what happened then?"

"I'll tell you, ma'am. Last night he returned. They went upstairs again, and I wrapped myself up so my shadow wouldn't give me away, and I listened at the door once more. The first words I heard Monks say were these: 'So the only proof of the boy's identity is at the bottom of the river, and the old woman who took them from his mother is rotting in her grave.' They laughed and talked about his success in doing this."

Monks, getting very agitated as he spoke about the boy, said that although he had the young devil's money safely now, he would have preferred it the other way. He said it would have been a real game to ruin the pride of his father's will by dragging him through every jail in the city, and then setting him up for a serious crime that Fagin could easily arrange, after having made a good profit off him as well."

"What does all this mean!" Rose asked.

"It's the truth, ma'am, even if it comes from my mouth," the girl replied. "Then he said, using curses that are common enough to my ears but strange to yours, that if he could satisfy his hatred by taking the boy's life without putting his own neck in danger, he would. But since he couldn't, he would watch for him at every turn in life; and if he could use his birth and history against him, he might still destroy him. 'In short, Fagin,' he said, 'Jew that you are, you never set such traps as I will devise for my young brother, Oliver.'"

"His brother!" Rose exclaimed.

"Those were his words," Nancy said, glancing nervously around, as she had barely stopped doing since she began speaking, for the thought of Sikes haunted her constantly. "And there is more. When he spoke of you and the other lady, and said it seemed arranged by Heaven, or the devil, that Oliver should fall into your hands, he laughed and said there was some comfort in that, too. He asked how many thousands and hundreds of thousands of pounds you wouldn't give, if you had them, to know who your little pet really is."

"You don't mean," Rose said, turning very pale, "to tell me that he was serious?"

"He spoke with harsh and angry sincerity, if a man ever did," the girl replied, shaking her head. "He is a serious man when his hatred is stirred. I know many people who do worse things, but I would rather listen to them all a dozen times than to that Monks once. It is getting late, and I have to get home without anyone suspecting I was on an errand like this. I must return quickly."

"But what can I do?" Rose asked. "How can I use this information without you? Go back! Why do you want to return to companions you describe in such terrible terms? If you repeat this information to a gentleman I can call in an instant from the next room, you could be taken to a place of safety in less than half an hour."

"I want to go back," the girl said. "I must go back, because—how can I tell such things to an innocent lady like you?"

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 076 / E4_076 / condition: simplify

Original passage

—She joined them at the wall, and found them more engaged in talking than in looking around. He was giving Harriet information as to modes of agriculture, etc. and Emma received a smile which seemed to say, “These are my own concerns. I have a right to talk on such subjects, without being suspected of introducing Robert Martin.”—She did not suspect him. It was too old a story.—Robert Martin had probably ceased to think of Harriet.—They took a few turns together along the walk.—The shade was most refreshing, and Emma found it the pleasantest part of the day.

The next remove was to the house; they must all go in and eat;—and they were all seated and busy, and still Frank Churchill did not come. Mrs. Weston looked, and looked in vain. His father would not own himself uneasy, and laughed at her fears; but she could not be cured of wishing that he would part with his black mare. He had expressed himself as to coming, with more than common certainty. “His aunt was so much better, that he had not a doubt of getting over to them.”—Mrs. Churchill’s state, however, as many were ready to remind her, was liable to such sudden variation as might disappoint her nephew in the most reasonable dependence—and Mrs. Weston was at last persuaded to believe, or to say, that it must be by some attack of Mrs. Churchill that he was prevented coming.—Emma looked at Harriet while the point was under consideration; she behaved very well, and betrayed no emotion.

The cold repast was over, and the party were to go out once more to see what had not yet been seen, the old Abbey fish-ponds; perhaps get as far as the clover, which was to be begun cutting on the morrow, or, at any rate, have the pleasure of being hot, and growing cool again.—Mr. Woodhouse, who had already taken his little round in the highest part of the gardens, where no damps from the river were imagined even by him, stirred no more; and his daughter resolved to remain with him, that Mrs. Weston might be persuaded away by her husband to the exercise and variety which her spirits seemed to need.

Mr. Knightley had done all in his power for Mr. Woodhouse’s entertainment. Books of engravings, drawers of medals, cameos, corals, shells, and every other family collection within his cabinets, had been prepared for his old friend, to while away the morning; and the kindness had perfectly answered. Mr. Woodhouse had been exceedingly well amused. Mrs. Weston had been shewing them all to him, and now he would shew them all to Emma;—fortunate in having no other resemblance to a child, than in a total want of taste for what he saw, for he was slow, constant, and methodical.—Before this second looking over was begun, however, Emma walked into the hall for the sake of a few moments’ free observation of the entrance and ground-plot of the house—and was hardly there, when Jane Fairfax appeared, coming quickly in from the garden, and with a look of escape.—Little expecting to meet Miss Woodhouse so soon, there was a start at first; but Miss Woodhouse was the very person she was in quest of.

Rewritten passage

Emma joined them at the wall and found them more interested in talking than in looking at the scenery. He was explaining farming methods to Harriet, and Emma received a smile from him that seemed to say, “These are my own interests. I have a right to discuss such topics without being suspected of bringing up Robert Martin.” She did not suspect him. That was old news, and Robert Martin had likely stopped thinking about Harriet. They walked together for a while; the shade was refreshing, and Emma found it the most pleasant part of the day.

Next, they moved to the house; they all had to go inside to eat. They were seated and busy, yet Frank Churchill still had not arrived. Mrs. Weston looked for him repeatedly, but in vain. His father refused to admit he was worried and laughed at her concerns, though she could not stop wishing he would get rid of his black mare. Frank had spoken about coming with more than usual certainty, saying, “His aunt was so much better that he had no doubt he could get over to them.” However, as many were quick to remind her, Mrs. Churchill’s health was prone to sudden changes that could disappoint her nephew despite his reasonable expectations. Mrs. Weston was finally persuaded to believe, or at least to say, that some attack of Mrs. Churchill’s must have prevented his arrival. Emma watched Harriet while this was being discussed; she behaved very well and showed no emotion.

The cold meal ended, and the group prepared to go out once more to see the parts of the estate they had not yet visited, such as the old Abbey fish-ponds. They might even walk as far as the clover field, which was to be cut the next day, or at the very least, enjoy the experience of getting warm and cooling down again. Mr. Woodhouse, who had already taken his short walk in the highest part of the gardens where he believed no dampness from the river could reach him, moved no further. His daughter decided to stay with him so that Mrs. Weston might be persuaded by her husband to enjoy the exercise and variety her spirits seemed to require.

Mr. Knightley had done everything possible to entertain Mr. Woodhouse. He had prepared books of engravings, drawers of medals, cameos, corals, shells, and every other family collection in his cabinets to help his old friend pass the morning, and his kindness had worked perfectly. Mr. Woodhouse had been very well amused. Mrs. Weston had shown them all to him, and now he wanted to show them all to Emma. He was fortunate in having no resemblance to a child other than a total lack of interest in what he saw, for he was slow, steady, and methodical. Before this second viewing began, however, Emma walked into the hall to get a few moments to observe the entrance and the layout of the house. She had barely arrived when Jane Fairfax appeared, coming quickly in from the garden with a look of escape. Not expecting to meet Miss Woodhouse so soon, she started at first, but Miss Woodhouse was the very person she was looking for.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 077 / E4_077 / condition: modernize

Original passage

I must go now. Good-bye. Don't forget that you will have only one child now to look after, and believe me that if this man wrongs my sister, I will find out who he is, track him down, and kill him like a dog. I swear it."

The exaggerated folly of the threat, the passionate gesture that accompanied it, the mad melodramatic words, made life seem more vivid to her. She was familiar with the atmosphere. She breathed more freely, and for the first time for many months she really admired her son. She would have liked to have continued the scene on the same emotional scale, but he cut her short. Trunks had to be carried down and mufflers looked for. The lodging-house drudge bustled in and out. There was the bargaining with the cabman. The moment was lost in vulgar details. It was with a renewed feeling of disappointment that she waved the tattered lace handkerchief from the window, as her son drove away. She was conscious that a great opportunity had been wasted. She consoled herself by telling Sibyl how desolate she felt her life would be, now that she had only one child to look after. She remembered the phrase. It had pleased her. Of the threat she said nothing. It was vividly and dramatically expressed. She felt that they would all laugh at it some day.

CHAPTER VI.

"I suppose you have heard the news, Basil?" said Lord Henry that evening as Hallward was shown into a little private room at the Bristol where dinner had been laid for three.

"No, Harry," answered the artist, giving his hat and coat to the bowing waiter. "What is it? Nothing about politics, I hope! They don't interest me. There is hardly a single person in the House of Commons worth painting, though many of them would be the better for a little whitewashing."

"Dorian Gray is engaged to be married," said Lord Henry, watching him as he spoke.

Hallward started and then frowned. "Dorian engaged to be married!" he cried. "Impossible!"

"It is perfectly true."

"To whom?"

"To some little actress or other."

"I can't believe it. Dorian is far too sensible."

"Dorian is far too wise not to do foolish things now and then, my dear Basil."

"Marriage is hardly a thing that one can do now and then, Harry."

"Except in America," rejoined Lord Henry languidly. "But I didn't say he was married. I said he was engaged to be married. There is a great difference. I have a distinct remembrance of being married, but I have no recollection at all of being engaged. I am inclined to think that I never was engaged."

"But think of Dorian's birth, and position, and wealth. It would be absurd for him to marry so much beneath him."

"If you want to make him marry this girl, tell him that, Basil. He is sure to do it, then. Whenever a man does a thoroughly stupid thing, it is always from the noblest motives."

"I hope the girl is good, Harry. I don't want to see Dorian tied to some vile creature, who might degrade his nature and ruin his

intellect.”

“Oh, she is better than good—she is beautiful,” murmured Lord Henry, sipping a glass of vermouth and orange-bitters.

Rewritten passage

“I have to go now. Goodbye. Don’t forget that you’ll only have one child to look after now, and believe me, if this man hurts my sister, I will find out who he is, track him down, and kill him like a dog. I swear it.”

The exaggerated foolishness of the threat, the passionate gesture that accompanied it, and the wild, melodramatic words made life feel more vivid to her. She was used to this atmosphere. She breathed more easily, and for the first time in many months, she truly admired her son. She would have liked to continue the scene on that same emotional level, but he cut her short. Trunks had to be carried down and scarves looked for. The boarding-house maid bustled in and out. There was the haggling with the taxi driver. The moment was lost in mundane details. It was with a renewed sense of disappointment that she waved her tattered lace handkerchief from the window as her son drove away. She was aware that a great opportunity had been wasted. She consoled herself by telling Sibyl how desolate she felt her life would be now that she only had one child to look after. She remembered the phrase. It had pleased her. She said nothing about the threat. It had been vividly and dramatically expressed. She felt that they would all laugh about it one day.

CHAPTER VI.

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“No, Harry,” the artist answered, handing his hat and coat to the bowing waiter. “What is it? Nothing about politics, I hope! They don’t interest me. There is hardly anyone in the House of Commons worth painting, though many of them would benefit from a little whitewashing.”

“Dorian Gray is engaged to be married,” Lord Henry said, watching him as he spoke.

Hallward jumped and then frowned. “Dorian engaged to be married!” he cried. “Impossible!”

“It’s perfectly true.”

“To whom?”

“To some little actress or other.”

“I can’t believe it. Dorian is far too sensible.”

“Dorian is far too wise not to do foolish things now and then, my dear Basil.”

“Marriage is hardly something one can do now and then, Harry.”

“Except in America,” Lord Henry replied languidly. “But I didn’t say he was married. I said he was engaged to be married. There is a big difference. I have a distinct memory of being married, but I have no recollection at all of being engaged. I’m inclined to think I was never engaged.”

“But think of Dorian’s background, position, and wealth. It would be absurd for him to marry so far beneath him.”

“If you want to make him marry this girl, tell him that, Basil. He’s sure to do it then. Whenever a man does a thoroughly stupid thing, it’s always from the noblest motives.”

“I hope the girl is good, Harry. I don’t want to see Dorian tied to some vile creature who might degrade his character and ruin his intellect.”

“Oh, she is better than good—she is beautiful,” Lord Henry murmured, sipping a glass of vermouth and orange bitters.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 078 / E4_078 / condition: modernize

Original passage

—Every body so happy! and she and her partner the happiest!—"I said it would be so," was the only consolation.

Her father's feelings were quite distinct. He thought principally of Mrs. Churchill's illness, and wanted to know how she was treated; and as for the ball, it was shocking to have dear Emma disappointed; but they would all be safer at home.

Emma was ready for her visitor some time before he appeared; but if this reflected at all upon his impatience, his sorrowful look and total want of spirits when he did come might redeem him. He felt the going away almost too much to speak of it. His dejection was most evident. He sat really lost in thought for the first few minutes; and when rousing himself, it was only to say,

"Of all horrid things, leave-taking is the worst."

"But you will come again," said Emma. "This will not be your only visit to Randalls."

"Ah!—(shaking his head)—the uncertainty of when I may be able to return!—I shall try for it with a zeal!—It will be the object of all my thoughts and cares!—and if my uncle and aunt go to town this spring—but I am afraid—they did not stir last spring—I am afraid it is a custom gone for ever."

"Our poor ball must be quite given up."

"Ah! that ball!—why did we wait for any thing?—why not seize the pleasure at once?—How often is happiness destroyed by preparation, foolish preparation!—You told us it would be so.—Oh! Miss Woodhouse, why are you always so right?"

"Indeed, I am very sorry to be right in this instance. I would much rather have been merry than wise."

"If I can come again, we are still to have our ball. My father depends on it. Do not forget your engagement."

Emma looked graciously.

"Such a fortnight as it has been!" he continued; "every day more precious and more delightful than the day before!—every day making me less fit to bear any other place. Happy those, who can remain at Highbury!"

"As you do us such ample justice now," said Emma, laughing, "I will venture to ask, whether you did not come a little doubtfully at first? Do not we rather surpass your expectations? I am sure we do. I am sure you did not much expect to like us. You would not have been so long in coming, if you had had a pleasant idea of Highbury."

He laughed rather consciously; and though denying the sentiment, Emma was convinced that it had been so.

"And you must be off this very morning?"

"Yes; my father is to join me here: we shall walk back together, and I must be off immediately. I am almost afraid that every moment will bring him."

"Not five minutes to spare even for your friends Miss Fairfax and Miss Bates? How unlucky! Miss Bates's powerful, argumentative mind might have strengthened yours."

"Yes—I _have_ called there; passing the door, I thought it better. It was a right thing to do. I went in for three minutes, and was detained by Miss Bates's being absent. She was out; and I felt it impossible not to wait till she came in.

Rewritten passage

Everyone was so happy, and she and her partner were the happiest of all! "I told you it would be this way," was her only consolation.

Her father's perspective was entirely different. He was primarily concerned with Mrs. Churchill's illness and wanted to know about her medical treatment. As for the ball, he found it terrible that dear Emma was disappointed, but he felt they would all be safer at home.

Emma was ready for her visitor well before he arrived, but if that suggested he lacked impatience, his sorrowful expression and complete lack of energy when he finally appeared made up for it. He found the prospect of leaving almost too difficult to discuss. His low spirits were obvious. He sat lost in thought for the first few minutes, and when he finally roused himself, it was only to say, "Of all the terrible things, saying goodbye is the worst."

"But you will come back," Emma said. "This won't be your only visit to Randalls."

"Ah," he said, shaking his head, "the uncertainty of when I might return! I will try with all my might! It will be the focus of all my thoughts and efforts. If my aunt and uncle go to the city this spring—though I'm afraid they didn't go last spring—I fear that tradition is gone forever."

"Our poor ball must be completely called off."

"Ah, that ball! Why did we wait for anything? Why didn't we just grab the opportunity for fun? How often is happiness ruined by preparation—foolish preparation! You told us it would happen. Oh, Miss Woodhouse, why are you always so right?"

"Truly, I am very sorry to be right in this case. I would much rather have been happy than wise."

"If I can return, we are still going to have our ball. My father is counting on it. Don't forget your promise."

Emma gave him a gracious look.

"What a fortnight it has been!" he continued. "Every day was more precious and delightful than the last! Every day made me less capable of enduring any other place. How happy are those who can stay in Highbury!"

"Since you are giving us such high praise now," Emma said with a laugh, "I'll dare to ask if you didn't arrive feeling a bit doubtful at first? Don't we exceed your expectations? I'm sure we do. I'm certain you didn't expect to like us very much. You wouldn't have taken so long to visit if you had held a positive view of Highbury."

He laughed with a sense of self-awareness, and although he denied the feeling, Emma was convinced it had been true.

"And you really must leave this very morning?"

"Yes, my father is meeting me here. We will walk back together, and I must leave immediately. I'm almost afraid he will arrive at any moment."

"Not even five minutes to spare for your friends Miss Fairfax and Miss Bates? How unfortunate! Miss Bates's powerful, argumentative mind might have strengthened your own."

"Actually, I have already stopped by there. Passing the door, I thought it was the right thing to do. I went in for three minutes, but I was held up because Miss Bates was out. She wasn't there, and I felt I couldn't leave until she returned."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 079 / E4_079 / condition: simplify

Original passage

Man the sweeps—man the sweeps!”

But me and Jim was consulting—and thinking. And after we’d thought a minute, I says:

“Say it, Jim.”

So he says:

“Well, den, dis is de way it look to me, Huck. Ef it wuz _him_ dat ‘uz bein’ sot free, en one er de boys wuz to git shot, would he say, ‘Go on en save me, nemmine ‘bout a doctor f’r to save dis one?’ Is dat like Mars Tom Sawyer? Would he say dat? You _bet_ he wouldn’t! _Well_, den, is _Jim_ gywne to say it? No, sah—I doan’ budge a step out’n dis place ‘dout a _doctor;_ not if it’s forty year!”

I knowed he was white inside, and I reckoned he’d say what he did say—so it was all right now, and I told Tom I was a-going for a doctor. He raised considerable row about it, but me and Jim stuck to it and wouldn’t budge; so he was for crawling out and setting the raft loose himself; but we wouldn’t let him. Then he give us a piece of his mind, but it didn’t do no good.

So when he sees me getting the canoe ready, he says:

“Well, then, if you’re bound to go, I’ll tell you the way to do when you get to the village. Shut the door and blindfold the doctor tight and fast, and make him swear to be silent as the grave, and put a purse full of gold in his hand, and then take and lead him all around the back alleys and everywhere in the dark, and then fetch him here in the canoe, in a roundabout way amongst the islands, and search him and take his chalk away from him, and don’t give it back to him till you get him back to the village, or else he will chalk this raft so he can find it again. It’s the way they all do.”

So I said I would, and left, and Jim was to hide in the woods when he see the doctor coming till he was gone again.

CHAPTER XLI.

The doctor was an old man; a very nice, kind-looking old man when I got him up. I told him me and my brother was over on Spanish Island hunting yesterday afternoon, and camped on a piece of a raft we found, and about midnight he must a kicked his gun in his dreams, for it went off and shot him in the leg, and we wanted him to go over there and fix it and not say nothing about it, nor let anybody know, because we wanted to come home this evening and surprise the folks.

“Who is your folks?” he says.

“The Phelpses, down yonder.”

“Oh,” he says. And after a minute, he says:

“How’d you say he got shot?”

“He had a dream,” I says, “and it shot him.”

“Singular dream,” he says.

So he lit up his lantern, and got his saddle-bags, and we started. But when he sees the canoe he didn’t like the look of her—said she was big enough for one, but didn’t look pretty safe for two. I says:

“Oh, you needn’t be afeard, sir, she carried the three of us easy enough.”

Rewritten passage

"Man the oars—man the oars!"

But Jim and I were consulting and thinking. After we had thought for a minute, I said:

"Say it, Jim."

So he said:

"Well, then, this is how it looks to me, Huck. If it were him being set free, and one of the boys got shot, would he say, 'Go on and save me, never mind about a doctor to save this one?' Is that like Master Tom Sawyer? Would he say that? You bet he wouldn't! Well, then, is Jim going to say it? No, sir—I won't budge a step out of this place without a doctor; not if it takes forty years!"

I knew he was a good man at heart, and I figured he would say exactly that. Everything was settled, so I told Tom I was going for a doctor. He made a considerable fuss about it, but Jim and I stood our ground and wouldn't budge. He tried to crawl out to set the raft loose himself, but we wouldn't let him. He gave us a piece of his mind, but it didn't do any good.

When he saw me getting the canoe ready, he said:

"Well, then, if you are determined to go, I will tell you how to handle it when you get to the village. Shut the door, blindfold the doctor tightly, and make him swear to be silent as the grave. Put a purse full of gold in his hand, lead him all around the back alleys in the dark, and then bring him here in the canoe by a roundabout way through the islands. Search him and take his chalk away, and don't give it back until you get him back to the village, or else he will mark this raft so he can find it again. That is how they all do it."

I agreed, and left. Jim was to hide in the woods when he saw the doctor coming until he was gone again.

CHAPTER XLI.

The doctor was an old man; a very nice, kind-looking old man when I woke him up. I told him my brother and I were over on Spanish Island hunting yesterday afternoon and camped on a piece of a raft we found. I said that around midnight he must have kicked his gun in his sleep, because it went off and shot him in the leg. I asked him to go over there and fix it without saying anything or letting anyone know, because we wanted to come home this evening and surprise our family.

"Who is your family?" he asked.

"The Phelpses, down yonder."

"Oh," he said. After a minute, he asked, "How did you say he got shot?"

"He had a dream," I said, "and it shot him."

"A strange dream," he replied.

He lit his lantern, grabbed his saddlebags, and we started. But when he saw the canoe, he didn't like the look of it—he said it was big enough for one, but didn't look very safe for two. I said:

"Oh, you don't need to be afraid, sir; it carried the three of us easily enough."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 080 / E4_080 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

Alas! its emaciation was excessive, and not one vestige of the former being lurked in any single line of the contour. My burning glances at length fell upon the face.

The forehead was high, and very pale, and singularly placid; and the once jetty hair fell partially over it, and overshadowed the hollow temples with innumerable ringlets, now of a vivid yellow, and jarring discordantly, in their fantastic character, with the reigning melancholy of the countenance. The eyes were lifeless, and lustreless, and seemingly pupilless, and I shrank involuntarily from their glassy stare to the contemplation of the thin and shrunken lips. They parted; and in a smile of peculiar meaning, the teeth of the changed Berenice disclosed themselves slowly to my view. Would to God that I had never beheld them, or that, having done so, I had died!

The shutting of a door disturbed me, and, looking up, I found that my cousin had departed from the chamber. But from the disordered chamber of my brain, had not, alas! departed, and would not be driven away, the white and ghastly spectrum of the teeth. Not a speck on their surface—not a shade on their enamel—not an indenture in their edges—but what that period of her smile had sufficed to brand in upon my memory. I saw them now even more unequivocally than I beheld them then. The teeth!—the teeth!—they were here, and there, and everywhere, and visibly and palpably before me; long, narrow, and excessively white, with the pale lips writhing about them, as in the very moment of their first terrible development. Then came the full fury of my monomania, and I struggled in vain against its strange and irresistible influence. In the multiplied objects of the external world I had no thoughts but for the teeth. For these I longed with a phrenzied desire. All other matters and all different interests became absorbed in their single contemplation. They—they alone were present to the mental eye, and they, in their sole individuality, became the essence of my mental life. I held them in every light. I turned them in every attitude. I surveyed their characteristics. I dwelt upon their peculiarities. I pondered upon their conformation. I mused upon the alteration in their nature. I shuddered as I assigned to them in imagination a sensitive and sentient power, and even when unassisted by the lips, a capability of moral expression. Of Mademoiselle Salle it has been well said, “Que tous ses pas etaient des sentiments,” and of Berenice I more seriously believed que toutes ses dents etaient des idées. Des idées!—ah here was the idiotic thought that destroyed me! Des idées!—ah, therefore it was that I coveted them so madly! I felt that their possession could alone ever restore me to peace, in giving me back to reason.

And the evening closed in upon me thus—and then the darkness came, and tarried, and went—and the day again dawned—and the mists of a second night were now gathering around—and still I sat motionless in that solitary room—and still I sat buried in meditation—and still the phantasma of the teeth maintained its terrible ascendancy, as, with the most vivid hideous distinctness, it floated about amid the changing lights and shadows of the chamber.

Rewritten passage

Alas! Her thinness was extreme, and not a trace of her former self remained in any feature of her outline. My intense gaze finally settled upon her face.

The forehead was lofty, extremely pale, and remarkably calm; the once black hair hung partially across it, shading the sunken temples with countless curls, now a bright yellow, clashing strangely in their whimsical style with the pervasive sadness of her expression. Her eyes were dull, devoid of light, and appeared to lack pupils, causing me to recoil instinctively from their glassy gaze to examine her thin, withered lips. They parted, and in a smile of strange significance, the teeth of the transformed Berenice were revealed to me slowly. I wish to God I had never seen them, or that, having seen them, I had perished!

The sound of a closing door startled me, and looking up, I realized my cousin had left the room. Yet, from the chaotic chamber of my mind,

the white and spectral image of those teeth had not departed, nor could it be banished. Not a spot on their surface, not a blemish on their enamel, not a notch in their edges escaped being branded into my memory by that brief moment of her smile. I perceived them now even more clearly than I had then. The teeth! The teeth! They were present everywhere, visible and tangible before me; long, slender, and strikingly white, with pale lips twisting around them, just as they had appeared during that first horrific revelation. Then the full intensity of my obsession seized me, and I fought fruitlessly against its bizarre and overpowering force. Amidst the many objects of the outside world, I could think of nothing but the teeth. I craved them with a frantic intensity. All other concerns and interests were swallowed up by their singular contemplation. They alone occupied my mind, and in their solitary existence, they became the core of my mental life. I examined them in every light. I rotated them into every position. I scrutinized their features. I focused on their distinct traits. I reflected on their structure. I pondered the change in their nature. I trembled as I imagined them possessing a sensitive and sentient quality, and even when separated from the lips, a capacity for moral expression. It has been aptly remarked of Mademoiselle Salle that "all her steps were sentiments," and I believed even more earnestly of Berenice that all her teeth were ideas. Ideas! Ah, that was the foolish notion that ruined me! Ideas! Ah, that was why I desired them so desperately! I felt that only by possessing them could I regain my peace and return to sanity.

Thus the evening ended for me—and then the darkness arrived, lingered, and passed—and the day broke once more—and the mists of a second night were now collecting—yet I remained sitting still in that lonely room—still lost in thought—and still the phantom of the teeth held its terrifying dominance, as it drifted with vivid, hideous clarity amidst the shifting lights and shadows of the room.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 081 / E4_081 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

"Oh! very delightful indeed; I can say nothing less, for I suppose Miss Woodhouse and Mr. Frank Churchill are hearing every thing that passes. And (raising his voice still more) I do not see why Miss Fairfax should not be mentioned too. I think Miss Fairfax dances very well; and Mrs. Weston is the very best country-dance player, without exception, in England. Now, if your friends have any gratitude, they will say something pretty loud about you and me in return; but I cannot stay to hear it."

"Oh! Mr. Knightley, one moment more; something of consequence—so shocked!—Jane and I are both so shocked about the apples!"

"What is the matter now?"

"To think of your sending us all your store apples. You said you had a great many, and now you have not one left. We really are so shocked! Mrs. Hodges may well be angry. William Larkins mentioned it here. You should not have done it, indeed you should not. Ah! he is off. He never can bear to be thanked. But I thought he would have staid now, and it would have been a pity not to have mentioned.... Well, (returning to the room,) I have not been able to succeed. Mr. Knightley cannot stop. He is going to Kingston. He asked me if he could do any thing...."

"Yes," said Jane, "we heard his kind offers, we heard every thing."

"Oh! yes, my dear, I dare say you might, because you know, the door was open, and the window was open, and Mr. Knightley spoke loud. You must have heard every thing to be sure. 'Can I do any thing for you at Kingston?' said he; so I just mentioned.... Oh! Miss Woodhouse, must you be going?—You seem but just come—so very obliging of you."

Emma found it really time to be at home; the visit had already lasted long; and on examining watches, so much of the morning was perceived to be gone, that Mrs. Weston and her companion taking leave also, could allow themselves only to walk with the two young ladies to Hartfield gates, before they set off for Randalls.

CHAPTER XI

It may be possible to do without dancing entirely. Instances have been known of young people passing many, many months successively, without being at any ball of any description, and no material injury accrue either to body or mind;—but when a beginning is made—when the felicities of rapid motion have once been, though slightly, felt—it must be a very heavy set that does not ask for more.

Frank Churchill had danced once at Highbury, and longed to dance again; and the last half-hour of an evening which Mr. Woodhouse was persuaded to spend with his daughter at Randalls, was passed by the two young people in schemes on the subject. Frank's was the first idea; and his the greatest zeal in pursuing it; for the lady was the best judge of the difficulties, and the most solicitous for accommodation and appearance. But still she had inclination enough for shewing people again how delightfully Mr. Frank Churchill and Miss Woodhouse danced—for doing that in which she need not blush to compare herself with Jane Fairfax—and even for simple dancing itself, without any of the wicked aids of vanity—to assist him first in pacing out the room they were in to see what it could be made to hold—and then in taking the dimensions of the other parlour, in the hope of discovering, in spite of all that Mr.

Rewritten passage

"Oh! truly wonderful; I must say as much, for I imagine Miss Woodhouse and Mr. Frank Churchill are catching every word. And (elevating his tone further) I see no reason why Miss Fairfax should be excluded. I believe Miss Fairfax is an excellent dancer; and Mrs. Weston is, without question, the finest country-dance musician in England. If your companions possess any sense of gratitude, they will speak quite loudly of you and me in turn; however, I cannot wait to hear it."

"Oh! Mr. Knightley, just a second; something of importance—I am so distressed!—Jane and I are both so troubled regarding the apples!"

"What is the trouble now?"

"To think of you sending us your entire supply of apples. You mentioned having a large quantity, and now you have none remaining. We are truly so distressed! Mrs. Hodges has every right to be annoyed. William Larkins spoke of it here. You really should not have done it, you truly should not. Ah! he has departed. He cannot endure being thanked. Yet I imagined he might linger now, and it would have been a shame not to have brought up.... Well, (re-entering the room,) I have failed. Mr. Knightley cannot remain. He is traveling to Kingston. He inquired if he could assist with anything...."

"Yes," Jane replied, "we overheard his generous offers, we heard everything."

"Oh! yes, my dear, I suppose you might have, as the door was ajar, and the window was open, and Mr. Knightley spoke with a loud voice. You must have heard everything, certainly. 'Can I do anything for you at Kingston?' he asked; so I simply brought up.... Oh! Miss Woodhouse, must you leave?—You seem to have only just arrived—how very kind of you."

Emma realized it was truly time to return home; the call had already been lengthy; and upon checking their watches, they saw so much of the morning had vanished that Mrs. Weston and her friend, while departing as well, could only manage to accompany the two young ladies as far as the Hartfield gates before heading toward Randalls.

CHAPTER XI

It is perhaps possible to exist entirely without dancing. There have been cases of young individuals spending many, many months in a row without attending a ball of any kind, and no significant harm coming to their physical or mental health;—yet once a start is made—once the joys of swift movement have been experienced, however briefly—it must be a very dull group that does not desire more.

Frank Churchill had danced once in Highbury, and desired to dance again; and the final half-hour of an evening that Mr. Woodhouse was convinced to spend with his daughter at Randalls was occupied by the two young people in planning for this purpose. Frank initiated the concept; and his was the greatest enthusiasm in following it; for the lady was the better judge of the obstacles, and the most concerned for convenience and propriety. Nevertheless, she possessed enough desire to demonstrate once more how beautifully Mr. Frank Churchill and Miss Woodhouse danced—to perform that in which she need not feel ashamed to be compared with Jane Fairfax—and even for the sake of dancing itself, without any of the sinful trappings of vanity—to help him first by pacing out the room they occupied to see what it might accommodate—and then by measuring the other parlor, in the hope of finding, despite all that Mr.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 082 / E4_082 / condition: modernize

Original passage

Gardiner, though seldom able to indulge the taste, was very fond of fishing, and was so much engaged in watching the occasional appearance of some trout in the water, and talking to the man about them, that he advanced but little. Whilst wandering on in this slow manner, they were again surprised, and Elizabeth's astonishment was quite equal to what it had been at first, by the sight of Mr. Darcy approaching them, and at no great distance. The walk being here less sheltered than on the other side, allowed them to see him before they met. Elizabeth, however astonished, was at least more prepared for an interview than before, and resolved to appear and to speak with calmness, if he really intended to meet them. For a few moments, indeed, she felt that he would probably strike into some other path. The idea lasted while a turning in the walk concealed him from their view; the turning past, he was immediately before them. With a glance she saw that he had lost none of his recent civility; and, to imitate his politeness, she began as they met to admire the beauty of the place; but she had not got beyond the words "delightful," and "charming," when some unlucky recollections obtruded, and she fancied that praise of Pemberley from her might be mischievously construed. Her colour changed, and she said no more.

Mrs. Gardiner was standing a little behind; and on her pausing, he asked her if she would do him the honour of introducing him to her friends. This was a stroke of civility for which she was quite unprepared; and she could hardly suppress a smile at his being now seeking the acquaintance of some of those very people, against whom his pride had revolted, in his offer to herself. "What will be his surprise," thought she, "when he knows who they are! He takes them now for people of fashion."

The introduction, however, was immediately made; and as she named their relationship to herself, she stole a sly look at him, to see how he bore it; and was not without the expectation of his decamping as fast as he could from such disgraceful companions. That he was surprised by the connection was evident: he sustained it, however, with fortitude: and, so far from going away, turned back with them, and entered into conversation with Mr. Gardiner. Elizabeth could not but be pleased, could not but triumph. It was consoling that he should know she had some relations for whom there was no need to blush. She listened most attentively to all that passed between them, and gloried in every expression, every sentence of her uncle, which marked his intelligence, his taste, or his good manners.

The conversation soon turned upon fishing; and she heard Mr. Darcy invite him, with the greatest civility, to fish there as often as he chose, while he continued in the neighbourhood, offering at the same time to supply him with fishing tackle, and pointing out those parts of the stream where there was usually most sport. Mrs. Gardiner, who was walking arm in arm with Elizabeth, gave her a look expressive of her wonder. Elizabeth said nothing, but it gratified her exceedingly; the compliment must be all for herself. Her astonishment, however, was extreme; and continually was she repeating, "Why is he so altered?"

Rewritten passage

Mr. Gardiner, though rarely finding the time, was very fond of fishing. He was so preoccupied with watching for trout in the water and chatting with the man about them that he made very little progress. While they wandered along at this slow pace, they were surprised again—and Elizabeth's astonishment was just as great as it had been the first time—by the sight of Mr. Darcy approaching them from a short distance away. Because the path was less sheltered here than on the other side, they could see him before they actually met. Elizabeth, however surprised, was at least better prepared for an encounter than before, and she resolved to appear and speak with composure if he truly intended to approach them. For a few moments, she actually thought he might turn onto a different path. This hope lasted only while a bend in the walk hid him from view; once past the turn, he was immediately in front of them. With a quick glance, she saw that he had lost none of his recent civility. To match his politeness, she began to admire the beauty of the grounds as they met, but she had barely uttered the words "delightful" and "charming" before some unfortunate memories surfaced, and she worried that her praise of Pemberley might be misinterpreted. Her face flushed, and she said no more.

Mrs. Gardiner was standing slightly behind, and when Elizabeth paused, Darcy asked if she would do him the honor of introducing him to her friends. This was a gesture of courtesy for which she was completely unprepared, and she could barely suppress a smile at the thought of him now seeking the acquaintance of the very people whose status had once offended his pride when he proposed to her. "How surprised he will be," she thought, "when he finds out who they are! He clearly takes them for people of high social standing."

The introduction was made immediately, and as she explained their relationship to her, she stole a sly look at him to see how he handled it, half-expecting him to retreat as quickly as possible from such embarrassing company. It was obvious that he was surprised by the connection, yet he handled it with composure. Far from leaving, he turned back to walk with them and began a conversation with Mr. Gardiner. Elizabeth could not help but feel pleased and triumphant. It was comforting to know that she had relatives for whom she had no reason to feel ashamed. She listened intently to their exchange, taking pride in every remark and sentence her uncle spoke that demonstrated his intelligence, taste, or good manners.

The conversation soon shifted to fishing, and she heard Mr. Darcy invite him, with the utmost civility, to fish there as often as he liked while he remained in the area. He offered to provide him with fishing gear and pointed out the parts of the stream where the fishing was usually best. Mrs. Gardiner, who was walking arm-in-arm with Elizabeth, gave her a look of pure wonder. Elizabeth said nothing, but she was deeply gratified; the compliment was clearly meant for her. Her astonishment, however, was extreme, and she kept repeating to herself, "Why has he changed so much?"

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 083 / E4_083 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

The boy

has strong symptoms of fever upon him, and is in no condition to be talked to any more; that's one comfort. We must make the best of it; and if bad be the best, it is no fault of ours. Come in!"

"Well, master," said Blathers, entering the room followed by his colleague, and making the door fast, before he said any more. "This warn't a put-up thing."

"And what the devil's a put-up thing?" demanded the doctor, impatiently.

"We call it a put-up robbery, ladies," said Blathers, turning to them, as if he pitied their ignorance, but had a contempt for the doctor's, "when the servants is in it."

"Nobody suspected them, in this case," said Mrs. Maylie.

"Wery likely not, ma'am," replied Blathers; "but they might have been in it, for all that."

"More likely on that wery account," said Duff.

"We find it was a town hand," said Blathers, continuing his report; "for the style of work is first-rate."

"Wery pretty indeed it is," remarked Duff, in an undertone.

"There was two of 'em in it," continued Blathers; "and they had a boy with 'em; that's plain from the size of the window. That's all to be said at present. We'll see this lad that you've got upstairs at once, if you please."

"Perhaps they will take something to drink first, Mrs. Maylie?" said the doctor: his face brightening, as if some new thought had occurred to him.

"Oh! to be sure!" exclaimed Rose, eagerly. "You shall have it immediately, if you will."

"Why, thank you, miss!" said Blathers, drawing his coat-sleeve across his mouth; "it's dry work, this sort of duty. Anythink that's handy, miss; don't put yourself out of the way, on our accounts."

"What shall it be?" asked the doctor, following the young lady to the sideboard.

"A little drop of spirits, master, if it's all the same," replied Blathers. "It's a cold ride from London, ma'am; and I always find that spirits comes home warmer to the feelings."

This interesting communication was addressed to Mrs. Maylie, who received it very graciously. While it was being conveyed to her, the doctor slipped out of the room.

"Ah!" said Mr. Blathers: not holding his wine-glass by the stem, but grasping the bottom between the thumb and forefinger of his left hand: and placing it in front of his chest; "I have seen a good many pieces of business like this, in my time, ladies."

"That crack down in the back lane at Edmonton, Blathers," said Mr. Duff, assisting his colleague's memory.

"That was something in this way, warn't it?" rejoined Mr. Blathers; "that was done by Conkey Chickweed, that was."

"You always gave that to him" replied Duff. "It was the Family Pet, I tell you. Conkey hadn't any more to do with it than I had."

"Get out!" retorted Mr. Blathers; "I know better. Do you mind that time

when Conkey was robbed of his money, though? What a start that was! Better than any novel-book _I_ ever see!"

"What was that?" inquired Rose: anxious to encourage any symptoms of good-humour in the unwelcome visitors.

"It was a robbery, miss, that hardly anybody would have been down upon," said Blathers. "This here Conkey Chickweed—"

"Conkey means Nosey, ma'am," interposed Duff.

"Of course the lady knows that, don't she?"

Rewritten passage

The lad is suffering from a severe fever and is in no state to be questioned further; that is one small mercy. We must simply do what we can, and if the outcome is poor, it is not through any failing of ours. Enter!"

"Good day, sir," Blathers stated, stepping into the chamber behind his partner and securing the door before speaking further. "This was not an inside job."

"And what on earth is an inside job?" the physician asked, showing his irritation.

"We refer to a robbery as an inside job, ladies," Blathers explained, addressing them with an air of pity for their lack of knowledge, though he clearly held the doctor's ignorance in disdain, "when the household staff is involved."

"No one here suspected them," Mrs. Maylie noted.

"Quite possibly not, ma'am," Blathers answered; "yet they could have been involved regardless."

"Even more likely for that very reason," Duff added.

"We have determined it was a professional from the city," Blathers continued his summary; "the quality of the work is excellent."

"Truly impressive, indeed," Duff muttered quietly.

"There were two individuals involved," Blathers went on; "and they brought a boy along; the size of the window opening makes that clear. That is all we can say for now. We would like to examine the youth you have upstairs immediately, if you do not mind."

"Perhaps they would care for a drink first, Mrs. Maylie?" the doctor suggested, his expression lightening as if a fresh idea had struck him.

"Oh! Certainly!" Rose replied with enthusiasm. "You shall have it at once, if you wish."

"Why, thank you, miss!" Blathers said, wiping his mouth with his sleeve; "this line of work is thirsty business. Anything convenient will do, miss; please do not trouble yourself on our behalf."

"What would you like?" the doctor inquired, trailing the young woman to the sideboard.

"A small amount of spirits, sir, if it makes no difference," Blathers answered. "It is a chilly journey from London, ma'am; and I find that spirits always provide a warmer sensation."

This observation was directed at Mrs. Maylie, who accepted it with great kindness. While she attended to the request, the doctor quietly exited the room.

"Ah!" Mr. Blathers remarked, gripping his wine glass by the base between his thumb and forefinger rather than the stem, and holding it against his chest; "I have witnessed many affairs of this nature during my career, ladies."

"That break-in down the back lane at Edmonton, Blathers," Mr. Duff said, prompting his associate's recollection.

"That was similar to this, was it not?" Mr. Blathers replied; "that was the work of Conkey Chickweed, that was."

"You always credited him with that," Duff countered. "It was the Family Pet, I tell you. Conkey had no more involvement than I did."

"Nonsense!" Blathers snapped; "I know better. Do you recall when Conkey was robbed of his own cash? What a surprise that was! Better than any storybook I have ever read!"

"What was that?" Rose asked, hoping to foster a pleasant mood in their unwanted guests.

"It was a theft, miss, that hardly anyone would have suspected," Blathers said. "This fellow Conkey Chickweed—"

"Conkey means Nosey, ma'am," Duff interrupted.

"Surely the lady is aware of that, is she not?"

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 084 / E4_084 / condition: modernize

Original passage

But if they was joyful, it warn't nothing to what I was; for it was like being born again, I was so glad to find out who I was. Well, they froze to me for two hours; and at last, when my chin was so tired it couldn't hardly go any more, I had told them more about my family—I mean the Sawyer family—than ever happened to any six Sawyer families. And I explained all about how we blowed out a cylinder-head at the mouth of White River, and it took us three days to fix it. Which was all right, and worked first-rate; because _they_ didn't know but what it would take three days to fix it. If I'd a called it a bolthead it would a done just as well.

Now I was feeling pretty comfortable all down one side, and pretty uncomfortable all up the other. Being Tom Sawyer was easy and comfortable, and it stayed easy and comfortable till by-and-by I hear a steamboat coughing along down the river. Then I says to myself, s'pose Tom Sawyer comes down on that boat? And s'pose he steps in here any minute, and sings out my name before I can throw him a wink to keep quiet? Well, I couldn't _have_ it that way; it wouldn't do at all. I must go up the road and waylay him. So I told the folks I reckoned I would go up to the town and fetch down my baggage. The old gentleman was for going along with me, but I said no, I could drive the horse myself, and I druther he wouldn't take no trouble about me.

CHAPTER XXXIII.

So I started for town in the wagon, and when I was half-way I see a wagon coming, and sure enough it was Tom Sawyer, and I stopped and waited till he come along. I says "Hold on!" and it stopped alongside, and his mouth opened up like a trunk, and stayed so; and he swallowed two or three times like a person that's got a dry throat, and then says:

"I hain't ever done you no harm. You know that. So, then, what you want to come back and ha'nt _me_ for?"

I says:

"I hain't come back—I hain't been _gone_."

When he heard my voice it righted him up some, but he warn't quite satisfied yet. He says:

"Don't you play nothing on me, because I wouldn't on you. Honest injun, now, you ain't a ghost?"

"Honest injun, I ain't," I says.

"Well—I—I—well, that ought to settle it, of course; but I can't somehow seem to understand it no way. Looky here, warn't you ever murdered _at all?_"

"No. I warn't ever murdered at all—I played it on them. You come in here and feel of me if you don't believe me."

So he done it; and it satisfied him; and he was that glad to see me again he didn't know what to do. And he wanted to know all about it right off, because it was a grand adventure, and mysterious, and so it hit him where he lived. But I said, leave it alone till by-and-by; and told his driver to wait, and we drove off a little piece, and I told him the kind of a fix I was in, and what did he reckon we better do?

Rewritten passage

But if they were joyful, it was nothing compared to how I felt; it was like being born again, I was so relieved to know who I was. They stuck to me for two hours, and by the time my jaw was so tired it could barely move, I had told them more about my family—I mean the Sawyer family—than had ever happened to any six Sawyer families combined. I explained all about how we blew a cylinder-head at the mouth of the White River, and it took us three days to repair it. That worked out perfectly, because they had no idea whether it should take three days or not. If I had called it a bolthead, it would have worked just as well.

I was feeling pretty comfortable on one side, but quite uneasy on the other. Being Tom Sawyer was easy, but that feeling lasted only until I heard a steamboat chugging down the river. I thought to myself, what if Tom Sawyer is on that boat? What if he walks in here any minute and calls out my name before I can signal him to keep quiet? I couldn't let that happen; it would be a disaster. I had to head up the road and intercept him. I told the family I thought I would go into town to get my luggage. The old gentleman offered to go with me, but I said no, I could drive the horse myself, and I would rather he didn't go to any trouble for me.

I started for town in the wagon, and halfway there I saw another wagon approaching. Sure enough, it was Tom Sawyer, so I stopped and waited for him to reach me. I yelled, "Hold on!" and he pulled up alongside. His mouth dropped open like a trunk and stayed that way. He swallowed a few times like someone with a dry throat, then said, "I've never done you any harm. You know that. So, why have you come back to haunt me?"

I replied, "I haven't come back—I haven't been gone."

When he heard my voice, he seemed to recover a bit, but he still wasn't entirely convinced. He said, "Don't play any tricks on me, because I wouldn't do that to you. Honestly, now, you aren't a ghost?"

"Honestly, I'm not," I said.

"Well—I—well, that should settle it, of course; but I just can't seem to understand it. Look here, weren't you murdered at all?"

"No. I wasn't murdered at all—I faked it. Come over here and touch me if you don't believe me."

He did, and it satisfied him. He was so happy to see me again he didn't know what to do. He wanted to know the whole story immediately, because it was a grand, mysterious adventure that really appealed to him. But I told him to let it go for now, instructed his driver to wait, and we drove a short distance away so I could explain the predicament I was in and ask what he thought we should do.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 085 / E4_085 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

Referring the education to her seemed to imply it.

"Now, ma'am," said Jane to her aunt, "shall we join Mrs. Elton?"

"If you please, my dear. With all my heart. I am quite ready. I was ready to have gone with her, but this will do just as well. We shall soon overtake her. There she is—no, that's somebody else. That's one of the ladies in the Irish car party, not at all like her.—Well, I declare—"

They walked off, followed in half a minute by Mr. Knightley. Mr. Weston, his son, Emma, and Harriet, only remained; and the young man's spirits now rose to a pitch almost unpleasant. Even Emma grew tired at last of flattery and merriment, and wished herself rather walking quietly about with any of the others, or sitting almost alone, and quite unattended to, in tranquil observation of the beautiful views beneath her. The appearance of the servants looking out for them to give notice of the carriages was a joyful sight; and even the bustle of collecting and preparing to depart, and the solicitude of Mrs. Elton to have her carriage first, were gladly endured, in the prospect of the quiet drive home which was to close the very questionable enjoyments of this day of pleasure. Such another scheme, composed of so many ill-assorted people, she hoped never to be betrayed into again.

While waiting for the carriage, she found Mr. Knightley by her side. He looked around, as if to see that no one were near, and then said,

"Emma, I must once more speak to you as I have been used to do: a privilege rather endured than allowed, perhaps, but I must still use it. I cannot see you acting wrong, without a remonstrance. How could you be so unfeeling to Miss Bates? How could you be so insolent in your wit to a woman of her character, age, and situation?—Emma, I had not thought it possible."

Emma recollected, blushed, was sorry, but tried to laugh it off.

"Nay, how could I help saying what I did?—Nobody could have helped it. It was not so very bad. I dare say she did not understand me."

"I assure you she did. She felt your full meaning. She has talked of it since. I wish you could have heard how she talked of it—with what candour and generosity. I wish you could have heard her honouring your forbearance, in being able to pay her such attentions, as she was for ever receiving from yourself and your father, when her society must be so irksome."

"Oh!" cried Emma, "I know there is not a better creature in the world: but you must allow, that what is good and what is ridiculous are most unfortunately blended in her."

"They are blended," said he, "I acknowledge; and, were she prosperous, I could allow much for the occasional prevalence of the ridiculous over the good. Were she a woman of fortune, I would leave every harmless absurdity to take its chance, I would not quarrel with you for any liberties of manner. Were she your equal in situation—but, Emma, consider how far this is from being the case. She is poor; she has sunk from the comforts she was born to; and, if she live to old age, must probably sink more."

Rewritten passage

Entrusting the instruction to her appeared to suggest it.

"Now, ma'am," Jane remarked to her aunt, "shall we go find Mrs. Elton?"

"If you like, my dear. With all my heart. I am perfectly prepared. I was prepared to have departed with her, but this will serve just as well. We shall quickly catch up to her. There she is—no, that is someone else. That is one of the women from the Irish carriage group, not at all resembling her.—Well, I declare—"

They departed, trailed shortly thereafter by Mr. Knightley. Mr. Weston, his son, Emma, and Harriet remained, and the young man's mood

now climbed to a level nearly disagreeable. Even Emma eventually grew weary of the praise and gaiety, wishing instead to be strolling calmly with any of the others, or sitting nearly solitary, and entirely ignored, in peaceful contemplation of the lovely scenery below her. The sight of the attendants searching for them to announce the carriages was a welcome relief; and even the commotion of gathering and getting ready to leave, and the eagerness of Mrs. Elton to have her carriage arrive first, were patiently tolerated, in anticipation of the peaceful ride home that would conclude the highly dubious pleasures of this day of enjoyment. She hoped never to be lured into another such plan, made up of so many mismatched individuals, again.

While expecting the carriage, she discovered Mr. Knightley at her elbow. He glanced about, as if to ensure no one was nearby, and then remarked,

"Emma, I must speak to you once more as I have been accustomed to do: a right perhaps merely tolerated rather than permitted, yet I must still exercise it. I cannot watch you behaving incorrectly without a protest. How could you be so heartless toward Miss Bates? How could you be so rude in your humor toward a woman of her standing, years, and circumstances?—Emma, I had not imagined it possible."

Emma remembered, flushed, felt regret, but attempted to dismiss it with a laugh.

"Why, how could I avoid saying what I did?—No one could have avoided it. It was not that terrible. I suspect she did not grasp my meaning."

"I can confirm she did. She understood your entire intent. She has spoken of it since. I wish you could have heard how she spoke of it—with such fairness and kindness. I wish you could have heard her praising your patience, in being capable of showing her such kindness, as she was constantly receiving from you and your father, when her company must be so tiresome."

"Oh!" Emma exclaimed, "I am aware there is not a finer person in existence: but you must concede, that what is virtuous and what is absurd are most unhappily mixed in her."

"They are mixed," he replied, "I concede; and, were she wealthy, I could excuse much for the occasional dominance of the absurd over the virtuous. Were she a woman of means, I would permit every harmless folly to pass, I would not argue with you for any freedoms of behavior. Were she your peer in status—but, Emma, reflect on how far this is from being the truth. She is indigent; she has fallen from the luxuries she was accustomed to; and, if she survives to old age, must likely fall further."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 086 / E4_086 / condition: simplify

Original passage

"There was another in with Compeyson, as was called Arthur,—not as being so chrisen'd, but as a surname. He was in a Decline, and was a shadow to look at. Him and Compeyson had been in a bad thing with a rich lady some years afore, and they'd made a pot of money by it; but Compeyson betted and gamed, and he'd have run through the king's taxes. So, Arthur was a dying, and a dying poor and with the horrors on him, and Compeyson's wife (which Compeyson kicked mostly) was a having pity on him when she could, and Compeyson was a having pity on nothing and nobody.

"I might a took warning by Arthur, but I didn't; and I won't pretend I was partick'ler—for where 'ud be the good on it, dear boy and comrade? So I begun wi' Compeyson, and a poor tool I was in his hands. Arthur lived at the top of Compeyson's house (over nigh Brentford it was), and Compeyson kept a careful account agen him for board and lodging, in case he should ever get better to work it out. But Arthur soon settled the account. The second or third time as ever I see him, he come a tearing down into Compeyson's parlour late at night, in only a flannel gown, with his hair all in a sweat, and he says to Compeyson's wife, 'Sally, she really is upstairs alonger me, now, and I can't get rid of her. She's all in white,' he says, 'wi' white flowers in her hair, and she's awful mad, and she's got a shroud hanging over her arm, and she says she'll put it on me at five in the morning.'

"Says Compeyson: 'Why, you fool, don't you know she's got a living body? And how should she be up there, without coming through the door, or in at the window, and up the stairs?'

"'I don't know how she's there,' says Arthur, shivering dreadful with the horrors, 'but she's standing in the corner at the foot of the bed, awful mad. And over where her heart's broke—_you_ broke it!—there's drops of blood.'

"Compeyson spoke hardy, but he was always a coward. 'Go up alonger this drivelling sick man,' he says to his wife, 'and Magwitch, lend her a hand, will you?' But he never come nigh himself.

"Compeyson's wife and me took him up to bed agen, and he raved most dreadful. 'Why look at her!' he cries out. 'She's a shaking the shroud at me! Don't you see her? Look at her eyes! Ain't it awful to see her so mad?' Next he cries, 'She'll put it on me, and then I'm done for! Take it away from her, take it away!' And then he caught hold of us, and kep on a talking to her, and answering of her, till I half believed I see her myself.

"Compeyson's wife, being used to him, giv him some liquor to get the horrors off, and by and by he quieted. 'O, she's gone! Has her keeper been for her?' he says. 'Yes,' says Compeyson's wife. 'Did you tell him to lock her and bar her in?' 'Yes.' 'And to take that ugly thing away from her?' 'Yes, yes, all right.' 'You're a good creetur,' he says, 'don't leave me, whatever you do, and thank you!'

Rewritten passage

"There was another man with Compeyson named Arthur—not his first name, but his surname. He was suffering from a wasting disease and looked like a mere shadow. He and Compeyson had been involved in a dishonest scheme against a wealthy lady some years earlier, and they had made a great deal of money from it. However, Compeyson gambled and bet so recklessly that he would have squandered the king's taxes. Arthur was dying, penniless and tormented by hallucinations. Compeyson's wife, whom Compeyson frequently abused, tried to show Arthur pity when she could, but Compeyson felt pity for no one.

"I could have taken warning from Arthur, but I didn't, and I won't pretend I was particularly moral—for what would be the point of that, dear boy and comrade? So, I started working with Compeyson, and I was a poor tool in his hands. Arthur lived at the top of Compeyson's house near Brentford, and Compeyson kept a careful record of his debts for food and lodging, in case he ever recovered enough to pay them off. But Arthur soon settled the account. The second or third time I ever saw him, he came tearing down into Compeyson's parlor late at night, wearing only a flannel gown, his hair soaked with sweat. He said to Compeyson's wife, 'Sally, she really is upstairs with me now, and I cannot get rid of her. She is dressed all in white with white flowers in her hair. She is terribly angry, and she has a burial shroud hanging over her arm. She says she will put it on me at five in the morning.'

"Compeyson said, 'You fool, don't you know she has a living body? How could she be up there without coming through the door, or in at the window, and up the stairs?'

“‘I don’t know how she is there,’ Arthur said, shivering violently with terror, ‘but she is standing in the corner at the foot of the bed, looking furious. And over where her heart is broken—you broke it!—there are drops of blood.’

“Compeyson spoke boldly, but he was always a coward. ‘Go up with this babbling sick man,’ he said to his wife, ‘and Magwitch, give her a hand, will you?’ But he never went near the room himself.

“Compeyson’s wife and I helped him back to bed, and he raved dreadfully. ‘Look at her!’ he cried out. ‘She is shaking the shroud at me! Don’t you see her? Look at her eyes! Isn’t it awful to see her so mad?’ Next, he cried, ‘She will put it on me, and then I am finished! Take it away from her, take it away!’ He grabbed hold of us and kept talking to her and answering her, until I half believed I saw her myself.

“Compeyson’s wife, being used to his condition, gave him some liquor to calm his nerves, and eventually he quieted down. ‘Oh, she’s gone! Has her keeper come for her?’ he asked. ‘Yes,’ said Compeyson’s wife. ‘Did you tell him to lock her and bar her in?’ ‘Yes.’ ‘And to take that ugly thing away from her?’ ‘Yes, yes, all right.’ ‘You are a good creature,’ he said, ‘don’t leave me, whatever you do, and thank you!’

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 087 / E4_087 / condition: simplify

Original passage

Then I turned in, with my clothes all on; but I couldn't a gone to sleep if I'd a wanted to, I was in such a sweat to get through with the business. By-and-by I heard the king and the duke come up; so I rolled off my pallet and laid with my chin at the top of my ladder, and waited to see if anything was going to happen. But nothing did.

So I held on till all the late sounds had quit and the early ones hadn't begun yet; and then I slipped down the ladder.

CHAPTER XXVII.

I crept to their doors and listened; they was snoring. So I tiptoed along, and got down stairs all right. There warn't a sound anywheres. I peeped through a crack of the dining-room door, and see the men that was watching the corpse all sound asleep on their chairs. The door was open into the parlor, where the corpse was laying, and there was a candle in both rooms. I passed along, and the parlor door was open; but I see there warn't nobody in there but the remainders of Peter; so I shoved on by; but the front door was locked, and the key wasn't there. Just then I heard somebody coming down the stairs, back behind me. I run in the parlor and took a swift look around, and the only place I see to hide the bag was in the coffin. The lid was shoved along about a foot, showing the dead man's face down in there, with a wet cloth over it, and his shroud on. I tucked the money-bag in under the lid, just down beyond where his hands was crossed, which made me creep, they was so cold, and then I run back across the room and in behind the door.

The person coming was Mary Jane. She went to the coffin, very soft, and kneeled down and looked in; then she put up her handkerchief, and I see she begun to cry, though I couldn't hear her, and her back was to me. I slid out, and as I passed the dining-room I thought I'd make sure them watchers hadn't seen me; so I looked through the crack, and everything was all right. They hadn't stirred.

I slipped up to bed, feeling ruther blue, on accounts of the thing playing out that way after I had took so much trouble and run so much resk about it. Says I, if it could stay where it is, all right; because when we get down the river a hundred mile or two I could write back to Mary Jane, and she could dig him up again and get it; but that ain't the thing that's going to happen; the thing that's going to happen is, the money 'll be found when they come to screw on the lid. Then the king 'll get it again, and it 'll be a long day before he gives anybody another chance to smouch it from him. Of course I _wanted_ to slide down and get it out of there, but I dasn't try it. Every minute it was getting earlier now, and pretty soon some of them watchers would begin to stir, and I might get catched—catched with six thousand dollars in my hands that nobody hadn't hired me to take care of.

Rewritten passage

Then I went to bed with all my clothes on, but I could not have slept even if I had wanted to, because I was so anxious to finish the business. Before long, I heard the king and the duke come upstairs, so I rolled off my mattress and lay with my chin at the top of the ladder, waiting to see if anything would happen. Nothing did.

I waited until all the late-night sounds had stopped and the early morning ones had not yet begun, and then I slipped down the ladder.

I crept to their doors and listened; they were snoring. I tiptoed along and got downstairs safely. There was not a sound anywhere. I peeked through a crack in the dining-room door and saw the men watching the corpse fast asleep in their chairs. The door to the parlor, where the body lay, was open, and there was a candle in both rooms. I walked past, and although the parlor door was open, I saw that no one was inside except for Peter's remains, so I kept moving. However, the front door was locked, and the key was missing. Just then, I heard someone coming down the stairs behind me. I ran into the parlor and took a quick look around; the only place I could see to hide the bag was in the coffin. The lid was pushed aside about a foot, revealing the dead man's face with a wet cloth over it and his burial shroud on. I tucked the money bag under the lid, just past where his hands were crossed. Touching them made me shudder because they were so cold. Then, I ran across the room and hid behind the door.

The person approaching was Mary Jane. She went to the coffin very softly, knelt down, and looked inside. Then she raised her handkerchief, and I saw she had begun to cry, though I could not hear her, and her back was turned to me. I slipped out, and as I passed the dining room, I

decided to make sure the watchers had not seen me. I looked through the crack, and everything was fine. They had not moved.

I slipped back to bed, feeling rather sad because things had turned out that way after I had taken so much trouble and run such a risk. I thought that if the money could stay where it was, that would be fine, because when we were a hundred miles or two down the river, I could write back to Mary Jane, and she could dig him up and get it. But that is not what will happen. What will happen is that the money will be found when they come to screw the lid down. Then the king will get it again, and it will be a long time before he gives anyone another chance to steal it from him. Of course, I wanted to sneak back down and get it out of there, but I did not dare. It was getting earlier by the minute, and soon some of the watchers would begin to stir. I might get caught—caught with six thousand dollars in my hands that no one had hired me to take care of.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes:

Item 088 / E4_088 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

The door being opened, a sturdy man got out of the coach and stationed himself on one side of the steps, while another man, who had been seated on the box, dismounted too, and stood upon the other side. At a sign from Mr. Brownlow, they helped out a third man, and taking him between them, hurried him into the house. This man was Monks.

They walked in the same manner up the stairs without speaking, and Mr. Brownlow, preceding them, led the way into a back-room. At the door of this apartment, Monks, who had ascended with evident reluctance, stopped. The two men looked at the old gentleman as if for instructions.

"He knows the alternative," said Mr. Brownlow. "If he hesitates or moves a finger but as you bid him, drag him into the street, call for the aid of the police, and impeach him as a felon in my name."

"How dare you say this of me?" asked Monks.

"How dare you urge me to it, young man?" replied Mr. Brownlow, confronting him with a steady look. "Are you mad enough to leave this house? Unhand him. There, sir. You are free to go, and we to follow. But I warn you, by all I hold most solemn and most sacred, that instant will have you apprehended on a charge of fraud and robbery. I am resolute and immovable. If you are determined to be the same, your blood be upon your own head!"

"By what authority am I kidnapped in the street, and brought here by these dogs?" asked Monks, looking from one to the other of the men who stood beside him.

"By mine," replied Mr. Brownlow. "Those persons are indemnified by me. If you complain of being deprived of your liberty—you had power and opportunity to retrieve it as you came along, but you deemed it advisable to remain quiet—I say again, throw yourself for protection on the law. I will appeal to the law too; but when you have gone too far to recede, do not sue to me for leniency, when the power will have passed into other hands; and do not say I plunged you down the gulf into which you rushed, yourself."

Monks was plainly disconcerted, and alarmed besides. He hesitated.

"You will decide quickly," said Mr. Brownlow, with perfect firmness and composure. "If you wish me to prefer my charges publicly, and consign you to a punishment the extent of which, although I can, with a shudder, foresee, I cannot control, once more, I say, for you know the way. If not, and you appeal to my forbearance, and the mercy of those you have deeply injured, seat yourself, without a word, in that chair. It has waited for you two whole days."

Monks muttered some unintelligible words, but wavered still.

"You will be prompt," said Mr. Brownlow. "A word from me, and the alternative has gone for ever."

Still the man hesitated.

"I have not the inclination to parley," said Mr. Brownlow, "and, as I advocate the dearest interests of others, I have not the right."

"Is there—" demanded Monks with a faltering tongue,—"is there—no middle course?"

"None."

Monks looked at the old gentleman, with an anxious eye; but, reading in his countenance nothing but severity and determination, walked into the room, and, shrugging his shoulders, sat down.

Rewritten passage

Once the door swung open, a robust individual stepped from the carriage and took his place beside the steps, while a second man, who had been riding on the box, climbed down to stand on the opposite side. Following a gesture from Mr. Brownlow, they assisted a third man out, gripped him between them, and rushed him inside the residence. This individual was Monks.

They proceeded up the staircase in the same fashion, remaining silent, while Mr. Brownlow walked ahead to guide them into a rear chamber. At the entrance to this room, Monks, who had climbed the stairs with clear unwillingness, halted. The two men glanced toward the elderly gentleman as if awaiting his commands.

"He is aware of the choice," Mr. Brownlow stated. "Should he waver or make any move other than what you direct, haul him out to the street, summon the police, and denounce him as a criminal in my name."

"How can you speak of me in such a way?" Monks inquired.

"How can you force me to do so, young man?" Mr. Brownlow answered, meeting his gaze with a firm expression. "Are you foolish enough to attempt leaving this house? Release him. There, sir. You are at liberty to depart, and we are at liberty to pursue you. Yet I caution you, by everything I deem most grave and holy, that the very moment you do, I will have you arrested for fraud and theft. I am fixed and unyielding. If you choose to be the same, the consequences will rest entirely upon you!"

"By what right am I seized in the public street and dragged here by these curs?" Monks demanded, glancing between the two men standing at his sides.

"By my right," Mr. Brownlow replied. "Those men are protected by me. If you object to being held against your will—you possessed the strength and the chance to escape while we traveled here, yet you chose to remain passive—I repeat, seek refuge in the law. I shall also turn to the law; but once you have proceeded too far to turn back, do not beg me for mercy, as the authority will have shifted to others; and do not claim that I pushed you into the abyss you chose to enter yourself."

Monks appeared visibly unsettled and frightened. He paused.

"You must choose immediately," Mr. Brownlow declared with absolute resolve and calm. "If you desire for me to bring my accusations in public and hand you over to a penalty whose severity I can foresee with dread but cannot alter, then once again, I say, you know the path. If not, and you seek my indulgence, along with the mercy of those you have gravely harmed, take your seat in that chair without speaking. It has been prepared for you for two full days."

Monks mumbled some indistinct phrases but continued to waver.

"Be quick," Mr. Brownlow urged. "One word from me, and the other option is lost forever."

Still, the man lingered.

"I have no desire to negotiate," Mr. Brownlow said, "and, as I am representing the vital interests of others, I have no authority to do so."

"Is there—" Monks asked with a trembling voice,— "is there—no alternative?"

"None."

Monks studied the old man with a worried expression; yet, finding only sternness and resolve in his face, he stepped into the room and, with a shrug of his shoulders, took his seat.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 089 / E4_089 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

Can't you
see that _they'd_ go and tell? Ther' ain't no way but just to not
tell anybody at _all_."

"Well, maybe you're right—yes, I judge you _are_ right."

"But I reckon we ought to tell Uncle Harvey she's gone out a while,
anyway, so he won't be uneasy about her?"

"Yes, Miss Mary Jane she wanted you to do that. She says, 'Tell them to
give Uncle Harvey and William my love and a kiss, and say I've run over
the river to see Mr.'—Mr.—what _is_ the name of that rich family your
uncle Peter used to think so much of?—I mean the one that—"

"Why, you must mean the Apthorps, ain't it?"

"Of course; bother them kind of names, a body can't ever seem to
remember them, half the time, somehow. Yes, she said, say she has run
over for to ask the Apthorps to be sure and come to the auction and buy
this house, because she allowed her uncle Peter would ruther they had
it than anybody else; and she's going to stick to them till they say
they'll come, and then, if she ain't too tired, she's coming home; and
if she is, she'll be home in the morning anyway. She said, don't say
nothing about the Proctors, but only about the Apthorps—which'll be
perfectly true, because she _is_ going there to speak about their
buying the house; I know it, because she told me so herself."

"All right," they said, and cleared out to lay for their uncles, and
give them the love and the kisses, and tell them the message.

Everything was all right now. The girls wouldn't say nothing because
they wanted to go to England; and the king and the duke would ruther
Mary Jane was off working for the auction than around in reach of
Doctor Robinson. I felt very good; I judged I had done it pretty neat—I
reckoned Tom Sawyer couldn't a done it no neater himself. Of course he
would a throwed more style into it, but I can't do that very handy, not
being brung up to it.

Well, they held the auction in the public square, along towards the end
of the afternoon, and it strung along, and strung along, and the old
man he was on hand and looking his level pisonest, up there longside of
the auctioneer, and chipping in a little Scripture now and then, or a
little goody-goody saying of some kind, and the duke he was around
goo-gooing for sympathy all he knowed how, and just spreading himself
generly.

But by-and-by the thing dragged through, and everything was
sold—everything but a little old trifling lot in the graveyard. So
they'd got to work _that_ off—I never see such a giraff as the king
was for wanting to swallow _everything_. Well, whilst they was at it a
steamboat landed, and in about two minutes up comes a crowd a-whooping
and yelling and laughing and carrying on, and singing out:

"_Here's_ your opposition line! here's your two sets o' heirs to old
Peter Wilks—and you pays your money and you takes your choice!"

CHAPTER XXIX.

They was fetching a very nice-looking old gentleman along, and a
nice-looking younger one, with his right arm in a sling.

Rewritten passage

"Don't you realize they would go and report it? There is no other way except to tell absolutely nobody."

"Well, perhaps you are correct—yes, I suppose you are right."

"But I think we should inform Uncle Harvey that she has stepped out for a bit, just so he won't worry about her?"

"Yes, Miss Mary Jane requested that you do that. She said, 'Tell them to give Uncle Harvey and William my love and a kiss, and mention that I have crossed the river to visit Mr.'—Mr.—what is the name of that wealthy family your uncle Peter held in such high regard?—I mean the one that—"

"Why, you must be referring to the Apthorps, aren't you?"

"Naturally; blast those sorts of names, a person can never seem to recall them, most of the time, somehow. Yes, she said, tell them she has gone over to ask the Apthorps to be certain to attend the auction and purchase this house, because she figured her uncle Peter would prefer they had it over anyone else; and she intends to stay with them until they promise to come, and then, if she isn't too exhausted, she is returning home; and if she is, she will be back in the morning regardless. She said, don't mention the Proctors, but only the Apthorps—which will be entirely accurate, because she is going there to speak about them buying the house; I am certain of it, because she told me so herself."

"Very well," they replied, and departed to wait for their uncles, to deliver the love and the kisses, and relay the message.

Everything was settled now. The girls would remain silent because they desired to travel to England; and the king and the duke preferred Mary Jane to be away working on the auction rather than within reach of Doctor Robinson. I felt quite satisfied; I figured I had managed it rather skillfully—I reckoned Tom Sawyer could not have done it any better himself. Naturally, he would have added more flair to it, but I cannot manage that very easily, not having been raised to it.

Well, they conducted the auction in the public square, toward the end of the afternoon, and it dragged on and on, and the old man was present and looking his most venomous, standing there beside the auctioneer, and interjecting a bit of Scripture now and then, or some pious remark of some sort, and the duke was nearby acting pathetic for sympathy as best he knew how, and generally making a spectacle of himself.

But eventually the affair concluded, and everything was sold—everything except a small, insignificant plot in the graveyard. So they had to dispose of that—I never saw such a glutton as the king was for wanting to swallow everything. Well, while they were at it, a steamboat arrived, and in about two minutes a crowd came up whooping and yelling and laughing and carrying on, and shouting out:

"Here is your opposition line! Here are your two sets of heirs to old Peter Wilks—and you pay your money and you take your choice!"

CHAPTER XXIX.

They were bringing along a very respectable-looking old gentleman, and a respectable-looking younger one, with his right arm in a sling.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 090 / E4_090 / condition: modernize

Original passage

I wound up by laying my hand upon his shoulder, and saying, "I can't help confiding in you, though I know it must be troublesome to you; but that is your fault, in having ever brought me here."

Wemmick was silent for a little while, and then said with a kind of start, "Well you know, Mr. Pip, I must tell you one thing. This is devilish good of you."

"Say you'll help me to be good then," said I.

"Ecod," replied Wemmick, shaking his head, "that's not my trade."

"Nor is this your trading-place," said I.

"You are right," he returned. "You hit the nail on the head. Mr. Pip, I'll put on my considering-cap, and I think all you want to do may be done by degrees. Skiffins (that's her brother) is an accountant and agent. I'll look him up and go to work for you."

"I thank you ten thousand times."

"On the contrary," said he, "I thank you, for though we are strictly in our private and personal capacity, still it may be mentioned that there _are_ Newgate cobwebs about, and it brushes them away."

After a little further conversation to the same effect, we returned into the Castle where we found Miss Skiffins preparing tea. The responsible duty of making the toast was delegated to the Aged, and that excellent old gentleman was so intent upon it that he seemed to me in some danger of melting his eyes. It was no nominal meal that we were going to make, but a vigorous reality. The Aged prepared such a hay-stack of buttered toast, that I could scarcely see him over it as it simmered on an iron stand hooked on to the top-bar; while Miss Skiffins brewed such a jorum of tea, that the pig in the back premises became strongly excited, and repeatedly expressed his desire to participate in the entertainment.

The flag had been struck, and the gun had been fired, at the right moment of time, and I felt as snugly cut off from the rest of Walworth as if the moat were thirty feet wide by as many deep. Nothing disturbed the tranquillity of the Castle, but the occasional tumbling open of John and Miss Skiffins: which little doors were a prey to some spasmodic infirmity that made me sympathetically uncomfortable until I got used to it. I inferred from the methodical nature of Miss Skiffins's arrangements that she made tea there every Sunday night; and I rather suspected that a classic brooch she wore, representing the profile of an undesirable female with a very straight nose and a very new moon, was a piece of portable property that had been given her by Wemmick.

We ate the whole of the toast, and drank tea in proportion, and it was delightful to see how warm and greasy we all got after it. The Aged especially, might have passed for some clean old chief of a savage tribe, just oiled. After a short pause of repose, Miss Skiffins—in the absence of the little servant who, it seemed, retired to the bosom of her family on Sunday afternoons—washed up the tea-things, in a trifling lady-like amateur manner that compromised none of us. Then, she put on her gloves again, and we drew round the fire, and Wemmick said, "Now, Aged Parent, tip us the paper."

Rewritten passage

I finished by placing my hand on his shoulder and saying, "I can't help confiding in you, even though I know it must be a burden; but that is your own fault for having brought me here in the first place."

Wemmick was silent for a moment, then said with a slight start, "Well, you know, Mr. Pip, I must tell you one thing. This is incredibly kind of you."

"Then say you'll help me to be good," I said.

"Good heavens," Wemmick replied, shaking his head, "that's not my line of work."

"And this isn't your place of business," I countered.

"You're right," he answered. "You hit the nail on the head. Mr. Pip, I'll put on my thinking cap, and I believe everything you want to accomplish can be done gradually. Skiffins—that's her brother—is an accountant and agent. I'll look him up and get to work for you."

"I thank you ten thousand times."

"On the contrary," he said, "I thank you, for although we are strictly in our private and personal capacity, it's worth mentioning that there are Newgate cobwebs around, and this helps brush them away."

After a bit more conversation along those lines, we returned to the Castle, where we found Miss Skiffins preparing tea. The serious responsibility of making the toast was assigned to the Aged, and that excellent old gentleman was so focused on it that he seemed in danger of melting his eyes. It wasn't just a symbolic meal we were about to have, but a hearty reality. The Aged prepared such a haystack of buttered toast that I could barely see him over it as it sizzled on an iron rack hooked to the top bar, while Miss Skiffins brewed such a large pot of tea that the pig in the backyard became quite excited, repeatedly squealing his desire to join the party.

The flag had been lowered and the gun fired at the precise moment, and I felt as snugly cut off from the rest of Walworth as if the moat were thirty feet wide and just as deep. Nothing disturbed the tranquility of the Castle except for the occasional swinging open of the doors for John and Miss Skiffins; these small doors suffered from a mechanical glitch that made me feel sympathetically uncomfortable until I got used to it. I inferred from the methodical way Miss Skiffins handled things that she made tea there every Sunday night, and I suspected that a classic brooch she wore, depicting the profile of an unappealing woman with a very straight nose and a crescent moon, was a piece of portable property given to her by Wemmick.

We ate all the toast and drank a proportional amount of tea, and it was delightful to see how warm and greasy we all became afterward. The Aged, in particular, could have passed for a clean old chief of a savage tribe, freshly oiled. After a short rest, Miss Skiffins—in the absence of the little servant who apparently returned to her family on Sunday afternoons—washed the tea things in a casual, ladylike, amateur way that didn't inconvenience any of us. Then, she put her gloves back on, we gathered around the fire, and Wemmick said, "Now, Aged Parent, read us the paper."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 091 / E4_091 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

Finally he reached the corner of the passage that led to luckless Washington's room. For a moment he paused there, the wind blowing his long grey locks about his head, and twisting into grotesque and fantastic folds the nameless horror of the dead man's shroud. Then the clock struck the quarter, and he felt the time was come. He chuckled to himself, and turned the corner; but no sooner had he done so, than, with a piteous wail of terror, he fell back, and hid his blanched face in his long, bony hands. Right in front of him was standing a horrible spectre, motionless as a carven image, and monstrous as a madman's dream! Its head was bald and burnished; its face round, and fat, and white; and hideous laughter seemed to have writhed its features into an eternal grin. From the eyes streamed rays of scarlet light, the mouth was a wide well of fire, and a hideous garment, like to his own, swathed with its silent snows the Titan form. On its breast was a placard with strange writing in antique characters, some scroll of shame it seemed, some record of wild sins, some awful calendar of crime, and, with its right hand, it bore aloft a falchion of gleaming steel.

Never having seen a ghost before, he naturally was terribly frightened, and, after a second hasty glance at the awful phantom, he fled back to his room, tripping up in his long winding-sheet as he sped down the corridor, and finally dropping the rusty dagger into the Minister's jack-boots, where it was found in the morning by the butler. Once in the privacy of his own apartment, he flung himself down on a small pallet-bed, and hid his face under the clothes. After a time, however, the brave old Canterville spirit asserted itself, and he determined to go and speak to the other ghost as soon as it was daylight. Accordingly, just as the dawn was touching the hills with silver, he returned towards the spot where he had first laid eyes on the grisly phantom, feeling that, after all, two ghosts were better than one, and that, by the aid of his new friend, he might safely grapple with the twins. On reaching the spot, however, a terrible sight met his gaze. Something had evidently happened to the spectre, for the light had entirely faded from its hollow eyes, the gleaming falchion had fallen from its hand, and it was leaning up against the wall in a strained and uncomfortable attitude. He rushed forward and seized it in his arms, when, to his horror, the head slipped off and rolled on the floor, the body assumed a recumbent posture, and he found himself clasping a white dimity bed-curtain, with a sweeping-brush, a kitchen cleaver, and a hollow turnip lying at his feet! Unable to understand this curious transformation, he clutched the placard with feverish haste, and there, in the grey morning light, he read these fearful words:—

YE OLDE GHOSTE

Ye Onlie True and Originale Spook.
Beware of Ye Imitationes.
All others are Counterfeite.

The whole thing flashed across him. He had been tricked, foiled, and outwitted! The old Canterville look came into his eyes; he ground his toothless gums together; and, raising his withered hands high above his head, swore, according to the picturesque phraseology of the antique school, that when Chanticleer had sounded twice his merry horn, deeds of blood would be wrought, and Murder walk abroad with silent feet.

Rewritten passage

At last, he arrived at the turn in the hallway leading toward unfortunate Washington's chamber. He halted briefly, the breeze tossing his lengthy grey hair and shaping the ghastly shroud of the deceased into bizarre, twisted forms. When the clock chimed the quarter-hour, he sensed the moment had arrived. He let out a soft laugh and rounded the bend, but immediately recoiled with a mournful cry of alarm, burying his pale countenance within his skeletal fingers. Directly before him stood a terrifying apparition, still as a statue and as grotesque as a lunatic's vision. Its scalp was smooth and polished; its visage was circular, plump, and pallid, with a permanent, twisted sneer etched by some ghastly mirth. Crimson beams radiated from its eyes, its maw resembled a glowing pit, and a repulsive robe, mirroring his own, draped its massive frame in silent white. A sign rested upon its chest, covered in mysterious, archaic script—perhaps a list of disgraces, a chronicle of reckless transgressions, or a grim register of misdeeds—while its right hand brandished a shining steel blade.

Having never encountered a spirit previously, he was understandably paralyzed with fear. After one brief, panicked look at the dreadful phantom, he retreated toward his quarters, stumbling over his trailing burial garment as he hurried along the passage and inadvertently dropping his tarnished dagger into the Minister's riding boots, where the butler discovered it the next day. Safely inside his own room, he

collapsed onto a small cot and pulled the covers over his head. Eventually, though, the courageous spirit of Canterville regained its composure, and he resolved to address the other specter once daylight arrived. Thus, as the morning light began to silver the hills, he headed back to the location where he had first spotted the terrifying figure, reasoning that two ghosts were superior to one and that, with his new companion's assistance, he could successfully confront the twins. Upon arriving, however, a shocking scene greeted him. Clearly, something had befallen the phantom; the glow had vanished from its empty eye sockets, the bright blade had slipped from its grasp, and it slumped against the wall in an awkward, rigid pose. He dashed forward and grabbed it, only to be horrified when the head detached and tumbled to the ground, the torso collapsed, and he realized he was holding nothing but a white cotton bed-curtain, with a broom, a meat cleaver, and a hollowed-out turnip scattered at his feet. Baffled by this strange metamorphosis, he snatched the sign with trembling hands and, in the dim morning glow, deciphered these ominous lines:

YE OLDE GHOSTE

Ye Onlie True and Originale Spook.
Beware of Ye Imitationes.
All others are Counterfeite.

The realization hit him instantly. He had been deceived, defeated, and outplayed. The traditional Canterville expression returned to his gaze; he gnashed his toothless jaws, and lifting his shriveled arms toward the ceiling, he vowed, in the colorful language of a bygone era, that once the rooster had crowed twice, violent acts would be committed, and Murder would roam with quiet steps.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 092 / E4_092 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

'This is the portrait of Mr. W. H.,' said Erskine, with a sad smile. It might have been a chance effect of light, but it seemed to me that his eyes were quite bright with tears.

'Mr. W. H.!' I exclaimed; 'who was Mr. W. H.?'

'Don't you remember?' he answered; 'look at the book on which his hand is resting.'

'I see there is some writing there, but I cannot make it out,' I replied.

'Take this magnifying-glass and try,' said Erskine, with the same sad smile still playing about his mouth.

I took the glass, and moving the lamp a little nearer, I began to spell out the crabbed sixteenth-century handwriting. 'To the onlie begetter of these insuing sonnets.' . . . 'Good heavens!' I cried, 'is this Shakespeare's Mr. W. H.?'

'Cyril Graham used to say so,' muttered Erskine.

'But it is not a bit like Lord Pembroke,' I answered. 'I know the Penshurst portraits very well. I was staying near there a few weeks ago.'

'Do you really believe then that the sonnets are addressed to Lord Pembroke?' he asked.

'I am sure of it,' I answered. 'Pembroke, Shakespeare, and Mrs. Mary Fitton are the three personages of the Sonnets; there is no doubt at all about it.'

'Well, I agree with you,' said Erskine, 'but I did not always think so. I used to believe—well, I suppose I used to believe in Cyril Graham and his theory.'

'And what was that?' I asked, looking at the wonderful portrait, which had already begun to have a strange fascination for me.

'It is a long story,' said Erskine, taking the picture away from me—rather abruptly I thought at the time—'a very long story; but if you care to hear it, I will tell it to you.'

'I love theories about the Sonnets,' I cried; 'but I don't think I am likely to be converted to any new idea. The matter has ceased to be a mystery to any one. Indeed, I wonder that it ever was a mystery.'

'As I don't believe in the theory, I am not likely to convert you to it,' said Erskine, laughing; 'but it may interest you.'

'Tell it to me, of course,' I answered. 'If it is half as delightful as the picture, I shall be more than satisfied.'

'Well,' said Erskine, lighting a cigarette, 'I must begin by telling you about Cyril Graham himself. He and I were at the same house at Eton. I was a year or two older than he was, but we were immense friends, and did all our work and all our play together. There was, of course, a good deal more play than work, but I cannot say that I am sorry for that. It is always an advantage not to have received a sound commercial education, and what I learned in the playing fields at Eton has been quite as useful to me as anything I was taught at Cambridge. I should tell you that Cyril's father and mother were both dead. They had been drowned in a horrible yachting accident off the Isle of Wight. His father had been in the diplomatic service, and had married a daughter, the only daughter, in fact, of old Lord Crediton, who became Cyril's guardian after the death of his parents.

Rewritten passage

"This represents the likeness of Mr. W. H.," Erskine remarked, wearing a melancholy expression. Perhaps it was merely the way the light hit him, but his eyes appeared to glisten with moisture.

"Mr. W. H.!" I cried out; "who exactly was Mr. W. H.?"

"Have you forgotten?" he replied; "observe the volume his hand is placed upon."

"I notice there is some script there, yet I am unable to decipher it," I responded.

"Use this lens and attempt it," Erskine suggested, that same mournful smile still lingering on his lips.

I accepted the glass, and shifting the lamp closer, I started to decipher the difficult script from the sixteenth century. "To the onlie begetter of these insuing sonnets." . . . "Good heavens!" I shouted, "is this the Mr. W. H. of Shakespeare?"

"Cyril Graham maintained that it was," Erskine murmured.

"But it bears no resemblance to Lord Pembroke," I countered. "I am quite familiar with the portraits at Penshurst. I was visiting that area just a few weeks back."

"Do you truly hold the conviction that the sonnets were written to Lord Pembroke?" he inquired.

"I am certain of it," I replied. "Pembroke, Shakespeare, and Mrs. Mary Fitton are the trio of figures in the Sonnets; there is no question regarding that."

"Well, I concur with you," Erskine stated, "though I did not always hold that view. I once believed—well, I suppose I once believed in Cyril Graham and his hypothesis."

"And what was that?" I asked, gazing at the remarkable portrait, which had already started to exert a peculiar pull upon me.

"It is a lengthy tale," Erskine said, reclaiming the image from me—somewhat suddenly, I felt at the time—"a very lengthy tale; yet if you wish to hear it, I shall recount it for you."

"I am fond of theories concerning the Sonnets," I exclaimed; "though I doubt I shall be swayed toward any fresh perspective. The subject is no longer a puzzle to anyone. In truth, I am surprised it was ever considered a mystery."

"Since I do not subscribe to the theory, I am unlikely to persuade you of it," Erskine said, chuckling; "but it might intrigue you."

"By all means, tell me," I answered. "If it is half as charming as the painting, I shall be more than content."

"Very well," Erskine said, igniting a cigarette, "I must start by describing Cyril Graham himself. He and I were in the same boarding house at Eton. I was a couple of years his senior, yet we were close companions, sharing all our studies and recreations. Naturally, there was far more recreation than study, though I cannot claim to regret that. It is always beneficial to avoid a strictly practical education, and the lessons I gathered on the playing fields of Eton have proven just as valuable as anything I acquired at Cambridge. I should mention that Cyril's parents were both deceased. They had perished in a tragic yachting disaster near the Isle of Wight. His father had served in the diplomatic corps and had wed the daughter—the sole daughter, in fact—of the elderly Lord Crediton, who assumed the role of Cyril's guardian following his parents' passing.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 093 / E4_093 / condition: simplify

Original passage

But little time will be left me to ponder upon my destiny! The circles rapidly grow small—we are plunging madly within the grasp of the whirlpool—and amid a roaring, and bellowing, and thundering of ocean and of tempest, the ship is quivering—oh God! and—going down.

NOTE.—The “MS. Found in a Bottle,” was originally published in 1831, and it was not until many years afterwards that I became acquainted with the maps of Mercator, in which the ocean is represented as rushing, by four mouths, into the (northern) Polar Gulf, to be absorbed into the bowels of the earth; the Pole itself being represented by a black rock, towering to a prodigious height.

THE OVAL PORTRAIT

The château into which my valet had ventured to make forcible entrance, rather than permit me, in my desperately wounded condition, to pass a night in the open air, was one of those piles of commingled gloom and grandeur which have so long frowned among the Appennines, not less in fact than in the fancy of Mrs. Radcliffe. To all appearance it had been temporarily and very lately abandoned. We established ourselves in one of the smallest and least sumptuously furnished apartments. It lay in a remote turret of the building. Its decorations were rich, yet tattered and antique. Its walls were hung with tapestry and bedecked with manifold and multiform armorial trophies, together with an unusually great number of very spirited modern paintings in frames of rich golden arabesque. In these paintings, which depended from the walls not only in their main surfaces, but in very many nooks which the bizarre architecture of the château rendered necessary—in these paintings my incipient delirium, perhaps, had caused me to take deep interest; so that I bade Pedro to close the heavy shutters of the room—since it was already night—to light the tongues of a tall candelabrum which stood by the head of my bed, and to throw open far and wide the fringed curtains of black velvet which enveloped the bed itself. I wished all this done that I might resign myself, if not to sleep, at least alternately to the contemplation of these pictures, and the perusal of a small volume which had been found upon the pillow, and which purported to criticise and describe them.

Long, long I read—and devoutly, devotedly I gazed. Rapidly and gloriously the hours flew by and the deep midnight came. The position of the candelabrum displeased me, and outreaching my hand with difficulty, rather than disturb my slumbering valet, I placed it so as to throw its rays more fully upon the book.

But the action produced an effect altogether unanticipated. The rays of the numerous candles (for there were many) now fell within a niche of the room which had hitherto been thrown into deep shade by one of the bed-posts. I thus saw in vivid light a picture all unnoticed before. It was the portrait of a young girl just ripening into womanhood. I glanced at the painting hurriedly, and then closed my eyes. Why I did this was not at first apparent even to my own perception. But while my lids remained thus shut, I ran over in my mind my reason for so shutting them. It was an impulsive movement to gain time for thought—to make sure that my vision had not deceived me—to calm and subdue my fancy for a more sober and more certain gaze.

Rewritten passage

I have little time left to think about my fate! The circles are shrinking rapidly—we are plunging wildly into the grip of the whirlpool—and amidst the roaring, bellowing, and thundering of the ocean and the storm, the ship is shaking—oh God!—and sinking.

NOTE.—“MS. Found in a Bottle” was first published in 1831. It was not until many years later that I saw Mercator’s maps, which show the

ocean rushing through four openings into the northern Polar Gulf to be swallowed into the earth's core, with the Pole itself marked by a black rock of enormous height.

THE OVAL PORTRAIT

The castle that my valet had forced his way into, rather than let me spend the night outside in my severely wounded state, was one of those gloomy, grand structures that have long loomed over the Apennines, just as they appear in the stories of Mrs. Radcliffe. It seemed to have been abandoned only recently. We settled into one of the smallest, least luxurious rooms, located in a remote tower. The decorations were rich but old and worn. The walls were covered with tapestries and various coats of arms, along with many spirited modern paintings in ornate gold frames. Perhaps because I was beginning to feel delirious, I took a deep interest in these paintings, which hung not only on the main walls but also in the many nooks created by the castle's strange architecture. I told Pedro to close the heavy shutters—since it was already night—to light the candles in the tall stand by my bed, and to pull back the fringed black velvet curtains surrounding the bed. I wanted to do this so I could either sleep or spend my time looking at these pictures and reading a small book I had found on the pillow, which claimed to describe and critique them.

I read for a long, long time, and I gazed with deep devotion. The hours flew by quickly and beautifully until it was midnight. The position of the candle stand bothered me, so I reached out with difficulty, not wanting to wake my sleeping valet, and moved it to shine more light on the book.

This action had an entirely unexpected effect. The light from the many candles now fell into a corner of the room that had previously been hidden in deep shadow by one of the bedposts. I suddenly saw a painting I had not noticed before. It was a portrait of a young girl just becoming a woman. I glanced at the painting quickly and then closed my eyes. I did not immediately understand why I had done this. But while my eyes were shut, I thought about my reasons. It was an impulsive move to give myself time to think—to make sure my eyes had not tricked me—and to calm my imagination before taking a more steady and certain look.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 094 / E4_094 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

Man the sweeps—man the sweeps!”

But me and Jim was consulting—and thinking. And after we’d thought a minute, I says:

“Say it, Jim.”

So he says:

“Well, den, dis is de way it look to me, Huck. Ef it wuz _him_ dat ‘uz bein’ sot free, en one er de boys wuz to git shot, would he say, ‘Go on en save me, nemmine ‘bout a doctor f’r to save dis one?’ Is dat like Mars Tom Sawyer? Would he say dat? You _bet_ he wouldn’t! _Well_, den, is _Jim_ gywne to say it? No, sah—I doan’ budge a step out’n dis place ‘dout a _doctor;_ not if it’s forty year!”

I knowed he was white inside, and I reckoned he’d say what he did say—so it was all right now, and I told Tom I was a-going for a doctor. He raised considerable row about it, but me and Jim stuck to it and wouldn’t budge; so he was for crawling out and setting the raft loose himself; but we wouldn’t let him. Then he give us a piece of his mind, but it didn’t do no good.

So when he sees me getting the canoe ready, he says:

“Well, then, if you’re bound to go, I’ll tell you the way to do when you get to the village. Shut the door and blindfold the doctor tight and fast, and make him swear to be silent as the grave, and put a purse full of gold in his hand, and then take and lead him all around the back alleys and everywhere in the dark, and then fetch him here in the canoe, in a roundabout way amongst the islands, and search him and take his chalk away from him, and don’t give it back to him till you get him back to the village, or else he will chalk this raft so he can find it again. It’s the way they all do.”

So I said I would, and left, and Jim was to hide in the woods when he see the doctor coming till he was gone again.

CHAPTER XLI.

The doctor was an old man; a very nice, kind-looking old man when I got him up. I told him me and my brother was over on Spanish Island hunting yesterday afternoon, and camped on a piece of a raft we found, and about midnight he must a kicked his gun in his dreams, for it went off and shot him in the leg, and we wanted him to go over there and fix it and not say nothing about it, nor let anybody know, because we wanted to come home this evening and surprise the folks.

“Who is your folks?” he says.

“The Phelps, down yonder.”

“Oh,” he says. And after a minute, he says:

“How’d you say he got shot?”

“He had a dream,” I says, “and it shot him.”

“Singular dream,” he says.

So he lit up his lantern, and got his saddle-bags, and we started. But when he sees the canoe he didn’t like the look of her—said she was big enough for one, but didn’t look pretty safe for two. I says:

“Oh, you needn’t be afeard, sir, she carried the three of us easy enough.”

Rewritten passage

"Man the oars—man the oars!"

However, Jim and I were conferring and reflecting. After a moment of thought, I spoke.

"Tell me, Jim."

He replied:

"Well, then, here is how it appears to me, Huck. If it were him being liberated, and one of the boys were to be shot, would he declare, 'Proceed and rescue me, never mind a physician to save this one?' Is that like Master Tom Sawyer? Would he utter that? You can bet he would not! Well, then, is Jim going to say it? No, sir—I am not moving an inch from this spot without a doctor; not even if it takes forty years!"

I understood he possessed a noble heart, and I figured he would speak exactly as he did—so everything was settled, and I informed Tom I was departing to fetch a physician. He made quite a fuss, but Jim and I remained firm and would not yield; he attempted to crawl out and release the raft himself, but we prevented him. He then scolded us, yet it accomplished nothing.

When he observed me preparing the canoe, he remarked:

"Well, then, if you are determined to go, I will instruct you on how to proceed once you reach the town. Close the door, bind the doctor's eyes securely, and force him to swear to absolute silence. Place a purse of gold in his hand, lead him through the back alleys and everywhere in the darkness, then bring him here by canoe, taking a circuitous route through the islands. Search him and confiscate his chalk, and do not return it until you have brought him back to the village, or he will mark this raft so he can locate it again. That is the standard procedure."

I agreed, then departed, with Jim instructed to conceal himself in the woods upon the doctor's arrival until he had left.

CHAPTER XLI.

The physician was an elderly man; a very pleasant, kind-appearing gentleman once I roused him. I explained that my brother and I were hunting on Spanish Island yesterday afternoon and had camped on a section of a raft we discovered. Around midnight, he must have kicked his firearm while dreaming, causing it to discharge and wound his leg. We requested that he travel there to treat it without mentioning a word to anyone, as we intended to return home this evening to surprise our family.

"Who are your people?" he inquired.

"The Phelpses, down that way."

"Oh," he said. After a moment, he added:

"How did you say he was shot?"

"He had a dream," I answered, "and it shot him."

"A peculiar dream," he remarked.

He ignited his lantern, retrieved his saddlebags, and we set off. Upon seeing the canoe, however, he appeared uneasy—stating it was large enough for one, but did not seem particularly safe for two. I replied:

"Oh, you need not be afraid, sir; it carried the three of us easily enough."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 095 / E4_095 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

Tom stirred up the other pirates and they all clattered away with a shout, and in a minute or two were stripped and chasing after and tumbling over each other in the shallow limpid water of the white sandbar. They felt no longing for the little village sleeping in the distance beyond the majestic waste of water. A vagrant current or a slight rise in the river had carried off their raft, but this only gratified them, since its going was something like burning the bridge between them and civilization.

They came back to camp wonderfully refreshed, glad-hearted, and ravenous; and they soon had the camp-fire blazing up again. Huck found a spring of clear cold water close by, and the boys made cups of broad oak or hickory leaves, and felt that water, sweetened with such a wildwood charm as that, would be a good enough substitute for coffee. While Joe was slicing bacon for breakfast, Tom and Huck asked him to hold on a minute; they stepped to a promising nook in the river-bank and threw in their lines; almost immediately they had reward. Joe had not had time to get impatient before they were back again with some handsome bass, a couple of sun-perch and a small catfish—provisions enough for quite a family. They fried the fish with the bacon, and were astonished; for no fish had ever seemed so delicious before. They did not know that the quicker a fresh-water fish is on the fire after he is caught the better he is; and they reflected little upon what a sauce open-air sleeping, open-air exercise, bathing, and a large ingredient of hunger make, too.

They lay around in the shade, after breakfast, while Huck had a smoke, and then went off through the woods on an exploring expedition. They tramped gayly along, over decaying logs, through tangled underbrush, among solemn monarchs of the forest, hung from their crowns to the ground with a drooping regalia of grape-vines. Now and then they came upon snug nooks carpeted with grass and jeweled with flowers.

They found plenty of things to be delighted with, but nothing to be astonished at. They discovered that the island was about three miles long and a quarter of a mile wide, and that the shore it lay closest to was only separated from it by a narrow channel hardly two hundred yards wide. They took a swim about every hour, so it was close upon the middle of the afternoon when they got back to camp. They were too hungry to stop to fish, but they fared sumptuously upon cold ham, and then threw themselves down in the shade to talk. But the talk soon began to drag, and then died. The stillness, the solemnity that brooded in the woods, and the sense of loneliness, began to tell upon the spirits of the boys. They fell to thinking. A sort of undefined longing crept upon them. This took dim shape, presently—it was budding homesickness. Even Finn the Red-Handed was dreaming of his doorsteps and empty hogsheads. But they were all ashamed of their weakness, and none was brave enough to speak his thought.

For some time, now, the boys had been dully conscious of a peculiar sound in the distance, just as one sometimes is of the ticking of a clock which he takes no distinct note of.

Rewritten passage

Tom roused his fellow pirates, who dashed off with a cheer, quickly shedding their clothes to chase and wrestle in the clear, shallow water of the white sandbar. They felt no desire for the small town resting far away across the vast expanse of the river. Although a stray current or a slight swell had swept away their raft, they were pleased, viewing its departure as akin to destroying the connection to their former lives.

Returning to camp invigorated, joyful, and starving, they soon rekindled the fire. Huck discovered a nearby spring of cold, clear water, and the boys fashioned cups from large oak or hickory leaves, deciding that water with such rustic appeal was a fine replacement for coffee. As Joe prepared to slice bacon for their meal, Tom and Huck requested a brief delay; they walked to a likely spot on the riverbank and cast their lines, finding success almost instantly. Before Joe could grow restless, they returned with several fine bass, a pair of sun-perch, and a small catfish—a bounty sufficient for a large family. They fried the fish alongside the bacon and were amazed, as no fish had ever tasted so exquisite. They were unaware that freshwater fish are best when cooked immediately after being caught, nor did they fully appreciate how much appetite, outdoor exercise, swimming, and sleeping under the sky enhanced their meal.

Following breakfast, they lounged in the shade while Huck smoked, then departed on a journey to explore the woods. They marched happily over rotting logs, pushed through thick brush, and walked among the forest's towering trees, which were draped from top to bottom in hanging grapevines. Occasionally, they stumbled upon cozy clearings covered in grass and adorned with flowers.

They encountered many delightful sights, though nothing truly surprising. They determined the island spanned about three miles in length and a quarter-mile in width, separated from the nearest shore by a narrow channel barely two hundred yards across. They swam roughly every hour, so it was nearly mid-afternoon by the time they returned to camp. Too famished to fish, they feasted on cold ham before lying in the shade to converse. However, their talk soon faltered and ceased. The quiet, the heavy atmosphere of the woods, and the feeling of isolation began to weigh on their moods. They grew pensive, and a vague yearning emerged, eventually taking the form of budding homesickness. Even Finn the Red-Handed found himself picturing his doorstep and empty barrels. Yet, each felt embarrassed by this vulnerability, and none possessed the courage to voice his feelings.

For a while, the boys had been vaguely aware of a strange noise in the distance, much like the ticking of a clock that one hears without truly noticing.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes:

Item 096 / E4_096 / condition: simplify

Original passage

No signal came that night.

Morning came, eventually, and by ten or eleven o'clock a giddy and rollicking company were gathered at Judge Thatcher's, and everything was ready for a start. It was not the custom for elderly people to mar the picnics with their presence. The children were considered safe enough under the wings of a few young ladies of eighteen and a few young gentlemen of twenty-three or thereabouts. The old steam ferry-boat was chartered for the occasion; presently the gay throng filed up the main street laden with provision-baskets. Sid was sick and had to miss the fun; Mary remained at home to entertain him. The last thing Mrs. Thatcher said to Becky, was:

"You'll not get back till late. Perhaps you'd better stay all night with some of the girls that live near the ferry-landing, child."

"Then I'll stay with Susy Harper, mamma."

"Very well. And mind and behave yourself and don't be any trouble."

Presently, as they tripped along, Tom said to Becky:

"Say—I'll tell you what we'll do. 'Stead of going to Joe Harper's we'll climb right up the hill and stop at the Widow Douglas'. She'll have ice-cream! She has it most every day—dead loads of it. And she'll be awful glad to have us."

"Oh, that will be fun!"

Then Becky reflected a moment and said:

"But what will mamma say?"

"How'll she ever know?"

The girl turned the idea over in her mind, and said reluctantly:

"I reckon it's wrong—but—"

"But shucks! Your mother won't know, and so what's the harm? All she wants is that you'll be safe; and I bet you she'd 'a' said go there if she'd 'a' thought of it. I know she would!"

The Widow Douglas' splendid hospitality was a tempting bait. It and Tom's persuasions presently carried the day. So it was decided to say nothing to anybody about the night's programme. Presently it occurred to Tom that maybe Huck might come this very night and give the signal. The thought took a deal of the spirit out of his anticipations. Still he could not bear to give up the fun at Widow Douglas'. And why should he give it up, he reasoned—the signal did not come the night before, so why should it be any more likely to come tonight? The sure fun of the evening outweighed the uncertain treasure; and, boy-like, he determined to yield to the stronger inclination and not allow himself to think of the box of money another time that day.

Three miles below town the ferryboat stopped at the mouth of a woody hollow and tied up. The crowd swarmed ashore and soon the forest distances and craggy heights echoed far and near with shoutings and laughter. All the different ways of getting hot and tired were gone through with, and by-and-by the rovers straggled back to camp fortified with responsible appetites, and then the destruction of the good things began. After the feast there was a refreshing season of rest and chat in the shade of spreading oaks. By-and-by somebody shouted:

"Who's ready for the cave?"

Everybody was. Bundles of candles were procured, and straightway there was a general scamper up the hill. The mouth of the cave was up the hillside—an opening shaped like a letter A.

Rewritten passage

No signal arrived that night.

Morning came eventually, and by ten or eleven o'clock, a lively and excited group gathered at Judge Thatcher's house, ready to depart. It was not customary for older people to join these picnics. The children were considered safe under the supervision of a few young women of eighteen and young men around twenty-three. The old steam ferryboat was rented for the occasion, and soon the cheerful crowd walked up the main street carrying baskets of food. Sid was sick and had to miss the fun, so Mary stayed home to look after him. The last thing Mrs. Thatcher said to Becky was:

"You won't be back until late. Perhaps you should stay the night with one of the girls who lives near the ferry landing, child."

"Then I will stay with Susy Harper, mamma."

"Very well. And remember to behave yourself and don't be any trouble."

As they walked along, Tom said to Becky:

"Listen, I'll tell you what we'll do. Instead of going to Joe Harper's, we'll climb up the hill and stop at the Widow Douglas'. She'll have ice cream! She has it almost every day—plenty of it. And she'll be very happy to have us."

"Oh, that will be fun!"

Then Becky thought for a moment and said:

"But what will mamma say?"

"How will she ever know?"

The girl considered the idea and said hesitantly:

"I think it's wrong—but—"

"Oh, nonsense! Your mother won't know, so what's the harm? All she wants is for you to be safe; I bet she would have told you to go there if she had thought of it. I know she would!"

The Widow Douglas' generous hospitality was a tempting offer. It, combined with Tom's persuasion, eventually won her over. They decided not to tell anyone about their plans for the night. Suddenly, it occurred to Tom that Huck might come that very night to give the signal. The thought dampened his excitement. Still, he could not bear to give up the fun at the Widow Douglas'. Why should he, he reasoned—the signal did not come the night before, so why would it be more likely to come tonight? The certain fun of the evening outweighed the uncertain treasure, and, like a boy, he decided to follow his stronger desire and stop thinking about the box of money for the rest of the day.

Three miles below town, the ferryboat stopped at the mouth of a wooded valley and tied up. The crowd swarmed ashore, and soon the forest and rocky hills echoed with shouting and laughter. They tried every way to get hot and tired, and eventually, the group wandered back to camp with healthy appetites, where they began to eat the food. After the feast, there was a refreshing time of rest and conversation in the shade of the oak trees. Soon, someone shouted:

"Who's ready for the cave?"

Everyone was. Bundles of candles were gathered, and they all scrambled up the hill. The mouth of the cave was on the hillside, shaped like the letter A.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 097 / E4_097 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

Jones is going to try to spring something on the people here tonight, but I overheard him tell auntie today about it, as a secret, but I reckon it's not much of a secret now. Everybody knows—the widow, too, for all she tries to let on she don't. Mr. Jones was bound Huck should be here—couldn't get along with his grand secret without Huck, you know!"

"Secret about what, Sid?"

"About Huck tracking the robbers to the widow's. I reckon Mr. Jones was going to make a grand time over his surprise, but I bet you it will drop pretty flat."

Sid chuckled in a very contented and satisfied way.

"Sid, was it you that told?"

"Oh, never mind who it was. _Somebody_ told—that's enough."

"Sid, there's only one person in this town mean enough to do that, and that's you. If you had been in Huck's place you'd 'a' sneaked down the hill and never told anybody on the robbers. You can't do any but mean things, and you can't bear to see anybody praised for doing good ones. There—no thanks, as the widow says"—and Tom cuffed Sid's ears and helped him to the door with several kicks. "Now go and tell auntie if you dare—and tomorrow you'll catch it!"

Some minutes later the widow's guests were at the supper-table, and a dozen children were propped up at little side-tables in the same room, after the fashion of that country and that day. At the proper time Mr. Jones made his little speech, in which he thanked the widow for the honor she was doing himself and his sons, but said that there was another person whose modesty—

And so forth and so on. He sprung his secret about Huck's share in the adventure in the finest dramatic manner he was master of, but the surprise it occasioned was largely counterfeit and not as clamorous and effusive as it might have been under happier circumstances. However, the widow made a pretty fair show of astonishment, and heaped so many compliments and so much gratitude upon Huck that he almost forgot the nearly intolerable discomfort of his new clothes in the entirely intolerable discomfort of being set up as a target for everybody's gaze and everybody's laudations.

The widow said she meant to give Huck a home under her roof and have him educated; and that when she could spare the money she would start him in business in a modest way. Tom's chance was come. He said:

"Huck don't need it. Huck's rich."

Nothing but a heavy strain upon the good manners of the company kept back the due and proper complimentary laugh at this pleasant joke. But the silence was a little awkward. Tom broke it:

"Huck's got money. Maybe you don't believe it, but he's got lots of it. Oh, you needn't smile—I reckon I can show you. You just wait a minute."

Tom ran out of doors. The company looked at each other with a perplexed interest—and inquiringly at Huck, who was tongue-tied.

"Sid, what ails Tom?" said Aunt Polly. "He—well, there ain't ever any making of that boy out. I never—"

Tom entered, struggling with the weight of his sacks, and Aunt Polly did not finish her sentence.

Rewritten passage

Jones intends to reveal something to the guests this evening, though I happened to hear him mention it to Auntie earlier as a confidential matter; I suspect it is hardly a secret anymore. Everyone is aware—including the widow, despite her attempts to act otherwise. Mr. Jones

insisted that Huck be present, as he apparently could not manage his big surprise without him.

"What is the secret about, Sid?"

"About Huck following those robbers to the widow's place. I suppose Mr. Jones planned to make a grand spectacle of his announcement, but I imagine it will fall quite flat."

Sid laughed in a smug, self-satisfied manner.

"Sid, were you the one who leaked it?"

"Oh, it makes no difference who did it. Someone told—that is sufficient."

"Sid, there is only one person in this village spiteful enough for that, and it is you. If you had been in Huck's position, you would have crept away and never reported the thieves to anyone. You are incapable of anything but malice, and you cannot stand to see others commended for virtuous acts. There—do not thank me, as the widow says"—and Tom boxed Sid's ears and shoved him toward the exit with a few kicks. "Now go and inform Auntie if you have the nerve—and you will suffer for it tomorrow!"

Shortly afterward, the widow's visitors were seated for supper, with a dozen youngsters arranged at smaller tables nearby, following the customs of that region and era. At the appropriate moment, Mr. Jones delivered a brief address, thanking the widow for the honor she bestowed upon him and his sons, but noting that there was another individual whose humility—

And so the speech continued. He unveiled his secret regarding Huck's role in the event with the most theatrical flair he could muster, yet the resulting surprise was mostly feigned and lacked the boisterous enthusiasm that might have occurred under better conditions. Still, the widow performed a decent display of shock and showered Huck with so much praise and appreciation that he nearly forgot the unbearable irritation of his stiff new suit in the even worse agony of being the focus of everyone's attention and acclaim.

The widow announced her intention to provide Huck with a home and an education, and stated that once she had sufficient funds, she would help him establish a modest business. Tom saw his opening. He declared:

"Huck does not require that. Huck is wealthy."

Only a significant effort to maintain social decorum prevented the guests from offering the expected polite laughter at this humorous remark. The silence grew somewhat strained. Tom interrupted it:

"Huck possesses money. You may doubt it, but he has a great deal. Oh, there is no need to smirk—I believe I can prove it. Just give me a moment."

Tom dashed outside. The guests exchanged looks of confused curiosity—and glanced inquiringly at Huck, who remained speechless.

"Sid, what is wrong with Tom?" Aunt Polly asked. "He—well, there is simply no understanding that boy. I never—"

Tom returned, laboring under the burden of his heavy bags, and Aunt Polly left her remark unfinished.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 098 / E4_098 / condition: simplify

Original passage

I tried, therefore, to dress my food in the same manner, placing it on the live embers. I found that the berries were spoiled by this operation, and the nuts and roots much improved.

"Food, however, became scarce, and I often spent the whole day searching in vain for a few acorns to assuage the pangs of hunger. When I found this, I resolved to quit the place that I had hitherto inhabited, to seek for one where the few wants I experienced would be more easily satisfied. In this emigration I exceedingly lamented the loss of the fire which I had obtained through accident and knew not how to reproduce it. I gave several hours to the serious consideration of this difficulty, but I was obliged to relinquish all attempt to supply it, and wrapping myself up in my cloak, I struck across the wood towards the setting sun. I passed three days in these rambles and at length discovered the open country. A great fall of snow had taken place the night before, and the fields were of one uniform white; the appearance was disconsolate, and I found my feet chilled by the cold damp substance that covered the ground.

"It was about seven in the morning, and I longed to obtain food and shelter; at length I perceived a small hut, on a rising ground, which had doubtless been built for the convenience of some shepherd. This was a new sight to me, and I examined the structure with great curiosity. Finding the door open, I entered. An old man sat in it, near a fire, over which he was preparing his breakfast. He turned on hearing a noise, and perceiving me, shrieked loudly, and quitting the hut, ran across the fields with a speed of which his debilitated form hardly appeared capable. His appearance, different from any I had ever before seen, and his flight somewhat surprised me. But I was enchanted by the appearance of the hut; here the snow and rain could not penetrate; the ground was dry; and it presented to me then as exquisite and divine a retreat as Pandæmonium appeared to the dæmons of hell after their sufferings in the lake of fire. I greedily devoured the remnants of the shepherd's breakfast, which consisted of bread, cheese, milk, and wine; the latter, however, I did not like. Then, overcome by fatigue, I lay down among some straw and fell asleep.

"It was noon when I awoke, and allured by the warmth of the sun, which shone brightly on the white ground, I determined to recommence my travels; and, depositing the remains of the peasant's breakfast in a wallet I found, I proceeded across the fields for several hours, until at sunset I arrived at a village. How miraculous did this appear! The huts, the neater cottages, and stately houses engaged my admiration by turns. The vegetables in the gardens, the milk and cheese that I saw placed at the windows of some of the cottages, allured my appetite. One of the best of these I entered, but I had hardly placed my foot within the door before the children shrieked, and one of the women fainted. The whole village was roused; some fled, some attacked me, until, grievously bruised by stones and many other kinds of missile weapons, I escaped to the open country and fearfully took refuge in a low hovel, quite bare, and making a wretched appearance after the palaces I had beheld in the village.

Rewritten passage

I tried to prepare my food in the same way, placing it on the hot coals. I discovered that the berries were ruined by this, but the nuts and roots were much improved.

Food, however, became scarce, and I often spent the entire day searching unsuccessfully for a few acorns to satisfy my hunger. When I realized this, I decided to leave the place where I had been living to find somewhere where my few needs would be more easily met. During this journey, I deeply regretted the loss of the fire I had accidentally discovered, as I did not know how to start it again. I spent several hours thinking seriously about this problem, but I eventually had to give up. Wrapping myself in my cloak, I walked through the woods toward the setting sun. I spent three days wandering before I finally reached open country. A heavy snowfall had occurred the night before, and the fields were covered in a uniform white; the sight was bleak, and my feet were chilled by the cold, damp substance covering the ground.

It was about seven in the morning, and I longed for food and shelter. Eventually, I noticed a small hut on a hill, which had clearly been built for a shepherd. This was a new sight to me, and I examined the building with great curiosity. Finding the door open, I went inside. An old man sat near a fire, preparing his breakfast. He turned when he heard a noise, and upon seeing me, he shrieked loudly. He ran out of the hut and across the fields with a speed that his frail body did not seem capable of. His appearance, which was different from anyone I had ever seen,

and his flight surprised me. However, I was delighted by the hut; the snow and rain could not get inside, the ground was dry, and it seemed as wonderful and divine a retreat to me as Pandemonium appeared to the demons of hell after their suffering in the lake of fire. I greedily ate the leftovers of the shepherd's breakfast, which included bread, cheese, milk, and wine; I did not like the wine, however. Then, exhausted, I lay down in some straw and fell asleep.

It was noon when I woke up. Attracted by the warmth of the sun, which shone brightly on the white ground, I decided to continue my travels. I put the remains of the shepherd's breakfast into a bag I found and walked across the fields for several hours until I reached a village at sunset. How miraculous it looked! The huts, the tidy cottages, and the grand houses all caught my attention. The vegetables in the gardens and the milk and cheese I saw in the cottage windows tempted my appetite. I entered one of the nicer homes, but I had barely stepped inside before the children screamed and one of the women fainted. The entire village was stirred up; some people ran away, while others attacked me. After being badly bruised by stones and other objects, I escaped into the open country and fearfully took refuge in a low, empty shed that looked wretched compared to the houses I had seen in the village.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 099 / E4_099 / condition: modernize

Original passage

It will be remembered, that, in the usual version of the tales, a certain monarch having good cause to be jealous of his queen, not only puts her to death, but makes a vow, by his beard and the prophet, to espouse each night the most beautiful maiden in his dominions, and the next morning to deliver her up to the executioner.

Having fulfilled this vow for many years to the letter, and with a religious punctuality and method that conferred great credit upon him as a man of devout feeling and excellent sense, he was interrupted one afternoon (no doubt at his prayers) by a visit from his grand vizier, to whose daughter, it appears, there had occurred an idea.

Her name was Scheherazade, and her idea was, that she would either redeem the land from the depopulating tax upon its beauty, or perish, after the approved fashion of all heroines, in the attempt.

Accordingly, and although we do not find it to be leap-year (which makes the sacrifice more meritorious), she deposes her father, the grand vizier, to make an offer to the king of her hand. This hand the king eagerly accepts—he had intended to take it at all events, and had put off the matter from day to day, only through fear of the vizier,—but, in accepting it now, he gives all parties very distinctly to understand, that, grand vizier or no grand vizier, he has not the slightest design of giving up one iota of his vow or of his privileges. When, therefore, the fair Scheherazade insisted upon marrying the king, and did actually marry him despite her father's excellent advice not to do any thing of the kind—when she would and did marry him, I say, will I, nill I, it was with her beautiful black eyes as thoroughly open as the nature of the case would allow.

It seems, however, that this politic damsel (who had been reading Machiavelli, beyond doubt), had a very ingenious little plot in her mind. On the night of the wedding, she contrived, upon I forget what specious pretence, to have her sister occupy a couch sufficiently near that of the royal pair to admit of easy conversation from bed to bed; and, a little before cock-crowing, she took care to awaken the good monarch, her husband (who bore her none the worse will because he intended to wring her neck on the morrow),—she managed to awaken him, I say, (although on account of a capital conscience and an easy digestion, he slept well) by the profound interest of a story (about a rat and a black cat, I think) which she was narrating (all in an undertone, of course) to her sister. When the day broke, it so happened that this history was not altogether finished, and that Scheherazade, in the nature of things could not finish it just then, since it was high time for her to get up and be bowstrung—a thing very little more pleasant than hanging, only a trifle more genteel!

The king's curiosity, however, prevailing, I am sorry to say, even over his sound religious principles, induced him for this once to postpone the fulfilment of his vow until next morning, for the purpose and with the hope of hearing that night how it fared in the end with the black cat (a black cat, I think it was) and the rat.

Rewritten passage

As you may recall, in the standard version of these tales, a certain king, having valid reason to be jealous of his queen, not only executes her but swears an oath, by his beard and the prophet, to marry the most beautiful maiden in his kingdom each night, only to hand her over to the executioner the following morning.

Having carried out this vow for many years with a religious punctuality and methodical approach that earned him a reputation as a man of devout character and sound judgment, he was interrupted one afternoon—presumably while praying—by a visit from his grand vizier, whose daughter had come up with an idea.

Her name was Scheherazade, and her plan was to either save the land from this tax on its beauty or die, as all heroines are expected to, in

the attempt.

Accordingly, even though it was not a leap year—which makes her sacrifice even more commendable—she instructs her father, the grand vizier, to offer her hand in marriage to the king. The king eagerly accepts this offer—he had intended to take her anyway, having only delayed the matter out of fear of the vizier—but in accepting, he makes it perfectly clear to everyone that, regardless of the vizier's status, he has no intention of abandoning his vow or his privileges. Therefore, when the beautiful Scheherazade insisted on marrying the king, and actually did so despite her father's wise advice to the contrary—when she insisted on marrying him, whether he liked it or not—she did so with her beautiful black eyes as wide open as the situation allowed.

It seems, however, that this clever young woman (who had undoubtedly been reading Machiavelli) had a very ingenious plan in mind. On the night of the wedding, she managed, under some plausible pretext, to have her sister sleep on a couch close enough to the royal bed for them to converse easily. Shortly before dawn, she made sure to wake the king, her husband (who held no grudge against her, even though he planned to break her neck the next day). She managed to wake him—even though he slept soundly due to a clear conscience and good digestion—by telling a story (about a rat and a black cat, I believe) in a low voice to her sister. When day broke, the story was not quite finished, and naturally, Scheherazade could not complete it then, as it was time for her to get up and be strangled—a fate slightly less pleasant than hanging, though perhaps a bit more refined.

The king's curiosity, however, unfortunately outweighed his religious principles, leading him to postpone his vow for one day, with the hope of hearing that night how the black cat (I believe it was a black cat) and the rat fared in the end.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 100 / E4_100 / condition: modernize

Original passage

Night approached, and we were overtaken by a storm. The cabin of a small sloop lying at anchor in the stream, and laden with garden mould, afforded us the only available shelter. We made the best of it, and passed the night on board. I slept in one of the only two berths in the vessel—and the berths of a sloop of sixty or twenty tons need scarcely be described. That which I occupied had no bedding of any kind. Its extreme width was eighteen inches. The distance of its bottom from the deck overhead was precisely the same. I found it a matter of exceeding difficulty to squeeze myself in. Nevertheless, I slept soundly, and the whole of my vision—for it was no dream, and no nightmare—arose naturally from the circumstances of my position—from my ordinary bias of thought—and from the difficulty, to which I have alluded, of collecting my senses, and especially of regaining my memory, for a long time after awaking from slumber. The men who shook me were the crew of the sloop, and some laborers engaged to unload it. From the load itself came the earthly smell. The bandage about the jaws was a silk handkerchief in which I had bound up my head, in default of my customary nightcap.

The tortures endured, however, were indubitably quite equal for the time, to those of actual sepulture. They were fearfully—they were inconceivably hideous; but out of Evil proceeded Good; for their very excess wrought in my spirit an inevitable revulsion. My soul acquired tone—acquired temper. I went abroad. I took vigorous exercise. I breathed the free air of Heaven. I thought upon other subjects than Death. I discarded my medical books. “Buchan” I burned. I read no “Night Thoughts”—no fustian about churchyards—no bugaboo tales—such as this. In short, I became a new man, and lived a man’s life. From that memorable night, I dismissed forever my charnel apprehensions, and with them vanished the cataleptic disorder, of which, perhaps, they had been less the consequence than the cause.

There are moments when, even to the sober eye of Reason, the world of our sad Humanity may assume the semblance of a Hell—but the imagination of man is no Carathis, to explore with impunity its every cavern. Alas! the grim legion of sepulchral terrors cannot be regarded as altogether fanciful—but, like the Demons in whose company Afrasiab made his voyage down the Oxus, they must sleep, or they will devour us—they must be suffered to slumber, or we perish.

THE DOMAIN OF ARNHEIM

The garden like a lady fair was cut,
That lay as if she slumbered in delight,
And to the open skies her eyes did shut.
The azure fields of Heaven were ’sembled right
In a large round, set with the flowers of light.
The flowers de luce, and the round sparks of dew
That hung upon their azure leaves did shew
Like twinkling stars that sparkle in the evening blue.
—_Giles Fletcher_.

From his cradle to his grave a gale of prosperity bore my friend Ellison along. Nor do I use the word prosperity in its mere worldly sense. I mean it as synonymous with happiness. The person of whom I speak seemed born for the purpose of foreshadowing the doctrines of Turgot, Price, Priestley, and Condorcet—of exemplifying by individual instance what has been deemed the chimera of the perfectionists.

Rewritten passage

Night fell, and a storm caught us. The cabin of a small sloop anchored in the stream, filled with garden soil, provided our only shelter. We made do and spent the night on board. I slept in one of the vessel’s two berths—and the berths of a twenty-ton sloop hardly need description.

The one I used had no bedding. It was exactly eighteen inches wide, and the distance from the bottom to the deck above was precisely the same. I found it extremely difficult to squeeze inside. Nevertheless, I slept soundly, and my entire vision—for it was neither a dream nor a nightmare—arose naturally from my circumstances, my usual patterns of thought, and the difficulty I mentioned of gathering my senses and regaining my memory long after waking. The men who shook me were the sloop's crew and some laborers hired to unload it. The earthy smell came from the cargo itself. The bandage around my jaw was a silk handkerchief I had used to wrap my head, lacking my usual nightcap.

The tortures I endured, however, were undoubtedly equal for that time to those of actual burial. They were fearfully, inconceivably hideous; but out of evil came good, for their very intensity caused an inevitable reaction in my spirit. My soul regained its strength and composure. I went out. I exercised vigorously. I breathed the open air. I thought about subjects other than death. I discarded my medical books. I burned my copy of Buchan. I read no more Night Thoughts, no nonsense about graveyards, and no ghost stories like this one. In short, I became a new man and lived a man's life. From that memorable night, I dismissed my fears of the grave forever, and with them vanished the cataleptic disorder, which perhaps had been less the consequence than the cause of those fears.

There are moments when, even to the sober eye of reason, the world of our sad humanity may seem like a hell—but the human imagination is no Carathis, able to explore every cavern with impunity. Alas, the grim legion of sepulchral terrors cannot be considered entirely imaginary—but, like the demons who accompanied Afrasiab on his voyage down the Oxus, they must sleep, or they will devour us; they must be allowed to slumber, or we perish.

THE DOMAIN OF ARNHEIM

The garden like a lady fair was cut,
That lay as if she slumbered in delight,
And to the open skies her eyes did shut.
The azure fields of Heaven were 'sembled right
In a large round, set with the flowers of light.
The flowers de luce, and the round sparks of dew
That hung upon their azure leaves did shew
Like twinkling stars that sparkle in the evening blue.
—Giles Fletcher.

From his cradle to his grave, a gale of prosperity carried my friend Ellison along. Nor do I use the word prosperity in its merely worldly sense. I mean it as synonymous with happiness. The person I speak of seemed born to foreshadow the doctrines of Turgot, Price, Priestley, and Condorcet—to exemplify through an individual instance what has been considered the fantasy of the perfectionists.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 101 / E4_101 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

Then I asked if there were many clerks? to which he replied,—

“We don’t run much into clerks, because there’s only one Jaggers, and people won’t have him at second hand. There are only four of us. Would you like to see ’em? You are one of us, as I may say.”

I accepted the offer. When Mr. Wemmick had put all the biscuit into the post, and had paid me my money from a cash-box in a safe, the key of which safe he kept somewhere down his back and produced from his coat-collar like an iron-pigtail, we went upstairs. The house was dark and shabby, and the greasy shoulders that had left their mark in Mr. Jaggers’s room seemed to have been shuffling up and down the staircase for years. In the front first floor, a clerk who looked something between a publican and a rat-catcher—a large pale, puffed, swollen man—was attentively engaged with three or four people of shabby appearance, whom he treated as unceremoniously as everybody seemed to be treated who contributed to Mr. Jaggers’s coffers. “Getting evidence together,” said Mr. Wemmick, as we came out, “for the Bailey.” In the room over that, a little flabby terrier of a clerk with dangling hair (his cropping seemed to have been forgotten when he was a puppy) was similarly engaged with a man with weak eyes, whom Mr. Wemmick presented to me as a smelter who kept his pot always boiling, and who would melt me anything I pleased,—and who was in an excessive white-perspiration, as if he had been trying his art on himself. In a back room, a high-shouldered man with a face-ache tied up in dirty flannel, who was dressed in old black clothes that bore the appearance of having been waxed, was stooping over his work of making fair copies of the notes of the other two gentlemen, for Mr. Jaggers’s own use.

This was all the establishment. When we went downstairs again, Wemmick led me into my guardian’s room, and said, “This you’ve seen already.”

“Pray,” said I, as the two odious casts with the twitchy leer upon them caught my sight again, “whose likenesses are those?”

“These?” said Wemmick, getting upon a chair, and blowing the dust off the horrible heads before bringing them down. “These are two celebrated ones. Famous clients of ours that got us a world of credit. This chap (why you must have come down in the night and been peeping into the inkstand, to get this blot upon your eyebrow, you old rascal!) murdered his master, and, considering that he wasn’t brought up to evidence, didn’t plan it badly.”

“Is it like him?” I asked, recoiling from the brute, as Wemmick spat upon his eyebrow and gave it a rub with his sleeve.

“Like him? It’s himself, you know. The cast was made in Newgate, directly after he was taken down. You had a particular fancy for me, hadn’t you, Old Artful?” said Wemmick. He then explained this affectionate apostrophe, by touching his brooch representing the lady and the weeping willow at the tomb with the urn upon it, and saying, “Had it made for me, express!”

“Is the lady anybody?” said I.

“No,” returned Wemmick. “Only his game. (You liked your bit of game, didn’t you?)

Rewritten passage

I then inquired if there were many clerks, to which he answered, “We don’t employ many, as there is only one Jaggers, and clients refuse to deal with anyone else. There are just four of us. Would you care to meet them? You are, in a sense, one of us.” I agreed. After Mr. Wemmick finished mailing the biscuits and handed me my funds from a safe—retrieving the key from his coat collar like a metallic pigtail—we ascended the stairs. The building was dim and dilapidated, and the oily stains on the walls suggested years of heavy traffic. In the front room on the first floor, a clerk resembling a cross between a tavern keeper and a rat-catcher—a large, pale, bloated man—was busy with several disheveled individuals, whom he handled with the same lack of courtesy shown to everyone who paid Mr. Jaggers. “Gathering testimony,” Mr. Wemmick remarked as we exited, “for the Old Bailey.” In the room above, a small, limp clerk with unkempt hair was occupied with a weak-eyed man whom Wemmick introduced as a smelter who kept his furnace running constantly and could melt anything; the man was sweating profusely, as if he had been testing his craft on his own person. In a rear office, a man with hunched shoulders and a jaw wrapped in soiled flannel,

wearing aged black garments that looked waxed, was bent over his task of transcribing the notes of the other two for Mr. Jagger's review. This constituted the entire staff. Upon returning downstairs, Wemmick guided me into my guardian's office and noted, "You have already seen this." "Tell me," I asked, as the two repulsive casts with their twitching expressions came into view, "whose portraits are those?" "These?" Wemmick replied, climbing onto a chair and dusting off the grotesque heads before lowering them. "These are two renowned figures. Famous clients who brought us great prestige. This fellow—you must have snuck in at night and peered into the inkwell to get that smudge on your brow, you old scoundrel!—killed his master, and for someone untrained in legal matters, he planned it quite well." "Is it an accurate likeness?" I inquired, pulling back from the brute as Wemmick spat on its eyebrow and wiped it with his sleeve. "Accurate? It is the man himself. The mold was taken at Newgate immediately after he was removed from the gallows. You had a particular fondness for me, didn't you, Old Artful?" Wemmick then clarified this affectionate address by pointing to his brooch, which depicted a lady and a weeping willow beside a tomb with an urn, stating, "Had it commissioned specifically for me!" "Is the lady someone in particular?" I asked. "No," Wemmick replied. "Just his little joke. (You enjoyed your bit of fun, didn't you?)

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes:

Item 102 / E4_102 / condition: modernize

Original passage

The sergeant tossed off his glass again and seemed quite ready for another glass. I noticed that Mr. Pumblechook in his hospitality appeared to forget that he had made a present of the wine, but took the bottle from Mrs. Joe and had all the credit of handing it about in a gush of joviality. Even I got some. And he was so very free of the wine that he even called for the other bottle, and handed that about with the same liberality, when the first was gone.

As I watched them while they all stood clustering about the forge, enjoying themselves so much, I thought what terrible good sauce for a dinner my fugitive friend on the marshes was. They had not enjoyed themselves a quarter so much, before the entertainment was brightened with the excitement he furnished. And now, when they were all in lively anticipation of "the two villains" being taken, and when the bellows seemed to roar for the fugitives, the fire to flare for them, the smoke to hurry away in pursuit of them, Joe to hammer and clink for them, and all the murky shadows on the wall to shake at them in menace as the blaze rose and sank, and the red-hot sparks dropped and died, the pale afternoon outside almost seemed in my pitying young fancy to have turned pale on their account, poor wretches.

At last, Joe's job was done, and the ringing and roaring stopped. As Joe got on his coat, he mustered courage to propose that some of us should go down with the soldiers and see what came of the hunt. Mr. Pumblechook and Mr. Hubble declined, on the plea of a pipe and ladies' society; but Mr. Wopsle said he would go, if Joe would. Joe said he was agreeable, and would take me, if Mrs. Joe approved. We never should have got leave to go, I am sure, but for Mrs. Joe's curiosity to know all about it and how it ended. As it was, she merely stipulated, "If you bring the boy back with his head blown to bits by a musket, don't look to me to put it together again."

The sergeant took a polite leave of the ladies, and parted from Mr. Pumblechook as from a comrade; though I doubt if he were quite as fully sensible of that gentleman's merits under arid conditions, as when something moist was going. His men resumed their muskets and fell in. Mr. Wopsle, Joe, and I, received strict charge to keep in the rear, and to speak no word after we reached the marshes. When we were all out in the raw air and were steadily moving towards our business, I treasonably whispered to Joe, "I hope, Joe, we shan't find them." and Joe whispered to me, "I'd give a shilling if they had cut and run, Pip."

We were joined by no stragglers from the village, for the weather was cold and threatening, the way dreary, the footing bad, darkness coming on, and the people had good fires in-doors and were keeping the day. A few faces hurried to glowing windows and looked after us, but none came out. We passed the finger-post, and held straight on to the churchyard. There we were stopped a few minutes by a signal from the sergeant's hand, while two or three of his men dispersed themselves among the graves, and also examined the porch.

Rewritten passage

The sergeant downed his drink again and looked eager for another. I noticed that Mr. Pumblechook, in his hospitality, seemed to forget he had gifted the wine; instead, he took the bottle from Mrs. Joe and claimed all the credit for serving it with a burst of cheerfulness. Even I received some. He was so generous with the wine that he even called for the second bottle, serving it with the same open-handedness once the first was empty.

As I watched them gathered around the forge, enjoying themselves so thoroughly, I thought about what an effective spice for a dinner my fugitive friend on the marshes had become. They hadn't enjoyed themselves a quarter as much before the event was enlivened by the excitement he provided. Now, as they all anticipated the capture of "the two villains," the bellows seemed to roar for the fugitives, the fire to flare for them, the smoke to rush away in pursuit, Joe to hammer and clink for them, and all the dark shadows on the wall to shake in menace as the flames rose and fell, and the red-hot sparks dropped and died. In my sympathetic young mind, the pale afternoon outside almost seemed to have turned pale on their account, poor wretches.

Finally, Joe's work was finished, and the ringing and roaring ceased. As Joe put on his coat, he gathered the courage to suggest that some of us should join the soldiers to see the outcome of the hunt. Mr. Pumblechook and Mr. Hubble declined, citing a preference for a pipe and the company of the ladies, but Mr. Wopsle said he would go if Joe did. Joe agreed and said he would take me, provided Mrs. Joe approved. I am certain we never would have received permission to go if not for Mrs. Joe's curiosity to know everything about it and how it concluded. As it

was, she merely stipulated, "If you bring the boy back with his head blown to pieces by a musket, don't expect me to put it back together."

The sergeant politely took his leave of the ladies and parted from Mr. Pumblechook as if from a comrade, though I doubt he was as fully aware of that gentleman's merits when things were dry as he was when something wet was available. His men picked up their muskets and fell into line. Mr. Wopsle, Joe, and I were strictly ordered to stay in the rear and to speak not a word once we reached the marshes. When we were out in the raw air and moving steadily toward our task, I whispered treasonably to Joe, "I hope, Joe, we don't find them," and Joe whispered back, "I'd give a shilling if they had escaped, Pip."

No stragglers from the village joined us, for the weather was cold and threatening, the path was dreary, the ground was difficult, darkness was falling, and the people had warm fires indoors and were staying inside for the holiday. A few faces hurried to glowing windows to watch us pass, but no one came out. We passed the signpost and kept straight toward the churchyard. There, we were stopped for a few minutes by a signal from the sergeant's hand, while two or three of his men spread out among the graves and also checked the porch.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 103 / E4_103 / condition: modernize

Original passage

Jones is going to try to spring something on the people here tonight, but I overheard him tell auntie today about it, as a secret, but I reckon it's not much of a secret now. Everybody knows—the widow, too, for all she tries to let on she don't. Mr. Jones was bound Huck should be here—couldn't get along with his grand secret without Huck, you know!"

"Secret about what, Sid?"

"About Huck tracking the robbers to the widow's. I reckon Mr. Jones was going to make a grand time over his surprise, but I bet you it will drop pretty flat."

Sid chuckled in a very contented and satisfied way.

"Sid, was it you that told?"

"Oh, never mind who it was. _Somebody_ told—that's enough."

"Sid, there's only one person in this town mean enough to do that, and that's you. If you had been in Huck's place you'd 'a' sneaked down the hill and never told anybody on the robbers. You can't do any but mean things, and you can't bear to see anybody praised for doing good ones. There—no thanks, as the widow says"—and Tom cuffed Sid's ears and helped him to the door with several kicks. "Now go and tell auntie if you dare—and tomorrow you'll catch it!"

Some minutes later the widow's guests were at the supper-table, and a dozen children were propped up at little side-tables in the same room, after the fashion of that country and that day. At the proper time Mr. Jones made his little speech, in which he thanked the widow for the honor she was doing himself and his sons, but said that there was another person whose modesty—

And so forth and so on. He sprung his secret about Huck's share in the adventure in the finest dramatic manner he was master of, but the surprise it occasioned was largely counterfeit and not as clamorous and effusive as it might have been under happier circumstances. However, the widow made a pretty fair show of astonishment, and heaped so many compliments and so much gratitude upon Huck that he almost forgot the nearly intolerable discomfort of his new clothes in the entirely intolerable discomfort of being set up as a target for everybody's gaze and everybody's laudations.

The widow said she meant to give Huck a home under her roof and have him educated; and that when she could spare the money she would start him in business in a modest way. Tom's chance was come. He said:

"Huck don't need it. Huck's rich."

Nothing but a heavy strain upon the good manners of the company kept back the due and proper complimentary laugh at this pleasant joke. But the silence was a little awkward. Tom broke it:

"Huck's got money. Maybe you don't believe it, but he's got lots of it. Oh, you needn't smile—I reckon I can show you. You just wait a minute."

Tom ran out of doors. The company looked at each other with a perplexed interest—and inquiringly at Huck, who was tongue-tied.

"Sid, what ails Tom?" said Aunt Polly. "He—well, there ain't ever any making of that boy out. I never—"

Tom entered, struggling with the weight of his sacks, and Aunt Polly did not finish her sentence.

Rewritten passage

Jones is planning to reveal something to everyone here tonight. I overheard him telling Auntie about it earlier today as a secret, but I don't think it's much of a secret anymore. Everyone knows—even the Widow, despite her pretending she doesn't. Mr. Jones insisted that Huck be

here; he couldn't manage his big surprise without Huck, you know!"

"Secret about what, Sid?"

"About Huck tracking the robbers to the Widow's house. I suppose Mr. Jones intended to make a big deal out of his surprise, but I bet it falls pretty flat."

Sid chuckled in a very smug and satisfied way.

"Sid, were you the one who told?"

"Oh, never mind who it was. Someone told—that's enough."

"Sid, there's only one person in this town mean enough to do that, and that's you. If you had been in Huck's place, you would have sneaked down the hill and never told anyone about the robbers. You can't do anything but mean things, and you can't stand to see anyone praised for doing good ones. There—no thanks, as the Widow says"—and Tom cuffed Sid's ears and helped him to the door with several kicks. "Now go and tell Auntie if you dare—and tomorrow you'll get what's coming to you!"

Some minutes later, the Widow's guests were at the dinner table, and a dozen children were propped up at little side tables in the same room, following the custom of that region and era. At the appropriate moment, Mr. Jones made his short speech, in which he thanked the Widow for the honor she was showing him and his sons, but noted that there was another person whose modesty—

And so on. He revealed his secret about Huck's role in the adventure with the most dramatic flair he could muster, but the surprise it caused was largely feigned and not as loud or enthusiastic as it might have been under better circumstances. Still, the Widow put on a decent show of astonishment and heaped so many compliments and so much gratitude upon Huck that he almost forgot the nearly intolerable discomfort of his new clothes in the entirely intolerable discomfort of being a target for everyone's gaze and praise.

The Widow said she intended to give Huck a home under her roof and have him educated; and that when she could spare the money, she would help him start a business in a modest way. Tom's chance had arrived. He said:

"Huck doesn't need it. Huck's rich."

Only a heavy strain on the guests' good manners kept back the expected polite laugh at this joke. But the silence was a little awkward. Tom broke it:

"Huck has money. Maybe you don't believe it, but he has plenty of it. Oh, you don't need to smile—I think I can prove it to you. Just wait a minute."

Tom ran outside. The company looked at each other with perplexed interest—and inquiringly at Huck, who was speechless.

"Sid, what is wrong with Tom?" said Aunt Polly. "He—well, there is just no understanding that boy. I never—"

Tom entered, struggling with the weight of his sacks, and Aunt Polly did not finish her sentence.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 104 / E4_104 / condition: modernize

Original passage

The perplexity and dissatisfaction of the house expressed itself in murmurs and provoked a reproof from the bench. Counsel for the prosecution now said:

"By the oaths of citizens whose simple word is above suspicion, we have fastened this awful crime, beyond all possibility of question, upon the unhappy prisoner at the bar. We rest our case here."

A groan escaped from poor Potter, and he put his face in his hands and rocked his body softly to and fro, while a painful silence reigned in the courtroom. Many men were moved, and many women's compassion testified itself in tears. Counsel for the defence rose and said:

"Your honor, in our remarks at the opening of this trial, we foreshadowed our purpose to prove that our client did this fearful deed while under the influence of a blind and irresponsible delirium produced by drink. We have changed our mind. We shall not offer that plea." [Then to the clerk:] "Call Thomas Sawyer!"

A puzzled amazement awoke in every face in the house, not even excepting Potter's. Every eye fastened itself with wondering interest upon Tom as he rose and took his place upon the stand. The boy looked wild enough, for he was badly scared. The oath was administered.

"Thomas Sawyer, where were you on the seventeenth of June, about the hour of midnight?"

Tom glanced at Injun Joe's iron face and his tongue failed him. The audience listened breathless, but the words refused to come. After a few moments, however, the boy got a little of his strength back, and managed to put enough of it into his voice to make part of the house hear:

"In the graveyard!"

"A little bit louder, please. Don't be afraid. You were—"

"In the graveyard."

A contemptuous smile flitted across Injun Joe's face.

"Were you anywhere near Horse Williams' grave?"

"Yes, sir."

"Speak up—just a trifle louder. How near were you?"

"Near as I am to you."

"Were you hidden, or not?"

"I was hid."

"Where?"

"Behind the elms that's on the edge of the grave."

Injun Joe gave a barely perceptible start.

"Any one with you?"

"Yes, sir. I went there with—"

"Wait—wait a moment. Never mind mentioning your companion's name. We will produce him at the proper time. Did you carry anything there with you."

Tom hesitated and looked confused.

"Speak out, my boy—don't be diffident. The truth is always respectable. What did you take there?"

"Only a—a—dead cat."

There was a ripple of mirth, which the court checked.

"We will produce the skeleton of that cat. Now, my boy, tell us everything that occurred—tell it in your own way—don't skip anything, and don't be afraid."

Tom began—hesitatingly at first, but as he warmed to his subject his words flowed more and more easily; in a little while every sound ceased but his own voice; every eye fixed itself upon him; with parted lips and bated breath the audience hung upon his words, taking no note of time, rapt in the ghastly fascinations of the tale. The strain upon pent emotion reached its climax when the boy said:

"—and as the doctor fetched the board around and Muff Potter fell, Injun Joe jumped with the knife and—"

Crash! Quick as lightning the halfbreed sprang for a window, tore his way through all opposers, and was gone!

Rewritten passage

The confusion and frustration in the room broke out into murmurs, prompting a reprimand from the judge. The prosecutor then stated:

"Through the testimony of citizens whose integrity is beyond doubt, we have proven this horrific crime, without any room for question, against the unfortunate prisoner. We rest our case."

A groan escaped poor Potter, who buried his face in his hands and rocked gently back and forth, while a painful silence filled the courtroom. Many men were moved, and many women showed their compassion through tears. The defense attorney stood and said:

"Your honor, in our opening remarks, we indicated our intent to prove that our client committed this terrible act while suffering from a blind, uncontrollable delirium caused by alcohol. We have changed our minds. We will not pursue that defense." [Then to the clerk:] "Call Thomas Sawyer!"

Confused amazement appeared on every face in the room, including Potter's. Every eye fixed on Tom with curious interest as he stood and took his place on the witness stand. The boy looked frantic, as he was terrified. He was sworn in.

"Thomas Sawyer, where were you on the seventeenth of June, around midnight?"

Tom glanced at Injun Joe's stoic face, and his voice failed him. The audience listened breathlessly, but the words would not come. After a few moments, however, the boy regained some composure and managed to speak loudly enough for part of the room to hear:

"In the graveyard!"

"A little louder, please. Don't be afraid. You were—"

"In the graveyard."

A mocking smile crossed Injun Joe's face.

"Were you anywhere near Horse Williams' grave?"

"Yes, sir."

"Speak up—just a bit louder. How close were you?"

"As close as I am to you."

"Were you hidden, or not?"

"I was hidden."

"Where?"

"Behind the elm trees at the edge of the grave."

Injun Joe flinched almost imperceptibly.

"Was anyone with you?"

"Yes, sir. I went there with—"

"Wait—wait a moment. Never mind mentioning your companion's name. We will produce him at the right time. Did you bring anything with you?"

Tom hesitated and looked confused.

"Speak up, my boy—don't be shy. The truth is always respectable. What did you take there?"

"Only a—a—dead cat."

A ripple of laughter broke out, which the court quickly silenced.

"We will produce the remains of that cat. Now, my boy, tell us everything that happened—tell it in your own words—don't leave anything out, and don't be afraid."

Tom began—hesitantly at first, but as he got into the story, his words flowed more easily. Soon, every sound ceased except for his voice; every eye was fixed on him. With parted lips and bated breath, the audience hung on his words, losing track of time, captivated by the gruesome details. The tension reached its peak when the boy said:

"—and as the doctor swung the board around and Muff Potter fell, Injun Joe jumped with the knife and—"

Crash! Quick as lightning, the half-breed lunged for a window, shoved his way through everyone in his path, and was gone!

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 105 / E4_105 / condition: simplify

Original passage

She was always a heroine. The last night she played—the night you saw her—she acted badly because she had known the reality of love. When she knew its unreality, she died, as Juliet might have died. She passed again into the sphere of art. There is something of the martyr about her. Her death has all the pathetic uselessness of martyrdom, all its wasted beauty. But, as I was saying, you must not think I have not suffered. If you had come in yesterday at a particular moment—about half-past five, perhaps, or a quarter to six—you would have found me in tears. Even Harry, who was here, who brought me the news, in fact, had no idea what I was going through. I suffered immensely. Then it passed away. I cannot repeat an emotion. No one can, except sentimentalists. And you are awfully unjust, Basil. You come down here to console me. That is charming of you. You find me consoled, and you are furious. How like a sympathetic person! You remind me of a story Harry told me about a certain philanthropist who spent twenty years of his life in trying to get some grievance redressed, or some unjust law altered—I forget exactly what it was. Finally he succeeded, and nothing could exceed his disappointment. He had absolutely nothing to do, almost died of _ennui_, and became a confirmed misanthrope. And besides, my dear old Basil, if you really want to console me, teach me rather to forget what has happened, or to see it from a proper artistic point of view. Was it not Gautier who used to write about _la consolation des arts_? I remember picking up a little vellum-covered book in your studio one day and chancing on that delightful phrase. Well, I am not like that young man you told me of when we were down at Marlow together, the young man who used to say that yellow satin could console one for all the miseries of life. I love beautiful things that one can touch and handle. Old brocades, green bronzes, lacquer-work, carved ivories, exquisite surroundings, luxury, pomp—there is much to be got from all these. But the artistic temperament that they create, or at any rate reveal, is still more to me. To become the spectator of one's own life, as Harry says, is to escape the suffering of life. I know you are surprised at my talking to you like this. You have not realized how I have developed. I was a schoolboy when you knew me. I am a man now. I have new passions, new thoughts, new ideas. I am different, but you must not like me less. I am changed, but you must always be my friend. Of course, I am very fond of Harry. But I know that you are better than he is. You are not stronger—you are too much afraid of life—but you are better. And how happy we used to be together! Don't leave me, Basil, and don't quarrel with me. I am what I am. There is nothing more to be said."

The painter felt strangely moved. The lad was infinitely dear to him, and his personality had been the great turning point in his art.

Rewritten passage

She was always a heroine. The final night she performed—the night you saw her—she acted poorly because she had experienced the reality of love. Once she realized its unreality, she died, just as Juliet might have. She returned to the realm of art. There is a touch of the martyr about her. Her death possesses all the pathetic uselessness of martyrdom, all its wasted beauty. But, as I was saying, you must not think I have not suffered. If you had arrived yesterday at a certain moment—perhaps around five-thirty or a quarter to six—you would have found me in tears. Even Harry, who was here and actually brought me the news, had no idea what I was enduring. I suffered immensely. Then, the feeling passed. I cannot repeat an emotion. No one can, except for sentimentalists. And you are terribly unfair, Basil. You come here to comfort me. That is charming of you. You find me already comforted, and you are furious. How typical of a sympathetic person! You remind me of a story Harry told me about a philanthropist who spent twenty years of his life trying to fix a grievance or change an unjust law—I forget exactly what it was. Finally, he succeeded, and his disappointment was total. He had nothing left to do, nearly died of boredom, and became a bitter misanthrope. Besides, my dear old Basil, if you truly want to comfort me, teach me to forget what has happened or to view it from a proper artistic perspective. Was it not Gautier who wrote about the consolation of the arts? I remember finding a small vellum-covered book in your studio one day and noticing that delightful phrase. Well, I am not like that young man you told me about when we were at Marlow, the one who claimed that yellow satin could console a person for all the miseries of life. I love beautiful things that one can touch and handle. Old brocades, green bronzes, lacquer-work, carved ivories, exquisite surroundings, luxury, and pomp—there is much to be gained from all these. But the artistic temperament they create, or at least reveal, means even more to me. To become a spectator of one's own life, as Harry says, is to escape the suffering of life. I know you are surprised to hear me talk like this. You have not realized how I have grown. I was a schoolboy when you knew me. I am a man now. I have new passions, new thoughts, and new ideas. I am different, but you must not like me any less. I have changed, but you must always be my friend. Of course, I am very fond of Harry. But I know that you are a better person than he is. You are not stronger—you are too afraid of life—but you are better. And how happy we used to be together! Do not leave me, Basil, and do not quarrel with me. I am who I am. There is nothing more to be said.

The painter felt strangely moved. The young man was infinitely dear to him, and his personality had been the great turning point in his art.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes:

Item 106 / E4_106 / condition: modernize

Original passage

and he wandered away a dismantled hero.

Shortly Tom came upon the juvenile pariah of the village, Huckleberry Finn, son of the town drunkard. Huckleberry was cordially hated and dreaded by all the mothers of the town, because he was idle and lawless and vulgar and bad—and because all their children admired him so, and delighted in his forbidden society, and wished they dared to be like him. Tom was like the rest of the respectable boys, in that he envied Huckleberry his gaudy outcast condition, and was under strict orders not to play with him. So he played with him every time he got a chance. Huckleberry was always dressed in the cast-off clothes of full-grown men, and they were in perennial bloom and fluttering with rags. His hat was a vast ruin with a wide crescent lopped out of its brim; his coat, when he wore one, hung nearly to his heels and had the rearward buttons far down the back; but one suspender supported his trousers; the seat of the trousers bagged low and contained nothing, the fringed legs dragged in the dirt when not rolled up.

Huckleberry came and went, at his own free will. He slept on doorsteps in fine weather and in empty hogsheads in wet; he did not have to go to school or to church, or call any being master or obey anybody; he could go fishing or swimming when and where he chose, and stay as long as it suited him; nobody forbade him to fight; he could sit up as late as he pleased; he was always the first boy that went barefoot in the spring and the last to resume leather in the fall; he never had to wash, nor put on clean clothes; he could swear wonderfully. In a word, everything that goes to make life precious that boy had. So thought every harassed, hampered, respectable boy in St. Petersburg.

Tom hailed the romantic outcast:

“Hello, Huckleberry!”

“Hello yourself, and see how you like it.”

“What’s that you got?”

“Dead cat.”

“Lemme see him, Huck. My, he’s pretty stiff. Where’d you get him?”

“Bought him off’n a boy.”

“What did you give?”

“I give a blue ticket and a bladder that I got at the slaughter-house.”

“Where’d you get the blue ticket?”

“Bought it off’n Ben Rogers two weeks ago for a hoop-stick.”

“Say—what is dead cats good for, Huck?”

“Good for? Cure warts with.”

“No! Is that so? I know something that’s better.”

“I bet you don’t. What is it?”

“Why, spunk-water.”

“Spunk-water! I wouldn’t give a dern for spunk-water.”

“You wouldn’t, wouldn’t you? D’you ever try it?”

“No, I hain’t. But Bob Tanner did.”

“Who told you so!”

"Why, he told Jeff Thatcher, and Jeff told Johnny Baker, and Johnny told Jim Hollis, and Jim told Ben Rogers, and Ben told a nigger, and the nigger told me. There now!"

"Well, what of it? They'll all lie. Leastways all but the nigger. I don't know _him_. But I never see a nigger that _wouldn't_ lie. Shucks! Now you tell me how Bob Tanner done it, Huck."

"Why, he took and dipped his hand in a rotten stump where the rain-water was."

"In the daytime?"

"Certainly."

"With his face to the stump?"

"Yes. Least I reckon so."

Rewritten passage

He wandered off, a defeated hero.

Soon, Tom encountered the village's young outcast, Huckleberry Finn, the son of the town drunk. Huckleberry was deeply disliked and feared by all the local mothers because he was lazy, lawless, vulgar, and wicked—and because all their children admired him, loved his forbidden company, and wished they had the courage to be like him. Tom was like the other respectable boys in that he envied Huckleberry's flashy life as an outcast and was under strict orders not to play with him. Naturally, he played with him every chance he got. Huckleberry always wore the hand-me-down clothes of grown men, which were perpetually tattered and fluttering with rags. His hat was a massive wreck with a wide crescent cut out of the brim; his coat, when he wore one, hung nearly to his heels with the back buttons positioned far down; a single suspender held up his trousers, which sagged in the seat and were empty, their frayed legs dragging in the dirt unless rolled up.

Huckleberry came and went as he pleased. He slept on doorsteps in good weather and in empty barrels when it rained; he didn't have to attend school or church, answer to any master, or obey anyone. He could go fishing or swimming whenever and wherever he chose, staying as long as he liked; no one stopped him from fighting; he could stay up as late as he wanted; he was always the first boy to go barefoot in the spring and the last to wear shoes in the fall; he never had to wash or wear clean clothes; and he could swear impressively. In short, that boy had everything that makes life worth living. At least, that is what every stressed, restricted, respectable boy in St. Petersburg thought.

Tom called out to the romantic outcast:

"Hello, Huckleberry!"

"Hello yourself, and see how you like it."

"What's that you've got?"

"A dead cat."

"Let me see him, Huck. Wow, he's pretty stiff. Where did you get him?"

"Bought him from a boy."

"What did you give for him?"

"I gave a blue ticket and a bladder I got at the slaughterhouse."

"Where did you get the blue ticket?"

"Bought it from Ben Rogers two weeks ago for a hoop-stick."

"Say—what are dead cats good for, Huck?"

"Good for? Curing warts."

"No! Is that true? I know something better."

"I bet you don't. What is it?"

"Well, spunk-water."

"Spunk-water! I wouldn't give a damn for spunk-water."

"You wouldn't, really? Have you ever tried it?"

"No, I haven't. But Bob Tanner did."

"Who told you that?"

"Well, he told Jeff Thatcher, and Jeff told Johnny Baker, and Johnny told Jim Hollis, and Jim told Ben Rogers, and Ben told a Black man, and the man told me. There now!"

"Well, so what? They'll all lie. At least all of them except the Black man. I don't know him. But I've never seen a Black man who wouldn't lie. Forget it! Now tell me how Bob Tanner did it, Huck."

"Well, he dipped his hand into a rotten stump filled with rainwater."

"In the daytime?"

"Certainly."

"With his face toward the stump?"

"Yes. At least, I think so."

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 107 / E4_107 / condition: paraphrase

Original passage

"Good. You had better try him in his own house. The way shall be prepared for you, and you can see his son first, who is in London. When will you come to London?"

I said (glancing at Joe, who stood looking on, motionless), that I supposed I could come directly.

"First," said Mr. Jaggers, "you should have some new clothes to come in, and they should not be working-clothes. Say this day week. You'll want some money. Shall I leave you twenty guineas?"

He produced a long purse, with the greatest coolness, and counted them out on the table and pushed them over to me. This was the first time he had taken his leg from the chair. He sat astride of the chair when he had pushed the money over, and sat swinging his purse and eyeing Joe.

"Well, Joseph Gargery? You look dumbfounded?"

"I _am_!" said Joe, in a very decided manner.

"It was understood that you wanted nothing for yourself, remember?"

"It were understood," said Joe. "And it are understood. And it ever will be similar according."

"But what," said Mr. Jaggers, swinging his purse,—“what if it was in my instructions to make you a present, as compensation?"

"As compensation what for?" Joe demanded.

"For the loss of his services."

Joe laid his hand upon my shoulder with the touch of a woman. I have often thought him since, like the steam-hammer that can crush a man or pat an egg-shell, in his combination of strength with gentleness. "Pip is that hearty welcome," said Joe, "to go free with his services, to honour and fortune", as no words can tell him. But if you think as Money can make compensation to me for the loss of the little child—what come to the forge—and ever the best of friends!—"

O dear good Joe, whom I was so ready to leave and so unthankful to, I see you again, with your muscular blacksmith's arm before your eyes, and your broad chest heaving, and your voice dying away. O dear good faithful tender Joe, I feel the loving tremble of your hand upon my arm, as solemnly this day as if it had been the rustle of an angel's wing!

But I encouraged Joe at the time. I was lost in the mazes of my future fortunes, and could not retrace the by-paths we had trodden together. I begged Joe to be comforted, for (as he said) we had ever been the best of friends, and (as I said) we ever would be so. Joe scooped his eyes with his disengaged wrist, as if he were bent on gouging himself, but said not another word.

Mr. Jaggers had looked on at this, as one who recognised in Joe the village idiot, and in me his keeper. When it was over, he said, weighing in his hand the purse he had ceased to swing:—

"Now, Joseph Gargery, I warn you this is your last chance. No half measures with me. If you mean to take a present that I have it in charge to make you, speak out, and you shall have it. If on the contrary you mean to say—" Here, to his great amazement, he was stopped by Joe's suddenly working round him with every demonstration of a fell pugilistic purpose.

Rewritten passage

"Excellent. It would be best to test him at his own residence. The path will be cleared for you, and you may meet his son first, who resides in London. When do you intend to arrive in London?"

I replied (casting a look at Joe, who remained standing there, perfectly still), that I imagined I could depart immediately.

"To begin with," Mr. Jagers stated, "you ought to acquire fresh attire for your arrival, and it should not be laboring garments. Let us say this day week. You will require funds. Shall I provide you with twenty guineas?"

He drew out a lengthy purse with absolute composure, tallied the coins upon the table, and slid them toward me. This was the initial moment he had removed his leg from the chair. He sat straddling the seat once he had moved the money, swinging his purse while observing Joe.

"Well, Joseph Gargery? You appear stunned?"

"I am!" Joe declared, in a very firm tone.

"It was agreed that you desired nothing for your own benefit, keep in mind?"

"It were agreed," Joe replied. "And it are agreed. And it ever will be the same."

"But what," Mr. Jagers inquired, swinging his purse,—“what if my instructions included offering you a gift, by way of compensation?"

"Compensation for what?" Joe asked.

"For the forfeiture of his labor."

Joe placed his hand upon my shoulder with a woman's gentleness. I have frequently thought of him since as resembling a steam-hammer capable of crushing a man or tapping an eggshell, in his blend of power and tenderness. "Pip is most welcome," Joe said, "to depart freely with his services, toward honor and fortune, in ways no words can express. But if you imagine that money can compensate me for the loss of the little child—who arrived at the forge—and was always the best of friends!—"

Oh dear, kind Joe, whom I was so prepared to abandon and so ungrateful toward, I behold you once more, with your powerful blacksmith's arm covering your eyes, your broad chest rising and falling, and your voice fading away. Oh dear, kind, loyal, tender Joe, I sense the affectionate tremor of your hand upon my arm, as solemnly today as if it were the rustle of an angel's wing!

Yet I urged Joe to be heartened at the time. I was consumed by the complexities of my future prospects and could not revisit the paths we had walked together. I implored Joe to find comfort, for (as he noted) we had always been the best of friends, and (as I noted) we always would be. Joe wiped his eyes with his free wrist, as if he intended to gouge himself, but uttered nothing further.

Mr. Jagers had observed this, like a man who identified Joe as the village simpleton and me as his guardian. When it concluded, he remarked, balancing the purse he had stopped swinging in his hand:—

"Now, Joseph Gargery, I caution you that this is your final opportunity. No half-measures with me. If you intend to accept a gift that I am authorized to offer, speak plainly, and it shall be yours. If, conversely, you intend to say—" Here, to his profound astonishment, he was interrupted by Joe suddenly circling him with every indication of a fierce pugilistic intent.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____

Item 108 / E4_108 / condition: simplify

Original passage

The picture had not changed. It was folly to think so.

Yet it was watching him, with its beautiful marred face and its cruel smile. Its bright hair gleamed in the early sunlight. Its blue eyes met his own. A sense of infinite pity, not for himself, but for the painted image of himself, came over him. It had altered already, and would alter more. Its gold would wither into grey. Its red and white roses would die. For every sin that he committed, a stain would fleck and wreck its fairness. But he would not sin. The picture, changed or unchanged, would be to him the visible emblem of conscience. He would resist temptation. He would not see Lord Henry any more—would not, at any rate, listen to those subtle poisonous theories that in Basil Hallward's garden had first stirred within him the passion for impossible things. He would go back to Sibyl Vane, make her amends, marry her, try to love her again. Yes, it was his duty to do so. She must have suffered more than he had. Poor child! He had been selfish and cruel to her. The fascination that she had exercised over him would return. They would be happy together. His life with her would be beautiful and pure.

He got up from his chair and drew a large screen right in front of the portrait, shuddering as he glanced at it. "How horrible!" he murmured to himself, and he walked across to the window and opened it. When he stepped out on to the grass, he drew a deep breath. The fresh morning air seemed to drive away all his sombre passions. He thought only of Sibyl. A faint echo of his love came back to him. He repeated her name over and over again. The birds that were singing in the dew-drenched garden seemed to be telling the flowers about her.

CHAPTER VIII.

It was long past noon when he awoke. His valet had crept several times on tiptoe into the room to see if he was stirring, and had wondered what made his young master sleep so late. Finally his bell sounded, and Victor came in softly with a cup of tea, and a pile of letters, on a small tray of old Sevres china, and drew back the olive-satin curtains, with their shimmering blue lining, that hung in front of the three tall windows.

"Monsieur has well slept this morning," he said, smiling.

"What o'clock is it, Victor?" asked Dorian Gray drowsily.

"One hour and a quarter, Monsieur."

How late it was! He sat up, and having sipped some tea, turned over his letters. One of them was from Lord Henry, and had been brought by hand that morning. He hesitated for a moment, and then put it aside. The others he opened listlessly. They contained the usual collection of cards, invitations to dinner, tickets for private views, programmes of charity concerts, and the like that are showered on fashionable young men every morning during the season. There was a rather heavy bill for a chased silver Louis-Quinze toilet-set that he had not yet had the courage to send on to his guardians, who were extremely old-fashioned people and did not realize that we live in an age when unnecessary things are our only necessities; and there were several very courteously worded communications from Jermyn Street money-lenders offering to advance any sum of money at a moment's notice and at the most reasonable rates of interest.

Rewritten passage

The painting had not changed. It was foolish to think it had.

Yet it seemed to watch him with its beautiful, damaged face and cruel smile. Its bright hair shone in the morning sun, and its blue eyes met his. He felt a deep sense of pity, not for himself, but for the painted image. It had already changed, and it would change more. Its gold would fade to grey, and its red and white roses would wither. Every sin he committed would leave a stain that ruined its beauty. But he would not sin. The picture, whether it changed or not, would serve as a visible reminder of his conscience. He would resist temptation. He would no

longer see Lord Henry, or at least he would stop listening to those clever, poisonous ideas that had first sparked his desire for impossible things in Basil Hallward's garden. He would return to Sibyl Vane, make amends, marry her, and try to love her again. Yes, it was his duty. She must have suffered more than he had. Poor girl! He had been selfish and cruel to her. The charm she once held over him would return. They would be happy together. His life with her would be beautiful and pure.

He stood up and pulled a large screen in front of the portrait, shuddering as he looked at it. "How horrible!" he whispered to himself. He walked to the window and opened it. Stepping out onto the grass, he took a deep breath. The fresh morning air seemed to clear away his dark moods. He thought only of Sibyl. A faint echo of his love returned. He repeated her name over and over. The birds singing in the dew-covered garden seemed to be telling the flowers about her.

CHAPTER VIII.

It was well past noon when he woke up. His valet had tiptoed into the room several times to see if he was awake, wondering why his young master was sleeping so late. Finally, his bell rang, and Victor entered quietly with a cup of tea and a stack of letters on a small tray of antique Sevres china. He pulled back the olive-satin curtains, which had shimmering blue linings and hung before the three tall windows.

"Monsieur has slept well this morning," he said with a smile.

"What time is it, Victor?" Dorian Gray asked sleepily.

"It is a quarter past one, Monsieur."

How late it was! He sat up, sipped his tea, and looked through his mail. One letter was from Lord Henry, delivered by hand that morning. He hesitated for a moment, then set it aside. He opened the others without much interest. They were the usual collection of cards, dinner invitations, tickets for private art shows, and programs for charity concerts that fashionable young men receive every morning during the social season. There was a rather expensive bill for a decorated silver Louis-Quinze toilet set. He had not yet had the courage to send it to his guardians, who were very old-fashioned and did not understand that we live in an age where unnecessary things are our only necessities. There were also several polite letters from Jermyn Street money-lenders, offering to loan him any amount of money at a moment's notice at very reasonable interest rates.

Mark your answers

added_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

omitted_facts_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

narrative_order_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

speaker_or_character_relation_change_0_1: ☐ 0 ☐ 1

tone_drift_0_2: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2

meaning_preservation_1_5: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

overall_usable_yes_no: ☐ yes ☐ no

notes: _____
